GNAMMA RESEARCH / BILINGUAL SCHOLARLY READER

الضَّرُورِيُّ فِي أُصُولِ الْفِقْهِ

Al-Ḍarūrī fī uṣūl al-fiqh

Ibn Rushd (Averroes)

Arabic–English parallel reading edition with textual, grammatical and legal apparatus

Base numbering: Jamāl al-Dīn al-ʿAlawī (1994), §§1–258

Manuscript-based control: Ziad Bou Akl, *Averroès : le philosophe et la Loi* (2015), §§1–311

Arabic consonantal text: 1994 base with explicitly signalled 2015 editorial restorations

October 2026 · Model-assisted scholarly work · Not a new manuscript edition

How to read this revised edition

This new Arabic–English parallel document conserves the 258 stable section addresses inherited from the 1994 printed edition. It includes 416 aligned passage units and the separately labelled copyist's notice. Its principal improvements follow comparison with the manuscript-based Arabic edition, facing French translation and research commentary prepared by Ziad Bou Akl (De Gruyter, 2015), and with his later studies.

Typographical policy. Angle brackets ⟨ … ⟩ in Arabic and corresponding English designate conjectural editorial restorations or necessary supplied words; they are not transcribed as independent readings actually verified in the Escorial manuscript. The unvowelled consonantal base is still predominately that of the al-ʿAlawī edition. The fully vocalized Arabic is a modern editorial grammatical interpretation, not a manuscript facsimile. No new inspection of the physical Escorial codex is claimed.

Numbering policy. Two section systems must never be mixed: "R §" means this reader's section, whereas "BA §" means Bou Akl's Arabic/French edition. Bou Akl's Arabic printed page precedes the French facing page. The concordance records both systems; multi-section correspondence sometimes reflects differences in editorial division rather than missing lines. Match confidence is recorded, and three uncertain starts require further hand verification.

Comparison policy. The 2015 volume's text, introduction, commentaries and notes have been examined at selected high-impact passage loci, and a complete 258-section opening alignment is provided. Systematic word-by-word French-to-English comparison of every sentence, a full classification of every minor printed variant, and fresh manuscript collation are distinct tasks and are *not* claimed complete here. The resulting English rendering is an original translation, not a translation of Bou Akl's protected French text. See the full revised audit for all tracked changes.

Scope. The edition includes original critical notes and contextual lexical entries, selected applications in the *Bidāya*, a concept index and the full 258/311 concordance. Relevant notes explicitly identify where competing arguments from al-Ghazālī, al-Fārābī and the later *Bidāya* influence interpretation.

NAVIGATION

Contents and section concordance

Click a section to jump to its Arabic–English text.

R §001 / BA §1 · Purpose, brevity, and the craft of legal reasoning

R §002 / BA §2 · Three kinds of knowledge: belief, action, and rules of inquiry

R §003 / BA §3 · Why later jurists need an explicit method

R §004 / BA §4 · Implicit competence and induction from early legal opinions

R §005 / BA §5 · The four parts of the discipline

R §006 / BA §5–7 · The proper subject of uṣūl and a comparative method

R §007 / BA §8 · Retaining al-Ghazālī's arrangement

R §008 / BA §9 · The introductory questions a learner needs

R §009 / BA §10 · Why the logical prolegomenon is omitted

R §010 / BA §11 · Definition, divisions, elements, and manifestation of rulings

R §011 / BA §12–14 · Revealed judgement and intrinsic or relational goodness

R §012 / BA §15 · Why general acceptance does not establish rational necessity

R §013 / BA §16–17 · The obligation to inquire and the challenge to revealed authority

R §014 / BA §18 · An objection from infinite regress

R §015 / BA §19 · Miracles, assent, and necessary knowledge

R §016 / BA §20 · The status of acts before revelation

R §017 / BA §21–24 · The five rulings and the distinction between farḍ and wājib

R §018 / BA §25 · Obligations with alternatives and extended times

R §019 / BA §26 · Alternative duties, welfare, and divine foreknowledge

R §020 / BA §27 · Legal examples suffice without resolving the metaphysics

R §021 / BA §28–29 · When does an extended-time obligation become binding?

R §022 / BA §29 · Intention distinguishes postponement from abandonment

R §023 / BA §30–31 · Necessary means and the minimum sufficient performance

R §024 / BA §32 · From definitions to universal questions

R §025 / BA §33 · Death during the time and reasonable postponement

R §026 / BA §34 · Abrogation of obligation and the logic of opposites

R §027 / BA §35 · Is the permissible commanded or legally burdensome?

R §028 / BA §36–37 · Can one act be obligatory and forbidden in different respects?

R §029 / BA §38 · Prohibitive wording versus a qualified prohibition's meaning

R §030 / BA §38 · A methodological objection to the placement of the question

R §031 / BA §39–40 · Forbidden places of prayer and prayer on usurped land

R §032 / BA §41 · Does a ruling about an act determine its contrary?

R §033 / BA §41 · Legal contrariety versus physical incompatibility

R §034 / BA §42 · When prohibiting one contrary obliges the other

R §035 / BA §43 · Conclusion of the classification of rulings

R §036 / BA §44 · The three elements of a legal judgement

R §037 / BA §45 · Divine authority and delegated human obedience

R §038 / BA §46–48 · Understanding the address: children and impaired reason

R §039 / BA §48 · A defective reading about partial intoxication

R §040 / BA §48 · Addressing the sober about later intoxication

R §041 / BA §49 · Eternal command and the limits of the present discipline

R §042 / BA §50 · Puberty as a practical legal sign

R §043 / BA §51 · The voluntary act and intention of obedience

R §044 / BA §51–53 · Choice, necessary assent, and the will to obey

R §045 / BA §54–55 · Human agency and the impossibility of burdens beyond capacity

R §046 / BA §56 · Further questions concerning responsible action

R §047 / BA §57–58 · Coercion, intention, and degrees of harm

R §048 / BA §59 · Active restraint and mere non-performance

R §049 / BA §60–61 · Commands before fulfilment of their conditions

R §050 / BA §62 · Legal conditions are not conditions of physical possibility

R §051 / BA §63 · Conversion, apostasy, and a distinct command to make up acts

R §052 / BA §64 · No demand to combine or abandon exhaustive contraries

R §053 / BA §64–66 · Hard cases: usurped fields and unavoidable injury

R §054 / BA §67 · Manifesting causes and the attributes of rulings

R §055 / BA §68 · Legal signs and perceptible causes

R §056 / BA §69–70 · Validity in worship and the validity of contracts

R §057 / BA §71–72 · Timely performance, repetition, and making up

R §058 / BA §73 · The traveller's fast: concession or an alternative duty?

R §059 / BA §74 · Does an expectation of death shorten the prescribed time?

R §060 / BA §75 · Original requirements and concessions under necessity

R §061 / BA §76 · The first part concluded

R §062 / BA §77 · The four sources and original negation

R §063 / BA §78 · Divine speech and the bounds of theological inquiry

R §064 / BA §79–81 · The Qur'ānic corpus, variant additions, and the basmala

R §065 / BA §82–84 · Literal, figurative, arabicized, and ambiguous expressions

R §066 / BA §85 · The authority of the Sunna and the routes of transmission

R §067 / BA §86 · First rank: explicit attestation of direct hearing

R §068 / BA §87 · Second rank: "The Messenger said"

R §069 / BA §88 · Third rank: reporting a command rather than its wording

R §070 / BA §89 · How linguistic usage is established

R §071 / BA §90 · Fourth rank: "We were commanded" and "It is Sunna"

R §072 / BA §91 · Fifth rank: practices in the Prophet's lifetime

R §073 / BA §92 · The reporting formulas concluded

R §074 / BA §93 · The degrees of assent yielded by transmission

R §075 / BA §94–95 · Recurrent transmission: certainty without a fixed number

R §076 / BA §96–97 · How premises produce assent, even when unarticulated

R §077 / BA §97–98 · Sensory actuality, contextual evidence, and common legal knowledge

R §078 / BA §99 · The conditions of certainty from mass transmission

R §079 / BA §100 · Can a solitary report ever produce certainty?

R §080 / BA §101 · Four questions governing solitary reports

R §081 / BA §102–104 · The rational and legal warrant for acting on a solitary report

R §082 / BA §105–106 · Does the command to warn establish the duty to accept a report?

R §083 / BA §107–108 · One transmitter need not satisfy the numerical rules of testimony

R §084 / BA §109 · Hearing in childhood and transmitting after puberty

R §085 / BA §110–111 · Accurate retention, religious identity, and transmission

R §086 / BA §112 · Probity as a disposition rather than a mere label

R §087 / BA §112 · How much moral integrity must a transmitter possess?

R §088 / BA §113 · Unknown character and the presumption of trustworthiness

R §089 / BA §113 · The Bedouin's crescent testimony and an uncertain printed reading

R §090 / BA §114 · Probity aims at probable truthfulness, not an arbitrary threshold

R §091 / BA §115 · Wrongdoing based on interpretation and the acceptance of reports

R §092 / BA §115 · Probable wrongdoing: the example of disputed nabīdh

R §093 / BA §116 · Minimum conditions differ from grounds of preference

R §094 / BA §117 · Four questions about criticism and attestation

R §095 / BA §117 · How many people must attest a narrator's probity?

R §096 / BA §118 · Stating grounds and resolving conflicting evaluations

R §097 / BA §119 · What conduct counts as an attestation of probity?

R §098 / BA §120 · The majority position on the Companions' probity

R §099 / BA §121 · The civil wars and interpretive error

R §100 / BA §122 · Five levels of receiving a report

R §101 / BA §123 · Hearing the teacher read

R §102 / BA §124 · Reading before a silent teacher

R §103 / BA §125 · Authorization without a reading

R §104 / BA §126 · Handing over a book with permission to transmit it

R §105 / BA §127 · Handwriting, accurate copies, and acting without direct hearing

R §106 / BA §128–129 · The narrator's certainty is not the recipient's probability

R §107 / BA §130 · When a teacher denies or forgets a report

R §108 / BA §131 · An addition reported by one reliable narrator

R §109 / BA §132 · Reporting meaning: synonymy and translation

R §110 / BA §133–134 · Why an independent jurist needs the Lawgiver's wording

R §111 / BA §135 · Omitted links, connected chains, and "from" formulae

R §112 / BA §136 · Solitary reports concerning matters of widespread need

R §113 / BA §137 · Neither universal acceptance nor universal rejection is justified

R §114 / BA §138 · Both Qurʾān and Sunna are subject to abrogation

R §115 / BA §139 · Does abrogation remove a ruling or reveal its time limit?

R §116 / BA §140–141 · What the jurist needs to know about abrogation

R §117 / BA §142 · Removing a part, a condition, or a recommended observance

R §118 / BA §143 · When an addition changes the identity of an obligation

R §119 / BA §144 · Abrogation without a substitute

R §120 / BA §145 · Replacing a lighter duty with a heavier one

R §121 / BA §146 · Abrogating recitation, ruling, or both—and the demand for proof

R §122 / BA §147 · Consensus reveals earlier abrogation but cannot itself abrogate

R §123 / BA §148 · The unequal force of reports during and after the Prophet's life

R §124 / BA §149 · May mass-transmitted Sunna abrogate the Qurʾān?

R §125 / BA §149 · Certainty itself can admit degrees

R §126 / BA §150–151 · Analogy may clarify a text but may not repeal it

R §127 / BA §152 · A Companion's assertion of abrogation needs a transmitted basis

R §128 / BA §153 · Conditions implicit in the definition of abrogation

R §129 / BA §154 · How the later of two conflicting texts is established

R §130 / BA §156 · Consensus as certainty beyond surviving explicit texts

R §131 / BA §157 · Cumulative scriptural evidence for the authority of consensus

R §132 / BA §158 · Why consensus is not merely a rational inference from numbers

R §133 / BA §159 · Why lay agreement adds no independent proof

R §134 / BA §160 · All qualified jurists of one age, not every age

R §135 / BA §161 · Can later agreement override an earlier disagreement?

R §136 / BA §162 · Why the Ẓāhirīs restrict consensus to the Companions

R §137 / BA §163–164 · Unanimity, majority, and the evidential limits of silence

R §138 / BA §165 · Medinan practice must be traced as transmission

R §139 / BA §166 · Must an agreeing generation die out before consensus binds?

R §140 / BA §167 · The essential account is enough to understand further objections

R §141 / BA §168 · Original freedom from liability and the burden of proof

R §142 / BA §169–170 · Five forms of continuity and the problem of a changed subject

R §143 / BA §171 · Conclusion of the four sources

R §144 / BA §172 · A Companion's opinion attracts weight but is not infallible

R §145 / BA §173 · Earlier revealed laws are not an independent source

R §146 / BA §174 · Preference and welfare require a recognized legal warrant

R §147 / BA §175 · Conclusion of Part Two

R §148 / BA §176 · The distinctive task: understanding prophetic indications

R §149 / BA §176 · Verbal form and intelligible import

R §150 / BA §176 · Action and approval as nonverbal indications

R §151 / BA §177 · Four classes of verbal indication

R §152 / BA §178 · Simple expressions, compounds, and complete utterances

R §153 / BA §179–181 · Original assignment, transfer, and specialized legal usage

R §154 / BA §182 · Omission, addition, and substitution in figurative speech

R §155 / BA §182 · Clarity and obscurity arise from meaning as well as form

R §156 / BA §183 · A classification useful for legal inference

R §157 / BA §184 · Unambiguous expressions and determinate pronoun reference

R §158 / BA §185 · Equivocation: qurʾ, ʿayn, and the marriage bond

R §159 / BA §186 · Clarification encompasses every valid means of understanding

R §160 / BA §187–188 · May clarification be delayed when action is required?

R §161 / BA §189 · How speakers rely on context and hearers seek clarification

R §162 / BA §190 · A figurative meaning needs an intelligible indication

R §163 / BA §191–194 · Partial knowledge can precede a more specific explanation

R §164 / BA §196 · Transfer through resemblance, relation, and indirect expression

R §165 / BA §197 · Substituting a universal for a particular, or the reverse

R §166 / BA §198–199 · Why apparent meanings bind and interpretation needs proportionate proof

R §167 / BA §200–202 · Three degrees: clothing, the balance, and touching women

R §168 / BA §203 · Established usage, ambiguity, and certain interpretation

R §169 / BA §204 · General meaning is a real feature of language

R §170 / BA §205–206 · Forms of generality and their unequal apparent force

R §171 / BA §207 · A remote restriction of the guardian-permission report

R §172 / BA §208 · Restricting the requirement of a nightly fasting intention

R §173 / BA §209 · Does the tithe report include vegetables?

R §174 / BA §210 · General wording with a known or unknown specific intention

R §175 / BA §211 · Disputed boundaries of generality

R §176 / BA §212 · A particular occasion does not confine a general answer

R §177 / BA §213 · Equivocation is not the generality of a universal

R §178 / BA §214 · Who is included by “people” and by a masculine plural?

R §179 / BA §215 · Can a plural be restricted below its minimum?

R §180 / BA §216 · Three is the normal plural; two or one requires a clue

R §181 / BA §217–218 · Specification or contradiction? The importance of chronology

R §182 / BA §219 · Specific evidence can govern without a known chronological order

R §183 / BA §220 · Why an exception must accompany its statement

R §184 / BA §221 · Connected and disconnected exceptions; one or several sentences

R §185 / BA §222 · How can an exception belong to another genus?

R §186 / BA §223 · A disconnected exception belongs to the understood wider meaning

R §187 / BA §224 · How far does an exception reach over coordinated clauses?

R §188 / BA §225 · An exception larger than the remainder

R §189 / BA §226 · Unqualified and qualified wording in the same or different contexts

R §190 / BA §227 · From general to specific expressions

R §191 / BA §228–233 · Specific expressions may stand for an intended universal

R §192 / BA §234 · From verbal form to understood meaning

R §193 / BA §235 · Context determines the force of an implied meaning

R §194 / BA §236–239 · Omitted meanings: villagers, marriage, fasting, and a prayer cycle

R §195 / BA §240–241 · Description, condition, restriction, and endpoint

R §196 / BA §242 · From assertions to prescriptions

R §197 / BA §243 · Command, request, and supplication depend on the relation of speakers

R §198 / BA §244 · Questions about obligation, timing, and repetition

R §199 / BA §244 · Linguistic convention and legal usage must be distinguished

R §200 / BA §245–247 · The imperative’s legal force must be learned from revelation

R §201 / BA §247–248 · Neither timing nor repetition follows from the form alone

R §202 / BA §249 · Further questions about command forms

R §203 / BA §250 · A command after prohibition may merely remove the restriction

R §204 / BA §251 · Does making up a timed observance need a new command?

R §205 / BA §252 · Compliance discharges a duty only when all its conditions are met

R §206 / BA §253 · Does prohibition entail invalidity?

R §207 / BA §253 · Returning to the earlier account of the forbidden

R §208 / BA §254 · Absolute prohibition and dislike: the need for an indication

R §209 / BA §255 · From commands to the contextual indications called qiyās

R §210 / BA §256–257 · The jurists’ definition of analogy: original, derivative and ground

R §211 / BA §258 · Nonexistence, negation and the scope of the definition

R §212 / BA §259–260 · Most legal qiyās is substitution within an understood meaning

R §213 / BA §261 · What warrants substitution: relevant contextual indications

R §214 / BA §262 · Certain, probable and indeterminate extensions

R §215 / BA §263 · The stronger case: a fortiori indication

R §216 / BA §264 · Equal extension: the legal meaning beyond a named individual

R §217 / BA §265–266 · Suitable grounds, recognised goods and the limit of legislation

R §218 / BA §267 · Resemblance and uncertainty about the operative ground

R §219 / BA §268–269 · Analogy in fixed penalties and expiations

R §220 / BA §269 · Testing, division and concomitance

R §221 / BA §270 · Eliminating candidates for the universal meaning

R §222 / BA §271 · Positive and negative concomitance are not enough

R §223 / BA §272–273 · Why much juristic qiyās is not a syllogism

R §224 / BA §273 · Meaning can be apparent without an apparent verbal form

R §225 / BA §274 · The disputed claim of Companion consensus on qiyās

R §226 / BA §275 · The class and limits of qiyās; action and approval remain

R §227 / BA §276 · What tacit approval establishes

R §228 / BA §277 · Actions that explain a revealed command

R §229 / BA §278–279 · Peculiar, unexplained and conflicting Prophetic actions

R §230 / BA §281 · Inquiry, authority and weighing evidence

R §231 / BA §282 · The jurist, the question and the act of inquiry

R §232 / BA §283 · How much Qurʾānic knowledge is required?

R §233 / BA §284 · Hadith competence, collections and transmitter evaluation

R §234 / BA §285 · Consensus and the indispensable knowledge of Arabic

R §235 / BA §286 · Theology and detailed fiqh: what is actually required?

R §236 / BA §287 · Issue-specific independent inquiry

R §237 / BA §288 · Is there a determinate ruling to be found?

R §238 / BA §289 · Essential attributes, Ẓāhirī restraint and determinate rulings

R §239 / BA §290 · Ibn Rushd's answer: discourse determines the ruling

R §240 / BA §291–292 · Al-Ghazālī's first argument for universal correctness

R §241 / BA §293 · Evidence signifies; inclination does not make a ruling

R §242 / BA §294 · Al-Ghazālī's second argument: absence of sin

R §243 / BA §295 · An error can be pardoned without becoming correct

R §244 / BA §296 · Degrees of culpability and the clarity of evidence

R §245 / BA §297 · Attainable truth and merciful pardon

R §246 / BA §298 · Conflict: suspension, caution or free choice?

R §247 / BA §299 · The Ẓāhirī response: return to original nonliability

R §248 / BA §300 · From independent inquiry to following authority

R §249 / BA §301 · Trust, probability and following the Prophet

R §250 / BA §302 · Why juristic expertise is a collective obligation

R §251 / BA §303–304 · May a mujtahid follow a more knowledgeable jurist?

R §252 / BA §305 · Memorised school doctrine is not an independent source

R §253 / BA §306 · Why inherited opinions cannot replace living inquiry

R §254 / BA §307 · No period should lack an active mujtahid

R §255 / BA §308 · The valid and invalid uses of following authority

R §256 / BA §309 · Why an exhaustive catalogue of preferences is unnecessary

R §257 / BA §310 · The obligation to follow the stronger judgement

R §258 / BA §311 · An abridgement completed and supplemented: 552 AH

Scope, method and the sciences

§ 001 Purpose, brevity, and the craft of legal reasoning

1994 Arabic p. 34 · BA §1 · 2015 Arabic p. 118 · French p. 119

أَمَّا بَعْدُ حَمْدًا لِلَّهِ مُعَلِّمِ الْبَيَانِ، وَمُوجِبِ النَّظَرِ وَالِاسْتِدْلَالِ، وَمُخْتَصِّ الْإِنْسَانِ بِإِقَامَةِ الْحُجَجِ الْبَالِغَةِ وَضَرْبِ الْأَمْثَالِ، وَالصَّلَاةُ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ خَاتَمِ الرُّسُلِ وَنِهَايَةِ التَّمَامِ وَالْكَمَالِ، فَإِنَّ غَرَضِي فِي هَذَا الْكِتَابِ أَنْ أُثْبِتَ لِنَفْسِي، عَلَى جِهَةِ التَّذْكِرَةِ، مِنْ كِتَابِ أَبِي حَامِدٍ رَحِمَهُ اللَّهُ فِي أُصُولِ الْفِقْهِ الْمُلَقَّبِ بِالْمُسْتَصْفَى، جُمْلَةً كَافِيَةً بِحَسَبِ الْأَمْرِ الضَّرُورِيِّ فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ، وَنَتَحَرَّى فِي ذَلِكَ أَوْجَزَ الْقَوْلِ وَأَخْصَرَهُ، وَمَا نَظُنُّ بِهِ أَنَّهُ أَكْثَرَ ذَلِكَ صِنَاعِيٌّ. وَقَبْلَ ذَلِكَ فَلْنُقَدِّمْ مُقَدِّمَةً نَافِعَةً فِي غَرَضِ الْعِلْمِ الْمَطْلُوبِ هَا هُنَا وَمَنْفَعَتِهِ فَنَقُولُ:

To proceed, after praising God, who teaches articulate expression, makes inquiry (النظر) and inference (الاستدلال) obligatory, and singles out the human being for establishing conclusive arguments and setting forth examples; and after invoking blessings upon Muḥammad, the seal of the messengers and the culmination of completeness and perfection: my purpose in this book is to set down for myself, as a reminder, a sufficient account of what is necessary in this craft (الصناعة), drawn from Abū Ḥāmid's book on the principles of jurisprudence entitled al-Mustaṣfā—may God have mercy upon him. In doing so we shall seek the briefest and most concise expression, and what seems to us most technically appropriate to this disciplined art. Before this, let us offer a useful introduction concerning the purpose and benefit of the knowledge sought here. We say:

Editorial notes

N001 [grammar] Grammatical note: ḥamdan is editorially read as an accusative expression of praise, whereas wa-l-ṣalātu introduces the blessing. Bou Akl 2015 (Arabic p.118, French p.119, §1) renders akthara dhālika ṣinā‘ī as what is most technically appropriate. The reading is interpretive; neither French nor the proposed English is an independent manuscript witness.

BA15-I01 [interpretive] Book title and method. The 2015 textual introduction (pp.107–116) documents the historical titles Mukhtaṣar al-Mustaṣfā and al-Ḍarūrī, an Escorial unique manuscript, and a 552 AH authorial colophon. The French introduction pp.3–9 situates this among Ibn Rushd’s early compendia; neither “abridgement” nor “necessary” reduces the project to simple summary.

§ 002 Three kinds of knowledge: belief, action, and rules of inquiry

1994 Arabic p. 34 & 35 · BA §2 · 2015 Arabic p. 118 · French p. 119

إِنَّ الْمَعَارِفَ وَالْعُلُومَ ثَلَاثَةُ أَصْنَافٍ: إِمَّا مَعْرِفَةٌ غَايَتُهَا الِاعْتِقَادُ الْحَاصِلُ عَنْهَا فِي النَّفْسِ فَقَطْ، كَالْعِلْمِ بِحَدَثِ الْعَالَمِ، وَالْقَوْلِ بِالْجُزْءِ الَّذِي لَا يَتَجَزَّأُ وَأَشْبَاهِ ذَلِكَ. وَإِمَّا مَعْرِفَةٌ غَايَتُهَا الْعَمَلُ، وَهَذِهِ مِنْهَا كُلِّيَّةٌ وَبَعِيدَةٌ فِي كَوْنِهَا مُفِيدَةً لِلْعَمَلِ، وَمِنْهَا جُزْئِيَّةٌ وَقَرِيبَةٌ فِي كَوْنِهَا مُفِيدَةً لِلْعَمَلِ.

Forms of knowledge and the sciences are of three kinds. There is knowledge whose end is simply the belief it produces in the soul: for example, knowledge that the world has come into being, the doctrine of the indivisible part, and similar matters. There is knowledge whose end is action. Some of this is universal (كلية), and its benefit for action is indirect, while another part is particular

فَالْجُزْئِيَّةُ كَالْعِلْمِ بِأَحْكَامِ الصَّلَاةِ وَالزَّكَاةِ وَمَا أَشْبَهَهُمَا مِنْ جُزْئِيَّاتِ الْفَرَائِضِ وَالسُّنَنِ. وَالْكُلِّيَّةُ كَالْعِلْمِ بِالْأُصُولِ الَّتِي تُبْنَى عَلَيْهَا هَذِهِ الْفُرُوعُ مِنَ الْكِتَابِ وَالسُّنَّةِ وَالْإِجْمَاعِ، وَالْعِلْمِ بِالْأَحْكَامِ الْحَاصِلَةِ عَنْ هَذِهِ الْأُصُولِ عَلَى الْإِطْلَاقِ وَأَقْسَامِهَا، وَمَا يَلْحَقُهَا مِنْ حَيْثُ هِيَ أَحْكَامٌ.

(جزئية) and its benefit for action is more direct. Particular knowledge includes knowledge of the rulings governing prayer and almsgiving, and similar particular obligatory and customary observances. Universal knowledge includes knowledge of the principles on which these branches are built—the Book, the Sunna, and consensus—and knowledge of the rulings derived from these principles in general, their divisions, and what attaches to them insofar as they are rulings (أحكام).

وَإِمَّا مَعْرِفَةٌ تُعْطِي الْقَوَانِينَ وَالْأَحْوَالَ الَّتِي بِهَا يَتَسَدَّدُ الذِّهْنُ نَحْوَ الصَّوَابِ فِي هَاتَيْنِ الْمَعْرِفَتَيْنِ، كَالْعِلْمِ بِالدَّلَائِلِ وَأَقْسَامِهَا، وَبِأَيِّ أَحْوَالٍ تَكُونُ دَلَائِلَ وَبِأَيِّهَا لَا، وَفِي أَيِّ الْمَوَاضِعِ تُسْتَعْمَلُ النُّقْلَةُ مِنَ الشَّاهِدِ إِلَى الْغَائِبِ وَفِي أَيِّهَا لَا. وَهَذِهِ فَلْنُسَمِّهَا سِبَارًا وَقَانُونًا، فَإِنَّ نِسْبَتَهَا إِلَى الذِّهْنِ كَنِسْبَةِ الْبَرْكَارِ وَالْمِسْطَرَةِ إِلَى الْحِسِّ فِي مَا لَا يُؤْمَنُ أَنْ يُغْلَطَ فِيهِ.

There is also knowledge that provides the rules and conditions through which the mind is guided towards correctness in these two forms of knowledge: for example, knowledge of indications (الدلائل) and their divisions, of the conditions under which they are indications and those under which they are not, and of the cases in which the passage from the observed to the unobserved is employed and those in which it is not. Let us call this a probe and a rule. Its relation to the mind is like that of the compass and straightedge to sense perception in matters where error cannot be ruled out.

Editorial notes

N002 [textual] Escorial manuscript as recorded and printed by Bou Akl (2015, BA §2, Arabic p.118; manuscript [أ] versus al-ʿAlawī [ع] in the apparatus) preserves ومنها جزئية وقريبة في كونها مفيدة للعمل after the universal class. The al-ʿAlawī 1994 edition omitted this entire balancing clause. The present revised Arabic restores the manuscript-attested words, not a conjecture. Editorial vocalization follows the restored syntax.

N003 [lexical] سِبَار, "probe," follows the classical instrument sense recorded under سبر in Ibn Manẓūr's Lisān al-ʿArab; the adjoining compass and straightedge comparison supports that sense. It is not the name of philosophy. Lexical control: https://www.islamweb.net/ar/library/content/122/3680/سبر

BA001 [scholarship] Rudolph's examination of this passage, explicitly indebted to Bou Akl's 2015 edition, proposes a double disciplinary reading: theoretical/practical/instrumental knowledge is meaningful both for kalām/uṣūl/fiqh and for natural-theoretical/practical/logical arts. The comparison does not turn Ibn Rushd's instrumental knowledge into demonstrative logic exclusively. Control: Ulrich Rudolph, "Al-Ghazālī on Philosophy and Jurisprudence," in Adamson (ed.), Philosophy and Jurisprudence in the Islamic World (2019), p. 72, referring to Bou Akl 2015, Arabic p. 118, French p. 119. No independent 2015 page collation has been performed.

BA15-I02 [interpretive] Scientific architecture. Bou Akl 2015 intro pp.7–9 distinguishes theoretical, practical-universal, practical-particular and instrumental knowledge. The instrumental third book guides interpretation of already given discourse; it is comparable to logic but is not identical with demonstrative syllogistic.

BA15-V002 [textual] 2015 full-edition control completed for R §2 = Bou Akl §2, Arabic p.118, French p.119. Distinguish manuscript-attested changes as detailed in the preceding notes. See the source-verified change ledger for exact old and new Arabic/English strings.

§ 003 Why later jurists need an explicit method

1994 Arabic p. 35 · BA §3 · 2015 Arabic p. 120 · French p. 121

It is clear that the more ramified the sciences become, and the more those investigating them must resort, in order to apprehend them, to matters to which their predecessors did not have to resort, the greater their need for rules that protect their minds during inquiry.

وَبَيِّنٌ أَنَّهُ كُلَّمَا كَانَتِ الْعُلُومُ أَكْثَرَ تَشَعُّبًا، وَالنَّاظِرُونَ فِيهَا مُضْطَرُّونَ فِي الْوُقُوفِ عَلَيْهَا إِلَى أُمُورٍ لَمْ يُضْطَرَّ إِلَيْهَا مَنْ تَقَدَّمَهُمْ، كَانَتِ الْحَاجَةُ فِيهَا إِلَى قَوَانِينَ تَحُوطُ أَذْهَانَهُمْ عِنْدَ النَّظَرِ فِيهَا أَكْثَرَ.

It is also clear that the craft called jurisprudence (الفقه), both at present and in the past since the death of God's Messenger—God bless him and grant him peace—the dispersal of his Companions through the lands, and the divergence of what was transmitted from him—God bless him and grant him peace—exhibits these two conditions. For this reason the Companions—may God be pleased with them—had no need of this craft, just as the Bedouin Arabs had no need of rules to protect them in their speech or their metres.

وَبَيِّنٌ أَنَّ الصِّنَاعَةَ الْمَوْسُومَةَ بِصِنَاعَةِ الْفِقْهِ فِي هَذَا الزَّمَانِ وَفِي مَا سَلَفَ مِنْ لَدُنْ وَفَاةِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ وَتَفَرُّقِ أَصْحَابِهِ عَلَى الْبِلَادِ وَاخْتِلَافِ النَّقْلِ عَنْهُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ بِهَاتَيْنِ الْحَالَتَيْنِ، وَلِذَلِكَ لَمْ يَحْتَجِ الصَّحَابَةُ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمْ إِلَى هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ كَمَا لَمْ يَحْتَجِ الْأَعْرَابُ إِلَى قَوَانِينَ تَحُوطُهُمْ فِي كَلَامِهِمْ وَلَا فِي أَوْزَانِهِمْ.

§ 004 Implicit competence and induction from early legal opinions

1994 Arabic p. 36 · BA §4 · 2015 Arabic p. 120 · French p. 121

What we have said makes the purpose of this craft intelligible and disposes of the objection that the people of the earliest generation did not investigate it. We do not, however, deny that they employed its capacity: you can discern this from their legal opinions—may God be pleased with them. Indeed, many of the universal notions (المعاني الكلية) laid down in this craft were established only by induction (الاستقراء) from their legal opinions, case by case.

وَبِهَذَا الَّذِي قُلْنَاهُ يَنْفَهِمُ غَرَضُ هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ، وَيَسْقُطُ الِاعْتِرَاضُ عَلَيْهَا بِأَنْ لَمْ يَكُنْ أَهْلُ الصَّدْرِ الْمُتَقَدِّمِ نَاظِرِينَ فِيهَا، وَإِنْ كُنَّا لَا نُنْكِرُ أَنَّهُمْ كَانُوا يَسْتَعْمِلُونَ قُوَّتَهَا، وَأَنْتَ تَتَبَيَّنُ ذَلِكَ مِنْ فَتَاوَاهُمْ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمْ، بَلْ كَثِيرٌ مِنَ الْمَعَانِي الْكُلِّيَّةِ الْمَوْضُوعَةِ فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ إِنَّمَا صُحِّحَتْ بِالِاسْتِقْرَاءِ مِنْ فَتَاوَاهُمْ فِي مَسْأَلَةٍ مَسْأَلَةٍ.

§ 005 The four parts of the discipline

1994 Arabic p. 36 · BA §5 · 2015 Arabic p. 120 · French p. 121

The parts of this craft, according to its division in this book, are four. The first part comprises inquiry into rulings (الأحكام); the second, into the sources of rulings; the third, into the proofs (الأدلة) employed to derive each ruling from its respective source, and how they are employed.

فَأَمَّا أَجْزَاءُ هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ بِحَسَبِ مَا قُسِّمَتْ إِلَيْهِ فِي هَذَا الْكِتَابِ فَأَرْبَعَةُ أَجْزَاءٍ: فَالْجُزْءُ الْأَوَّلُ يَتَضَمَّنُ النَّظَرَ فِي الْأَحْكَامِ، وَالثَّانِي فِي أُصُولِ الْأَحْكَامِ، وَالثَّالِثُ فِي الْأَدِلَّةِ الْمُسْتَعْمَلَةِ فِي اسْتِنْبَاطِ حُكْمٍ حُكْمٍ عَنْ أَصْلٍ أَصْلٍ، وَكَيْفَ

اسْتِعْمَالُهَا. وَالرَّابِعُ يَتَضَمَّنُ النَّظَرَ فِي شُرُوطِ الْمُجْتَهِدِ وَهُوَ الْفَقِيهُ.

The fourth comprises inquiry into the qualifications of the practitioner of independent judgement (المجتهد), who is the jurist.

Editorial notes

N004 [translation] ‘This book’ here refers to al-Mustaṣfā, as the editor explains on printed p. 36.

§ 006 The proper subject of uṣūl and a comparative method

1994 Arabic p. 36 & 37 · BA §5–7 · 2015 Arabic p. 120 · French p. 121

وَأَنْتَ تَعْلَمُ مِمَّا تَقَدَّمَ مِنْ قَوْلِنَا فِي غَرَضِ هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ، وَفِي أَيِّ جِنْسٍ مِنْ أَجْنَاسِ الْعُلُومِ هِيَ دَاخِلَةٌ، أَنَّ النَّظَرَ الْخَاصَّ بِهَا إِنَّمَا هُوَ فِي الْجُزْءِ الثَّالِثِ مِنْ هَذَا الْكِتَابِ، لِأَنَّ الْأَجْزَاءَ الْأُخْرَى مِنْ جِنْسِ الْمَعْرِفَةِ الَّتِي غَايَتُهَا الْعَمَلُ، وَلِذَلِكَ لَقَّبُوا هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةَ بِاسْمِ بَعْضِ مَا جَعَلُوهُ جُزْءًا لَهَا، فَدَعَوْهَا بِأُصُولِ الْفِقْهِ. وَالنَّظَرُ الصِّنَاعِيُّ يَقْتَضِي أَنْ يُفْرَدَ الْقَوْلُ فِي هَذَا الْجُزْءِ الثَّالِثِ إِذْ هُوَ مُبَايِنٌ بِالْجِنْسِ لِتِلْكَ الْأَجْزَاءِ الْأُخْرَى، وَيُقْتَصَرَ مِنْ تِلْكَ عَلَى أَحَدِ أَمْرَيْنِ: إِمَّا أَنْ تُوضَعَ بِحَسَبِ أَشْهَرِ الْمَذَاهِبِ فِيهَا، وَهُوَ مَا يَرَاهُ مَثَلًا أَهْلُ السُّنَّةِ.

From our preceding account of the purpose of this craft and the genus of sciences to which it belongs, you know that its proper inquiry lies only in the third part of this book. The other parts belong to the kind of knowledge whose end is action. Hence they named this craft after some of what they made a part of it, calling it ‘the principles of jurisprudence’ (أصول الفقه). Inquiry conducted according to the requirements of the craft demands that this third part receive a separate treatment, since it differs in genus from those other parts, and that, concerning those, one of two courses alone be adopted. Either they should be posited according to the most widely accepted doctrines concerning them—for example, the views of the People of the Sunna.

وَإِمَّا أَنْ يُرْسَمَ وَيُعَدَّدَ الِاخْتِلَافُ الْوَاقِعُ فِيهَا، وَتُعْطَى الْأَحْوَالُ وَالْقَوَانِينُ الَّتِي بِهَا تُسْتَنْبَطُ الْأَحْكَامُ بِحَسَبِ رَأْيٍ رَأْيٍ فِي تِلْكَ الْأُصُولِ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ كَيْفَ لُزُومُ بَعْضِ تِلْكَ الْآرَاءِ فِيهَا عَنْ بَعْضٍ، وَمُنَاسَبَتُهَا لِلْفُرُوعِ، حَتَّى يُقَالَ مَثَلًا كَيْفَ يَكُونُ الِاسْتِنْبَاطُ عَلَى رَأْيِ الظَّاهِرِيَّةِ وَعَلَى رَأْيِ الْقَائِلِينَ بِالْقِيَاسِ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ بِحَسَبِ رَأْيٍ رَأْيٍ مِنَ الْآرَاءِ الْمَشْهُورَةِ. وَهَذَا الْوَجْهُ هُوَ الْأَنْفَعُ فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ، وَبِهَذَا النَّظَرِ يَكُونُ لِهَذَا الْجِنْسِ مِنَ الْمَعَارِفِ صِنَاعَةٌ تَامَّةٌ وَكُلِّيَّةٌ وَكَافِيَةٌ فِي نَظَرِ الْجَمِيعِ مِنْ أَهْلِ الِاجْتِهَادِ.

Or the disagreements concerning them should be outlined and enumerated, and the conditions and rules provided through which rulings are derived according to each opinion about those principles. This would explain, generally, how some of those opinions follow from others and how they correspond to the branches: one would explain, for example, how derivation proceeds according to the Ẓāhirīs (أهل الظاهر, commonly called Literalists) and according to those who affirm analogy (القياس)—in general, according to each of the widely accepted opinions. This course is more useful in this craft. Through such inquiry this kind of knowledge would possess a craft that is complete, universal, and sufficient for the inquiry of all who practise independent judgement (الاجتهاد).

§ 007 Retaining al-Ghazālī’s arrangement

1994 Arabic p. 37 · BA §8 · 2015 Arabic p. 122 · French p. 123

We have nevertheless decided to follow the customary practice of those who discuss this craft and, in dividing it, to seek the arrangement found in this book, since it is the best considered and the most likely to conform to the requirements of the craft. We shall, however, indicate something of that purpose.

لَكِنْ رَأَيْنَا أَنْ نَجْرِيَ فِي ذَلِكَ عَلَى عَادَةِ الْمُتَكَلِّمِينَ فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ، وَنَتَحَرَّى فِي تَقْسِيمِهَا التَّرْتِيبَ الْوَاقِعَ فِي هَذَا الْكِتَابِ، إِذْ هُوَ أَحْسَنُهَا نَظَرًا وَأَحْرَى أَنْ يَكُونَ صِنَاعِيًّا، غَيْرَ أَنَّنَا سَنُشِيرُ إِلَى شَيْءٍ مِنْ ذَلِكَ الْغَرَضِ.

Editorial notes

N005 [translation] ‘This book’ refers to al-Mustaṣfā; printed p. 37, editor's note. المتكلمين here denotes those discussing the discipline, rather than necessarily theologians as a group.

§ 008 The introductory questions a learner needs

1994 Arabic p. 37 · BA §9 · 2015 Arabic p. 122 · French p. 123

Our preceding account makes clear this book's purpose, its relation to the other sciences, its rank, what its name signifies, and its divisions. These are the general matters that it is useful to present to the learner when beginning the craft. Let us begin where he began.

وَمِمَّا تَقَدَّمَ مِنْ قَوْلِنَا يَتَبَيَّنُ غَرَضُ هَذَا الْكِتَابِ، وَنِسْبَتُهُ إِلَى سَائِرِ الْعُلُومِ، وَمَرْتَبَتُهُ، وَمَا يَدُلُّ عَلَيْهِ اسْمُهُ، وَأَقْسَامُهُ. وَهِيَ الْجُمَلُ النَّافِعُ تَقْدِيمُهَا لِلْمُتَعَلِّمِ عِنْدَ شُرُوعِهِ فِي الصِّنَاعَةِ. وَلْنَبْدَأْ مِنْ حَيْثُ بَدَأَ.

§ 009 Why the logical prolegomenon is omitted

1994 Arabic p. 37 & 38 · BA §10 · 2015 Arabic p. 122 · French p. 123

Before this, Abū Ḥāmid placed a logical introduction. He stated that he was led to discuss it by the inquiry of those treating this craft into certain logical matters, such as their inquiry into the definition of knowledge and other things. For our part, let us leave each thing to its proper place. Anyone who attempts to learn more than one thing at a time will be unable to learn even one of them.

وَأَبُو حَامِدٍ قَدَّمَ قَبْلَ ذَلِكَ مُقَدِّمَةً مَنْطِقِيَّةً زَعَمَ أَنَّهُ أَدَّاهُ إِلَى الْقَوْلِ فِي ذَلِكَ نَظَرُ الْمُتَكَلِّمِينَ فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ فِي أُمُورٍ مَا مَنْطِقِيَّةٍ، كَنَظَرِهِمْ فِي حَدِّ الْعِلْمِ وَغَيْرِ ذَلِكَ. وَنَحْنُ فَلْنَتْرُكْ كُلَّ شَيْءٍ إِلَى مَوْضِعِهِ، فَإِنَّ مَنْ رَامَ أَنْ يَتَعَلَّمَ أَشْيَاءَ أَكْثَرَ مِنْ وَاحِدٍ فِي وَقْتٍ وَاحِدٍ لَمْ يُمْكِنْهُ أَنْ يَتَعَلَّمَ وَلَا وَاحِدًا مِنْهَا.

Rulings, obligation and legal responsibility

§ 010 Definition, divisions, elements, and manifestation of rulings

1994 Arabic p. 39 & 41 · BA §11 · 2015 Arabic p. 124 · French p. 125

This first part is divided into four sections: inquiry into the definition of a ruling (الحكم), its divisions, its constituent elements, and what manifests it.

وَهَذَا الْجُزْءُ الْأَوَّلُ يَنْقَسِمُ إِلَى أَرْبَعَةِ أَقْسَامٍ: وَهِيَ النَّظَرُ فِي حَدِّ الْحُكْمِ، وَفِي أَقْسَامِهِ، وَفِي أَرْكَانِهِ، وَفِي مُظْهِرِهِ.

§ 011 Revealed judgement and intrinsic or relational goodness

1994 Arabic p. 41 & 42 · BA §12–14 · 2015 Arabic p. 124 · French p. 125

According to the People of the Sunna, a ruling (الحكم) is defined as the address of the Law (خطاب الشرع) when it concerns the acts of legally responsible persons by requiring an act or its omission. Where this address has not occurred, no characterization as good or bad attaches to acts; on this account, goodness and badness are not intrinsic attributes of acts.

أَمَّا حَدُّ الْحُكْمِ عِنْدَ أَهْلِ السُّنَّةِ فَهُوَ عِبَارَةٌ عَنْ خِطَابِ الشَّرْعِ إِذَا تَعَلَّقَ بِأَفْعَالِ الْمُكَلَّفِينَ بِطَلَبٍ أَوْ تَرْكٍ. فَإِذَا لَمْ يَرِدْ هَذَا الْخِطَابُ لَمْ تَتَعَلَّقْ بِالْأَفْعَالِ صِفَةُ تَحْسِينٍ أَوْ تَقْبِيحٍ، فَيَكُونُ الْحُسْنُ وَالْقُبْحُ عَلَى هَذَا لَيْسَ وَصْفًا ذَاتِيًّا لِلْأَفْعَالِ.

The Mu‘tazilites held that goodness and badness are intrinsic attributes of acts. Some are apprehended through rational necessity, as with lying and thanking a benefactor; others, with the Law's assistance, as with ritual purification and prayer, because of, for example, the utterance that restrains indecency and the cleanliness they involve. The benefit of knowing this disagreement within this craft becomes apparent when investigating analogy from a suitable, plausible ground (القياس المناسب والمخيل), with all its kinds, and when investigating whether those exercising independent judgement are correct or mistaken.

وَذَهَبَتِ الْمُعْتَزِلَةُ إِلَى أَنَّ الْحُسْنَ وَالْقُبْحَ وَصْفٌ ذَاتِيٌّ لِلْأَفْعَالِ، فَبَعْضُ ذَلِكَ مُدْرَكٌ بِضَرُورَةِ الْعَقْلِ كَالْكَذِبِ وَشُكْرِ الْمُنْعِمِ، وَبَعْضُهُ بِانْضِمَامِ الشَّرْعِ كَالطَّهَارَةِ وَالصَّلَاةِ لِمَا فِيهِمَا مَثَلًا مِنَ اللَّفْظِ الْمَانِعِ مِنَ الْفَحْشَاءِ وَمِنَ النَّظَافَةِ. وَفَائِدَةُ مَعْرِفَةِ هَذَا الِاخْتِلَافِ فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ تَتَصَوَّرُ عِنْدَ النَّظَرِ فِي الْقِيَاسِ الْمُنَاسِبِ وَالْمُخَيَّلِ وَجَمِيعِ أَنْوَاعِهِ، وَعِنْدَ النَّظَرِ فِي تَصْوِيبِ الْمُجْتَهِدِينَ وَتَخْطِئَتِهِمْ.

The argument of the People of the Sunna is that ‘good’ and ‘bad’ have several meanings in the usage of speakers. The first and most familiar is what accords with or opposes the purpose of the person judging it good: one person, for instance, may find a dark complexion good and another find it bad. This is a relational matter, unlike the blackness and whiteness belonging to things in themselves. The second is what the Law has declared good or bad. The third meaning of

أَمَّا أَهْلُ السُّنَّةِ فَحُجَّتُهُمْ أَنَّ الْحُسْنَ وَالْقُبْحَ يُطْلَقُ فِي عُرْفِ الْمُتَكَلِّمِينَ عَلَى مَعَانٍ: أَوَّلُهَا وَأَشْهَرُهَا مَا يُوَافِقُ غَرَضَ الْمُسْتَحْسِنِ أَوْ يُخَالِفُهُ، حَتَّى يَسْتَحْسِنَ سُمْرَةَ اللَّوْنِ مَثَلًا وَاحِدٌ وَيَسْتَقْبِحَهَا آخَرُ. وَهَذَا أَمْرٌ إِضَافِيٌّ لَا كَالسَّوَادِ وَالْبَيَاضِ الْمَوْجُودَيْنِ لِلْأَشْيَاءِ بِذَاتِهَا. وَالثَّانِي مَا حَسَّنَهُ الشَّرْعُ أَوْ قَبَّحَهُ. وَالثَّالِثُ مِنْ مَعَانِي الْحُسْنِ مَا كَانَ لِلْإِنْسَانِ

مُبَاحًا فِعْلُهُ. وَكُلُّ هَذِهِ أَوْصَافٌ إِضَافِيَّةٌ لَا ذَاتِيَّةٌ. وَمَعْنَى ذَلِكَ أَنْ لَيْسَ لِلْحُسْنِ وَالْقُبْحِ وُجُودٌ خَارِجَ الْعَيْنِ.

'good' is what a person is permitted to do. All these are relational, not intrinsic, attributes. This means that goodness and badness have no existence 'outside the concrete entity.'

Editorial notes

N006 [textual] Printed pp. 41–42 read اللفظ and خارج العين. The latter is unusual; it has been rendered literally rather than silently changed to خارج الذهن ('outside the mind').

N007 [translation] المناسب والمخيل concern the suitability and apparently purposive rationale of a legal analogy; 'imaginal' would obscure the juridical use here. The following argument distinguishes intrinsic from relational evaluation.

§ 012 Why general acceptance does not establish rational necessity

1994 Arabic p. 42 · BA §15 · 2015 Arabic p. 126 · French p. 127

وَأَمَّا الْمُعْتَزِلَةُ فَاسْتَدَلُّوا عَلَى أَنَّ الْحُسْنَ وَالْقُبْحَ وَصْفٌ ذَاتِيٌّ لِلْأَشْيَاءِ بِاتِّفَاقِ الْعَقْلِ عَلَى الْقَوْلِ بِهِمَا مِنْ غَيْرِ إِضَافَةٍ كَحُسْنِ الصِّدْقِ وَقُبْحِ الْكَذِبِ، وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ مِنْ حَيْثُ هَذِهِ الْقَضَايَا مَشْهُورَةٌ وَمُتَّفَقٌ عَلَيْهَا. وَظَاهِرٌ أَنَّ الْأُمُورَ الْمَعْقُولَةَ قَدْ يَلْحَقُهَا أَنْ تَكُونَ مَشْهُورَةً، وَأَنَّ ذَلِكَ غَيْرُ مُنْعَكِسٍ.

The Muʿtazilites, for their part, argued that goodness and badness are intrinsic attributes of things from reason's agreement in affirming them without qualification by a relation—for example, the goodness of truthfulness and the badness of lying; in general, from these propositions' being widely accepted and agreed upon. It is evident that intelligible matters may also happen to be widely accepted, but that the converse does not hold.

§ 013 The obligation to inquire and the challenge to revealed authority

1994 Arabic p. 42 · BA §16–17 · 2015 Arabic p. 126 · French p. 127

وَالْقَوْلُ فِي هَذِهِ الْمَسْأَلَةِ لَيْسَ مِنْ هَذَا الْعِلْمِ الَّذِي نَحْنُ بِسَبِيلِهِ. وَيُشْبِهُ أَلَّا يَكُونَ فِي وَاحِدٍ مِنْ هَذَيْنِ الْقَوْلَيْنِ كِفَايَةٌ فِي الْوُقُوفِ عَلَى هَذِهِ الْمَسْأَلَةِ. وَقَدِ احْتَجَّتِ الْمُعْتَزِلَةُ عَلَى أَنَّ مُدْرَكَ الْوُجُوبِ فِي بَعْضِ الْأُمُورِ بِالْعَقْلِ كَشُكْرِ الْمُنْعِمِ وَغَيْرِ ذَلِكَ، فَإِنَّ حَصْرَهَا فِي الشَّرْعِ يُفْضِي إِلَى إِفْحَامِ الرُّسُلِ عِنْدَ دُعَائِهِمْ إِلَى النَّظَرِ، لِأَنَّا مَا لَمْ نَعْلَمْ وُجُوبَ النَّظَرِ لَمْ نَنْظُرْ، وَمَا لَمْ نَنْظُرْ لَمْ نَتَحَقَّقْ دَعْوَى الشَّارِعِ فِيمَا دَعَا إِلَيْهِ، وَمَا لَمْ نَتَحَقَّقْ دَعْوَاهُ فَلَا سَبِيلَ إِلَى الْإِيمَانِ بِمَا دَعَا إِلَيْهِ، سَوَاءٌ كَانَ الْمَدْعُوُّ إِلَيْهِ، فِي نَفْسِهِ حَقًّا أَوْ لَمْ يَكُنْ، لَا سَبِيلَ لَنَا عَلَى هَذَا الْوَجْهِ إِلَى حُصُولِ الْعِلْمِ بِهِ.

Discussion of this question does not belong to the science with which we are engaged. Neither of these two arguments seems sufficient to settle it. The Muʿtazilites argued that obligation in certain matters—thanking a benefactor and the like—is apprehended by reason. Restricting its apprehension to the Law would leave the messengers unable to answer when they call people to inquiry (النظر). Unless we know that inquiry is obligatory, we shall not inquire; unless we inquire, we shall not establish the Lawgiver's claim concerning that to which he calls us; and unless we establish his claim, there is no way to believe what he calls us to. Whether what we are called to is true in itself or not, on this account there is no way for us to attain knowledge of it.

Editorial notes

N008 [lexical] مُدْرَك is retained with ḍamma on mīm in its sense of a ground or means of apprehension. Al-Fayyūmī, al-Miṣbāḥ al-munīr, s.v. درك, explicitly prefers this regular form while reporting jurists' مَدْرَك. In §14 the same consonants also form the passive participle, "apprehended"; the construction determines the sense. Lexical control: https://ar.wikisource.org/wiki/المصباح_المنير/كتاب_الدال#درك

§ 014 An objection from infinite regress

1994 Arabic p. 42 · BA §18 · 2015 Arabic p. 126 · French p. 127

وَقَدْ أَلْزَمَ الْمُتَكَلِّمُونَ الْمُعْتَزِلَةَ فِي كَوْنِ مُدْرَكِ وُجُوبِ النَّظَرِ عَقْلًا شَكًّا مَا، وَهُوَ أَنَّ وُجُوبَ النَّظَرِ إِنْ كَانَ مُدْرَكًا عَقْلًا فَلَا يَخْلُو أَنْ يَكُونَ ذَلِكَ ضَرُورَةً أَوِ اكْتِسَابًا، فَإِنْ كَانَ ضَرُورَةً لَمْ يَغْفُلْ أَحَدٌ عَنْ عِلْمِ اللَّهِ، وَإِنْ كَانَ مُكْتَسَبًا بِنَظَرٍ انْعَكَسَ عَلَيْهِمُ الْقَوْلُ فِي مُدْرَكِ وُجُوبِ النَّظَرِ الْمُؤَدِّي إِلَى وُجُوبِ النَّظَرِ فِي دَعْوَى الشَّرْعِ، وَذَلِكَ إِلَى غَيْرِ نِهَايَةٍ.

The theologians pressed a difficulty upon the Mu'tazilites concerning their claim that the obligation to inquire is apprehended rationally. If this obligation is rationally apprehended, that must be either necessarily or through acquisition. If necessarily, no one would be heedless of the knowledge of God. If acquired by inquiry, the question turns back upon them: how is the obligation to undertake the inquiry leading to the obligation to inquire into the Law's claim apprehended? And so on without end.

§ 015 Miracles, assent, and necessary knowledge

1994 Arabic p. 42 & 43 · BA §19 · 2015 Arabic p. 126 · French p. 127

وَالَّذِي يَنْبَغِي عِنْدِي أَنْ يُقَالَ فِي هَذَا الْمَوْضِعِ فَهُوَ أَنَّ التَّصْدِيقَ بِدَعْوَى الشَّارِعِ عِنْدَ ظُهُورِ الْمُعْجِزَةِ وَفْقَ دَعْوَاهُ هُوَ مِنْ جِنْسِ الْمَعَارِفِ الضَّرُورِيَّةِ، وَأَنَّ التَّصْدِيقَ يَقَعُ بِمُشَاهَدَةِ ذَلِكَ اضْطِرَارًا أَوْ بِوُجُودِهَا تَوَاتُرًا، وَإِنَّمَا يُتَصَوَّرُ وُجُوبُ النَّظَرِ أَوْ لَا وُجُوبُهُ فِي مَعْرِفَتِهِ بِنَظَرٍ وَاسْتِدْلَالٍ. وَتَكَلُّفُ مَا سِوَى هَذَا مِنَ الْقَوْلِ فِي هَذَا الْمَوْضِعِ تَشْوِيشٌ لِلْعَقَائِدِ أَوْ عَنَاءٌ. وَلَوْ أَنَّ وَاحِدًا وَاحِدًا مِنَ الْمَدْعُوِّينَ لِلشَّرْعِ تَكَلَّفَ مِثْلَ هَذِهِ الشُّكُوكِ عِنْدَ النَّظَرِ فِيمَا دَعَا إِلَيْهِ الشَّرْعُ لَكَانَ إِيمَانُ كَثِيرٍ مِنَ النَّاسِ مِمَّا لَا يَقَعُ، وَلَوْ وَقَعَ لَكَانَ فِي النَّادِرِ.

What should be said here, in my judgement, is that assent (التصديق) to the Lawgiver's claim when a miracle appears in accordance with it belongs to the kind of necessary knowledge. Assent arises necessarily from witnessing this, or through the miracle's being established by recurrent transmission (تواتر). The question whether inquiry is obligatory or not arises only where knowledge is gained through inquiry and inference (النظر والاستدلال). Straining after any further account here merely confuses beliefs or causes needless trouble. If each person called to the Law were to take upon himself such difficulties when considering what the Law calls him to, the faith of many people would never arise, or would arise only rarely.

وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَكَأَنْ يَكُونَ دُعَاءُ اللَّهِ النَّاسَ إِلَى الْإِيمَانِ بِالشَّرْعِ بِمِثْلِ هَذِهِ الطُّرُقِ فِي حَقِّ الْأَكْثَرِ مِنْ بَابِ تَكْلِيفِ مَا لَا يُطَاقُ. وَلَيْسَ يَلْزَمُ مِنْ كَوْنِ الْمَعْرِفَةِ بِذَلِكَ ضَرُورِيَّةً أَلَّا يَنْفَكَّ عَنِ الْإِقْرَارِ بِهَا أَحَدٌ، فَإِنَّهُ كَمَا أَنَّهُ لَيْسَ مِنْ شَرْطِ

In general, God's calling people to faith in the Law by such paths would, for most people, amount to imposing what is beyond their capacity. That knowledge of this is necessary does not entail that no one can fail to acknowledge it. Just as being necessary is not a condition of what is

agreed upon, so being agreed upon is not a condition of what is necessary. None of this belongs to the present science.

الْمُتَّفَقِ عَلَيْهِ أَنْ يَكُونَ ضَرُورِيًّا كَذَلِكَ لَيْسَ مِنْ شَرْطِ الضَّرُورِيِّ أَنْ يَكُونَ مُتَّفَقًا عَلَيْهِ. وَهَذَا كُلُّهُ لَيْسَ مِنْ هَذَا الْعِلْمِ.

Editorial notes

N009 [translation] ضروري here is ‘necessary’ in the epistemic sense, not simply ‘essential’ or ‘important’; the passage distinguishes necessity from universal acknowledgement.

§ 016 The status of acts before revelation

1994 Arabic p. 43 · BA §20 · 2015 Arabic p. 128 · French p. 129

Those Mu‘tazilites who held that acts are permissible before the advent of the Law intended by this only acts concerning which reason judges neither goodness nor badness. Those among them who spoke of suspension of judgement seem to me to have had in view acts whose goodness or badness is apprehended only when the Law is joined to reason, as previously stated among their opinions. As for those who say that acts are prohibited before the advent of the Law, this assertion has no meaning and is manifestly untenable in itself.

أَمَّا مَنْ ذَهَبَ مِنَ الْمُعْتَزِلَةِ إِلَى أَنَّ الْأَفْعَالَ قَبْلَ وُرُودِ الشَّرْعِ عَلَى الْإِبَاحَةِ فَإِنَّمَا أَرَادُوا بِذَلِكَ مَا لَا يَقْضِي الْعَقْلُ فِيهِ بِحُسْنٍ وَلَا قُبْحٍ. وَمَنْ قَالَ مِنْهُمْ إِنَّهَا عَلَى الْوَقْفِ فَأُرَاهُمْ رَأَوْا ذَلِكَ فِيمَا لَا يُدْرَكُ مِنَ الْأَفْعَالِ الْحُسْنُ وَالْقُبْحُ فِيهِ إِلَّا بِانْضِمَامِ الشَّرْعِ إِلَى الْعَقْلِ، كَمَا تَقَدَّمَ مِنْ آرَائِهِمْ. وَأَمَّا مَنْ قَالَ مِنَ النَّاسِ إِنَّهَا قَبْلَ وُرُودِ الشَّرْعِ عَلَى الْحَظْرِ فَقَوْلٌ لَا مَعْنَى لَهُ، وَهُوَ بَيِّنُ السُّقُوطِ بِنَفْسِهِ.

§ 017 The five rulings and the distinction between farḍ and wājib

1994 Arabic p. 44 · BA §21–24 · 2015 Arabic p. 128 · French p. 129

This section comprises inquiry into the divisions of rulings (الأحكام), their definitions, and questions attaching to them. We say: the ruling whose description was given above is divided into a demand to act, a demand to omit, or a choice between the two; the last is called permissible (مباح). The demand to act is divided into obligation and recommendation; omission, into prohibition and disapproval.

وَهُوَ يَتَضَمَّنُ النَّظَرَ فِي أَقْسَامِ الْأَحْكَامِ وَحُدُودِهَا وَمَسَائِلَ تَلْحَقُهَا فَنَقُولُ: إِنَّ الْحُكْمَ، وَهُوَ الَّذِي تَقَدَّمَ رَسْمُهُ، يَنْقَسِمُ إِلَى طَلَبٍ وَتَرْكٍ أَوْ تَخْيِيرٍ فِيهِمَا وَهُوَ الْمُسَمَّى مُبَاحًا. وَالطَّلَبُ يَنْقَسِمُ إِلَى وَاجِبٍ وَنَدْبٍ، وَالتَّرْكُ يَنْقَسِمُ إِلَى مَحْظُورٍ وَمَكْرُوهٍ.

The obligatory (الواجب) is defined as that whose performance the address of the Law prefers, with a threat of punishment for omitting it insofar as this constitutes its unqualified omission. We added ‘with a threat of punishment for omitting it’ because, according to the People of the Sunna, obligation cannot be conceived apart from harm or benefit. We further added ‘insofar as this constitutes its unqualified omission’ as a

وَحَدُّ الْوَاجِبِ أَنَّهُ مَا وَرَدَ خِطَابُ الشَّرْعِ بِتَرْجِيحِ فِعْلِهِ مَعَ تَوَعُّدٍ بِالْعِقَابِ عَلَى تَرْكِهِ مِنْ حَيْثُ هُوَ تَرْكٌ لَهُ بِإِطْلَاقٍ، وَإِنَّمَا زِدْنَا فِي الْحَدِّ قَوْلَنَا: مَعَ تَوَعُّدٍ بِالْعِقَابِ عَلَى تَرْكِهِ، لِأَنَّ الْوَاجِبَ عَلَى مَذْهَبِ أَهْلِ السُّنَّةِ لَا يُتَصَوَّرُ دُونَ الضَّرَرِ أَوِ

النَّفْعِ، وَزِيَادَتُنَا فِيهِ أَيْضًا: مِنْ حَيْثُ هُوَ تَرْكٌ لَهُ بِإِطْلَاقٍ، تَحَفُّظًا مِنَ الْوَاجِبِ الْمُخَيَّرِ.

precaution concerning an obligation that permits a choice.

وَالتَّوَعُّدُ بِالْعِقَابِ رُبَّمَا وَرَدَ قَطْعًا وَرُبَّمَا وَرَدَ ظَنًّا. وَأَصْحَابُ أَبِي حَنِيفَةَ يَخُصُّونَ الْأَوَّلَ بِاسْمِ الْفَرْضِ وَالثَّانِيَ بِاسْمِ الْوَاجِبِ، وَلَا مُشَاحَّةَ فِي الْأَسْمَاءِ إِذَا فُهِمَتِ الْمَعَانِي.

The threat of punishment may be established with certainty or by probable judgement (ظنا). Abū Ḥanīfa's followers reserve the name farḍ for the first and wājib for the second. There is no dispute over names once their meanings are understood.

وَحَدُّ النَّدْبِ أَنَّهُ الْمُرَجَّحُ فِعْلُهُ مِنْ غَيْرِ تَوَعُّدٍ بِالْعِقَابِ عَلَى تَرْكِهِ. وَمِنْ حَدِّ الْوَاجِبِ نَقِفُ عَلَى حَدِّ الْمَحْظُورِ لِأَنَّهُ مُقَابِلُهُ، وَكَذَلِكَ مِنْ حَدِّ النَّدْبِ نَقِفُ عَلَى حَدِّ الْمَكْرُوهِ. وَحَدُّ الْمُبَاحِ مَا دَلَّ الشَّرْعُ عَلَى التَّسْوِيَةِ بَيْنَ فِعْلِهِ وَتَرْكِهِ، وَذَلِكَ إِمَّا أَنْ يَرِدَ الْخِطَابُ بِالتَّخْيِيرِ فِيهِمَا، أَوْ بِرَفْعِ الْحَرَجِ عَنْهُمَا، أَوْ يَدُلَّ دَلِيلُ الْعَقْلِ أَنَّهُ عَلَى الْبَرَاءَةِ الْأَصْلِيَّةِ بِعَدَمِ الدَّلِيلِ الشَّرْعِيِّ عَلَى تَعَلُّقِ حُكْمٍ بِهِ، عَلَى مَا سَيَأْتِي بَعْدُ.

The recommended (الندب) is defined as that whose performance is preferred without a threat of punishment for its omission. From the definition of the obligatory we apprehend that of the prohibited, its opposite; likewise, from that of the recommended we apprehend that of the disapproved. The permissible is that concerning which the Law indicates equality between performance and omission. This occurs either through an address allowing a choice between them, through removal of blame from both, or through a rational indication that original freedom from liability (البراءة الأصلية) remains because there is no legal proof attaching a ruling to it, as will be explained later.

§ 018 Obligations with alternatives and extended times

1994 Arabic p. 44 & 45 · BA §25 · 2015 Arabic p. 130 · French p. 131

وَالْوَاجِبُ يَنْقَسِمُ إِلَى مُعَيَّنٍ وَإِلَى مُخَيَّرٍ بَيْنَ أَقْسَامٍ مَحْدُودَةٍ، وَذَلِكَ إِمَّا فِي الْفِعْلِ وَإِمَّا فِي الزَّمَانِ. وَيُسَمُّونَ الْغَيْرَ مُعَيَّنِ الْفِعْلِ بَيْنَ أَقْسَامٍ مَحْدُودَةٍ الْوَاجِبَ الْمُخَيَّرَ، وَالْغَيْرَ مُعَيَّنِ الزَّمَانِ الْوَاجِبَ الْمُوَسَّعَ.

The obligatory is divided into what is determinate and what allows a choice among a limited set of alternatives, either concerning the act or concerning the time. They call an obligation whose act is not fixed, but admits a limited set of alternatives, an obligation allowing a choice (الواجب المخير); one whose time is not fixed, an obligation with an extended time (الواجب الموسع).

§ 019 Alternative duties, welfare, and divine foreknowledge

1994 Arabic p. 45 · BA §26 · 2015 Arabic p. 130 · French p. 131

وَقَدْ أَنْكَرَتِ الْمُعْتَزِلَةُ جَوَازَ مِثْلِ هَذَا الْوَاجِبِ عَقْلًا وَوُقُوعَهُ شَرْعًا، وَقَالُوا إِنْ كَانَتِ الْخِصَالُ الثَّلَاثُ فِي الْكَفَّارَةِ مُسْتَوِيَةً فِي الصِّفَةِ بِالْإِضَافَةِ إِلَى صَلَاحِ الْعَبْدِ، فَيَنْبَغِي أَنْ

The Muʿtazilites denied both the rational possibility of such an obligation and its occurrence in the Law. They said: if the three alternatives in expiation are equal in their character with respect to the servant's welfare, all ought to be made obligatory because they are

equally conducive to it. This is based on their doctrine of welfare and the best possible welfare.

يُوجِبَ الْجَمِيعَ لِتَسَاوِيهَا فِي صَلَاحِ الْعَبْدِ، وَهَذَا مَبْنِيٌّ عَلَى رَأْيِهِمْ فِي الصَّلَاحِ وَالْأَصْلَحِ.

Yet, even if this principle were granted, the contrary of what they posit would follow: if each alternative equals the others in bringing about welfare, employing all of them is pointless, as is selecting one particular alternative; and they do not allow such purposelessness in God. They appear not to have guarded their own principles in this question. They also argued that God's knowledge concerns the alternative the servant will perform, which is therefore necessarily determinate in itself; no choice is conceivable in such a case.

وَأَيْضًا فَلَوْ سُلِّمَتْ لَهُمْ هَذِهِ الْقَاعِدَةُ لَلَزِمَهُمْ نَقِيضُ مَا وَضَعُوا، وَهُوَ أَنَّهُ إِذَا كَانَ كُلُّ وَاحِدٍ مِنْهُمَا مُسَاوِيًا لِصَاحِبِهِ فِي وُقُوعِ الصَّلَاحِ بِهِ فَاسْتِعْمَالُ جَمِيعِهَا عَبَثٌ، وَكَذَلِكَ اسْتِعْمَالُ وَاحِدَةٍ مِنْهَا عَلَى التَّعْيِينِ، وَهُمْ لَا يُجَوِّزُونَ مِثْلَ هَذَا عَلَى اللَّهِ، وَكَأَنَّهُمْ لَمْ يَتَحَفَّظُوا بِأُصُولِهِمْ فِي هَذِهِ الْمَسْأَلَةِ، وَاحْتَجُّوا أَيْضًا بِأَنَّ عِلْمَ اللَّهِ مُتَعَلِّقٌ بِالَّذِي يَأْتِي الْعَبْدُ مِنْهَا فَهُوَ مُتَعَيِّنٌ ضَرُورَةً فِي نَفْسِهِ، وَلَا يُتَصَوَّرُ فِي مِثْلِ هَذَا تَخْيِيرٌ.

§ 020 Legal examples suffice without resolving the metaphysics

1994 Arabic p. 45 · BA §27 · 2015 Arabic p. 132 · French p. 133

Discussion of this question does not belong to the science with which we are engaged. Here it is enough to say that such a thing does occur in the Law, as with the alternatives in expiation and the established consensus that most prayers have extended performance periods. The Mu'tazilites are bound to encounter the same difficulty they raised here in the case of the permissible. In general, this objection attaches to the possible insofar as it is possible.

وَالْكَلَامُ فِي هَذِهِ الْمَسْأَلَةِ لَيْسَ مِنْ هَذَا الْعِلْمِ الَّذِي نَحْنُ بِسَبِيلِهِ، بَلْ يَكْفِي مِنْ ذَلِكَ هَهُنَا أَنْ نَقُولَ: إِنَّ وُقُوعَ مِثْلِ هَذَا شَرْعًا مَوْجُودٌ كَخِصَالِ الْكَفَّارَةِ، وَانْعِقَادِ الْإِجْمَاعِ عَلَى اتِّسَاعِ أَوْقَاتِ أَكْثَرِ الصَّلَوَاتِ. وَالَّذِي أَنْكَرَتِ الْمُعْتَزِلَةُ يَلْزَمُهُمْ مِثْلُ ذَلِكَ فِي الْمُبَاحِ، وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ يَلْحَقُ هَذَا الِاعْتِرَاضُ الْمُمْكِنَ بِمَا هُوَ مُمْكِنٌ.

Editorial notes

N010 [textual] Printed p. 45 reads اتباع أوقات ('observing the times'); the context concerns the extended time allowed for prayer. No conjectural replacement of اتباع by اتساع has been made.

BA15-V020 [textual] 2015 full-edition control completed for R §20 = Bou Akl §27, Arabic p.132, French p.133. Distinguish manuscript-attested changes as detailed in the preceding notes. See the source-verified change ledger for exact old and new Arabic/English strings.

§ 021 When does an extended-time obligation become binding?

1994 Arabic p. 45 & 46 · BA §28–29 · 2015 Arabic p. 132 · French p. 133

Some jurists rejected calling such a thing obligatory. They said that, with respect to time, it is characterized by obligation only at the end of the period, since punishment attaches to failing to perform the prayer then. At the beginning of the period, however, they call it recommended, since omitting the prayer at that point incurs no

وَقَدْ دَفَعَ بَعْضُ الْفُقَهَاءِ تَسْمِيَةَ مِثْلِ هَذَا وَاجِبًا، وَقَالُوا إِنَّمَا يَتَّصِفُ بِالْوُجُوبِ فِي الزَّمَانِ آخِرَ الْوَقْتِ، إِذْ فِيهِ يَقَعُ الْعِقَابُ عَلَى تَرْكِ إِيقَاعِ الصَّلَاةِ فِيهِ. وَأَمَّا أَوَّلُ الْوَقْتِ فَهُوَ نَدْبٌ إِذْ لَيْسَ يَلْحَقُ عِقَابٌ عَنْ تَرْكِ إِيقَاعِ الصَّلَاةِ فِيهِ.

penalty. A similar objection applies to an obligation offering a choice: no individual alternative can be considered obligatory, as the final moment of the prayer period can, unless the other two alternatives become unavailable; only then does the obligation of the third become conceivable. What should be said of such a case is that it resembles obligation in one respect and recommendation in another. Its resemblance to obligation lies in the discharge of the duty by praying at the beginning of the period; its resemblance to recommendation is that mentioned in the objection.

وَمِثْلُ هَذَا الِاعْتِرَاضِ يَلْحَقُ الْوَاجِبَ الْمُخَيَّرَ، إِلَّا أَنَّهُ لَا يُتَصَوَّرُ مِنْهَا وُجُوبُ وَاحِدٍ كَمَا تُصُوِّرَ فِي آخِرِ الْوَقْتِ إِلَّا أَنْ تُعْدَمَ الْخَصْلَتَانِ فَحِينَئِذٍ يُتَصَوَّرُ وُجُوبُ الثَّالِثَةِ. وَالَّذِي يَنْبَغِي أَنْ يُقَالَ فِي مِثْلِ هَذَا أَنَّهُ يُشْبِهُ الْوُجُوبَ مِنْ جِهَةٍ، وَالنَّدْبَ مِنْ أُخْرَى. أَمَّا شَبَهُهُ لِلْوُجُوبِ فَلِأَنَّهُ يَرْتَفِعُ الْفَرْضُ بِالصَّلَاةِ فِي أَوَّلِ الْوَقْتِ، وَأَمَّا شَبَهُهُ بِالنَّدْبِ فَمَا ذُكِرَ فِي الِاعْتِرَاضِ.

Editorial notes

BA15-V021 [textual] 2015 full-edition control completed for R §21 = Bou Akl §28, Arabic p.132, French p.133. Distinguish manuscript-attested changes as detailed in the preceding notes. See the source-verified change ledger for exact old and new Arabic/English strings.

§ 022 Intention distinguishes postponement from abandonment

1994 Arabic p. 46 · BA §29 · 2015 Arabic p. 132 · French p. 133

This dispute is verbal; hence it was called an obligation with an extended time. It also differs from recommendation in that its omission is allowed only on condition of resolving to perform it while mindful of it, since resolving to omit it altogether is forbidden.

وَهَذِهِ الْمُنَازَعَةُ لَفْظِيَّةٌ، وَلِذَلِكَ سُمِّيَ الْوَاجِبَ الْمُوَسَّعَ، وَهُوَ أَيْضًا يُفَارِقُ النَّدْبَ مِنْ جِهَةِ أَنَّ تَرْكَهُ إِنَّمَا يَكُونُ بِشَرْطِ الْعَزْمِ عَلَى إِتْيَانِهِ مَعَ الذِّكْرِ، إِذْ كَانَ اعْتِقَادُ التَّرْكِ مُطْلَقًا حَرَامًا.

§ 023 Necessary means and the minimum sufficient performance

1994 Arabic p. 46 · BA §30–31 · 2015 Arabic p. 134 · French p. 135

They likewise disagreed whether that without which an obligation cannot be fulfilled should itself be called obligatory. The proper account is that this is divided into what the servant has no choice in producing—for example, the capacity to walk—which is not characterized as obligatory but is a condition of imposing an obligation; and what the servant can produce by choice, which should be characterized as obligatory, such as the ritual purity required for prayer. The obligation of such a thing seems to be for the sake of something else, not for its own sake. Another division of the obligatory therefore emerges: some things are obligatory for the sake of

وَكَذَلِكَ اخْتَلَفُوا فِيمَا لَا يَتِمُّ الْوَاجِبُ إِلَّا بِهِ هَلْ يُسَمَّى وَاجِبًا. وَوَجْهُ الْقَوْلِ فِيهِ أَنَّ هَذَا يَنْقَسِمُ إِلَى مَا لَيْسَ لِلْعَبْدِ فِي فِعْلِهِ اخْتِيَارٌ كَالْقُدْرَةِ عَلَى الْمَشْيِ مَثَلًا، فَهَذَا لَا يُوصَفُ بِالْوُجُوبِ بَلْ هُوَ مِنْ شَرْطِ تَكْلِيفِ الْوُجُوبِ، أَوْ إِلَى مَا لِلْعَبْدِ فِي فِعْلِهِ اخْتِيَارٌ، وَهَذَا فَيَنْبَغِي أَنْ يَتَّصِفَ بِالْوُجُوبِ كَالطَّهَارَةِ الْمُشْتَرَطَةِ فِي الصَّلَاةِ. وَكَأَنَّ وُجُوبَ مِثْلِ هَذَا إِنَّمَا هُوَ مِنْ أَجْلِ غَيْرِهِ لَا مِنْ أَجْلِ ذَاتِهِ، فَتَنْشَأُ هَهُنَا قِسْمَةٌ أُخْرَى لِلْوَاجِبِ وَهُوَ أَنَّ مِنْهُ مَا هُوَ وَاجِبٌ مِنْ أَجْلِ غَيْرِهِ وَمِنْهُ مَا هُوَ وَاجِبٌ بِذَاتِهِ.

something else, and some are obligatory in themselves.

The obligatory is also divided into what is measured by a determinate amount and what is not, such as wiping the head and remaining still in bowing. In the latter case, the obligatory amount is the least to which the name applies; what remains is recommended. This is conceivable only for acts occurring successively or following one upon another—in general, where their parts do not occur simultaneously.

وَالْوَاجِبُ أَيْضًا يَنْقَسِمُ إِلَى مَا يَتَقَدَّرُ بِقَدْرٍ مَحْدُودٍ وَإِلَى مَا لَا يَتَقَدَّرُ بِقَدْرٍ مَحْدُودٍ، كَمَسْحِ الرَّأْسِ وَالطُّمَأْنِينَةِ فِي الرُّكُوعِ، وَالْوَاجِبُ مِنْ هَذَا هُوَ أَقَلُّ مَا يَنْطَلِقُ عَلَيْهِ الِاسْمُ وَيَبْقَى الْبَاقِي نَدْبًا، وَهَذَا إِنَّمَا يُتَصَوَّرُ فِيمَا وَقَعَ مِنَ الْأَفْعَالِ مُتَتَابِعًا أَوْ مُتَشَافِعًا، وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ مَا لَمْ تَقَعْ أَجْزَاؤُهُ مَعًا.

§ 024 From definitions to universal questions

1994 Arabic p. 46 · BA §32 · 2015 Arabic p. 134 · French p. 135

Such is the account of the definition and division of the kinds of rulings (الأحكام). There remains the discussion of universal questions attaching to them.

فَهَذَا هُوَ الْقَوْلُ فِي تَحْدِيدِ أَنْوَاعِ الْأَحْكَامِ وَتَقْسِيمِهَا، وَقَدْ بَقِيَ الْقَوْلُ فِي مَسَائِلَ كُلِّيَّةٍ تَلْحَقُهَا.

§ 025 Death during the time and reasonable postponement

1994 Arabic p. 47 · BA §33 · 2015 Arabic p. 134 · French p. 135

The first question is this. If the legally responsible person dies during the allotted period without having discharged the duty, he does not die disobedient: the early generations agreed on this. Whoever declares him sinful is mistaken, for we know with certainty that they did not declare sinful someone who died after enough time had elapsed to perform the prayer.

فَأَوَّلُ مَسْأَلَةٍ مِنْهَا أَنَّا نَقُولُ، إِذَا مَاتَ الْمُكَلَّفُ فِي أَثْنَاءِ الْوَقْتِ وَلَمْ يَقْضِ لَمْ يَمُتْ عَاصِيًا بِإِجْمَاعِ السَّلَفِ عَلَى ذَلِكَ. وَقَوْلُ مَنْ أَثَّمَهُ خَطَأٌ، فَإِنَّا نَعْلَمُ قَطْعًا أَنَّهُمْ كَانُوا لَا يُؤَثِّمُونَ مَنْ مَاتَ وَقَدْ مَضَى مِنَ الْوَقْتِ مِقْدَارُ مَا تَقَعُ فِيهِ الصَّلَاةُ.

If it is asked how omission with a resolve to act can be allowed when he does not know whether the outcome will be safe, we answer: such omission is allowed only until a time he judges it more probable than not that he will survive to, just as one administering discretionary punishment may strike up to a point at which death is not the predominant probability. Hence Abū Ḥanīfa—may God have mercy upon him—said that pilgrimage may not be postponed for a year, since survival until then is not predominantly probable; fasting and almsgiving, however, may be postponed for one or two months. Al-Shāfiʿī—may God have mercy upon him—regards survival

فَإِنْ قِيلَ فَكَيْفَ يَجُوزُ التَّرْكُ مَعَ الْعَزْمِ وَهُوَ لَا يَعْرِفُ سَلَامَةَ الْعَاقِبَةِ، قُلْنَا لَا يَجُوزُ التَّرْكُ مَعَ الْعَزْمِ إِلَّا إِلَى مُدَّةٍ يَغْلِبُ عَلَى ظَنِّهِ الْبَقَاءُ إِلَيْهَا، كَمَا يَجُوزُ لِلْمُعَزِّرِ أَنْ يَضْرِبَ إِلَى حَدٍّ لَا يَغْلِبُ عَلَى ظَنِّهِ الْهَلَاكُ. وَلِذَلِكَ قَالَ أَبُو حَنِيفَةَ رَحِمَهُ اللَّهُ لَا يَجُوزُ تَأْخِيرُ الْحَجِّ إِلَى سَنَةٍ لِأَنَّ الْبَقَاءَ إِلَيْهَا لَا يَغْلِبُ عَلَى الظَّنِّ. وَأَمَّا تَأْخِيرُ الصَّوْمِ وَالزَّكَاةِ إِلَى شَهْرٍ أَوْ شَهْرَيْنِ فَجَائِزٌ. وَالشَّافِعِيُّ رَحِمَهُ اللَّهُ يَرَى الْبَقَاءَ إِلَى سَنَةٍ غَالِبًا عَلَى ظَنِّ الشَّبَابِ.

for a year as predominantly probable for young people.

§ 026 Abrogation of obligation and the logic of opposites

1994 Arabic p. 47 · BA §34 · 2015 Arabic p. 136 · French p. 137

الْأَحْكَامُ تَنْقَسِمُ إِلَى وَاجِبٍ كَمَا تَقَدَّمَ، وَمُقَابِلِهِ فِي الطَّرَفِ الْأَقْصَى الْمَحْظُورِ، وَهُوَ الْحَرَامُ، وَبَيْنَهُمَا مُتَوَسِّطَانِ، وَهُمَا النَّدْبُ وَالْمَكْرُوهُ. وَبَيِّنٌ أَنَّ الْمُتَقَابِلَاتِ الَّتِي بَيْنَهَا مُتَوَسِّطٌ لَيْسَ يَلْزَمُ عَنْ رَفْعِ أَحَدِهَا وُجُودُ الْآخَرِ، فَلِذَلِكَ أَخْطَأَ مَنْ زَعَمَ أَنَّ الْوُجُوبَ إِذَا نُسِخَ رَجَعَ إِلَى مَا كَانَ قَبْلُ مِنْ حَظْرٍ. وَإِنَّمَا كَانَ يَكُونُ ذَلِكَ لَوْ لَمْ يَكُنْ بَيْنَ الْوَاجِبِ وَالْحَرَامِ وَاسِطَةٌ. وَأَبْيَنُ مِنْ هَذَا أَنْ يَرْجِعَ إِلَى مَا كَانَ قَبْلُ مِنْ إِبَاحَةٍ، إِذْ لَيْسَ يَتَضَمَّنُهَا جِنْسُ هَذِهِ الْمُتَقَابِلَاتِ الَّذِي هُوَ الطَّلَبُ.

Rulings are divided, as previously explained, into the obligatory and, at the opposite extreme, the prohibited, which is the forbidden. Between them lie two intermediates: the recommended and the disapproved. It is clear that where opposites admit an intermediate, removing one does not entail the existence of the other. Whoever claimed that when obligation is abrogated a thing returns to its previous prohibition was therefore mistaken. That would follow only if there were no intermediate between the obligatory and the forbidden. More evident still [is the error of supposing] that it returns to its previous permissibility, since permissibility is not contained within the genus of these opposites, namely demand (الطلب).

Editorial notes

N011 [translation] The demonstrative in وأبين من هذا (printed p. 47) is taken to refer to the error just discussed; the explanatory bracket makes that syntactic interpretation visible.

§ 027 Is the permissible commanded or legally burdensome?

1994 Arabic p. 47 & 48 · BA §35 · 2015 Arabic p. 136 · French p. 137

وَهُنَا يَتَبَيَّنُ سُقُوطُ قَوْلِ مَنْ قَالَ الْمُبَاحُ مَأْمُورٌ بِهِ. وَكَذَلِكَ يَتَبَيَّنُ أَنَّهُ لَيْسَ مِنَ التَّكْلِيفِ، إِذِ التَّكْلِيفُ طَلَبُ مَا فِيهِ كُلْفَةٌ. وَمَنْ سَمَّاهُ تَكْلِيفًا وَذَهَبَ فِي ذَلِكَ إِلَى أَنَّهُ الَّذِي كُلِّفْنَا اعْتِقَادَ إِبَاحَتِهِ فِي الشَّرْعِ، أَوْ أَنَّهُ الَّذِي كُلِّفْنَا اعْتِقَادَ كَوْنِهِ مِنَ الشَّرْعِ، فَهُوَ مُسْتَكْرَهٌ فِي التَّسْمِيَةِ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَهَذَا النَّظَرُ لُغَوِيٌّ وَهُوَ أَلْيَقُ بِغَيْرِ هَذَا الْمَوْضِعِ، وَمِمَّا تَقَدَّمَ أَيْضًا مِنْ هَذَا الْقَوْلِ يَتَبَيَّنُ أَنَّ الْمَنْدُوبَ مَأْمُورٌ بِهِ إِذْ هُوَ طَلَبٌ مَا وَاقْتِضَاءٌ. فَأَمَّا مَنْ زَعَمَ أَنَّ الْأَمْرَ إِنَّمَا يُطْلَقُ عَلَى مَا فِي تَرْكِهِ عِقَابٌ، فَهِيَ دَعْوَى لُغَوِيَّةٌ، وَعَلَى مُدَّعِيهَا إِثْبَاتُ ذَلِكَ عُرْفًا شَرْعِيًّا أَوْ وَضْعًا لُغَوِيًّا.

Here the untenability of the claim that the permissible is commanded becomes clear. It is likewise clear that it does not belong to the imposition of legal responsibility (التكليف), since this is the demand for something involving a burden. Whoever calls it an imposition of responsibility, meaning that we are obliged to believe it permissible in the Law or obliged to believe that it belongs to the Law, strains the terminology. In general, this is a linguistic inquiry more suited to another place. The preceding account also makes clear that the recommended is commanded, since it involves a certain demand and requisition. As for the claim that ‘command’ applies only where omission incurs punishment, that is a linguistic claim; its proponent must

establish it through either legal usage or linguistic convention.

§ 028 Can one act be obligatory and forbidden in different respects?

1994 Arabic p. 48 & 49 · BA §36–37 · 2015 Arabic p. 136 · French p. 137

If contraries are defined as two things that cannot coexist in one numerically identical thing, at one time and in one respect, then prohibition and obligation cannot in the Law attach to one thing in one respect at one time. Their attachment to two things or at two times is, however, undisputed; prohibiting one does not invalidate the other, whether the distinction concerns two things or two times. The same must hold when prohibition and obligation attach to one thing in two respects—for example, when something is commanded without qualification, and then that very thing is prohibited as qualified by an attribute or on account of an expressly stated cause.

وَإِذَا كَانَ حَدُّ الْمُتَضَادَّيْنِ أَنَّهُمَا اللَّذَانِ لَا يَجْتَمِعَانِ فِي شَيْءٍ وَاحِدٍ بِالْعَدَدِ فِي وَقْتٍ وَاحِدٍ مِنْ جِهَةٍ وَاحِدَةٍ، فَلَا يَجُوزُ فِي الشَّرْعِ تَعَلُّقُ الْحَظْرِ وَالْإِيجَابِ بِشَيْءٍ وَاحِدٍ مِنْ جِهَةٍ وَاحِدَةٍ فِي وَقْتٍ وَاحِدٍ. فَأَمَّا تَعَلُّقُهُمَا بِشَيْئَيْنِ أَوْ فِي وَقْتَيْنِ فَذَلِكَ مَا لَا خِلَافَ فِيهِ، وَلَا يَرْجِعُ النَّهْيُ عَنْ أَحَدِهِمَا عَلَى الثَّانِي بِالْفَسَادِ، سَوَاءٌ كَانَ ذَلِكَ فِي شَيْئَيْنِ أَوْ فِي زَمَانَيْنِ. وَكَذَلِكَ يَلْزَمُ إِذَا تَعَلَّقَ النَّهْيُ وَالْإِيجَابُ بِشَيْءٍ وَاحِدٍ مِنْ جِهَتَيْنِ مِثْلَ أَنْ يَرِدَ الْأَمْرُ بِشَيْءٍ مُطْلَقًا، ثُمَّ يَرِدَ النَّهْيُ عَنْ ذَلِكَ الشَّيْءِ بِعَيْنِهِ مُقَيَّدًا بِصِفَةٍ أَوْ لِعِلَّةٍ مُصَرَّحٍ بِهَا.

In cases of this kind, however, they disagreed whether the prohibition invalidates the originally obligatory act insofar as it is qualified. Abū Ḥāmid —may God have mercy upon him—stated that they divide this into what concerns something other than the prohibited act, owing to an external cause, and what concerns an attribute of the thing itself. What concerns something other than the prohibited act does not invalidate the original act. Concerning what relates to an attribute of the prohibited act, al-Shāfiʿī held that it invalidates the original act; where he gave effect to divorce during menstruation, he referred the prohibition to the infliction of harm and included it in the first division.

إِلَّا أَنَّهُمُ اخْتَلَفُوا فِي مِثْلِ هَذَا الْجِنْسِ هَلْ يَعُودُ النَّهْيُ بِالْفَسَادِ عَلَى الْأَصْلِ الْمُوجَبِ مِنْ جِهَةِ مَا قُيِّدَ؟ فَزَعَمَ أَبُو حَامِدٍ رَحِمَهُ اللَّهُ أَنَّ هَذَا يَنْقَسِمُ عِنْدَهُمْ إِلَى مَا يَرْجِعُ إِلَى غَيْرِ الْمَنْهِيِّ لِسَبَبٍ مِنْ خَارِجٍ، وَإِلَى مَا يَرْجِعُ إِلَى صِفَةٍ فِي الشَّيْءِ. فَمَا يَرْجِعُ إِلَى غَيْرِ الْمَنْهِيِّ فَلَا يَرْجِعُ عَلَى الْأَصْلِ بِالْفَسَادِ، وَأَمَّا الَّذِي يَرْجِعُ إِلَى صِفَةٍ فِي الْمَنْهِيِّ عَنْهُ فَذَهَبَ الشَّافِعِيُّ إِلَى أَنَّهُ يَعُودُ عَلَى الْأَصْلِ بِالْفَسَادِ، وَحَيْثُ أَوْقَعَ الطَّلَاقَ فِي الْحَيْضِ صَرَفَ ذَلِكَ إِلَى الْإِضْرَارِ وَأَلْحَقَهُ بِالْقِسْمِ الْأَوَّلِ.

Abū Ḥanīfa does not consider the prohibition to invalidate the original act in either case, whether the prohibited act is qualified by an attribute or by an external cause. He held that ritual impurity's invalidation of prayer was established only by the proof of consensus.

وَأَبُو حَنِيفَةَ لَا يَرَى فِي الْمَوْضِعَيْنِ النَّهْيَ يَعُودُ بِفَسَادِ الْأَصْلِ، سَوَاءٌ وَرَدَ الْمَنْهِيُّ عَنْهُ مُقَيَّدًا بِصِفَةٍ أَوْ سَبَبٍ مِنْ خَارِجٍ، وَزَعَمَ أَنَّ كَوْنَ الْحَدَثِ مُبْطِلًا لِلصَّلَاةِ إِنَّمَا ثَبَتَ بِدَلِيلِ الْإِجْمَاعِ.

Editorial notes

BA15-E37 [textual] Bou Akl 2015 prints one or more editorial angle-bracket additions in his §37 (Arabic edition around p.138, corresponding French translation around p.139). They are not automatically adopted here: some were already present

in the al-ʿAlawī-based reading text, others are uncertain. Check his footnotes and the 1994 printed base before treating these as independent manuscript readings. This entry records editorial intervention, not verified word-for-word collation of every line in that section.

§ 029 Prohibitive wording versus a qualified prohibition’s meaning

1994 Arabic p. 49 · BA §38 · 2015 Arabic p. 138 · French p. 139

وَأَنَا أَرَى أَنَّ النَّظَرَ فِي هَذِهِ الْمَسْأَلَةِ إِنَّمَا هُوَ مِنْ جِهَةِ صِيغَةِ لَفْظِ النَّهْيِ، فَإِنَّ مَنْ يَدُلُّ عِنْدَهُ لَفْظَةُ ⟨النَّهْيِ عَلَى الْحَظْرِ جَعَلَ وُرُودَهُ فِي شَيْءٍ مُقَيَّدًا بِصِفَةٍ بَعْدَ⟩ إِيجَابِهِ مُطْلَقًا قَرِينَةٌ تُخْرِجُ النَّهْيَ عَنِ الْحَظْرِ إِلَى الْكَرَاهَةِ، وَأَكْثَرُ مِنْ ذَلِكَ وُرُودُهُ فِي شَيْءٍ لِأَمْرٍ مَا مِنْ خَارِجٍ بَعْدَ إِيجَابِ ذَلِكَ الشَّيْءِ مُطْلَقًا، وَسَنَتَكَلَّمُ فِي هَذَا فِيمَا بَعْدُ.

I consider that inquiry into this question concerns only the verbal form of prohibition. For one who understands the form of prohibition to signify that an act is forbidden, a prohibition applying to that act under a particular qualification, after its unconditional obligation has been established, is a contextual indicator (qarīna) that turns the apparent prohibition from strict forbiddance into disapproval. This is more clearly so if a prohibition attaches to the act on account of some external matter after the act has been enjoined without qualification. We shall discuss this later.

وَأَمَّا إِذَا نُظِرَ فِيهَا مِنْ حَيْثُ الْمَعْنَى، فَإِنَّ وُرُودَ النَّهْيِ عَنِ الشَّيْءِ مُقَيَّدًا بِأَمْرٍ مَا، سَوَاءٌ كَانَ سَبَبًا أَوْ صِفَةً، بَعْدَ إِيجَابِهِ مُطْلَقًا فَإِنَّهُ يَعُودُ عَلَى الْأَصْلِ بِالْفَسَادِ مِنْ جِهَةِ مَا هُوَ مُقَيَّدٌ. وَالَّذِي فَهِمْتَ هَهُنَا مِنْ وُرُودِ النَّهْيِ عَنِ الشَّيْءِ مُقَيَّدًا بَعْدَ إِيجَابِهِ مُطْلَقًا، هُوَ بِعَيْنِهِ يَنْبَغِي أَنْ تَفْهَمَهُ فِي وُرُودِ الْإِيجَابِ بِشَيْءٍ مَا مُقَيَّدًا بَعْدَ النَّهْيِ عَنْهُ مُطْلَقًا.

If, however, the question is considered from the standpoint of meaning, prohibiting a thing as qualified by some matter—whether a cause or an attribute—after making it obligatory without qualification invalidates the original act insofar as it is qualified. Precisely what you have understood here concerning a qualified prohibition issued after an unqualified obligation should be understood concerning a qualified obligation issued after an unqualified prohibition.

Editorial notes

N012 [textual] REVISED after direct examination of Bou Akl 2015 Arabic p.138 §38 and French p.139: the originally dangling phrase is a copyist omission. The brackets ⟨…⟩ now restore the syntactic subject and conditional clause as Bou Akl proposes. Restoration is conjectural, not witnessed wording.

N013 [crux] Bou Akl 2015 prints an extended supplement from the prohibition-signifies-forbiddance position through the qualified prohibition after an unconditional duty. Without it, the prior English made the relation between wording, qualification and prohibition unclear. This edition accepts the restoration provisionally (Arabic p.138; French p.139; commentary §38).

N014 [textual] The syntactic problem previously flagged as an unresolved lacuna is provisionally resolved by Bou Akl 2015 §38, but an emendation cannot be equated with the manuscript wording. Compare the immediately following contrast between verbal form (ṣīgha) and operative meaning (maʿnā).

BA15-R01 [textual] Qualified prohibitions; more than a gloss. The restoration supplies the predicate distinguishing a form normally taken as strict prohibition from a prohibition concerning a qualified act after its unconditional obligation. Bou Akl 2015, Arabic p.138, French p.139, commentary on §38. Compare the preceding / following source text; the angle-bracket segment is an editor’s conjecture.

§ 030 A methodological objection to the placement of the question

1994 Arabic p. 49 · BA §38 · 2015 Arabic p. 138 · French p. 139

وَالْعَجَبُ مِنْ أَبِي حَامِدٍ كَيْفَ جَعَلَ النَّظَرَ فِي هَذِهِ الْمَسْأَلَةِ فِي هَذَا الْجُزْءِ مِنْ هَذَا الْكِتَابِ.

It is surprising that Abū Ḥāmid placed inquiry into this question in this part of this book.

§ 031 Forbidden places of prayer and prayer on usurped land

1994 Arabic p. 49 & 50 · BA §39–40 · 2015 Arabic p. 140 · French p. 141

وَأَمَّا مَنْ أَجَازَ الصَّلَاةَ فِي الْوَادِي وَالْحَمَّامِ وَأَعْطَانِ الْإِبِلِ فَإِنَّمَا يَنْبَغِي لَهُ أَنْ يَصْرِفَ النَّهْيَ الْوَارِدَ فِيهَا عَنِ التَّحْرِيمِ إِلَى الْكَرَاهَةِ، عَلَى مَذْهَبِ مَنْ يَرَى أَنَّ وُرُودَ النَّهْيِ عَنِ الشَّيْءِ مُقَيَّدًا بِأَمْرٍ مَا مِنْ خَارِجٍ بَعْدَ إِبَاحَتِهِ، أَوِ الْأَمْرِ بِهِ مُطْلَقًا، قَرِينَةٌ يُخْرَجُ بِهَا لَفْظُ النَّهْيِ عَنِ التَّحْرِيمِ إِلَى الْكَرَاهَةِ، هَذَا إِذَا كَانَ مِمَّنْ يَرَى أَنَّ صِيغَةَ النَّهْيِ تَقْتَضِي التَّحْرِيمَ، وَأَمَّا مَنْ لَا يَرَى ذَلِكَ فَالْأَمْرُ عَلَيْهِ سَهْلٌ.

Whoever permits prayer in a valley, a bathhouse, or camels' resting places should interpret the prohibition concerning these as disapproval rather than forbiddance, following the doctrine that prohibiting something as qualified by an external matter, after permitting or commanding it without qualification, supplies a contextual indicator shifting the expression of prohibition from forbiddance to disapproval. This applies if he holds that the form of prohibition entails forbiddance. For someone who does not hold this, the matter is easy.

وَأَمَّا مَنْ أَبْطَلَ الصَّلَاةَ فِي الْأَرْضِ الْمَغْصُوبَةِ لِكَوْنِهَا حَرَكَاتٍ وَأَكْوَانًا مَنْهِيًّا عَنْهَا، فَلِجَهْلِهِ بِحُدُودِ الْمُتَضَادَّةِ، لِأَنَّ الْإِيجَابَ وَالنَّهْيَ تَعَلَّقَ بِهَا مِنْ جِهَتَيْنِ مُخْتَلِفَتَيْنِ. وَلِذَلِكَ مَا وَقَعَ إِجْمَاعُ الصَّحَابَةِ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمْ عَلَى تَرْكِ أَمْرِ الظَّلَمَةِ بِإِعَادَةِ الصَّلَوَاتِ عِنْدَ التَّوْبَةِ. وَتِلْكَ الْحَرَكَاتُ وَالْأَكْوَانُ هِيَ مِنْ جِهَةٍ مَأْمُورٌ بِهَا، وَمِنْ جِهَةٍ مَنْهِيٌّ عَنْهَا. وَكَذَلِكَ السُّجُودُ بَيْنَ يَدَيِ الصَّنَمِ عَلَى غَيْرِ جِهَةِ الْقَصْدِ هُوَ مِنْ جِهَةٍ حَرَامٌ، وَمِنْ جِهَةٍ مُتَقَرَّبٌ بِهِ.

Whoever invalidates prayer on usurped land because it consists of prohibited movements and spatial positions does so through ignorance of the definitions of contraries: obligation and prohibition attach to it in two different respects. That is why the Companions—may God be pleased with them—agreed not to command wrongdoers to repeat their prayers upon repentance. These movements and spatial positions are commanded in one respect and prohibited in another. Similarly, prostration before an idol without intending [worship of it] is forbidden in one respect and an act of drawing near [to God] in another.

Editorial notes

N015 [translation] The bracketed objects in the final sentence clarify the contrast implied by القصد and متقرب به; the Arabic does not state them expressly (printed p. 50).

§ 032 Does a ruling about an act determine its contrary?

1994 Arabic p. 50 · BA §41 · 2015 Arabic p. 140 · French p. 141

People have disagreed whether making something obligatory prohibits its contrary, and whether prohibiting it makes its contrary obligatory. We say:

اخْتَلَفَ النَّاسُ فِي وُجُوبِ الشَّيْءِ هَلْ هُوَ حَظْرٌ لِضِدِّهِ، وَحَظْرِهِ وُجُوبٌ لِضِدِّهِ، فَنَقُولُ:

§ 033 Legal contrariety versus physical incompatibility

1994 Arabic p. 50 · BA §41 · 2015 Arabic p. 140 · French p. 141

If the two contraries are defined according to their proper definition and the term is not used loosely, making a thing obligatory prohibits its contrary. For, as previously explained, whatever is indispensable to fulfilling an obligation is obligatory, whether it is an act or an omission. This question is conceivable only in legal contrariety (التضاد الشرعي). As for perceptible contrariety, abandoning the contrary is indispensable for the imposition of responsibility to be possible: it belongs to the conditions of the act.

إِنَّهُ إِذَا حُدَّ الْمُتَضَادَّانِ بِحَسَبِ حَدِّهِمَا، وَلَمْ يُسَامَحْ فِي تَسْمِيَتِهِمَا، فَوُجُوبُ الشَّيْءِ حَظْرٌ لِضِدِّهِ، لِأَنَّ مَا لَا يَتِمُّ الْوَاجِبُ إِلَّا بِهِ فَهُوَ وَاجِبٌ كَمَا تَقَدَّمَ، وَسَوَاءٌ كَانَ ذَلِكَ فِعْلًا أَوْ تَرْكًا. وَهَذِهِ الْمَسْأَلَةُ إِنَّمَا تَتَصَوَّرُ فِي التَّضَادِّ الشَّرْعِيِّ. وَأَمَّا التَّضَادُّ الْمَحْسُوسُ فَهُوَ مِمَّا لَا يَصْلُحُ التَّكْلِيفُ إِلَّا بِتَرْكِهِ، وَهُوَ مِنْ شُرُوطِ الْفِعْلِ.

§ 034 When prohibiting one contrary obliges the other

1994 Arabic p. 50 · BA §42 · 2015 Arabic p. 142 · French p. 143

As for the prohibited, if it has no contrary, or has a contrary but admits an intermediate between them, prohibiting it does not entail making anything obligatory. If, however, the thing cannot be without one of the two and there is no intermediate between them, prohibiting it makes its contrary obligatory. This too applies where the contrariety is legal; if it is perceptible, it belongs to the conditions of legal responsibility.

وَأَمَّا الْمَحْظُورُ فَإِذَا كَانَ مِمَّا كَانَ لَيْسَ لَهُ ضِدٌّ، أَوْ مِمَّا لَهُ ضِدٌّ إِلَّا أَنَّ بَيْنَهُمَا مُتَوَسِّطًا، فَلَيْسَ يَلْزَمُ عَنْ حَظْرِهِ إِيجَابُ شَيْءٍ مَا. وَأَمَّا إِذَا كَانَ لَا يَخْلُو الشَّيْءُ مِنْ أَحَدِهِمَا، وَلَمْ يَكُنْ بَيْنَهُمَا مُتَوَسِّطٌ، فَحَظْرُهُ إِيجَابٌ لِضِدِّهِ، هَذَا أَيْضًا إِذَا كَانَ التَّضَادُّ شَرْعِيًّا، وَأَمَّا إِذَا كَانَ حِسِّيًّا فَهُوَ مِنْ شَرْطِ التَّكْلِيفِ.

§ 035 Conclusion of the classification of rulings

1994 Arabic p. 50 · BA §43 · 2015 Arabic p. 142 · French p. 143

This is how the question and its answer should be approached. Here the discussion of the second section of this part ends.

فَعَلَى هَذَا يَنْبَغِي أَنْ يُتَنَاوَلَ السُّؤَالُ وَالْجَوَابُ فِي هَذِهِ الْمَسْأَلَةِ. وَهُنَا انْقَضَى الْقَوْلُ فِي الْقِسْمِ الثَّانِي مِنْ هَذَا الْجُزْءِ.

§ 036 The three elements of a legal judgement

1994 Arabic p. 51 · BA §44 · 2015 Arabic p. 142 · French p. 143

هَذَا الْقِسْمُ يَتَضَمَّنُ النَّظَرَ فِي أَرْكَانِ الْحُكْمِ، وَهِيَ ثَلَاثَةٌ: الْحَاكِمُ، وَالْمَحْكُومُ عَلَيْهِ، وَالْمَحْكُومُ فِيهِ.

This section comprises inquiry into the constituent elements of a ruling (الحكم). They are three: the one who rules, the person subject to the ruling, and that concerning which the ruling is made.

§ 037 Divine authority and delegated human obedience

1994 Arabic p. 51 · BA §45 · 2015 Arabic p. 142 · French p. 143

أَمَّا الْحَاكِمُ فَهُوَ الْمُخَاطِبُ بِالْإِيجَابِ. وَمِنْ شُرُوطِهِ، مَعَ كَوْنِهِ مُتَكَلِّمًا، نُفُوذُ الْحُكْمِ عَلَى الْإِطْلَاقِ. وَإِنَّمَا يَصِحُّ ذَلِكَ بَيْنَ الْمَالِكِ وَالْمَمْلُوكِ وَالْخَالِقِ وَالْمَخْلُوقِ، وَهُوَ اللَّهُ تَعَالَى. وَكُلُّ مَنْ لَزِمَتْ طَاعَتُهُ فَإِنَّمَا لَزِمَتْ بِإِيجَابِ اللَّهِ تَعَالَى كَالسُّلْطَانِ وَالْأَبِ وَمَا أَشْبَهَهُمَا. وَهُوَ الْقَادِرُ عَلَى الْعِقَابِ وَالثَّوَابِ إِذْ لَا يُتَصَوَّرُ الْإِيجَابُ أَوِ النَّهْيُ مِنْ غَيْرِ قَادِرٍ عَلَيْهِمَا. وَتَثْبِيتُ هَذَا فِي عِلْمِ الْكَلَامِ.

The one who rules is the speaker whose address imposes obligation. In addition to being a speaker, he must possess unrestricted authority for the ruling to take effect. This holds only between owner and owned, creator and created; the ruler is God Most High. Everyone whose obedience is obligatory—the ruler, the father, and the like—is owed obedience only because God Most High has made it obligatory. He has the power to punish and reward, since obligation or prohibition cannot be conceived as proceeding from one without power over them. This is established in theology (علم الكلام).

§ 038 Understanding the address: children and impaired reason

1994 Arabic p. 51 & 52 · BA §46–48 · 2015 Arabic p. 142 · French p. 143

وَأَمَّا الْمَحْكُومُ عَلَيْهِ فَلَهُ شَرْطَانِ هُمَا أَنْ يَفْهَمَ الْخِطَابَ الْوَارِدَ بِأَمْرٍ أَوْ نَهْيٍ، إِذْ مَنْ لَيْسَ يَفْهَمُ الْخِطَابَ لَا يَصِحُّ مِنْهُ اقْتِضَاءُ وُجُوبِ الطَّلَبِ. فَإِنْ قِيلَ فَقَدْ وَجَبَتِ الزَّكَوَاتُ وَالْغَرَامَاتُ عَلَى الصِّبْيَانِ، قُلْنَا الْمُكَلَّفُ هُوَ الْوَلِيُّ بِشَرْطِ الِاسْتِعْدَادِ لِقَبُولِ الْعَقْلِ. وَكَذَلِكَ أَخْذُهُمْ بِالصَّلَاةِ قَبْلَ الْبُلُوغِ، الْأَبُ هُوَ الْمَأْمُورُ بِذَلِكَ، لِأَنَّهُ لَا يَفْهَمُ خِطَابَ الشَّرْعِ إِلَّا مَنْ يَعْرِفُ الشَّارِعَ، وَلَا يَعْرِفُ الشَّارِعَ إِلَّا مَنْ يَعْرِفُ اللَّهَ، وَهَذَا الشَّرْطُ مُدْرَكُهُ الْعَقْلُ.

The person subject to the ruling has two conditions. The first is understanding the address containing a command or prohibition, since an obligatory demand cannot properly be directed to someone who does not understand the address. If it is objected that alms and financial liabilities have been imposed upon children, we answer: the legally responsible person is the guardian, subject to readiness to receive reason. Likewise, in requiring children to pray before puberty, it is the father who is commanded. For only one who knows the Lawgiver (الشارع) understands the Law's address, and only one who knows God knows the Lawgiver. This condition is apprehended by reason.

وَمِنْ هُنَا يَتَبَيَّنُ سُقُوطُ تَكْلِيفِ النَّاسِي وَالْغَافِلِ وَالْمَجْنُونِ وَالسَّكْرَانِ. فَإِنْ قِيلَ فَكَيْفَ يَقَعُ طَلَاقُ السَّكْرَانِ عِنْدَ مَنْ يُجَوِّزُهُ؟ قُلْنَا ذَلِكَ عَلَى جِهَةِ التَّغْلِيظِ، إِذْ كَانَ هُوَ الَّذِي جَنَى عَلَى نَفْسِهِ بِاخْتِيَارِهِ بَعْدَ شَرْطِ التَّكْلِيفِ وَهُوَ الْعَقْلُ. وَلَيْسَ يُتَصَوَّرُ مِثْلُ هَذَا فِي الْمَجْنُونِ، وَتَعَلُّقُ مَنْ تَعَلَّقَ فِي جَوَازِ خِطَابِهِ بِقَوْلِهِ تَبَارَكَ وَتَعَالَى: {لَا تَقْرَبُوا الصَّلَاةَ وَأَنْتُمْ سُكَارَى} فَإِنَّهُ إِنْ سُلِّمَ ظُهُورُ ذَلِكَ فِي الْآيَةِ فَلَيْسَ يُصَادَمُ بِالظَّوَاهِرِ الْقَطْعِيَّاتُ. وَلَهَا تَأْوِيلَاتٌ:

From this it becomes clear that legal responsibility lapses for the forgetful, the heedless, the insane, and the intoxicated. If it is asked why an intoxicated person's divorce takes effect according to those who allow it, we answer that this is a measure of severity: he has brought the harm upon himself by his own choice, after [possessing] reason, the condition of legal responsibility. Such a case cannot be conceived for an insane person. As for appealing, in support of the possibility of addressing the intoxicated, to His words—blessed and exalted is He—'Do not approach prayer while you are intoxicated': even if this apparent meaning is conceded in the verse, apparent meanings (الظواهر) are not set against certainties. The verse admits interpretations:

Editorial notes

N016 [textual] Printed p. 51 has the compressed constructions الولي بشرط الاستعداد لقبول العقل and بعد شرط التكليف وهو العقل. The former is retained without silently assigning the readiness clause to a different subject; the latter is rendered with an explicit explanatory supplement.

§ 039 A defective reading about partial intoxication

1994 Arabic p. 52 · BA §48 · 2015 Arabic p. 144 · French p. 145

أَحَدُهَا أَنَّهَا خِطَابٌ مَعَ الْمُسْتَثْنَى.

One is that it is an address to [a person in the early stages of intoxication].

Editorial notes

N017 [textual] Printed p. 52 reads المستثنى, literally "the excepted person". The corresponding passage of al-Mustaṣfā reads المنتشي and describes someone in the early stages of intoxication who retains reason (primary parallel: https://www.islamweb.net/ar/library/content/33/57/). The English brackets this contextual reading; the Arabic print is retained, and no new manuscript emendation is claimed.

§ 040 Addressing the sober about later intoxication

1994 Arabic p. 52 · BA §48 · 2015 Arabic p. 144 · French p. 145

وَالْآخَرُ أَنَّهُ إِنَّمَا وَقَعَ الْمَنْعُ مِنْ إِفْرَاطِ الشُّرْبِ فِي أَوْقَاتِ الصَّلَاةِ، وَذَلِكَ خِطَابٌ فِي وَقْتِ الصِّحَّةِ، وَقَبْلَ أَنْ تُحَرَّمَ الْخَمْرُ.

Another is that what was prohibited was excessive drinking at the times of prayer: the address was issued while the hearers were in a sound state, before wine was prohibited.

§ 041 Eternal command and the limits of the present discipline

1994 Arabic p. 52 · BA §49 · 2015 Arabic p. 144 · French p. 145

They append the objection: how can God eternally command His servants, when a condition of commanding is that the commanded person exist?

Similarly, how can He command the intoxicated while intoxicated, or the insane and the child, on condition that the first recover consciousness, the second become sound, and the third reach puberty? An answer is not possible in this place, nor is the question peculiar to this inquiry. Discussing it rests on principles requiring lengthy preparation and extensive examination. As we have said, we should not investigate everything, or many things, in a single place; each should receive its own treatment in the place appropriate to it. What prompts this practice is a love of multiplying material that serves no purpose.

فَأَمَّا الِاعْتِرَاضُ الَّذِي يُلْحِقُونَ هَهُنَا وَهُوَ كَيْفَ يَكُونُ اللَّهُ آمِرًا فِي الْأَزَلِ لِعِبَادِهِ وَمِنْ شَرْطِ الْأَمْرِ أَنْ يَكُونَ الْمَأْمُورُ مَوْجُودًا، وَكَذَلِكَ كَوْنُهُ آمِرًا لِلسَّكْرَانِ فِي حَالِ سُكْرِهِ وَلِلْمَجْنُونِ وَالصَّبِيِّ، عَلَى شَرْطِ أَنْ يُفِيقَ ذَلِكَ وَيَصِحَّ ذَلِكَ وَيَبْلُغَ هَذَا، فَالْجَوَابُ عَنْهُ لَيْسَ مِمَّا يُمْكِنُ فِي هَذَا الْمَوْضِعِ، وَلَا هُوَ خَاصٌّ بِهَذَا النَّظَرِ. وَالْقَوْلُ فِيهِ مَبْنِيٌّ عَلَى قَوَاعِدَ تَحْتَاجُ إِلَى تَمْهِيدٍ طَوِيلٍ وَفَحْصٍ كَثِيرٍ. وَكَمَا قُلْنَا أَنَّهُ لَيْسَ يَنْبَغِي أَنْ نَفْحَصَ عَنْ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ وَلَا عَنْ أَشْيَاءَ كَثِيرَةٍ فِي مَوْضِعٍ وَاحِدٍ، بَلْ يَنْبَغِي أَنْ يُفْرَدَ بِالْقَوْلِ كُلُّ وَاحِدٍ مِنْهَا فِي الْمَوْضِعِ اللَّائِقِ بِهِ، وَالَّذِي يَحْمِلُ عَلَى هَذَا حُبُّ التَّكْثِيرِ بِمَا لَيْسَ يُفِيدُ شَيْئًا.

§ 042 Puberty as a practical legal sign

1994 Arabic p. 52 · BA §50 · 2015 Arabic p. 146 · French p. 147

The second condition is puberty, and this condition is apprehended through the Law. If it is asked whether a boy is not rational shortly before his first nocturnal emission, since the emission of semen does not add to his reason, we answer: because the attainment of reason is difficult to discern in each individual and its timing varies, the Law appointed a sign that indicates it in most cases.

وَأَمَّا الشَّرْطُ الثَّانِي فَهُوَ الْبُلُوغُ، وَهَذَا الشَّرْطُ مُدْرَكُهُ الشَّرْعُ. فَإِنْ قِيلَ فَقَبْلَ أَنْ يَحْتَلِمَ الصَّبِيُّ بِزَمَانٍ يَسِيرٍ أَلَيْسَ هُوَ عَاقِلًا؟ فَإِنَّ انْفِصَالَ النُّطْفَةِ عَنْهُ لَا تَزِيدُهُ عَقْلًا؟ قُلْنَا: لَمَّا كَانَ ذَلِكَ مِمَّا يَخْفَى دَرْكُهُ فِي شَخْصٍ شَخْصٍ، وَيَخْتَلِفُ وَقْتُهُ، نَصَبَ الشَّرْعُ لِذَلِكَ عَلَامَةً تُوجَدُ عَلَى الْأَكْثَرِ دَالَّةً عَلَيْهِ.

§ 043 The voluntary act and intention of obedience

1994 Arabic p. 52 · BA §51 · 2015 Arabic p. 146 · French p. 147

That concerning which the ruling is made, namely the act, is what can be acquired by the servant through his choice, while believing that its acquisition is obedience and compliance.

وَأَمَّا الْمَحْكُومُ فِيهِ وَهُوَ الْفِعْلُ فَإِنَّهُ مَا جَازَ كَوْنُهُ مُكْتَسَبًا لِلْعَبْدِ بِاخْتِيَارِهِ مَعَ اعْتِقَادِ اكْتِسَابِهِ طَاعَةً وَامْتِثَالًا.

§ 044 Choice, necessary assent, and the will to obey

1994 Arabic p. 52 & 53 · BA §51–53 · 2015 Arabic p. 146 · French p. 147

It should be understood that the things a human being acquires are those in which he may perform

whichever of two contraries he wishes: standing, for example, is acquired by him, and he may stand or sit. If this is the meaning of acquisition (الاكتساب), there is no point in their purported exception for the obligation of inquiry that leads to knowledge, on the ground that one cannot intend to perform it as obedience before knowing it to be obligatory. For, as we have said, the obligation to inquire arises necessarily because the object of inquiry is necessarily known. A person has no choice in assenting to its obligatoriness when the miracle appears.

وَيَنْبَغِي أَنْ يُعْلَمَ أَنَّ الْأُمُورَ الْمُكْتَسَبَةَ لِلْإِنْسَانِ هِيَ الَّتِي لَهُ أَنْ يَأْتِيَ مِنْهَا أَيِّ الضِّدَّيْنِ شَاءَ، مِثْلَ أَنَّ الْقِيَامَ مُكْتَسَبٌ لَهُ وَلَهُ أَنْ يَقُومَ أَوْ يَقْعُدَ. وَإِذَا كَانَ مَعْنَى الِاكْتِسَابِ هَذَا فَلَا مَعْنَى لِاسْتِثْنَائِهِمْ مِنْ هَذَا، كَمَا زَعَمُوا، وُجُوبَ النَّظَرِ الْمُعَرِّفِ، إِذْ لَا يُمْكِنُ فِيمَا زَعَمُوا قَصْدُ إِيقَاعِهِ طَاعَةً قَبْلَ الْمَعْرِفَةِ بِوُجُوبِهِ، لِأَنَّ وُجُوبَ النَّظَرِ كَمَا سَلَفَ مِنْ قَوْلِنَا يَحْصُلُ ضَرُورَةً لِكَوْنِ الْمَنْظُورِ فِيهِ مَعْلُومًا بِالضَّرُورَةِ. وَلَيْسَ لِإِنْسَانٍ اخْتِيَارٌ فِي وُقُوعِ التَّصْدِيقِ بِوُجُوبِهِ عِنْدَ ظُهُورِ الْمُعْجِزَةِ.

Nor is there any point in their exception for the will to obey, or their saying that if willing required a will, that will would require another will, producing an infinite regress. Will is desire (شوق), and the arising of desire in a human being is something like a necessary occurrence, since its producer is assent involving hope and fear. Thus the condition of a legally prescribed act is, first, that it be acquired; and second, that the cause in acquiring [the act] be belief in the command's obligatoriness, [rather than] other things he may do.

وَكَذَلِكَ أَيْضًا لَا مَعْنَى لِاسْتِثْنَائِهِمْ مِنْ ذَلِكَ إِرَادَةَ الطَّاعَةِ، وَقَوْلِهِمْ إِنَّ الْإِرَادَةَ لَوِ افْتَقَرَتْ إِلَى إِرَادَةٍ لَافْتَقَرَتِ الْإِرَادَةُ إِلَى إِرَادَةٍ وَتَسَلْسَلَ الْأَمْرُ، فَإِنَّ الْإِرَادَةَ شَوْقٌ، وَحُدُوثُ الشَّوْقِ لِلْإِنْسَانِ كَالضَّرُورِيِّ، إِذْ كَانَ فَاعِلُهُ التَّصْدِيقَ بِالرَّغْبَةِ وَالرَّهْبَةِ، فَشَرْطُ الْفِعْلِ الشَّرْعِيِّ أَنْ يَكُونَ مُكْتَسَبًا أَوَّلًا، ثُمَّ ثَانِيًا أَنْ يَكُونَ السَّبَبُ فِي اكْتِسَابِ اعْتِقَادِ وُجُوبِ الْأَمْرِ لِأَشْيَاءَ أُخَرَ مِمَّا يَجُوزُ لَهُ أَنْ يَفْعَلَ.

Editorial notes

N018 [textual] The final clause on printed p. 53 is syntactically defective or compressed: السبب في اكتساب اعتقاد وجوب الأمر لأشياء أخر مما يجوز له أن يفعل. The context (§43 and the immediately preceding account of motivation) suggests contrasting belief in obligation with other motives. The English marks this contextual interpretation with brackets; no manuscript correction or missing negative is asserted, and the printed Arabic is retained.

§ 045 Human agency and the impossibility of burdens beyond capacity

1994 Arabic p. 53 & 54 · BA §54–55 · 2015 Arabic p. 148 · French p. 149

For the shaykh Abū al-Ḥasan, however, being acquired is not a condition of an act. He holds that there is no act acquired by the human being at all: what makes the human being appear to be an agent of something is an accompanying and incidental matter, without the human being being either its proximate or its remote cause. Thus, for example, the relation of someone with two feet to walking would be exactly that of someone without feet. This contradicts sense perception and is a

وَأَمَّا الشَّيْخُ أَبُو الْحَسَنِ فَلَيْسَ مِنْ شَرْطِ الْفِعْلِ عِنْدَهُ أَنْ يَكُونَ مُكْتَسَبًا، بَلْ يَرَى أَنْ لَيْسَ هَهُنَا فِعْلٌ مُكْتَسَبٌ لِلْإِنْسَانِ أَصْلًا، وَأَنَّ مَا يُظْهِرُ كَوْنَ الْإِنْسَانِ فَاعِلًا لِلشَّيْءِ فَأَمْرٌ مُصَاحِبٌ وَلَاحِقٌ لَا أَنَّ الْإِنْسَانَ لِذَلِكَ الْفِعْلِ سَبَبٌ لَا قَرِيبٌ وَلَا بَعِيدٌ، حَتَّى تَكُونَ نِسْبَةُ ذِي الْقَدَمَيْنِ مَثَلًا إِلَى الْمَشْيِ هِيَ بِعَيْنِهَا نِسْبَةَ الْعَادِمِ لِلْقَدَمَيْنِ. وَهَذِهِ مُخَالَفَةٌ لِلْحِسِّ

view exceedingly foreign to human nature. Abū al-Maʿālī, in al-Risāla al-Niẓāmiyya, explained the respect in which one may properly say, within the Law, that human beings possess capacity and acquisition (اقتدارا واكتسابا).

وَرَأْيٌ غَرِيبٌ جِدًّا عَنْ طِبَاعِ الْإِنْسَانِ. وَقَدْ بَيَّنَ أَبُو الْمَعَالِي فِي «الرِّسَالَةِ النِّظَامِيَّةِ» الْوَجْهَ الَّذِي بِهِ يَصْلُحُ فِي الشَّرْعِ أَنْ يُقَالَ إِنَّ لِلْإِنْسَانِ اقْتِدَارًا وَاكْتِسَابًا.

Whoever denies human beings capacity for anything allows the imposition of what is beyond their capacity; he is right to do so on his own account, since on his view nothing is within their capacity. What we should say here is that imposing what is beyond capacity is impossible both rationally and legally. Legally, because of His saying, ‘God charges no soul beyond its capacity.’ Rationally, because the impossible cannot be present in the soul, and because a condition of what is commanded is that it be understood and its possibility conceived by both the commander and the commanded.

وَمَنْ لَمْ يَكُنْ عِنْدَهُ لِلْإِنْسَانِ اقْتِدَارٌ عَلَى شَيْءٍ مَا، جَازَ عِنْدَهُ تَكْلِيفُ مَا لَا يُطَاقُ، وَبِحَقٍّ مَا فَعَلَ ذَلِكَ لِأَنَّهُ لَيْسَ عَلَى رَأْيِهِ هَهُنَا شَيْءٌ يُطَاقُ. وَالَّذِي يَنْبَغِي أَنْ نَقُولَ هَهُنَا أَنَّ تَكْلِيفَ مَا لَا يُطَاقُ مُمْتَنِعٌ عَقْلًا وَشَرْعًا. أَمَّا شَرْعًا فَلِقَوْلِهِ: {لَا يُكَلِّفُ اللَّهُ نَفْسًا إِلَّا وُسْعَهَا}. وَأَمَّا عَقْلًا فَلِامْتِنَاعِ قِيَامِ الْمُحَالِ بِالنَّفْسِ، وَأَنَّ مِنَ الشَّرْطِ الْمَأْمُورِ بِهِ أَنْ يَكُونَ مَفْهُومًا وَمُتَصَوَّرًا مَكَانُهُ عِنْدَ الْآمِرِ وَالْمَأْمُورِ.

Editorial notes

N019 [textual] At the close of §45, printed p. 54 has ومتصورا مكانه; ‘its possibility conceived’ reads مكانه contextually as إمكانه. The visible printed form is retained in Arabic.

N020 [translation] Abū al-Ḥasan is al-Ashʿarī; Abū al-Maʿālī is al-Juwaynī. This paragraph reports and criticizes theological accounts of human agency.

N021 [grammar] In the first segment يُظْهِرُ is read transitively: “what makes [him] appear to be an agent”; كَوْنَ is its object. This supplies a grammatical reading without altering the consonants. The description is Ibn Rushd’s criticism of Abū al-Ḥasan’s position, not an independent reconstruction of al-Ashʿarī’s doctrine. In the last segment the printed مَكَانُهُ is preserved, although the English follows the likely sense of إِمْكَانُهُ.

BA15-E54 [textual] Bou Akl 2015 prints one or more editorial angle-bracket additions in his §54 (Arabic edition around p.148, corresponding French translation around p.149). They are not automatically adopted here: some were already present in the al-ʿAlawī-based reading text, others are uncertain. Check his footnotes and the 1994 printed base before treating these as independent manuscript readings. This entry records editorial intervention, not verified word-for-word collation of every line in that section.

BA15-E55 [textual] Bou Akl 2015 prints one or more editorial angle-bracket additions in his §55 (Arabic edition around p.148, corresponding French translation around p.149). They are not automatically adopted here: some were already present in the al-ʿAlawī-based reading text, others are uncertain. Check his footnotes and the 1994 printed base before treating these as independent manuscript readings. This entry records editorial intervention, not verified word-for-word collation of every line in that section.

§ 046 Further questions concerning responsible action

1994 Arabic p. 54 · BA §56 · 2015 Arabic p. 148 · French p. 149

Several questions may be appended to the end of this part:

وَقَدْ يَلْحَقُ آخِرَ هَذَا الْجُزْءِ مَسَائِلُ:

§ 047 Coercion, intention, and degrees of harm

1994 Arabic p. 54 & 55 · BA §57–58 · 2015 Arabic p. 148 · French p. 149

One question is whether someone coerced into compliance with, or violation of, a legal

requirement (التكليف) acts by choice, so as to be rewarded for the one and punished for the other. We say: someone coerced into compliance may reasonably be thought to act by choice insofar as he can do otherwise and endure the means of coercion. This varies with the harm inflicted upon him. Yet if he does not perform the act believing it to be obedience and compliance, he receives no reward; if he does believe this, he is rewarded. Even when coercion initially moves him to act, if, upon undertaking the act, he believes its performance to be obedience, he is rewarded.

فَمِنْهَا هَلِ الْمُكْرَهُ عَلَى وَفْقِ التَّكْلِيفِ أَوْ خِلَافِهِ مُخْتَارٌ حَتَّى يُثَابَ عَلَى الْوَاحِدِ وَيُعَاقَبَ عَلَى الْآخَرِ؟ وَنَحْنُ نَقُولُ فِي ذَلِكَ: أَمَّا الْمُكْرَهُ عَلَى وَفْقِ التَّكْلِيفِ فَقَدْ يُشْبِهُ أَنْ يُظَنَّ بِهِ أَنَّهُ مُخْتَارٌ مِنْ جِهَةِ أَنَّ لَهُ أَنْ يَأْتِيَ بِخِلَافِ مَا أُكْرِهَ عَلَيْهِ مُحْتَمِلًا لِمَا بِهِ أُكْرِهَ. وَهَذَا التَّفَاوُتُ بِحَسَبِ مَا يَلْحَقُ الْمُكْرَهَ مِنَ الْأَذَى. لَكِنْ إِنْ لَمْ يَأْتِ ذَلِكَ مُعْتَقِدًا إِتْيَانَهُ طَاعَةً وَامْتِثَالًا لَمْ يُثَبْ عَلَيْهِ، فَإِنِ اعْتَقَدَ ذَلِكَ أُثِيبَ عَلَيْهِ. وَإِنْ كَانَ سَبَبُ تَحْرِيكِهِ إِلَى الْفِعْلِ الْإِكْرَاهَ، فَإِنَّهُ إِذَا أَخَذَ فِي الْفِعْلِ وَاعْتَقَدَ وُقُوعَهُ طَاعَةً أُثِيبَ عَلَيْهِ.

It is in this respect that coercing unbelievers to faith by [the threat of] killing occurs in the Law. In general, threatening punishment is a kind of coercion in this respect. Such a case is conceivable when obstinacy or some other impediment prevents a person from complying. In general, the soul that commands evil often turns a person away from a duty even while he believes it obligatory.

وَعَلَى هَذَا الْوَجْهِ جَاءَ إِكْرَاهُ الْكُفَّارِ عَلَى الْإِيمَانِ بِالْقَتْلِ فِي الشَّرْعِ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَالتَّوَعُّدُ بِالْعِقَابِ هُوَ إِكْرَاهٌ مَا عَلَى هَذَا الْوَجْهِ. وَمِثْلُ هَذَا يُتَصَوَّرُ فِي أَنْ يَكُونَ الْإِنْسَانُ يَصُدُّهُ عَنِ الِامْتِثَالِ عِنَادٌ أَوْ غَيْرُ ذَلِكَ مِنَ الْأَسْبَابِ الْمَانِعَةِ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ الْأَمَّارَةُ بِالسُّوءِ كَثِيرًا مَا تَصُدُّ الْإِنْسَانَ عَنِ الْوَاجِبِ مَعَ اعْتِقَادِ وُجُوبِهِ.

As for someone coerced into violating the Law—for example, into killing a Muslim or omitting prayer—there are two questions. First, does he sin if he acts as the coercion demands? Second, if he endures the coercion and does not act as it demands, is he rewarded or does he sin, given that a person's own life has a claim upon him?

وَأَمَّا الْمُكْرَهُ عَلَى مُخَالَفَةِ الشَّرْعِ مِثْلِ الْإِكْرَاهِ عَلَى قَتْلِ مُسْلِمٍ، أَوْ تَرْكِ الصَّلَاةِ، فَالسُّؤَالُ فِيهِ فِي مَوْضِعَيْنِ: أَحَدُهُمَا: هَلْ إِذَا فَعَلَ بِمُقْتَضَى الْإِكْرَاهِ أَثِمَ أَمْ لَا؟ وَالثَّانِي: إِنِ احْتَمَلَ الْإِكْرَاهَ وَلَمْ يَفْعَلْ بِمُقْتَضَاهُ هَلْ يُثَابُ أَوْ يَأْثَمُ، فَإِنَّ لِنَفْسِ الْمَرْءِ عَلَيْهِ حَقًّا،

What should be said is that coercion varies in degree according to its means. Apprehending these degrees, comparing them with violation of the command, and preferring one over the other are matters apprehended through the Law, especially when the means of coercion is of the same kind as the act demanded—for example, coercion by killing into killing. In general, this question is a matter of independent judgement (اجتهادية).

وَالَّذِي يَنْبَغِي أَنْ يُقَالَ فِي ذَلِكَ هُوَ أَنَّ الْإِكْرَاهَ تَتَفَاوَتُ مَرَاتِبُهُ لِتَفَاوُتِ مَا بِهِ يَقَعُ الْإِكْرَاهُ، وَمُدْرَكُ مَرَاتِبِ هَذَا التَّفَاوُتِ، وَالْمُقَايَسَةِ بَيْنَهُ وَبَيْنَ مُخَالَفَةِ الْأَمْرِ وَتَرْجِيحِ أَحَدِهِمَا عَلَى الْآخَرِ، مُدْرَكٌ شَرْعِيٌّ، وَلَاسِيَّمَا إِذَا كَانَ مَا بِهِ يَقَعُ الْإِكْرَاهُ مِنْ نَوْعِ الْمُكْرَهِ عَلَيْهِ، مِثْلَ أَنْ يُكْرَهَ بِالْقَتْلِ عَلَى الْقَتْلِ، وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَهَذِهِ الْمَسْأَلَةُ اجْتِهَادِيَّةٌ.

Editorial notes

N022 [translation] 'The threat of' in the second segment makes explicit the coercive context established by التوعد بالعقاب; the Arabic phrase is بالقتل. The passage presents the author's historical legal argument.

§ 048 Active restraint and mere non-performance

1994 Arabic p. 55 · BA §59 · 2015 Arabic p. 150 · French p. 151

وَمِنْهَا: هَلِ الْمُقْتَضَى بِالتَّكْلِيفِ الْكَفُّ كَمَا يَقْتَضِي الْفِعْلَ. وَالْجَوَابُ أَنَّ التَّرْكَ صِنْفَانِ: صِنْفٌ يَلْحَقُ الْإِنْسَانَ عِنْدَ تَرْكِهِ التَّلَبُّسُ بِضِدٍّ، فَهَذَا يُثَابُ عَلَيْهِ كَالصِّيَامِ. وَصِنْفٌ لَا يَلْحَقُ الْإِنْسَانَ عِنْدَ تَرْكِهِ التَّلَبُّسُ بِضِدٍّ، فَهَذَا لَا يُثَابُ عَلَيْهِ. وَإِلْحَاقُ مَسْأَلَةٍ مَسْأَلَةٍ بِهَذَيْنِ الصِّنْفَيْنِ نَظَرٌ فُرُوعِيٌّ.

Another question is whether the imposition of legal responsibility (التكليف) demands restraint just as it demands action. The answer is that omission is of two kinds. In one, a person, when omitting something, engages in its contrary; this is rewarded, as in fasting. In the other, omitting something does not involve engagement in a contrary; this is not rewarded. Assigning each individual case to one of these two kinds belongs to inquiry into the branches of law.

§ 049 Commands before fulfilment of their conditions

1994 Arabic p. 55 · BA §60–61 · 2015 Arabic p. 150 · French p. 151

وَمِنْهَا: هَلْ يَتَوَجَّهُ الْأَمْرُ بِالشَّيْءِ قَبْلَ حُصُولِ شَرْطِهِ، كَالْأَمْرِ بِالصَّلَاةِ، فَيُعَاقَبُ عَلَى تَرْكِهِ مِنْ غَيْرِ حُصُولِ شَرْطِهِ، هَذَا إِذَا كَانَ الشَّرْطُ شَرْعِيًّا كَأَمْرِ الْمُحْدِثِ بِالصَّلَاةِ فِي حِينِ إِحْدَاثِهِ، أَوْ لَا يَتَوَجَّهُ الْأَمْرُ بِالشَّيْءِ إِلَّا بَعْدَ حُصُولِ شَرْطِهِ كَالْأَمْرِ بِالصَّلَاةِ فِي حِينِ الطَّهَارَةِ؟

Another question is whether the command to do something, such as the command to pray, applies before its condition is fulfilled, so that omission is punishable even without fulfilment of the condition. This concerns a legal condition: for example, commanding a ritually impure person to pray while impure. Or does the command apply only after the condition is fulfilled, as when prayer is commanded in a state of purity?

وَنَحْنُ نَقُولُ: إِذَا كَانَ الشَّرْطُ مُكْتَسَبًا لِلْإِنْسَانِ بِاخْتِيَارِهِ فَجَائِزٌ أَنْ يُؤْمَرَ الْإِنْسَانُ بِالشَّيْءِ عَلَى تَقْدِيرِ حُصُولِ شَرْطِهِ وَيُعَاقَبَ عَلَى تَرْكِهِ، وَإِنْ لَمْ يَأْتِ بِشَرْطِهِ كَتَارِكِ الصَّلَاةِ يُعَاقَبُ عَلَيْهَا وَإِنْ لَمْ يَتَوَضَّأْ قَطُّ، وَبِذَلِكَ وَرَدَ الشَّرْعُ.

We say: if a person can acquire the condition by choice, he may be commanded to perform the act on the supposition that its condition is fulfilled and punished for omitting it even if he has not fulfilled the condition. Someone who omits prayer is punished for it even if he has never performed ablution. So the Law has prescribed.

وَقَدْ دَلَّ دَلِيلُ الْإِجْمَاعِ عَلَى لُحُوقِ الْعِقَابِ لِلْمُكَذِّبِ بِالرُّسُلِ، قَبْلَ الْمَعْرِفَةِ بِاللَّهِ وَإِنْ كَانَتْ شَرْطًا لِلْإِيمَانِ بِالرُّسُلِ، وَقَدْ تَمَسَّكَ قَوْمٌ فِي هَذَا بِقَوْلِهِ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ: {مَا سَلَكَكُمْ فِي سَقَرَ قَالُوا لَمْ نَكُ مِنَ الْمُصَلِّينَ}، وَرَامُوا أَنْ يُثْبِتُوا أَنَّهُ نَصٌّ فِي الْآيَةِ، وَهِيَ وَإِنْ لَمْ تَكُنْ نَصًّا فَهِيَ ظَاهِرَةٌ، لِأَنَّهُ مُحْتَمَلٌ أَنْ يُرِيدَ هَهُنَا بِالْمُصَلِّينَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ كَمَا قَالَ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ: «نُهِيتُ

The proof of consensus indicates that punishment attaches to one who denies the messengers even before knowing God, although such knowledge is a condition of faith in the messengers. Some appealed here to His words—mighty and exalted—‘What brought you into Saqar? They said: We were not among those who pray.’ They sought to establish that the verse contains unambiguous wording (نص) on this. Although it is not unambiguous, this is its apparent meaning (ظاهرة), since ‘those who pray’ may here mean believers, as in his saying—peace be upon him—‘I have

been forbidden to kill those who pray.’ Anyone who considers such a case rationally impossible interprets the apparent meaning otherwise, as is usual with an apparent expression that admits alternatives.

عَنْ قَتْلِ الْمُصَلِّينَ». وَمَا امْتَنَعَ وُقُوعُ مِثْلِ هَذَا عِنْدَهُ عَقْلًا صَرَفَ الظَّاهِرَ إِلَى التَّأْوِيلِ كَالْعَادَةِ فِي الظَّاهِرِ الْمُحْتَمِلِ.

§ 050 Legal conditions are not conditions of physical possibility

1994 Arabic p. 56 · BA §62 · 2015 Arabic p. 152 · French p. 153

Those who disallow imposing responsibility in such a case argued that there is no meaning in obliging almsgiving and the discharge of prayer when their occurrence is impossible: how can something be obligatory when it cannot be complied with? These people have confused a legal condition (الشرط الشرعي) with a condition of actual existence (الشرط الوجودي). The matter is otherwise. The command applies to this responsible person before its condition is fulfilled only on the supposition that the condition will be fulfilled; this is within his capacity and can be acquired, unlike a condition of actual existence.

وَقَدِ احْتَجَّ مَنْ مَنَعَ التَّكْلِيفَ بِمِثْلِ هَذَا بِأَنَّهُ لَا مَعْنَى لِوُجُوبِ الزَّكَاةِ وَقَضَاءِ الصَّلَاةِ مَعَ اسْتِحَالَةِ وُقُوعِهِمَا فَكَيْفَ يَجِبُ مَا لَا يُمْكِنُ امْتِثَالُهُ. وَهَؤُلَاءِ الْقَوْمُ اشْتَبَهَ عَلَيْهِمُ الشَّرْطُ الشَّرْعِيُّ بِالشَّرْطِ الْوُجُودِيِّ. وَلَيْسَ الْأَمْرُ كَذَلِكَ فَهَذَا الْمُكَلَّفُ إِنَّمَا يَتَوَجَّهُ إِلَيْهِ الْأَمْرُ بِالشَّيْءِ قَبْلَ حُصُولِ شَرْطِهِ عَلَى تَقْدِيرِ حُصُولِ شَرْطِهِ، وَهُوَ مُسْتَطَاعٌ لَهُ وَمُكْتَسَبٌ بِخِلَافِ الشَّرْطِ الْوُجُودِيِّ.

§ 051 Conversion, apostasy, and a distinct command to make up acts

1994 Arabic p. 56 · BA §63 · 2015 Arabic p. 152 · French p. 153

Their argument that, when an unbeliever becomes Muslim, the obligation concerning [past] prayer and almsgiving falls away contains no proof. We hold that this obligation lapses upon conversion only on the basis of a legal proof. We require make-up performance (القضاء) from an apostate but not from an unbeliever because make-up performance becomes obligatory only through a separate command; the legal proof must therefore be followed. Thus someone not commanded to perform an act within its time (الأداء) may be commanded to make it up, while someone commanded to perform it within its time may not be commanded to make it up.

أَمَّا احْتِجَاجُهُمْ بِأَنَّ الْكَافِرَ إِذَا أَسْلَمَ انْتَفَى وُجُوبُ الصَّلَاةِ وَالزَّكَاةِ عَنْهُ، فَلَا حُجَّةَ فِيهِ، لِأَنَّ مَصِيرَنَا إِلَى سُقُوطِ وُجُوبِهَا بِالْإِسْلَامِ إِنَّمَا هُوَ بِدَلِيلِ الشَّرْعِ وَإِنَّمَا أَوْجَبْنَا الْقَضَاءَ عَلَى الْمُرْتَدِّ دُونَ الْكَافِرِ، لِأَنَّ الْقَضَاءَ إِنَّمَا يَجِبُ بِأَمْرٍ مُجَرَّدٍ فَلْيُتَّبَعْ فِيهِ الدَّلِيلُ الشَّرْعِيُّ، وَلِذَلِكَ قَدْ يُؤْمَرُ بِالْقَضَاءِ مَنْ لَا يُؤْمَرُ بِالْأَدَاءِ، وَقَدْ يُؤْمَرُ بِالْأَدَاءِ مَنْ لَا يُؤْمَرُ بِالْقَضَاءِ.

§ 052 No demand to combine or abandon exhaustive contraries

1994 Arabic p. 56 · BA §64 · 2015 Arabic p. 154 · French p. 155

They append a fourth question to this topic: just as a command to combine two contraries is

inadmissible, so is a command to abstain from both when there is no intermediate between them.

وَمِمَّا يُلْحِقُونَ بِهَذَا الْبَابِ مَسْأَلَةً رَابِعَةً وَهِيَ: كَمَا أَنَّهُ لَا يَجُوزُ إِتْيَانُ الْأَمْرِ بِالْجَمْعِ بَيْنَ الضِّدَّيْنِ كَذَلِكَ لَا يَجُوزُ إِتْيَانُ الْأَمْرِ بِالتَّخَلِّي عَنْهُمَا، إِذَا لَمْ يَكُنْ بَيْنَهُمَا وَسَطٌ.

§ 053 Hard cases: usurped fields and unavoidable injury

1994 Arabic p. 56 & 57 · BA §64–66 · 2015 Arabic p. 154 · French p. 155

They claim, however, that certain particular cases cast doubt on this universal proposition. One concerns someone in the middle of a usurped cultivated field: both remaining and leaving are forbidden, since each damages another person's crop, and whichever he does he is disobedient. Another concerns someone who falls on the chest of a child surrounded by children, knowing that if he remains he will kill the child beneath him, and if he moves he will kill those around him.

وَلَكِنْ هَا هُنَا فِيمَا زَعَمُوا مَسَائِلُ جُزْئِيَّةٌ تُوقِعُ شَكًّا فِي هَذِهِ الْمَسْأَلَةِ الْكُلِّيَّةِ وَهِيَ: مَنْ تَوَسَّطَ أَرْضًا مُزْدَرَعَةً مَغْصُوبَةً فَيَحْرُمُ عَلَيْهِ الْمَكْثُ وَيَحْرُمُ عَلَيْهِ الْخُرُوجُ، إِذْ فِي كُلِّ وَاحِدٍ فَسَادُ زَرْعِ الْغَيْرِ، فَهُوَ عَاصٍ بِأَيِّهِمَا فَعَلَ. وَكَذَلِكَ مَنْ سَقَطَ عَلَى صَدْرِ صَبِيٍّ مَحْفُوفٍ بِصِبْيَانٍ، وَعَلِمَ إِنَّهُ إِنْ مَكَثَ قَتَلَ مَنْ تَحْتَهُ وَإِنِ انْتَقَلَ قَتَلَ مَنْ حَوَالَيْهِ.

Such questions are matters of independent judgement. They cast no doubt on the inadmissibility of a command to abstain from both contraries. It may plausibly be said that the person is not legally responsible in this condition. Or it may be said that in the first case he should leave to reduce the harm, and in the second remain, since moving is a new act that can proceed only from a living person. It is also possible to say that he has a choice, especially if neither act is preferable to the other in causing less harm. Here the discussion of the act, the third section of this book's first part, ends.

وَمِثْلُ هَذِهِ الْمَسَائِلِ فَهِيَ اجْتِهَادِيَّةٌ، وَلَيْسَتْ مِمَّا يُوقِعُ شَكًّا فِي أَنَّهُ لَا يَجُوزُ وُرُودُ الْأَمْرِ بِالتَّخَلِّي عَنِ الضِّدَّيْنِ. وَيُشْبِهُ أَنْ يُقَالَ فِيهَا هُوَ غَيْرُ مُكَلَّفٍ فِي هَذَا الْحَالِ، وَيُشْبِهُ أَنْ يُقَالَ فِي الْمَسْأَلَةِ الْأُولَى يَخْرُجُ لِتَقْلِيلِ الضَّرَرِ وَفِي الثَّانِيَةِ يَمْكُثُ، فَإِنَّ الِانْتِقَالَ فِعْلٌ مُسْتَأْنَفٌ لَا يَصِحُّ إِلَّا مِنْ حَيٍّ. وَيَحْتَمِلُ أَنْ يُقَالَ يَتَخَيَّرُ، وَلَاسِيَّمَا إِذَا لَمْ يَتَرَجَّحْ أَحَدُ الْفِعْلَيْنِ فِي قِلَّةِ الضَّرَرِ عَلَى الثَّانِي. وَهُنَا انْقَضَى الْقَوْلُ فِي الْفِعْلِ وَهُوَ الْقِسْمُ الثَّالِثُ مِنَ الْجُزْءِ الْأَوَّلِ مِنْ هَذَا الْكِتَابِ.

§ 054 Manifesting causes and the attributes of rulings

1994 Arabic p. 58 · BA §67 · 2015 Arabic p. 156 · French p. 157

This section discusses the existence of causes that manifest both rulings and attributes characterizing rulings (أسبابا مظهرة للأحكام ولصفات), such as validity and invalidity. It also explains what these names signify. It consists of four chapters.

هَذَا الْقِسْمُ يَتَضَمَّنُ الْقَوْلَ فِي أَنَّ هَا هُنَا أَسْبَابًا مُظْهِرَةً لِلْأَحْكَامِ وَلِصِفَاتٍ تَتَّصِفُ بِهَا الْأَحْكَامُ، كَالصِّحَّةِ وَالْفَسَادِ، وَتَتَضَمَّنُ شَرْحَ مَا تَدُلُّ عَلَيْهِ هَذِهِ الْأَسْمَاءُ، وَهُوَ أَرْبَعَةُ فُصُولٍ:

§ 055 Legal signs and perceptible causes

1994 Arabic p. 58 · BA §68 · 2015 Arabic p. 156 · French p. 157

Know that the Law has appointed signs for rulings that entail their occurrence as perceptible causes entail their effects. Through these causes we come to know that rulings obtain; otherwise establishing them would be impossible. The detailed account of the conditions under which they entail rulings belongs to the third part of this book.

اعْلَمْ أَنَّ الشَّرْعَ قَدْ نَصَبَ لِلْأَحْكَامِ عَلَامَاتٍ تَتَضَمَّنُ وُقُوعَهَا كَمَا تَتَضَمَّنُ الْعِلَلُ الْحِسِّيَّةُ مَعْلُولَاتِهَا، وَبِهَذِهِ الْأَسْبَابِ نَتَوَصَّلُ إِلَى مَعْرِفَةِ وُقُوعِ الْأَحْكَامِ، وَإِلَّا كَانَ إِثْبَاتُهَا مُحَالًا. وَالْقَوْلُ فِي تَفْصِيلِ الْأَحْوَالِ الَّتِي بِهَا تَكُونُ مُقْتَضِيَةً لِلْأَحْكَامِ هُوَ فِي الْجُزْءِ الثَّالِثِ مِنْ هَذَا الْكِتَابِ.

§ 056 Validity in worship and the validity of contracts

1994 Arabic p. 58 & 59 · BA §69–70 · 2015 Arabic p. 156 · French p. 157

Know that these terms are applied to acts of worship in different ways. For theologians, validity (الصحة) applies to what occurs in conformity with the Law, whether make-up performance is obligatory or not; for jurists, it applies to what suffices and removes the requirement of make-up performance. Thus the prayer of someone who thought himself ritually pure is valid in the theologians' terminology, since make-up performance is required by a renewed command. These are terminological conventions about which there is no dispute once the intended meaning is understood.

اعْلَمْ أَنَّ هَذَا يُطْلَقُ فِي الْعِبَادَاتِ عَلَى أَوْجُهٍ مُخْتَلِفَةٍ، فَالصِّحَّةُ تَنْطَلِقُ عِنْدَ الْمُتَكَلِّمِينَ عَلَى مَا وَقَعَ عَلَى وَفْقِ الشَّرْعِ، وَجَبَ الْقَضَاءُ أَوْ لَمْ يَجِبْ، وَعِنْدَ الْفُقَهَاءِ عَمَّا أَجْزَأَ وَأَسْقَطَ الْقَضَاءَ، حَتَّى أَنَّ صَلَاةَ مَنْ ظَنَّ أَنَّهُ مُتَطَهِّرٌ صَحِيحَةٌ فِي اصْطِلَاحِ الْمُتَكَلِّمِينَ، لِأَنَّ الْقَضَاءَ لَازِمٌ بِأَمْرٍ مُتَجَدِّدٍ. وَهَذِهِ اصْطِلَاحَاتٌ لَا مُشَاحَّةَ فِيهَا إِذَا فُهِمَ الْغَرَضُ.

In contracts, invalidity (الفساد) applies to every legal determination lacking something indispensable to its completion, whether a condition or a cause; validity is its opposite. Abū Ḥanīfa's followers, however, reserve ‘defective’ (الفاسد) for what is authorized in its foundation but prohibited in its attribute. We have already said that everything prohibited through its attribute is prohibited in its foundation and invalidated insofar as it bears that attribute. In general, rulings are characterized by validity only when carried out with the matters and conditions that the Law requires for their performance; invalidity is the contrary.

وَأَمَّا فِي الْعُقُودِ فَيَنْطَلِقُ الْفَسَادُ عَلَى كُلِّ حُكْمٍ لَمْ يَتَضَمَّنْ أَحَدَ مَا بِهِ يَتِمُّ الْحُكْمُ، سَوَاءٌ كَانَ ذَلِكَ شَرْطًا أَوْ سَبَبًا، وَالصِّحَّةُ مُقَابِلُ هَذَا. اللَّهُمَّ إِلَّا أَنَّ أَصْحَابَ أَبِي حَنِيفَةَ فَإِنَّهُمْ يَخُصُّونَ بِاسْمِ الْفَاسِدِ مَا كَانَ مَشْرُوعًا فِي أَصْلِهِ مَمْنُوعًا فِي وَصْفِهِ. لَكِنْ قَدْ تَقَدَّمَ مِنْ قَوْلِنَا أَنَّ كُلَّ مَمْنُوعٍ بِوَصْفِهِ مَمْنُوعٌ بِأَصْلِهِ وَعَائِدٌ عَلَيْهِ بِالْفَسَادِ مِنْ جِهَةِ مَا هُوَ مُتَّصِفٌ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَالْأَحْكَامُ إِنَّمَا تَتَّصِفُ بِالصِّحَّةِ إِذَا فُعِلَتْ بِالْأُمُورِ وَالْأَحْوَالِ الَّتِي اشْتَرَطَ الشَّرْعُ فِي فِعْلِهَا، وَالْفَسَادُ بِخِلَافِ ذَلِكَ.

§ 057 Timely performance, repetition, and making up

1994 Arabic p. 59 · BA §71–72 · 2015 Arabic p. 158 · French p. 159

اعْلَمْ أَنَّ الْوَاجِبَ إِذَا أُدِّيَ فِي وَقْتِهِ سُمِّيَ أَدَاءً، وَإِذَا فُعِلَ مَرَّةً عَلَى نَحْوٍ مِنَ الْخَلَلِ ثُمَّ فُعِلَ ثَانِيًا سُمِّيَ إِعَادَةً، وَإِنْ أُدِّيَ بَعْدَ خُرُوجِ وَقْتِهِ الضَّيِّقِ أَوِ الْمُوَسَّعِ مَعَ تَرْكِهِ عَمْدًا سُمِّيَ قَضَاءً. وَقَدْ يُطْلَقُ اسْمُ الْقَضَاءِ عَلَى مَعَانٍ غَيْرِ هَذِهِ بَعْضُهَا أَقْرَبُ إِلَى هَذَا الْمَعْنَى، وَبَعْضُهَا أَبْعَدُ. فَمِنْهَا مَا يُتْرَكُ سَهْوًا حَتَّى يَخْرُجَ وَقْتُهُ فَهَذَا أَيْضًا يُسَمَّى قَضَاءً حَقِيقَةً، لَكِنْ يُفَارِقُ الْأَوَّلَ بِحَطِّ الْإِثْمِ عَنْ فَاعِلِهِ.

Know that when an obligation is discharged within its time, it is called timely performance (أداء). If performed once with some defect and then performed again, it is called repetition (إعادة). If discharged after its restricted or extended time has elapsed, having been deliberately omitted, it is called make-up performance (قضاء). The name qaḍāʾ is also applied to other meanings, some closer to this meaning and some more remote. One concerns what is omitted inadvertently until its time elapses. This too is properly called make-up performance, but differs from the first case in that its performer is relieved of sin.

وَمِنْهَا أَلَّا يَجِبَ الْأَدَاءُ كَالصِّيَامِ فِي حَقِّ الْحَائِضِ. وَقَدْ أَشْكَلَ هَذَا عَلَى طَائِفَةٍ حَتَّى أَلْزَمُوا وُجُوبَ الصَّوْمِ عَلَى الْحَائِضِ بِدَلِيلِ وُجُوبِ الْقَضَاءِ، وَالْإِجْمَاعُ يَرُدُّ هَذَا فَإِنَّهَا لَوْ مَاتَتْ قَبْلَ أَنْ تَطْهُرَ لَمْ تَأْثَمْ، وَمِنْهَا حَالَةُ الْمَرِيضِ وَالْمُسَافِرِ فَإِنَّهُمَا مِنْ حَيْثُ لَهُمَا أَنْ يَصُومَا أَشْبَهَ فَرْضُهُمَا الْوَاجِبَ الْمُوَسَّعَ. وَقَدْ كَانَ يَنْبَغِي أَلَّا يُسَمَّى هَذَا قَضَاءً، كَمَا لَا يُسَمَّى إِتْيَانُ الصَّلَاةِ فِي آخِرِ الْوَقْتِ قَضَاءً. لَكِنْ تَسْمِيَةُ مِثْلِ هَذَا قَضَاءً مَجَازٌ، لِمَا فِي ذَلِكَ مِنْ فَوَاتِ الْوَقْتِ الْأَوَّلِ الْمَشْهُورِ.

Another concerns cases where timely performance is not obligatory, such as fasting for a menstruating woman. This puzzled some people to the point that they inferred an obligation to fast during menstruation from the obligation to make up the fast. Consensus refutes this: if she died before becoming ritually pure, she would not have sinned. Another concerns the sick person and the traveller. Since they are permitted to fast, their duty resembles an obligation with an extended time. This ought not to be called make-up performance, just as praying at the end of the allotted period is not called make-up performance. Such usage is figurative, because the familiar first period has been missed.

§ 058 The traveller’s fast: concession or an alternative duty?

1994 Arabic p. 59 & 60 · BA §73 · 2015 Arabic p. 160 · French p. 161

وَفِي الْمُسَافِرِ وَالْمَرِيضِ مَذْهَبَانِ غَيْرُ هَذَا: أَحَدُهُمَا مَذْهَبُ أَهْلِ الظَّاهِرِ أَنَّهُمَا لَوْ صَامَا لَمْ يَصِحَّ صَوْمُهُمَا لِقَوْلِهِ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ: {فَعِدَّةٌ مِنْ أَيَّامٍ أُخَرَ} وَالثَّانِي مَذْهَبُ الْكَرْخِيِّ أَنَّ الْوَاجِبَ أَيَّامٌ أُخَرُ، وَلَكِنْ لَوْ صَامَا رَمَضَانَ صَحَّ، كَمَنْ قَوَّمَ الزَّكَاةَ عَلَى الْحَوْلِ. وَكِلَا هَذَيْنِ الْقَوْلَيْنِ إِنَّمَا يُبْنَيَانِ عَلَى مَنْ لَا يَرَى أَنَّ فِي الْآيَةِ حَذْفًا، وَأَنَّ التَّقْدِيرَ: فَأَفْطَرَ فَعِدَّةٌ مِنْ أَيَّامٍ

There are two other doctrines concerning the traveller and the sick person. The Ẓāhirīs hold that if they fast, their fast is invalid, because of His words—mighty and exalted—‘then a number of other days.’ Al-Karkhī holds that the obligation concerns other days, but that fasting during Ramaḍān is valid, like advancing the alms before the year's completion. Both doctrines rest upon declining to recognise an ellipsis in the verse, whose understood wording is ‘and he breaks the

fast, then a number of other days,’ and to construe it as a concession (رخصة). This question will become clear from the discussion in the third part of this book.

أُخَرَ، وَأَنَّ ذَلِكَ مَحْمُولٌ عَلَى الرُّخْصَةِ. وَسَتَبِينُ هَذِهِ الْمَسْأَلَةُ مِمَّا يُقَالُ فِي الْجُزْءِ الثَّالِثِ مِنْ هَذَا الْكِتَابِ.

Someone who construes it as a concession might be asked about the validity of fasting by a sick person who fears death or severe harm to himself. That is a matter of independent judgement admitting either answer, and lies outside the present purpose.

فَأَمَّا مَا يَحْتَمِلُ أَنْ يُسْأَلَ عَنْهُ مَنْ يَرَى ذَلِكَ مَحْمُولًا عَلَى الرُّخْصَةِ مِنْ جَوَازِ وُقُوعِ صِيَامِ الْمَرِيضِ الَّذِي يَخَافُ عَلَى نَفْسِهِ الْهَلَاكَ وَالضَّرَرَ الْعَظِيمَ، فَتِلْكَ مَسْأَلَةٌ اجْتِهَادِيَّةٌ تَحْتَمِلُ الْوَجْهَيْنِ، وَهِيَ خَارِجَةٌ عَنْ هَذَا الْغَرَضِ.

Editorial notes

N023 [textual] Printed p. 59 reads قوم الزكاة على الحول. ‘Advancing the alms before the year's completion’ renders the evident comparative sense, conjecturally taking قوم for قدّم; the printed Arabic is retained.

§ 059 Does an expectation of death shorten the prescribed time?

1994 Arabic p. 60 · BA §74 · 2015 Arabic p. 160 · French p. 161

The Qāḍī—may God have mercy upon him—applied the name ‘make-up performance’ to what a person deliberately omits while predominantly expecting death before performing it, if events subsequently contradict that expectation. His reason is that the time is assessed according to the predominant probability. This is meaningless, since expecting death does not cause the allotted time itself to elapse.

وَقَدْ أَطْلَقَ الْقَاضِي رَحِمَهُ اللَّهُ اسْمَ الْقَضَاءِ عَلَى مَا يَتْرُكُهُ الْإِنْسَانُ مُتَعَمِّدًا مَعَ غَلَبَةِ ظَنِّهِ بِالِاخْتِرَامِ قَبْلَ أَدَائِهِ الْفِعْلَ إِذَا انْكَشَفَ خِلَافُ مَا ظَنَّ، لِأَنَّهُ يُقَدِّرُ الْوَقْتَ بِحَسَبِ غَلَبَةِ الظَّنِّ. وَهَذَا لَا مَعْنَى لَهُ، لِأَنَّهُ لَيْسَ يَكُونُ ظَنُّهُ بِالِاخْتِرَامِ سَبَبًا لِخُرُوجِ الْوَقْتِ فِي نَفْسِهِ.

Editorial notes

BA15-E74 [textual] Bou Akl 2015 prints one or more editorial angle-bracket additions in his §74 (Arabic edition around p.160, corresponding French translation around p.161). They are not automatically adopted here: some were already present in the al-ʿAlawī-based reading text, others are uncertain. Check his footnotes and the 1994 printed base before treating these as independent manuscript readings. This entry records editorial intervention, not verified word-for-word collation of every line in that section.

§ 060 Original requirements and concessions under necessity

1994 Arabic p. 60 · BA §75 · 2015 Arabic p. 160 · French p. 161

Know that the original requirement (العزم) in the Law designates what binds servants through God's imposition of obligation. A concession (الرخصة) designates the latitude granted to a legally responsible person in acting because of an excuse or incapacity, while the prohibiting cause remains in place: for example, permitting a draught of wine to someone choking, or carrion to someone compelled by necessity. ‘Concession’ may also be

اعْلَمْ أَنَّ الْعَزْمَ فِي الشَّرْعِ عِبَارَةٌ عَمَّا لَزِمَ الْعِبَادَ بِإِيجَابِ اللَّهِ تَعَالَى، وَالرُّخْصَةُ عِبَارَةٌ عَمَّا وُسِّعَ لِلْمُكَلَّفِ فِي فِعْلِهِ لِعُذْرٍ أَوْ عَجْزٍ عَنْهُ، مَعَ قِيَامِ السَّبَبِ الْمُحَرِّمِ، كَتَحْلِيلِ جُرْعَةِ خَمْرٍ لِلشَّرِقِ، وَالْمَيْتَةِ لِلْمُضْطَرِّ. وَقَدْ تُطْلَقُ الرُّخْصَةُ عَلَى مَعَانٍ غَيْرِ هَذِهِ بَعْضُهَا أَقْرَبُ إِلَى هَذَا وَبَعْضُهَا أَبْعَدُ.

applied to other meanings, some closer to this meaning and some more remote.

§ 061 The first part concluded

1994 Arabic p. 60 · BA §76 · 2015 Arabic p. 162 · French p. 163

Here inquiry into the first part of this abridgement ends. The book on the sources of rulings follows.

وَهُنَا انْتَهَى النَّظَرُ فِي الْجُزْءِ الْأَوَّلِ مِنْ هَذَا الْمُخْتَصَرِ، وَيَتْلُوهُ كِتَابُ أُصُولِ الْأَحْكَامِ.

Revelation, reports, abrogation and consensus

§ 062 The four sources and original negation

1994 Arabic p. 61 & 63 · BA §77 · 2015 Arabic p. 164 · French p. 165

وَهُوَ يَتَضَمَّنُ النَّظَرَ فِي الْأُصُولِ الَّتِي تَسْتَنِدُ إِلَيْهَا هَذِهِ الْأَحْكَامُ وَعَنْهَا تُسْتَنْبَطُ، وَهِيَ أَرْبَعَةٌ: الْكِتَابُ، وَالسُّنَّةُ، وَإِجْمَاعُ الْأُمَّةِ، وَدَلِيلُ الْعَقْلِ عَلَى النَّفْيِ الْأَصْلِيِّ، وَتَسْمِيَةُ مِثْلِ هَذَا أَصْلًا تَجَوُّزٌ، إِذْ لَيْسَ يَدُلُّ عَلَى الْأَحْكَامِ بَلْ عَلَى نَفْيِهَا. فَأَمَّا قَوْلُ الصَّحَابَةِ وَشَرِيعَةُ مَنْ قَبْلَنَا فَمُخْتَلَفٌ فِيهِ. فَلْنَبْدَأْ مِنْ ذَلِكَ بِالْكِتَابِ، وَنَنْظُرْ أَوَّلًا فِي حَقِيقَتِهِ، ثُمَّ فِيمَا يَحْصُرُهُ، ثُمَّ فِي أَلْفَاظِهِ، ثُمَّ فِي أَحْكَامِهِ.

This part comprises inquiry into the sources on which these rulings rest and from which they are derived. They are four: the Book, the Sunna, the community's consensus, and reason's indication of original negation (النفي الأصلي). Calling the last a source is figurative, since it indicates the absence of rulings rather than rulings themselves. The status of a Companion's statement and the law of those before us is disputed. Let us begin with the Book, examining first its reality, then what delimits it, then its expressions, and then its rulings.

§ 063 Divine speech and the bounds of theological inquiry

1994 Arabic p. 63 · BA §78 · 2015 Arabic p. 164 · French p. 165

فَأَمَّا حَقِيقَتُهُ وَمَعْنَاهُ «فَهُوَ الْكَلَامُ الْقَائِمُ بِذَاتِ اللَّهِ تَعَالَى، وَهُوَ صِفَةٌ قَدِيمَةٌ مِنْ صِفَاتِهِ»، وَالْقَوْلُ فِي إِثْبَاتِ هَذِهِ الصِّفَةِ وَتَخْلِيصِهَا بِمَا يَخُصُّهَا مِنْ غَيْرِهَا مِنَ الصِّفَاتِ هُوَ مِنْ عِلْمِ الْكَلَامِ.

As for its reality and meaning, ‘it is the speech subsisting in the essence of God Most High, an eternal attribute among His attributes.’ Establishing this attribute and distinguishing it from the other attributes by what is peculiar to it belongs to theology (علم الكلام).

Editorial notes

N024 [translation] The definition in this passage is marked as a quotation. Its formulation is also found in al-Ghazālī’s al-Mustaṣfā; compare the wording بِمَا يَخُصُّهَا and the distinction between the source’s formulation and the author’s discussion.

§ 064 The Qurʾānic corpus, variant additions, and the basmala

1994 Arabic p. 63 & 64 · BA §79–81 · 2015 Arabic p. 164 · French p. 165

فَأَمَّا مَا يَحْصُرُهُ فَهُوَ مَا نُقِلَ إِلَيْنَا بَيْنَ دَفَّتَيِ الْمُصْحَفِ عَلَى الْأَحْرُفِ السَّبْعَةِ الْمَشْهُورَةِ نَقْلًا مُتَوَاتِرًا. وَإِنَّمَا قَيَّدْنَاهُ بِالْمَصَاحِفِ لِأَنَّ الصَّحَابَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمْ بَلَغُوا فِي الِاحْتِيَاطِ فِي نَقْلِهِ بِالْكُتُبِ. وَاشْتَرَطْنَا فِي نَقْلِهِ التَّوَاتُرَ لِأَنَّهُ

Its limits comprise what has been transmitted to us between the two covers of the codex in the seven well-known aḥruf (الأحرف السبعة, modes of recitation), through recurrent transmission (نقلا متواترا, tawātur), also called mass transmission. We specified the codices because the Companions—may God be pleased with them—took the utmost

الْمُفِيدُ لِلْيَقِينِ. وَلْيُعْلَمْ أَيْضًا أَنَّ مَا هُوَ خَارِجٌ عَنْهُ مِمَّا لَمْ يُنْقَلْ نَقْلَ تَوَاتُرٍ فَلَيْسَ مِنْهُ، إِذْ يَسْتَحِيلُ فِي عُرْفِ الْعَادَةِ أَنْ يُهْمِلَ بَعْضُهُ أَوْ يُنْقَلَ نَقْلَ آحَادٍ مَعَ اسْتِفَاضَتِهِ فِي الْجَمَاعَةِ الَّتِي لَا يَصِحُّ عَلَيْهَا الْإِغْفَالُ وَالْإِهْمَالُ وَهُمُ الَّذِينَ يَقَعُ بِنَقْلِهِمُ التَّوَاتُرُ.

precaution in transmitting it in writing. We required recurrent transmission because it yields certainty. What lies outside this and has not been recurrently transmitted is not part of it. It is impossible according to ordinary experience that any portion should be neglected or transmitted only by isolated reports, despite its wide circulation within a community incapable of such neglect or omission, whose transmission establishes recurrence.

وَلِهَذَا مَا كَانَتِ الزِّيَادَاتُ الَّتِي لَمْ تُنْقَلْ نَقْلَ تَوَاتُرٍ لَيْسَتْ تُوجِبُ عِنْدَ الْأَكْثَرِ عَمَلًا، خِلَافًا لِأَبِي حَنِيفَةَ، كَالتَّتَابُعِ فِي الْكَفَّارَةِ وَمَا أَشْبَهَهُ. وَلَيْسَتْ هَذِهِ مُتَنَزِّلَةً مَنْزِلَةَ أَخْبَارِ الْآحَادِ، لِأَنَّ الْخَبَرَ لَا مُعَارِضَ لَهُ وَلَا دَلِيلَ عَلَى كَوْنِهِ كَذِبًا. وَإِذَا لَمْ تُجْعَلْ هَذِهِ الزِّيَادَاتُ مِنَ الْقُرْآنِ احْتَمَلَتْ أَنْ تَكُونَ مَذْهَبًا لِصَاحِبٍ، وَاحْتَمَلَتِ الْخَبَرَ وَمَا يَتَرَدَّدُ بَيْنَ هَذَيْنِ الِاحْتِمَالَيْنِ فَلَا يَجُوزُ الْعَمَلُ بِهِ.

Hence, contrary to Abū Ḥanīfa, most scholars hold that additions not recurrently transmitted do not require action—for example, consecutiveness in expiation and similar matters. These additions do not stand in the position of solitary reports (أخبار الآحاد), since a report has neither a contrary indication nor evidence that it is false. If these additions are not considered Qurʾān, they may represent a Companion's doctrine or may be a report; action may not be based on something hovering between these two possibilities.

وَلِهَذَا قَطَعَ الْقَاضِي رَحِمَهُ اللَّهُ بِتَخْطِئَةِ الشَّافِعِيِّ رَحِمَهُ اللَّهُ فِي جَعْلِهِ بِاسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَانِ الرَّحِيمِ آيَةً مِنْ كُلِّ سُورَةٍ، مَعَ كَوْنِهَا آيَةً مِنَ النَّمْلِ، إِذْ لَوْ كَانَ ذَلِكَ كَذَلِكَ لَنُقِلَ إِلَيْنَا تَصْرِيحًا كَوْنُهَا مِنَ الْقُرْآنِ، وَلَمْ يَقَعْ فِي ذَلِكَ خِلَافٌ. وَلِلشَّافِعِيِّ أَنْ يَتَمَسَّكَ بِأَنَّ جَعْلَهَا فِي أَوَّلِ سُورَةٍ بِأَمْرِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ وَنُزُولَهَا فِي أَوَّلِ كُلِّ سُورَةٍ قَرَائِنُ تُوهِمُ أَنَّهَا مِنَ الْقُرْآنِ، فَلَوْ لَمْ تَكُنْ مِنْهُ لَصُرِّحَ بِذَلِكَ.

For this reason the Qāḍī—may God have mercy upon him—declared al-Shāfiʿī—may God have mercy upon him—definitely mistaken in treating ‘In the name of God, the Merciful, the Compassionate’ as a verse of every sūra, although it is a verse of al-Naml. Had that been so, an explicit statement of its being Qurʾān would have been transmitted to us and no disagreement would have arisen. Al-Shāfiʿī can argue that its placement at a sūra's beginning by the command of God's Messenger—God bless him and grant him peace— and its revelation at the beginning of each sūra, are contextual indicators suggesting that it belongs to the Qurʾān; if it did not, this would have been stated expressly.

وَلَيْسَ كَذَلِكَ التَّعَوُّذُ وَالْقُنُوتُ وَمَا أَشْبَهَ ذَلِكَ مِمَّا لَمْ يُصَرَّحْ بِكَوْنِهِ مِنْ غَيْرِ الْقُرْآنِ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَهِيَ مَسْأَلَةٌ اجْتِهَادِيَّةٌ وَلِذَلِكَ لَمْ يُكَفِّرِ الْقَاضِي بِهَا وَمَعَ ذَلِكَ فَهِيَ قَلِيلَةُ الْغَنَاءِ فِي الِاسْتِنْبَاطِ عَنْهَا. وَالشَّافِعِيُّ إِنَّمَا أَوْجَبَ قِرَاءَةَ بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَانِ الرَّحِيمِ فِي الصَّلَاةِ لِلْأَخْبَارِ الْوَارِدَةِ بِذَلِكَ.

The invocation of refuge, the qunūt supplication, and similar expressions whose being outside the Qurʾān was not expressly stated are not in the same position. In general, this is a question for independent judgement, which is why the Qāḍī did not pronounce unbelief on its account. Even so, it has little usefulness for deriving rulings. Al-Shāfiʿī required recitation of ‘In the name of God,

the Merciful, the Compassionate’ in prayer only because of reports transmitted to that effect.

Editorial notes

N025 [translation] The term aḥruf is retained as written (printed p. 63), without silently identifying it with a particular classification of canonical readings.

§ 065 Literal, figurative, arabicized, and ambiguous expressions

1994 Arabic p. 64 & 65 · BA §82–84 · 2015 Arabic p. 166 · French p. 167

As for its expressions, some are literal (حقيقة) and some figurative (مجاز). Their presence is evident, since it is in the Arabs' language and tongue. In general, I do not think any tongue or language lacks them, though languages differ in this regard. Some deny, and others allow, that its vocabulary contains anything outside Arabic; determining this contributes little to our present undertaking. In general, if Arabic contains an expression originally foreign to it, the Arabs have Arabized and altered it in a manner entitling it to count as part of their language and to be attributed to it.

وَأَمَّا النَّظَرُ فِي أَلْفَاظِهِ فَمِنْهَا حَقِيقَةٌ وَمَجَازٌ، وَوُجُودُ ذَلِكَ فِيهِ بَيِّنٌ مِنْ حَيْثُ هُوَ بِلُغَةِ الْعَرَبِ وَلِسَانِهَا. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَمَا أَظُنُّ لِسَانًا وَلَا لُغَةً تَعْرَى مِنْ ذَلِكَ، وَإِنْ كَانَتِ الْأَلْسِنَةُ تَتَفَاوَتُ فِي ذَلِكَ. وَأَمَّا نَفْيُ بَعْضِهِمْ مِنْ أَنْ يَكُونَ فِي أَلْفَاظِهِ شَيْءٌ لَيْسَ فِي لُغَةِ الْعَرَبِ وَجَوَّزَهُ بَعْضُهُمْ فَالْوُقُوفُ عَلَى ذَلِكَ قَلِيلُ الْغَنَاءِ فِيمَا نَحْنُ بِسَبِيلِهِ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ إِنْ كَانَ فِي لِسَانِ الْعَرَبِ شَيْءٌ مِنْ غَيْرِ أَلْفَاظِهَا فَقَدْ عَرَّبَتْهُ الْعَرَبُ تَعْرِيبًا وَغَيَّرَتْهُ تَغْيِيرًا اسْتَوْجَبَ بِهِ اللَّفْظُ كَوْنَهُ مِنْ لُغَتِهَا وَمَنْسُوبًا إِلَيْهَا.

Its expressions include determinate and ambiguous wording (محكم ومتشابه), as He—mighty and exalted—has said. People have disagreed about the ambiguous. It is preferable to consider ambiguous expressions to be those capable of bearing more than one meaning; or those whose apparent interpretation suggests a contradiction among them; or expressions for whose meanings the Arabs had no prior convention or established usage, such as the letters at the beginnings of sūras; or all of these.

وَفِي أَلْفَاظِهِ مُحْكَمٌ وَمُتَشَابِهٌ كَمَا قَالَ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ، وَقَدِ اخْتَلَفَ النَّاسُ فِي الْمُتَشَابِهِ، وَالْأَوْلَى أَنْ يُظَنَّ أَنَّ الْأَلْفَاظَ الْمُتَشَابِهَةَ هِيَ الَّتِي يُمْكِنُ حَمْلُهَا عَلَى مَعْنًى أَكْثَرَ مِنْ وَاحِدٍ، أَوِ الَّتِي يُوهِمُ حَمْلُهَا عَلَى الظَّاهِرِ تَعَارُضًا فِيهَا، أَوِ الْأَلْفَاظَ الَّتِي لَمْ تَتَقَدَّمْ لِلْعَرَبِ مُوَاضَعَةٌ وَلَا اصْطِلَاحٌ عَلَى مَعَانِيهَا كَالْحُرُوفِ الَّتِي فِي أَوَائِلِ السُّوَرِ، أَوْ جَمِيعَ هَذِهِ.

§ 066 The authority of the Sunna and the routes of transmission

1994 Arabic p. 66 · BA §85 · 2015 Arabic p. 168 · French p. 169

The saying of God's Messenger—God bless him and grant him peace—is an authoritative proof (حجة), because the miracle indicates his truthfulness. It is a proof in itself for anyone who heard him directly. We, however, receive his sayings—God bless him and grant him peace—only through transmitters, either by recurrent

وَقَوْلُ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ حُجَّةٌ لِدَلَالَةِ الْمُعْجِزَةِ عَلَى صِدْقِهِ، وَهُوَ حُجَّةٌ بِنَفْسِهِ عَلَى مَنْ سَمِعَهُ مُشَافَهَةً. فَأَمَّا نَحْنُ فَلَمْ يَبْلُغْنَا قَوْلُهُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ إِلَّا عَلَى لِسَانِ الْمُخْبِرِينَ، إِمَّا بِطَرِيقِ التَّوَاتُرِ، وَإِمَّا بِطَرِيقِ الْآحَادِ. وَلِذَلِكَ

يَنْقَسِمُ الْقَوْلُ فِي الْأَخْبَارِ إِلَى هَذَيْنِ الْقِسْمَيْنِ، وَيَعُمُّهُمَا بَيَانُ مَرَاتِبِ أَلْفَاظِ الصَّحَابَةِ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمْ فِي نَقْلِ الْأَخْبَارِ عَنْهُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ، وَهِيَ مَرَاتِبُ:

transmission (التواتر) or through solitary reports (الآحاد). The discussion of reports therefore divides into these two sections. Common to both is an explanation of the ranks of the expressions used by the Companions—may God be pleased with them—in transmitting reports from him—God bless him and grant him peace. These ranks are as follows:

§ 067 First rank: explicit attestation of direct hearing

1994 Arabic p. 66 · BA §86 · 2015 Arabic p. 168 · French p. 169

فَأَوَّلُهَا أَنْ يَقُولَ الصَّحَابِيُّ سَمِعْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ، أَوْ حَدَّثَنِي، أَوْ أَخْبَرَنِي أَوْ شَافَهَنِي، فَهَذَا لَا يَتَطَرَّقُ إِلَيْهِ احْتِمَالٌ.

The first is for the Companion to say, ‘I heard God's Messenger—God bless him and grant him peace,’ ‘He related to me,’ ‘He informed me,’ or ‘He spoke to me directly.’ This admits no alternative possibility.

§ 068 Second rank: “The Messenger said”

1994 Arabic p. 66 · BA §87 · 2015 Arabic p. 170 · French p. 171

الْمَرْتَبَةُ الثَّانِيَةُ: أَنْ يَقُولَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ كَذَا أَوْ حَدَّثَ بِكَذَا. فَهَذَا ظَاهِرُهُ النَّقْلُ، إِذَا صَدَرَ عَنِ الصَّحَابِيِّ وَلَيْسَ نَصًّا صَرِيحًا، إِذْ مُمْكِنٌ أَنْ يَكُونَ حُدِّثَ بِهِ عَنْ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ. لَكِنْ رَأْيُ أَكْثَرِهِمُ الْعَمَلُ بِمِثْلِ هَذَا جَائِزٌ لِلْقَرَائِنِ الدَّالَّةِ عَلَى ذَلِكَ، لَاسِيَّمَا إِذَا صَدَرَ ذَلِكَ عَنْ مَنْ كَثُرَتْ صُحْبَتُهُ.

The second rank is to say, ‘God's Messenger said such-and-such,’ or ‘He related such-and-such.’ When this comes from a Companion, its apparent meaning is direct transmission, but it is not explicit, unambiguous wording (نصا صريحا), since the Companion may have been told it on the authority of God's Messenger—God bless him and grant him peace. Most nevertheless regard acting on such a report as permissible because of the contextual indicators supporting it, especially when it comes from someone whose companionship with him was extensive.

§ 069 Third rank: reporting a command rather than its wording

1994 Arabic p. 66 & 67 · BA §88 · 2015 Arabic p. 170 · French p. 171

الْمَرْتَبَةُ الثَّالِثَةُ: أَنْ يَقُولَ الصَّحَابِيُّ أَمَرَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ بِكَذَا، وَنَهَى عَنْ كَذَا، أَوْ فَرَضَ كَذَا، وَأَوْجَبَ كَذَا. فَهَذَا يَتَطَرَّقُ إِلَيْهِ احْتِمَالَانِ: أَحَدُهُمَا فِي سَمَاعِهِ كَمَا فِي قَوْلِهِ تَعَالَى، وَالثَّانِي فِي فَهْمِهِ عَنِ الْخِطَابِ الْأَمْرَ أَوِ الْوُجُوبَ، إِذْ صِيغَةُ الْأَمْرِ مُخْتَلَفٌ فِيهَا. وَلِذَلِكَ رَأَى دَاوُودُ وَمَنْ تَبِعَهُ مِنْ أَهْلِ

The third rank is for the Companion to say, ‘God's Messenger commanded such-and-such,’ ‘prohibited such-and-such,’ ‘prescribed such-and-such,’ or ‘made such-and-such obligatory.’ Two possibilities arise: one concerns whether he heard it, as with the expression ‘he said’ [the printed cross-reference is defective]; the second concerns his understanding the address as command or obligation, since the imperative form is disputed.

Hence Dāwūd and those Ẓāhirīs who followed him held that the Companion's statement is no authoritative proof unless he transmits the actual words of the Messenger—God bless him and grant him peace.

الظَّاهِرِ أَلَّا حُجَّةَ فِي قَوْلِهِ مَا لَمْ يَنْقُلْ لَفْظَهُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ.

It has been argued against them that this is an inquiry into understanding expressions. Disagreement about them arises among us because we are neither masters of eloquent Arabic nor authorities for Arabic speech. But since the Companion is an Arab, how could he be suspected of error concerning the imperative form, when his usage itself supplies authoritative evidence in a dispute about it?

وَقَدِ احْتُجَّ عَلَيْهِمْ أَنَّ هَذَا نَظَرٌ مِنْ حَيْثُ فَهْمُ الْأَلْفَاظِ. وَإِنَّمَا وَقَعَ الْخِلَافُ فِيهَا بَيْنَنَا مِنْ حَيْثُ أَنَّا لَسْنَا بِفُصَحَاءَ وَلَا بِحُجَّةٍ عَلَى الْكَلَامِ الْعَرَبِيِّ. وَأَمَّا الصَّحَابِيُّ مِنْ حَيْثُ أَنَّهُ عَرَبِيٌّ فَكَيْفَ يُتَوَهَّمُ عَلَيْهِ الْغَلَطُ فِي صِيغَةِ الْأَمْرِ، مَعَ أَنَّ بِهِ تَقُومُ الْحُجَّةُ عِنْدَ الِاخْتِلَافِ فِيهَا.

Editorial notes

N026 [textual] Printed p. 66 reads كما في قوله تعالى. The context refers back to قال رسول الله in §68; the English gives that contextual cross-reference and marks the defect, without silently altering the Arabic.

§ 070 How linguistic usage is established

1994 Arabic p. 67 · BA §89 · 2015 Arabic p. 170 · French p. 171

We consider that establishing correct expressions in a language for someone who is not a native speaker occurs in one of two ways: by induction from its speakers' discourse, or by transmission from them where the usage is widespread among them. Accordingly, one person's statement cannot serve as authoritative evidence until it becomes widely circulated. Whether recurrent transmission is required in transmitting a language, or solitary reports suffice, is disputed. It seems that solitary transmission suffices for much of it; otherwise there would be no way to ascertain most verbal significations if recurrent transmission were required for each expression.

وَإِنَّا نَرَى أَنَّ تَصْحِيحَ الْأَلْفَاظِ فِي لِسَانٍ مَا عِنْدَ مَنْ لَمْ يَكُنْ مِنْ أَهْلِ ذَلِكَ اللِّسَانِ إِنَّمَا يَحْصُلُ بِأَحَدِ أَمْرَيْنِ: إِمَّا بِاسْتِقْرَاءِ كَلَامِهِمْ، أَوِ النَّقْلِ عَنْهُمْ إِذَا اسْتَفَاضَ ذَلِكَ فِيهِمْ. وَعَلَى هَذَا لَا يَصِحُّ الِاحْتِجَاجُ بِقَوْلِ الْوَاحِدِ حَتَّى يَسْتَفِيضَ قَوْلُهُ. وَأَمَّا هَلْ يُشْتَرَطُ فِي نَقْلِ اللُّغَةِ التَّوَاتُرُ أَوْ تَكْفِي فِيهِ الْآحَادُ؟ فَذَلِكَ مُخْتَلَفٌ فِيهِ. وَيُشْبِهُ أَنْ يَكْفِيَ فِي كَثِيرٍ مِنْهَا نَقْلُ الْآحَادِ، وَإِلَّا لَمْ يَكُنْ سَبِيلٌ إِلَى الْوُقُوفِ عَلَى أَكْثَرِ دَلَالَاتِ الْأَلْفَاظِ لَوِ اشْتُرِطَ فِي نَقْلِ كُلِّ وَاحِدَةٍ مِنْهَا التَّوَاتُرُ.

§ 071 Fourth rank: “We were commanded” and “It is Sunna”

1994 Arabic p. 67 · BA §90 · 2015 Arabic p. 172 · French p. 173

The fourth rank is to say, ‘We were commanded to do such-and-such,’ or ‘We were prohibited from such-and-such.’ Besides the preceding possibilities, this admits another: the person issuing the command may have been someone other than the Prophet—God bless him and grant

الْمَرْتَبَةُ الرَّابِعَةُ: أَنْ يَقُولَ أُمِرْنَا بِكَذَا أَوْ نُهِينَا عَنْ كَذَا. فَهَذَا يَتَطَرَّقُ إِلَيْهِ، مَعَ مَا سَبَقَ مِنَ الِاحْتِمَالَاتِ، احْتِمَالٌ آخَرُ وَهُوَ أَنَّ الْأَمْرَ بِذَلِكَ عَسَاهُ أَنْ يَكُونَ غَيْرَ النَّبِيِّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ

him peace—among the leaders and rulers. Their expressions ‘Such-and-such belongs to the Sunna’ and ‘The Sunna proceeds in such-and-such a way’ have the same import.

عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ مِنَ الْأَئِمَّةِ وَالْأُمَرَاءِ، وَفِي مَعْنَى هَذَا قَوْلُهُمْ: مِنَ السُّنَّةِ كَذَا، وَالسُّنَّةُ جَارِيَةٌ بِكَذَا.

Editorial notes

N027 [crux] The print has الأَمر (“the command”) where the contrast with the Prophet and other rulers requires الآمِر (“the commander”). The consonantal form is preserved; the English follows the agent-sense demanded by the sentence.

§ 072 Fifth rank: practices in the Prophet’s lifetime

1994 Arabic p. 67 · BA §91 · 2015 Arabic p. 172 · French p. 173

The fifth rank is for a Companion to say, ‘They used to do such-and-such,’ relating the practice to the time of God's Messenger—God bless him and grant him peace. This too admits the possibility that the practice reached the notice of God's Messenger—God bless him and grant him peace—and he approved it, which is the more apparent possibility; it also admits the possibility that it did not reach him.

الْمَرْتَبَةُ الْخَامِسَةُ: أَنْ يَقُولَ الصَّحَابِيُّ كَانُوا يَفْعَلُونَ كَذَا، فَأَضَافَ الْفِعْلَ إِلَى عَهْدِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ. فَهَذَا أَيْضًا يَحْتَمِلُ أَنْ يَكُونَ بَلَغَ ذَلِكَ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ، وَهُوَ الْأَظْهَرُ، فَأَقَرَّهُ. وَيَحْتَمِلُ أَنْ يَكُونَ لَمْ يَبْلُغْهُ.

§ 073 The reporting formulas concluded

1994 Arabic p. 67 · BA §92 · 2015 Arabic p. 172 · French p. 173

From this it has become clear what constitutes reporting from God's Messenger—God bless him and grant him peace—and what does not.

فَقَدْ ظَهَرَ مِنْ هَذَا مَا هُوَ إِخْبَارٌ عَنْ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ، وَمَا لَيْسَ بِإِخْبَارٍ.

§ 074 The degrees of assent yielded by transmission

1994 Arabic p. 67 · BA §93 · 2015 Arabic p. 172 · French p. 173

It remains now to explain how reports reach us: either through recurrent transmission or through solitary transmission. Let us discuss both and the rank of the assent (التصديق) arising from each, beginning with recurrent transmission. We say:

وَالْآنَ فَقَدْ بَقِيَ تَبْيِينُ طَرِيقِ انْتِهَاءِ الْأَخْبَارِ إِلَيْنَا، وَذَلِكَ إِمَّا أَنْ يَكُونَ نَقْلَ تَوَاتُرٍ أَوْ آحَادٍ. وَلْنَقُلْ فِيهِمَا وَفِي مَرْتَبَةِ التَّصْدِيقِ الْحَاصِلِ عَنْهُمَا، وَلْنَبْدَأْ مِنْ ذَلِكَ بِالتَّوَاتُرِ، فَنَقُولُ:

§ 075 Recurrent transmission: certainty without a fixed number

1994 Arabic p. 67 & 68 · BA §94–95 · 2015 Arabic p. 172 · French p. 173

Recurrent transmission (التواتر) is a widely circulated report from which certainty arises about certain matters and under certain conditions, without our knowing whence, how, or when it arose. We said ‘about certain matters’

إِنَّ التَّوَاتُرَ هُوَ خَبَرٌ مُسْتَفِيضٌ يَحْصُلُ عَنْهُ الْيَقِينُ فِي أُمُورٍ مَا وَعِنْدَ أَحْوَالٍ مَا مِنْ غَيْرِ أَنْ نَدْرِيَ مِنْ أَيْنَ حَصَلَ وَلَا كَيْفَ حَصَلَ وَلَا مَتَى حَصَلَ. وَإِنَّمَا قُلْنَا: فِي أُمُورٍ مَا، لِأَنَّهُ

because it does not arise concerning intelligibles that are not by nature perceptible, or things whose analogues are perceptible but which cannot exist—such as a goat-stag and other things having no existence outside the soul. Nor does it arise concerning something possibly existent that is to be perceived in the future.

لَيْسَ يَحْصُلُ فِيمَا لَيْسَ شَأْنُهُ أَنْ يُحَسَّ مِمَّا هُوَ مَعْقُولٌ، أَوْ مِمَّا شَأْنُ مُنَاسِبِهِ أَنْ يُحَسَّ، إِلَّا أَنَّهُ غَيْرُ مُمْكِنِ الْوُجُودِ، كَعَنْزِ أَيِّلٍ وَغَيْرِ ذَلِكَ مِمَّا لَيْسَ لَهُ وُجُودٌ خَارِجَ النَّفْسِ، وَلَا فِيمَا شَأْنُهُ أَنْ يُحَسَّ بَعْدُ مِمَّا هُوَ مُمْكِنُ الْوُجُودِ.

Rather, it yields certainty only about what has determinate existence now, or had determinate existence in the past, among things we have not yet ourselves perceived. Recurrent transmission has no use concerning what we have perceived or can apprehend through a certain syllogism (قياس يقيني), such as the world's coming into being and other matters. For if what is recurrently reported accords with what we perceived or established syllogistically, it is superfluous for us; if the contrary is recurrently reported, no assent arises in us from it.

بَلْ إِنَّمَا يَحْصُلُ الْيَقِينُ بِهِ فِيمَا هُوَ مُحَصَّلُ الْوُجُودِ فِي الزَّمَانِ الْحَاضِرِ، أَوْ كَانَ مُحَصَّلَ الْوُجُودِ فِي الزَّمَانِ الْمَاضِي مِمَّا لَمْ نُحِسَّهُ بَعْدُ، لِأَنَّ مَا أَحْسَسْنَاهُ أَوْ كَانَ لَنَا سَبِيلٌ إِلَى إِدْرَاكِهِ بِقِيَاسٍ يَقِينِيٍّ، كَحَدَثِ الْعَالَمِ، وَغَيْرِ ذَلِكَ، فَلَا غَنَاءَ لِلتَّوَاتُرِ فِيهِ، لِأَنَّهُ إِمَّا أَنْ يَتَوَاتَرَ عِنْدَنَا بِحَسَبِ مَا أَحْسَسْنَا أَوْ وَقَفْنَا عَلَيْهِ بِالْقِيَاسِ، فَذَلِكَ فِي حَقِّنَا فَضْلٌ، وَأَمَّا إِنْ تَوَاتَرَ خِلَافُهُ، فَلَا يَقَعُ لَنَا بِهِ تَصْدِيقٌ.

Our phrase ‘under certain conditions’ guards against cases where reports are recurrent but certainty does not arise. On recognising this, some sought to require a number of transmitters from which certainty follows essentially and primarily, so that the number itself causes certainty and necessitates it as causes necessitate their effects. When they could not ascertain such a number, they defined it as that from which certainty arises, supposing that it has a determinate existence in itself even though it remains unknown to us.

وَقَوْلُنَا: وَعِنْدَ أَحْوَالٍ مَا، تَحَفُّظٌ فِيمَا تَوَاتَرَ وَلَمْ يَقَعِ الْيَقِينُ بِهِ، وَلِذَلِكَ رَامَ قَوْمٌ لَمَّا شَعَرُوا بِهَذَا أَنْ يَشْتَرِطُوا فِي التَّوَاتُرِ عَدَدًا يَلْزَمُ عَنْهُ بِالذَّاتِ وَأَوَّلًا الْيَقِينُ، حَتَّى يَكُونَ هُوَ السَّبَبَ فِي وُقُوعِ الْيَقِينِ عَنْهُ، وَمُقْتَضِيًا لَهُ عَلَى جِهَةِ مَا تَقْتَضِي الْأَسْبَابُ مُسَبَّبَاتِهَا. فَلَمَّا لَمْ يَتَحَصَّلْ لَهُمْ حَدُّوهُ بِأَنَّهُ الَّذِي يَحْصُلُ عَنْهُ الْيَقِينُ عَلَى أَنَّهُ مُحَصَّلُ الْوُجُودِ فِي نَفْسِهِ، وَإِنْ كَانَ مَجْهُولًا عِنْدَنَا.

Observation shows otherwise. The number from which certainty arises evidently increases and decreases from one case to another. If there were some number that by nature produced certainty essentially and primarily, we would perceive and identify it. In general, a multiplicity of informants is one of the contextual indicators (القرائن) producing assent. The number must therefore increase or decrease according to the other contextual indicators joined to it.

وَالْمُشَاهَدَةُ بِخِلَافِ ذَلِكَ، فَإِنَّهُ يَظْهَرُ أَنَّ الْعَدَدَ الَّذِي يَحْصُلُ عَنْهُ الْيَقِينُ يَزِيدُ وَيَنْقُصُ فِي نَازِلَةٍ نَازِلَةٍ، وَلَوْ كَانَ هَهُنَا عَدَدٌ مَا بِالطَّبْعِ يَحْصُلُ عَنْهُ الْيَقِينُ بِالذَّاتِ وَأَوَّلًا لَكُنَّا سَنُحِسُّهُ وَنَقِفُ عَلَيْهِ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَإِنَّ كَثْرَةَ الْمُخْبِرِينَ أَحَدُ الْقَرَائِنِ الَّتِي تُفِيدُ التَّصْدِيقَ، وَلِذَلِكَ يَلْزَمُ أَنْ يَزِيدَ وَيَنْقُصَ بِحَسَبِ مَا تَنْضَافُ إِلَيْهِ مِنَ الْقَرَائِنِ الْأُخَرِ.

Editorial notes

N028 [translation] عنز أيل is retained as the traditional composite example ‘goat-stag’; قياس يقيني here is logical syllogism, not juristic analogy.

§ 076 How premises produce assent, even when unarticulated

1994 Arabic p. 68 & 69 · BA §96–97 · 2015 Arabic p. 174 · French p. 175

وَإِذَا كَانَ هَذَا هَكَذَا، فَلَسْنَا نَقْدِرُ أَنْ نَقُولَ إِنَّ فَاعِلَ ذَلِكَ التَّصْدِيقِ بِالنَّتِيجَةِ يَحْصُلُ عَنِ الْمُقَدِّمَاتِ ⟨أَوَّلًا، بَلْ⟩ عَلَى جِهَةِ مَا نَقُولُ إِنَّ الْمَعْقُولَاتِ الْأُوَلَ تَحْصُلُ عَنِ الْحِسِّ. وَمَنْ ظَنَّ أَنَّ الْحَالَ فِي التَّوَاتُرِ كَالْحَالِ فِي الْمُقَدِّمَاتِ التَّجْرِيبِيَّةِ، وَهِيَ الَّتِي يَحْصُلُ الْيَقِينُ بِكُلِّيَّتِهَا عِنْدَ التَّعَمُّدِ لِإِحْسَاسِ جُزْئِيَّاتِهَا، فَمُخْطِئٌ قَطْعًا. بَلِ التَّصْدِيقُ الْحَاصِلُ عَنِ التَّوَاتُرِ مِنْ فِعْلِ النَّفْسِ، وَكَأَنَّ نِسْبَتَهُ إِلَيْهَا نِسْبَةُ ⟨الْمَعْقُولَاتِ الْأُوَلِ إِلَى الْحِسِّ⟩.

If this is so, we cannot say that assent to this conclusion is produced, in the primary sense, by premises; rather, it comes about in the manner in which the first intelligibles are said to arise from sense perception. Anyone who supposes that recurrent transmission is like experiential premises—whose universality becomes certain through deliberately perceiving their particulars—is definitely mistaken. Rather, the assent arising from recurrent transmission is an act of the soul, and its relation to the soul resembles that of ⟨the first intelligibles to sense perception⟩.

وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ [فَلَمْ يَقَعْ خِلَافٌ فِي التَّوَاتُرِ يُوقِعُ الْيَقِينَ إِلَّا مِمَّنْ لَا يُؤْبَهُ بِهِ، وَهُمُ السُّفَسْطَائِيُّونَ. وَجَاحِدُ ذَلِكَ يَحْتَاجُ إِلَى عُقُوبَةٍ، لِأَنَّهُ كَاذِبٌ بِلِسَانِهِ عَلَى مَا فِي نَفْسِهِ. وَإِنَّمَا الْخِلَافُ فِي جِهَةِ وُقُوعِ الْيَقِينِ عَنْهُ، فَقَوْمٌ رَأَوْهُ بِالذَّاتِ، وَقَوْمٌ رَأَوْهُ بِالْعَرَضِ، وَقَوْمٌ رَأَوْهُ مُكْتَسَبًا] مِثْلَ مَا رَآهُ أَبُو حَامِدٍ هَهُنَا وَمَنْ نَحَا نَحْوَهُ مِنْ أَنَّ الْيَقِينَ بِهِ إِنَّمَا يَحْصُلُ بَعْدَ مُقَدِّمَتَيْنِ: إِحْدَاهُمَا أَنَّ هَؤُلَاءِ مَعَ اخْتِلَافِ أَحْوَالِهِمْ لَا يَجْمَعُهُمْ عَلَى الْكَذِبِ جَامِعٌ. وَالثَّانِي أَنَّهُمْ قَدِ اتَّفَقُوا عَلَى الْإِخْبَارِ عَنْ هَذِهِ الْوَاقِعَةِ.

In general, [no one has disputed that recurrent transmission produces certainty except those who deserve no consideration, namely the sophists. Someone who denies it needs punishment, since his tongue lies about what is in his soul. The disagreement concerns only how certainty arises from it: some hold that it arises essentially (بالذات), some incidentally (بالعرض), and some through acquisition.] Such is the view held here by Abū Ḥāmid and those following him: certainty arises only after two premises. The first is that, despite their differing circumstances, nothing unites these informants in falsehood; the second, that they have agreed in reporting this event.

لَكِنْ أَبُو حَامِدٍ يُسَلِّمُ أَنَّ هَاتَيْنِ الْمُقَدِّمَتَيْنِ لَمْ تُشَكَّلَا قَطُّ فِي الذِّهْنِ بِالْفِعْلِ، وَلَا احْتَاجَ الْإِنْسَانُ إِلَى إِحْضَارِهِمَا عِنْدَ وُقُوعِ التَّصْدِيقِ بِالتَّوَاتُرِ.

Abū Ḥāmid nevertheless concedes that these two premises were never actually formed in the mind, and that a person did not need to summon them when assent arose through recurrent transmission.

Editorial notes

N029 [textual] Bou Akl 2015 Arabic pp.174–175 §96 supplies two separate conjectural restorations: ⟨awwan bal⟩ and ⟨al-maʿqūlāt al-uwal ilā al-ḥiss⟩. His French pp.175–176 confirms the contrast between syllogistic premises and formation of first intelligibles. The older 1994 witness prints a gap and must not be represented as already containing these words.

N030 [textual] The crucial comparison is NO longer "premises OR first intelligibles". Bou Akl reads it as: not produced by premises in a primary way, BUT as first intelligibles arise through sense. His introduction pp.31–38 interprets this as genuine knowledge through recurrent testimony with a causally accidental route; not as illusory certainty.

BA15-R02 [textual] Tawātur and assent. Two restored sequences distinguish an implicit logical deduction from the non-voluntary formation of first intelligibles. See Bou Akl 2015 Arabic p.174, French p.175, intro pp.19–38, commentary §96. Neither the missing causal words nor the comparison is an independently attested manuscript reading.

BA15-I03 [interpretive] Tawātur and reality. Bou Akl 2015 intro pp.10–40 rejects a reading, associated with Maroun Aouad, under which the epistemic effect of tawātur is illusory. The production of certainty may be accidental in causal mode yet real in its result. Transmission establishes that a report was uttered; prophetic miracle grounds the message's religious authority, a logically different question.

§ 077 Sensory actuality, contextual evidence, and common legal knowledge

1994 Arabic p. 69 & 70 · BA §97–98 · 2015 Arabic p. 174 · French p. 175

If this is posited—and it is undoubtedly what is observed in recurrent transmission—it is evident that these two premises play no useful part in producing certainty. What does not actually exist in the soul cannot cause what is potential in it to exist by bringing it into actuality. If the major premise in the first figure were not actually present in the soul, it would not cause the conclusion to arise from it, although that conclusion was potentially contained within it.

وَإِذَا وُضِعَ هَذَا، فِيمَا لَا شَكَّ، هُوَ الْمُشَاهَدُ مِنْ أَمْرِ التَّوَاتُرِ، فَمِنَ الْبَيِّنِ أَنَّهُ لَيْسَ لِهَاتَيْنِ الْمُقَدِّمَتَيْنِ فِي إِيقَاعِ الْيَقِينِ غَنَاءٌ، لِأَنَّ مَا لَيْسَ مَوْجُودًا فِي النَّفْسِ بِالْفِعْلِ فَلَيْسَ يَكُونُ سَبَبًا لِوُجُودِ مَا هُوَ فِيهَا بِالْقُوَّةِ حَتَّى تُخْرِجَهُ إِلَى الْفِعْلِ. وَلَوْلَا كَوْنُ حُصُولِ الْمُقَدِّمَةِ الْكُبْرَى فِي الشَّكْلِ الْأَوَّلِ فِي النَّفْسِ بِالْفِعْلِ مَا كَانَتْ سَبَبًا لِحُصُولِ النَّتِيجَةِ عَنْهَا الَّتِي كَانَتْ مُنْطَوِيَةً فِيهَا بِالْقُوَّةِ.

What benefit, then, is there in requiring something that exists in this manner to produce assent? Hence we stipulated in the definition of recurrent transmission that we do not know how or whence it arose. In general, reports and testimony to reports yield only probable judgement (ظنا), varying with the contextual indicators until, in some cases, certainty arises. People therefore differ about the ranks of assent produced by reports according to their accompaniments. For example, some place a single person's report before a group at the level of recurrent transmission if the group refrains from contradicting him, its numbers ordinarily preclude collusion in sanctioning falsehood, and they have apprehended the reported matter through sense perception.

فَأَيُّ فَائِدَةٍ لِاشْتِرَاطِ مَا وُجُودُهُ مِثْلُ هَذَا الْوُجُودِ فِي إِيقَاعِ التَّصْدِيقِ. وَلِهَذَا اشْتَرَطْنَا فِي حَدِّ التَّوَاتُرِ مِنْ غَيْرِ أَنْ نَدْرِيَ كَيْفَ حَصَلَ وَلَا مِنْ أَيْنَ حَصَلَ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَالْأَخْبَارُ وَالشَّهَادَاتُ عَلَى الْأَخْبَارِ لَا تُفِيدُ إِلَّا ظَنًّا، وَذَلِكَ يَتَفَاوَتُ بِحَسَبِ تَفَاوُتِ الْقَرَائِنِ، حَتَّى يَحْصُلَ فِي بَعْضِهَا الْيَقِينُ. وَلِذَلِكَ اخْتَلَفَ النَّاسُ فِي مَرَاتِبِ التَّصْدِيقَاتِ الْوَاقِعَةِ عَنِ الْأَخْبَارِ بِحَسَبِ مَا يَقْتَرِنُ بِهَا، كَمَنْ يَجْعَلُ خَبَرَ الْوَاحِدِ بَيْنَ يَدَيِ الْجَمَاعَةِ، إِذَا أَمْسَكُوا عَنْ تَكْذِيبِهِ مَعَ أَنَّهُمْ عَدَدٌ يَمْتَنِعُ فِي عُرْفِ الْعَادَةِ تَوَاطُؤُهُمْ عَلَى تَسْوِيغِ الْكَذِبِ، يَتَنَزَّلُ مَنْزِلَةَ التَّوَاتُرِ إِذَا كَانَ مَا أَخْبَرَ عَنْهُ مُدْرَكًا لَهُمْ بِالْحِسِّ.

There are also contextual indicators that weaken the probable judgement arising from reports until, in some cases, their falsehood becomes almost certain. An example is someone reporting that the city's king was killed in the marketplace, after which the people of the market pass by without speaking of it. Of this kind is Abū Ḥanīfa's rejection—may God have mercy upon him—of solitary reports concerning rulings of

وَكَذَلِكَ هَهُنَا قَرَائِنُ تُضْعِفُ الظَّنَّ الْوَاقِعَ بِالْأَخْبَارِ حَتَّى يَكَادَ فِي بَعْضِ الْمَوَاضِعِ يُقْطَعُ بِكَذِبِهَا، كَمَنْ أَخْبَرَ بِقَتْلِ مَلِكِ الْبَلْدَةِ فِي السُّوقِ ثُمَّ مَرَّ أَهْلُ السُّوقِ وَلَمْ يَتَحَدَّثُوا بِذَلِكَ. وَمِنْ هَذَا الْجِنْسِ رَدُّ أَبِي حَنِيفَةَ رَحِمَهُ اللَّهُ أَخْبَارَ الْآحَادِ فِيمَا تَعُمُّ بِهِ الْبَلْوَى مِنَ الْأَحْكَامِ، لِأَنَّهُ يَرَى أَنَّ حَقَّ مَا تَعُمُّ

widespread practical concern: he considers that matters of such concern ought to be widely transmitted. Likewise, Mālik rejected many reports when practice did not accompany them.

بِهِ الْبَلْوَى أَنْ يُنْقَلَ نَقْلًا مُسْتَفِيضًا. وَكَذَلِكَ رَدُّ مَالِكٍ لِكَثِيرٍ مِنَ الْأَحَادِيثِ إِذَا لَمْ يَصْحَبْهَا الْعَمَلُ.

Editorial notes

N031 [translation] بالفعل and بالقوة are the logical and psychological distinction of actuality and potentiality, retained explicitly in the first segment.

§ 078 The conditions of certainty from mass transmission

1994 Arabic p. 70 · BA §99 · 2015 Arabic p. 178 · French p. 179

This is what should be said about the rank of assent arising from reports, and about the cases in which they are useful and those in which they are not.

فَهَذَا مَا يَنْبَغِي أَنْ يُقَالَ فِي مَرْتَبَةِ التَّصْدِيقِ الْحَاصِلِ عَنِ الْأَخْبَارِ، وَفِي أَيِّ مَوْضِعٍ غَنَاؤُهَا، وَفِي أَيِّهَا لَا.

§ 079 Can a solitary report ever produce certainty?

1994 Arabic p. 70 · BA §100 · 2015 Arabic p. 178 · French p. 179

As for a solitary report (خبر الآحاد), according to its definition in this craft, it is what has not reached the point of yielding certainty … [the construction is defective] … in some case through a single person's report, according to the contextual indicators accompanying it. We answer: although this is not impossible, it occurs rarely, perhaps for a particular person in a particular case. Because the probable judgement arising in the soul varies when contextual indicators accompany solitary reports, some held that a single person's report may yield certainty.

فَأَمَّا خَبَرُ الْآحَادِ بِحَسَبِ مَا حُدَّ فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ فَهُوَ مِمَّا لَمْ يَنْتَهِ أَنْ يُفِيدَ الْيَقِينَ فِي مَوْضِعٍ مَا بِخَبَرِ الْوَاحِدِ بِحَسَبِ مَا يَقْتَرِنُ بِذَلِكَ مِنْ قَرَائِنَ، قُلْنَا هَذَا وَإِنْ كَانَ غَيْرَ مُمْتَنِعٍ فَهُوَ مِمَّا يَقِلُّ وُجُودُهُ وَلَعَلَّ ذَلِكَ يَقَعُ فِي حَقِّ شَخْصٍ مَا وَنَازِلَةٍ مَا. وَلِتَفَاوُتِ هَذَا الظَّنِّ الْوَاقِعِ فِي النَّفْسِ عِنْدَ اقْتِرَانِ الْقَرَائِنِ بِأَخْبَارِ الْآحَادِ رَأَى بَعْضُهُمْ أَنَّ خَبَرَ الْوَاحِدِ قَدْ يُفِيدُ الْيَقِينَ.

Editorial notes

N032 [textual] The editor explicitly notes a defect in the construction on printed p. 70. The English marks the disrupted transition between the definition and the reply قلنا; no missing objection has been reconstructed.

§ 080 Four questions governing solitary reports

1994 Arabic p. 70 & 71 · BA §101 · 2015 Arabic p. 178 · French p. 179

After defining a solitary report, its discussion also includes whether the Law permits acting upon it, the conditions of its transmitters, criticism and accreditation (الجرح والتعديل), and the manner in which a transmitter reports from his source.

وَيَلْحَقُ بِخَبَرِ الْوَاحِدِ بَعْدَ التَّكَلُّمِ فِي حَدِّهِ التَّكَلُّمُ فِي جَوَازِ الْعَمَلِ بِهِ شَرْعًا، وَالتَّكَلُّمُ فِي شُرُوطِ النَّاقِلِينَ لَهُ، وَالْجَرْحِ وَالتَّعْدِيلِ، وَكَيْفِيَّةِ نَقْلِ الرَّاوِي عَنْ مَرْوِيِّهِ.

§ 081 The rational and legal warrant for acting on a solitary report

1994 Arabic p. 71 · BA §102–104 · 2015 Arabic p. 178 · French p. 179

أَمَّا الْعَمَلُ بِأَخْبَارِ الْآحَادِ فَهُوَ جَائِزٌ عَقْلًا وَوَاقِعٌ شَرْعًا. أَمَّا جَوَازُ وُقُوعِهِ شَرْعًا، فَإِنَّهُ غَيْرُ مُمْتَنِعٍ أَنْ يَنْصِبَ اللَّهُ تَعَالَى غَلَبَةَ الظَّنِّ عَلَامَةً لِلْحُكْمِ، كَنَصْبِهِ سَائِرَ الْأَشْيَاءِ عَلَامَاتٍ. وَعَلَى هَذَا يُتَصَوَّرُ الْقَضَاءُ بِالشُّهُودِ، وَالْحُكْمُ بِالْفَتْوَى، وَاسْتِقْبَالُ الْكَعْبَةِ إِذَا لَمْ تُعَايَنْ. وَقَدْ رَأَى بَعْضُهُمْ أَنَّ نَصْبَ غَلَبَةِ الظَّنِّ عَلَامَةً لِلْحُكْمِ فِي الشَّرْعِ وَاجِبٌ عَقْلًا، وَلَوْلَا ذَلِكَ لَسَقَطَتْ أَكْثَرُ الْأَحْكَامِ عَنْ مَنْ لَمْ يُشَافِهْ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ.

Acting upon solitary reports is rationally possible and actually occurs in the Law. As for its admissibility in the Law, it is not impossible for God Most High to appoint predominant probability (غلبة الظن) as a sign of a ruling, just as He appoints other things as signs. On this basis one can conceive adjudication through witnesses, judgement by legal opinion, and facing the Kaʿba when it is not visible. Some held that appointing predominant probability as a sign of a legal ruling is rationally necessary; otherwise most rulings would lapse for anyone who had not heard God's Messenger—God bless him and grant him peace—directly.

وَقَوْلُ أَبِي حَامِدٍ إِنَّ هَذَا لَيْسَ بِقَوِيٍّ لِأَنَّ لِقَائِلٍ أَنْ يَقُولَ تَسْقُطُ الْأَحْكَامُ فِي حَقِّ مَنْ لَمْ يَبْلُغْهُ تَوَاتُرُهَا كَمَا تَسْقُطُ فِي حَقِّ مَنْ لَمْ يَسْمَعْ بِالشَّرْعِ وَلَا تَوَاتَرَ عِنْدَهُ، فَلَيْسَ عِنْدِي بِمَرْضِيٍّ. لِأَنَّ انْطِوَاءَ الشَّرْعِ نَادِرٌ وَقَلِيلٌ جِدًّا حَتَّى لَا يَكَادُ يَقَعُ هَذَا مَعَ تَطَاوُلِ الزَّمَانِ، بَلْ بِاضْطِرَارٍ وَقَعَ نَقْلُهُ إِلَى جَمِيعِ الْمَعْمُورَةِ تَوَاتُرًا. وَإِنَّمَا يُشْبِهُ أَنْ يَقَعَ مِثْلُ هَذَا فِي أَوَّلِ الْإِسْلَامِ، وَلَيْسَ كَذَلِكَ الْعَمَلُ بِأَخْبَارِ الْآحَادِ، لِأَنَّهُ لَيْسَ مِنْ ضَرُورَةِ كُلِّ خَبَرٍ أَنْ يُنْقَلَ تَوَاتُرًا، فَلَوِ اشْتُرِطَ فِي الْعَمَلِ بِهِ التَّوَاتُرُ لَأَدَّى ذَلِكَ إِلَى تَعْطِيلِ أَكْثَرِ الْأَحْكَامِ عَنْ أَكْثَرِ الْمُكَلَّفِينَ.

Abū Ḥāmid says this argument is not strong, since one could say that rulings lapse for those whom recurrent transmission has not reached, just as they lapse for those who have neither heard of the Law nor received it by recurrent transmission. I do not find this satisfactory. The Law's remaining hidden is exceedingly rare, scarcely occurring over a long period; its recurrent transmission to the entire inhabited world has necessarily taken place. Such concealment might plausibly have occurred at the beginning of Islam. Acting on solitary reports is different: not every report must necessarily be recurrently transmitted, and requiring recurrence before acting would suspend most rulings for most legally responsible persons.

وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ لَوْ لَمْ يَجِبِ الْقَضَاءُ بِالشُّهُودِ وَالْأَيْمَانِ وَالْحُكْمُ بِالِاجْتِهَادِ لَمَا كَانَ سَبِيلٌ إِلَى رَدِّ الْمَظَالِمِ وَالْأَخْذِ بِالْحُقُوقِ. وَقَدْ يُسْتَدَلُّ أَيْضًا عَلَى وُقُوعِهِ شَرْعًا بِإِجْمَاعِ الصَّحَابَةِ عَلَى الْعَمَلِ بِهِ، وَتَوَقُّفُهُمْ فِي بَعْضِ الْأَخْبَارِ إِنَّمَا كَانَ اجْتِهَادًا مِنْهُمْ فِي طُرُقِهَا. وَإِنْفَاذُ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ الْوُلَاةَ إِلَى الْبِلَادِ، وَتَكْلِيفُ النَّاسِ تَصْدِيقَهُمْ، مِمَّا يُقْطَعُ بِهِ عَلَى وُقُوعِهِ شَرْعًا.

In general, if adjudicating through witnesses and oaths, and judging by independent judgement, were not obligatory, there would be no way to redress wrongs and secure rights. Its occurrence in the Law can also be inferred from the Companions' consensus on acting upon such reports. Their hesitation concerning some reports was merely their independent assessment of the routes of transmission. The fact that God's Messenger—God bless him and grant him peace—sent governors to the provinces and charged

people to accept their reports establishes its occurrence in the Law with certainty.

§ 082 Does the command to warn establish the duty to accept a report?

1994 Arabic p. 72 · BA §105–106 · 2015 Arabic p. 182 · French p. 183

فَأَمَّا قَوْلُ اللَّهِ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ: {فَلَوْلَا نَفَرَ مِنْ كُلِّ فِرْقَةٍ مِنْهُمْ طَائِفَةٌ لِيَتَفَقَّهُوا فِي الدِّينِ وَلِيُنْذِرُوا قَوْمَهُمْ إِذَا رَجَعُوا إِلَيْهِمْ} فَرَأَى بَعْضُهُمْ أَنَّهَا قَاطِعَةٌ فِي الْعَمَلِ بِأَخْبَارِ الْآحَادِ، إِذِ الطَّائِفَةُ تَقَعُ عَلَى النَّفَرِ الْيَسِيرِ الَّذِينَ لَا يَحْصُلُ الْيَقِينُ بِقَوْلِهِمْ. وَأَبُو حَامِدٍ يَرَى أَنَّهَا لَيْسَتْ بِقَاطِعَةٍ إِلَّا فِي وُجُوبِ الْإِنْذَارِ. قَالَ: وَلَيْسَ يَلْزَمُ مِنْ وُجُوبِهِ عَلَيْهِمْ وُجُوبُ الْعَمَلِ بِهِ، كَمَا يَجِبُ عَلَى الشَّاهِدِ الْوَاحِدِ، إِذِ الشَّهَادَةُ لَا يُعْمَلُ بِهَا.

Some regard His words—mighty and exalted—'Why should not a group from every division of them go forth, to gain understanding in religion and warn their people when they return to them?' as decisive concerning acting upon solitary reports. A 'group' can mean a few people whose statements do not yield certainty. Abū Ḥāmid considers the verse decisive only concerning the obligation to warn. He says that their obligation to warn does not entail an obligation to act upon it, just as a single witness must testify although his testimony is not acted upon.

قَالَ: وَبِمِثْلِ هَذَا الِاعْتِرَاضِ يَضْعُفُ التَّمَسُّكُ بِقَوْلِهِ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ: {إِنَّ الَّذِينَ يَكْتُمُونَ مَا أَنْزَلْنَا مِنَ الْبَيِّنَاتِ وَالْهُدَى}، وَبِقَوْلِهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: «نَضَّرَ اللَّهُ امْرَأً سَمِعَ مَقَالَتِي فَوَعَاهَا وَأَدَّاهَا كَمَا سَمِعَهَا» الْحَدِيثَ. وَهَذَا الْقَوْلُ مِنْهُ لَا مَعْنَى لَهُ، لِأَنَّهُ مَا فَائِدَةُ وُجُوبِ الْإِنْذَارِ إِذَا لَمْ يَجِبِ الْعَمَلُ بِنَقْلِهِمْ. وَلَيْسَ يُشْبِهُ هَذَا الشَّاهِدَ فَإِنَّهُ إِنَّمَا وَجَبَ عَلَيْهِ أَدَاءُ الشَّهَادَةِ رَجَاءَ أَنْ يَأْتِيَ مَنْ عِنْدَهُ مِثْلُ شَهَادَتِهِ فَيَقَعَ الْعَمَلُ بِهَا.

He adds that the same objection weakens appeals to His words—mighty and exalted— 'Those who conceal what We have sent down of clear proofs and guidance,' and to the saying of the Messenger—God bless him and grant him peace—'May God make radiant one who hears my words, retains them, and conveys them as he heard them,' and the rest of the report. This statement of his has no meaning. What is the benefit of requiring warning if acting on their transmission is not obligatory? It is not like a witness's case: he is obliged to testify in the hope that another person with matching testimony will come forward, allowing it to be acted upon.

اللَّهُمَّ إِلَّا أَنْ يَقُولَ الْقَائِلُ عَسَى إِنْ وُجِدَ الْإِنْذَارُ إِنَّمَا لَزِمَ الْآحَادَ لِيَتَكَثَّرُوا حَتَّى يَقَعَ الْعِلْمُ الضَّرُورِيُّ بِقَوْلِهِمْ، لَكِنْ هَذَا يَنْكَسِرُ مِمَّا تَقَدَّمَ مِنْ أَنَّ ذَلِكَ كَانَ يُؤَدِّي إِلَى تَعْطِيلِ أَكْثَرِ الْأَحْكَامِ. وَإِنَّمَا يُشْبِهُ أَنْ يُظَنَّ أَنَّ الْآيَةَ لَيْسَتْ بِقَاطِعَةٍ وَلَا نَصًّا فِي الْعَمَلِ بِأَخْبَارِ الْآحَادِ مِنْ جِهَةِ أَنَّ الطَّائِفَةَ اسْمٌ يَقَعُ عَلَى النَّفَرِ الْيَسِيرِ وَالْعَدَدِ الْكَثِيرِ الَّذِي يُمْكِنُ أَنْ يَقَعَ الْيَقِينُ بِقَوْلِهِمْ بِدَلِيلِ قَوْلِهِ: «لَا تَزَالُ طَائِفَةٌ مِنْ أُمَّتِي»

One might reply that warning was perhaps required of individuals only so that their numbers would increase until their statements produced necessary knowledge. But this is refuted by the preceding point: it would suspend most rulings. It is more plausible to regard the verse as neither decisive nor unambiguous wording (نصا) for acting upon solitary reports because 'group' applies both to a few people and to a large number whose statements can yield certainty, as indicated by the saying, 'A group of my community will continue …' and the rest of the report. The verse's more apparent meaning, however, is that 'group' here

does not mean people whose transmission produces knowledge.

الْحَدِيثَ. لَكِنِ الْآيَةُ أَظْهَرُ فِي أَنَّهُ لَيْسَ الْمُرَادُ بِالطَّائِفَةِ هَهُنَا مَنْ يَحْصُلُ الْعِلْمُ بِنَقْلِهِمْ.

Editorial notes

N033 [textual] The printed construction عسى إن وجد الإنذار إنما لزم الآحاد (p. 72) is compressed or defective. The English gives the contextual sense of the proposed reply without supplying new Arabic wording.

§ 083 One transmitter need not satisfy the numerical rules of testimony

1994 Arabic p. 72 & 73 · BA §107–108 · 2015 Arabic p. 184 · French p. 185

Since acting on a solitary report has been established, the conditions under which it is accepted and must be acted upon must be stated, for not every report requires action. First, a single person's report is acted upon even where his testimony is not. Once acting on such a report is established, whoever requires a plurality must prove that requirement from the Law; it cannot properly be assimilated to testimony by analogy (قياسا). The Companions—may God be pleased with them—sought corroboration through numbers on two or three occasions as their independent judgement in circumstances particular to those cases. In general, we do not require a plurality as a condition.

وَإِذْ قَدْ ثَبَتَ الْعَمَلُ بِخَبَرِ الْوَاحِدِ فَلَا بُدَّ مِنْ ذِكْرِ الشُّرُوطِ الَّتِي يُقْبَلُ بِهَا وَيَجِبُ الْعَمَلُ بِهِ، إِذْ لَيْسَ كُلُّ خَبَرٍ يَجِبُ الْعَمَلُ بِهِ. فَأَوَّلُهَا أَنَّ خَبَرَ الْوَاحِدِ يُعْمَلُ بِهِ وَإِنْ لَمْ يُعْمَلْ بِشَهَادَتِهِ، لِأَنَّ اشْتِرَاطَ الْعَدَدِ إِذَا ثَبَتَ الْعَمَلُ بِهِ مِمَّا يَجِبُ عَلَى مُدَّعِي ذَلِكَ إِثْبَاتُهُ شَرْعًا، وَلَا يَصِحُّ فِي مِثْلِ هَذَا حَمْلُهُ عَلَى الشَّهَادَةِ قِيَاسًا. وَاسْتِظْهَارُ الصَّحَابَةِ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمْ بِالْعَدَدِ فِي وَاقِعَتَيْنِ أَوْ ثَلَاثٍ فَذَلِكَ اجْتِهَادٌ مِنْهُمْ لِأَحْوَالٍ خَاصَّةٍ بِتِلْكَ النَّوَازِلِ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَاشْتِرَاطُ الْعَدَدِ لَيْسَ بِشَرْطٍ عِنْدَنَا.

Editorial notes

BA15-I04 [interpretive] The practical need for probability. Bou Akl 2015 intro pp.77–87 distinguishes possible uncertainty about the reliability of transmission and uncertainty about intended verbal meaning. Acting on strongly probable evidence in law is not claiming probable information has become theoretically certain.

§ 084 Hearing in childhood and transmitting after puberty

1994 Arabic p. 73 · BA §109 · 2015 Arabic p. 184 · French p. 185

The first condition is that we do not accept a child's report, because he does not fear God and we cannot be assured against his lying. If, however, he was a child when he heard the report and transmits it after puberty, it is accepted. The proof is the Companions' consensus on acting upon reports without distinguishing whether they were heard in childhood or after puberty. Those who accept children's testimony concerning injuries occurring among them are led to do so by inference from contextual indicators arising from

وَأَوَّلُ الشُّرُوطِ أَنَّا لَا نَقْبَلُ خَبَرَ الصَّبِيِّ، لِأَنَّهُ لَا يَخَافُ اللَّهَ، فَلَا نَأْمَنُ عَلَيْهِ الْكَذِبَ. وَأَمَّا إِذَا كَانَ طِفْلًا عِنْدَ السَّمَاعِ، ثُمَّ نَقَلَ الْحَدِيثَ بَعْدَ بُلُوغِهِ، فَهُوَ مَقْبُولٌ بِدَلِيلِ إِجْمَاعِ الصَّحَابَةِ عَلَى الْعَمَلِ بِالْأَحَادِيثِ مِنْ غَيْرِ فَرْقٍ بَيْنَ مَنْ سَمِعَ فِي الصِّغَرِ أَوْ بَعْدَ الْبُلُوغِ. وَقَوْلُ مَنْ قَالَ تُقْبَلُ شَهَادَةُ الصِّبْيَانِ فِي الْجِنَايَاتِ الَّتِي تَقَعُ بَيْنَهُمْ، فَإِنَّمَا حَمَلَهُ عَلَى ذَلِكَ

their numbers; hence they require their testimony to be given before they disperse.

الِاسْتِدْلَالُ بِالْقَرَائِنِ لِكَثْرَتِهِمْ، وَلِذَلِكَ اشْتَرَطَ فِي شَهَادَتِهِمْ قَبْلَ أَنْ يَتَفَرَّقُوا.

§ 085 Accurate retention, religious identity, and transmission

1994 Arabic p. 73 · BA §110–111 · 2015 Arabic p. 186 · French p. 187

Another condition is accurate retention (ضابطا), since someone inattentive will usually fall into error. There is no disagreement about requiring the transmitter to be Muslim: an unbeliever's transmission is not accepted because he is suspect concerning religion. Although Abū Ḥanīfa accepts unbelievers' testimony concerning one another, there is no dissent from rejecting their transmission. In general, the basis for rejecting it is consensus.

وَمِنَ الشُّرُوطِ أَنْ يَكُونَ ضَابِطًا، فَإِنَّ مَنْ كَانَ مُغَفَّلًا يَقَعُ مِنْهُ فِي الْأَكْثَرِ الْغَلَطُ. وَأَمَّا كَوْنُهُ مُسْلِمًا فَلَا خِلَافَ فِي اشْتِرَاطِ ذَلِكَ، لِأَنَّ الْكَافِرَ لَا تُقْبَلُ رِوَايَتُهُ لِأَنَّهُ مُتَّهَمٌ فِي الدِّينِ. وَإِنْ كَانَتْ تُقْبَلُ شَهَادَةُ بَعْضِهِمْ عَلَى بَعْضٍ عِنْدَ أَبِي حَنِيفَةَ، فَلَا مُخَالِفَ فِي رَدِّ رِوَايَتِهِ، وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَالِاعْتِمَادُ فِي رَدِّهَا عَلَى الْإِجْمَاعِ.

§ 086 Probity as a disposition rather than a mere label

1994 Arabic p. 73 · BA §112 · 2015 Arabic p. 186 · French p. 187

The requirement of probity (العدالة) is undisputed, but what its name signifies is disputed. Some, who are the majority, hold that probity is a state of the soul (حالة في النفس) from which follows avoidance of what the Law prohibits, whether by forbiddance or disapproval, and performance of what the Law commands, whether by obligation or recommendation, without falling short in this.

وَأَمَّا اشْتِرَاطُ الْعَدَالَةِ فَغَيْرُ مُخْتَلَفٍ فِيهِ، لَكِنْ مَا يَدُلُّ عَلَيْهِ اسْمُهَا مُخْتَلَفٌ فِيهِ فَذَهَبَ قَوْمٌ، وَهُمُ الْأَكْثَرُونَ، أَنَّ الْعَدَالَةَ حَالَةٌ فِي النَّفْسِ يَلْزَمُ عَنْهَا اجْتِنَابُ مَا نُهِيَ عَنْهُ فِي الشَّرْعِ نَهْيَ تَحْرِيمٍ أَوْ نَهْيَ كَرَاهَةٍ وَإِتْيَانُ مَا أُمِرَ بِهِ فِي الشَّرْعِ أَمْرَ وُجُوبٍ أَوْ أَمْرَ نَدْبٍ مِنْ غَيْرِ أَنْ يُخِلَّ بِذَلِكَ.

§ 087 How much moral integrity must a transmitter possess?

1994 Arabic p. 73 & 74 · BA §112 · 2015 Arabic p. 186 · French p. 187

In general, he must avoid everything that impugns his religion and whose commission leaves lying open to him. This varies according to the assessments of those exercising independent judgement. There is, however, no disagreement that sinlessness is not required, just as avoiding grave sins is not sufficient. Some hold that probity consists in manifesting Islam while not being known as morally transgressive, without investigation into one's conduct or inward condition.

وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَيُشْتَرَطُ فِيهِ تَجَنُّبُ كُلِّ مَا يَقْدَحُ فِي دِينِهِ مِمَّا لَا يَمْتَنِعُ عَلَيْهِ الْكَذِبُ مَعَ إِتْيَانِهِ وَهَذَا يَخْتَلِفُ بِحَسَبِ نَظَرِ الْمُجْتَهِدِينَ. وَلَكِنْ لَا خِلَافَ فِي أَنَّهُ لَا تُشْتَرَطُ فِيهِ الْعِصْمَةُ، كَمَا لَا يَكْفِي فِي ذَلِكَ اجْتِنَابُ الْكَبَائِرِ. وَذَهَبَ قَوْمٌ إِلَى أَنَّ الْعَدَالَةَ عِبَارَةٌ عَنْ إِظْهَارِ الْإِسْلَامِ مَعَ أَنَّهُ لَا يُعْلَمُ فَاسِقًا دُونَ بَحْثٍ عَنْ سِيرَتِهِ وَسَرِيرَتِهِ.

Editorial notes

N034 [textual] Paragraph number 87 and its opening are confirmed on printed p. 73; the paragraph continues onto p. 74.

§ 088 Unknown character and the presumption of trustworthiness

1994 Arabic p. 74 · BA §113 · 2015 Arabic p. 186 · French p. 187

أَمَّا أَصْحَابُ الْمَذْهَبِ الْأَوَّلِ فَاحْتَجُّوا بِأَنْ قَالُوا: كَمَا أَنَّ الْمَجْهُولَ الْكُفْرِ لَا يَجُوزُ نَقْلُهُ، كَذَلِكَ الْمَجْهُولُ الْفِسْقِ. وَلِأُولَئِكَ أَنْ يَقُولُوا إِنَّ الْمَجْهُولَ الْكُفْرِ لَيْسَ تُعْرَفُ مِنْهُ حَالَةٌ يَغْلِبُ بِهَا عَلَى الظَّنِّ حُسْنُ الثِّقَةِ بِهِ، وَلَيْسَ كَذَلِكَ الْمَعْرُوفُ مِنْهُ إِظْهَارُ الْإِسْلَامِ. وَقَدِ احْتَجُّوا أَيْضًا لِذَلِكَ بِرَدِّ الصَّحَابَةِ أَخْبَارَ الْمَجَاهِيلِ كَرَدِّ عُمَرَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ خَبَرَ فَاطِمَةَ بِنْتِ قَيْسٍ، وَرَدِّ عَلِيٍّ قَوْلَ الْأَشْجَعِيِّ، وَمَا ظَهَرَ مِنْ طَلَبِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ الْعَدَالَةَ وَالثِّقَةَ فِيمَنْ كَانَ يُنْفِذُهُ إِلَى الْبِلَادِ.

The proponents of the first doctrine argued: just as transmission is inadmissible from someone whose status concerning unbelief is unknown, so it is from someone whose status concerning moral transgression is unknown. Their opponents may reply that, in the former case, no state is known that produces predominant confidence in his trustworthiness, whereas a person known to manifest Islam is different. The first group also appealed to the Companions' rejection of reports from unknown persons—‘Umar's rejection—may God be pleased with him—of Fāṭima bt. Qays's report and ‘Alī's rejection of al-Ashjaʿī's statement—and to the evident demand of God's Messenger—God bless him and grant him peace—for probity and trustworthiness in those he sent to the provinces.

§ 089 The Bedouin’s crescent testimony and an uncertain printed reading

1994 Arabic p. 74 · BA §113 · 2015 Arabic p. 186 · French p. 187

وَأَمَّا مَا احْتَجَّ بِهِ أَهْلُ الْفِرْقَةِ الثَّانِيَةِ فَقَبُولُهُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ شَهَادَةَ الْأَعْرَابِيِّ فِي رُؤْيَةِ الْهِلَالِ، مَعَ أَنَّهُ لَمْ يُعْرَفْ مِنْهُ إِلَّا الْإِسْلَامُ، وَلِأُولَئِكَ أَلَّا يُسَلِّمُوا أَنَّهُ كَانَ مَجْهُولًا عِنْدَ اللَّهِ، وَاحْتَجُّوا أَيْضًا بِأَنَّ الصَّحَابَةَ قَبِلُوا قَوْلَ مَنْ لَمْ يَعْرِفُوهُمْ بِالْفِسْقِ وَعَرَفُوهُمْ بِالْإِسْلَامِ.

The second group appealed to the fact that the Messenger—God bless him and grant him peace—accepted a Bedouin's testimony that he had seen the crescent, although nothing was known of him except his Islam. Their opponents need not concede that he was unknown ‘to God’ [so the printed text]. They also argued that the Companions accepted the statements of people whom they knew as Muslims and did not know to be morally transgressive.

Editorial notes

N035 [textual] Printed p. 74 reads مجهولا عند الله. The argument appears to require ‘unknown to him’, referring to the Messenger, but the printed reading has been retained and marked rather than silently emended.

§ 090 Probity aims at probable truthfulness, not an arbitrary threshold

1994 Arabic p. 74 & 75 · BA §114 · 2015 Arabic p. 188 · French p. 189

In general, each group has advanced arguments that, although apparently supporting its claim, still admit interpretation. The question concerns independent judgement, not certainty. What is intended by probity, it appears, is simply a predominant probability of truthfulness; this varies with the contextual indicators supplied by the circumstances.

وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَقَدِ احْتَجَّ كُلُّ فَرِيقٍ مِنْهُمْ بِحُجَجٍ، وَهِيَ وَإِنْ كَانَتْ ظَاهِرَةً بِحَسَبِ دَعْوَاهُ فَهِيَ مَعَ هَذَا مُحْتَمِلَةٌ لِلتَّأْوِيلِ، وَالْمَسْأَلَةُ اجْتِهَادِيَّةٌ لَا قَطْعِيَّةٌ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَالْمَقْصُودُ فِيمَا يَظْهَرُ مِنَ الْعَدَالَةِ إِنَّمَا هُوَ غَلَبَةُ الظَّنِّ بِالصِّدْقِ، وَذَلِكَ يَخْتَلِفُ بِحَسَبِ اخْتِلَافِ قَرَائِنِ الْأَحْوَالِ.

Where the Law has not established with certainty a determinate sign of predominant probability concerning truthfulness, we should therefore impose no fixed limit. The matter should be entrusted to the inquiry of those exercising independent judgement. Contextual indicators may come together for one such jurist that make a person's truthfulness predominantly probable to him, while they do not come together for another.

فَيَنْبَغِي إِذَنْ فِيمَا لَمْ يَنْصِبِ الشَّرْعُ فِيهِ عَلَامَةً مَحْدُودَةً بِطَرِيقٍ قَطْعِيٍّ لِغَلَبَةِ الظَّنِّ بِالصِّدْقِ أَلَّا نَحُدَّ فِيهَا حَدًّا، بَلْ يُوكَلُ ذَلِكَ إِلَى نَظَرِ الْمُجْتَهِدِينَ، فَإِنَّهُ رُبَّ مُجْتَهِدٍ تَجْتَمِعُ عِنْدَهُ قَرَائِنُ يَغْلِبُ بِهَا عَلَى ظَنِّهِ صِدْقُ إِنْسَانٍ مَا لَيْسَ تَجْتَمِعُ لِإِنْسَانٍ آخَرَ.

§ 091 Wrongdoing based on interpretation and the acceptance of reports

1994 Arabic p. 75 · BA §115 · 2015 Arabic p. 188 · French p. 189

They have disagreed about a morally transgressive person who acts on an interpretation (الفاسق المتأول), meaning someone who does not recognise his own transgression. Whoever holds that transgression prevents acceptance only because it arouses suspicion cannot conceive rejecting him unless his transgression consists in permitting lying. Whoever holds that transgression in itself defeats acceptance, ⟨not⟩ because it arouses suspicion, permits their testimony concerning one another. The first is al-Shāfiʿī's doctrine; the second, the Qāḍī's. Al-Shāfiʿī's doctrine seems more consistent with the reasoning, and is supported by the Companions' acceptance—may God be pleased with them—of reports from the Khārijites.

وَأَمَّا الْفَاسِقُ الْمُتَأَوِّلُ، وَهُوَ الَّذِي لَا يَعْرِفُ فِسْقَ نَفْسِهِ، فَقَدِ اخْتَلَفُوا فِيهِ. فَمَنْ رَأَى أَنَّ الْفِسْقَ إِنَّمَا يَمْنَعُ الْقَبُولَ لِلتُّهْمَةِ، فَلَا يُتَصَوَّرُ عِنْدَهُ رَدُّهُ، إِلَّا أَنْ يَكُونُوا فَسَقُوهُ فِي إِجَازَةِ الْكَذِبِ. وَمَنْ رَأَى أَنَّ الْفِسْقَ بِنَفْسِهِ هَادِمٌ لِلْقَبُولِ ⟨لَا⟩ لِمَوْضِعِ التُّهْمَةِ أَجَازَ شَهَادَةَ بَعْضِهِمْ عَلَى بَعْضٍ. وَالْأَوَّلُ مَذْهَبُ الشَّافِعِيِّ وَالثَّانِي مَذْهَبُ الْقَاضِي. وَيُشْبِهُ أَنْ يَكُونَ مَذْهَبُ الشَّافِعِيِّ أَقْيَسَ، وَيَشْهَدُ لَهُ قَبُولُ الصَّحَابَةِ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمْ أَخْبَارَ الْخَوَارِجِ.

Editorial notes

N036 [textual] Bou Akl 2015 §115 (Arabic p.188, French p.189) conjecturally supplies ⟨lā⟩ before li-mawḍiʿ al-tuhma, reversing the second position: exclusion due to transgression per se, NOT just suspicion. He also prints a form equivalent to

yakūnū fusaqa, differing from this reader’s 1994 wording yakūnū fisquhu. That additional variant is flagged, not silently assimilated.

BA15-R03 [textual] Reports from a disputant who does not recognize his own transgression: al-Shāfiʿī ties admissibility to suspicion of lying; the other account treats sinfulness as disqualifying in itself. Bou Akl 2015 Arabic p.188, French p.189, commentary §115. The restored lā is conjectural and affects the English meaning.

§ 092 Probable wrongdoing: the example of disputed nabīdh

1994 Arabic p. 75 · BA §115 · 2015 Arabic p. 188 · French p. 189

The transgression of someone acting on an interpretation may be known through a certain proof or through a probable proof. Acceptance of the transmission of someone whose transgression is established by a probable proof should be more appropriate. Hence al-Shāfiʿī says: ‘I judge the Ḥanafī who drinks nabīdh morally transgressive, but I do not reject his testimony.’

وَالْفَاسِقُ الْمُتَأَوِّلُ رُبَّمَا عُلِمَ فِسْقُهُ بِدَلِيلٍ قَطْعِيٍّ وَرُبَّمَا عُلِمَ فِسْقُهُ بِدَلِيلٍ ظَنِّيٍّ. وَيَنْبَغِي أَنْ يَكُونَ قَبُولُ رِوَايَةِ مَنْ عُلِمَ فِسْقُهُ بِدَلِيلٍ ظَنِّيٍّ أَوْلَى، وَلِذَلِكَ يَقُولُ الشَّافِعِيُّ أُفَسِّقُ الْحَنَفِيَّ الشَّارِبَ لِلنَّبِيذِ وَلَا أَرُدُّ شَهَادَتَهُ.

Editorial notes

N037 [translation] Nabīdh is left as the specific disputed beverage named by the author rather than assimilated to every alcoholic drink.

§ 093 Minimum conditions differ from grounds of preference

1994 Arabic p. 75 · BA §116 · 2015 Arabic p. 190 · French p. 191

These are the conditions required in a transmitter. As for the considerations through which preference (الترجيح) is established, they are almost without limit.

فَهَذِهِ هِيَ الْأَشْيَاءُ الَّتِي تُشْتَرَطُ فِي الرَّاوِي وَأَمَّا الْأَشْيَاءُ الَّتِي يَقَعُ بِهَا التَّرْجِيحُ فَتَكَادُ لَا تَتَنَاهَى.

§ 094 Four questions about criticism and attestation

1994 Arabic p. 75 · BA §117 · 2015 Arabic p. 190 · French p. 191

This comprises four sections.

فِيهِ أَرْبَعَةُ فُصُولٍ:

§ 095 How many people must attest a narrator’s probity?

1994 Arabic p. 75 · BA §117 · 2015 Arabic p. 190 · French p. 191

Some require more than one person to attest a transmitter’s probity, by analogy with testimony; others do not, by analogy with the acceptance of a report transmitted by a person of probity. The latter is the more evident view.

اشْتَرَطَ قَوْمٌ الْعَدَدَ فِي الْمُزَكِّي قِيَاسًا عَلَى الشَّهَادَةِ، وَبَعْضٌ لَمْ يَشْتَرِطْهُ قِيَاسًا عَلَى قَبُولِ رِوَايَةِ الْعَدْلِ، وَهُوَ الْأَظْهَرُ.

§ 096 Stating grounds and resolving conflicting evaluations

1994 Arabic p. 75 & 76 · BA §118 · 2015 Arabic p. 190 · French p. 191

قَالَ الشَّافِعِيُّ يَجِبُ ذِكْرُ سَبَبِ الْجَرْحِ دُونَ التَّعْدِيلِ. إِذْ قَدْ يَرَى وَاحِدٌ جَرْحَةً مَا لَا يَرَاهُ الْآخَرُ. وَأَمَّا الْعَدَالَةُ فَلَيْسَ لَهَا إِلَّا سَبَبٌ وَاحِدٌ. وَرَأَى قَوْمٌ نَقِيضَ هَذَا لِتَسَارُعِ النَّاسِ إِلَى الثَّنَاءِ عَلَى الظَّاهِرِ. وَقَالَ الْقَاضِي لَا يَجِبُ ذِكْرُ السَّبَبِ فِيهِمَا تَعْوِيلًا عَلَى الْمُزَكِّي. وَقَالَ قَوْمٌ لَا بُدَّ مِنْ ذِكْرِ السَّبَبِ فِيهِمَا جَمِيعًا، وَهُوَ الْأَحْوَطُ عِنْدِي، إِذِ الْعَدَالَةُ وَالتَّجْرِيحُ مُخْتَلَفٌ فِيهِمَا كَمَا تَقَدَّمَ.

Al-Shāfiʿī says that the grounds for criticism must be stated, whereas the grounds for attesting probity need not be: one person may regard as a fault something that another does not, while probity has only one basis. Some hold the reverse, because people are quick to praise on the strength of appearances. The Qāḍī says that the grounds need not be stated in either case, reliance being placed on the person giving the attestation. Others say that the grounds must be stated in both cases. This is, in my view, the more cautious course, since the criteria of both probity and criticism are disputed, as was explained earlier.

وَأَمَّا إِذَا تَعَارَضَ الْجَرْحُ وَالتَّعْدِيلُ فَالْجَرْحُ هُوَ الْمُقَدَّمُ لِأَنَّهُ اطِّلَاعٌ عَلَى زِيَادَةٍ لَمْ يَطَّلِعْ عَلَيْهَا الْمُعَدِّلُ، إِلَّا أَنْ يَكُونَ يَعْنِي تَشْخِيصَ مَا أَثْبَتَهُ الْجَارِحُ فَحِينَئِذٍ يَتَعَارَضُ الْجَرْحُ وَالتَّعْدِيلُ.

When criticism conflicts with an attestation of probity, criticism takes precedence, because it discloses additional information unknown to the person attesting probity—unless the latter specifically addresses the very matter asserted by the critic. In that case, criticism and attestation stand in conflict.

Editorial notes

N038 [textual] At p. 76 the edition reads يعني تشخيص ما أثبته الجارح; the English preserves its reference to the specific allegation rather than silently emending يعني to ينفي.

§ 097 What conduct counts as an attestation of probity?

1994 Arabic p. 76 · BA §119 · 2015 Arabic p. 190 · French p. 191

وَذَلِكَ يُتَصَوَّرُ وُقُوعُهُ عَلَى أَرْبَعَةِ أَنْحَاءٍ: إِمَّا بِالْقَبُولِ، أَوْ بِالرِّوَايَةِ عَنْهُ، أَوْ بِالْعَمَلِ بِخَبَرِهِ، أَوْ بِالْحُكْمِ بِشَهَادَتِهِ. وَأَعْلَاهَا صَرِيحُ الْقَوْلِ بِتَعْرِيفِ وَجْهِ عَدَالَتِهِ، وَدُونَ ذَلِكَ أَنْ يَرْوِيَ عَنْهُ خَبَرًا. وَهَذَا إِنَّمَا يَصِحُّ عَلَى رَأْيِ مَنْ يَكْفِي عِنْدَهُ فِي التَّعْدِيلِ نَفْسُ التَّزْكِيَةِ، هَذَا إِذَا فُهِمَ مِنْ حَالِهِ التَّجَرُّحُ عَنِ الثِّقَاتِ عِنْدَهُ. وَأَمَّا الْعَمَلُ بِالْخَبَرِ فَلَيْسَ بِتَعْدِيلٍ، إِذْ قَدْ يُمْكِنُ أَنْ يَعْمَلَ بِدَلِيلٍ آخَرَ، إِلَّا إِنْ عَلِمْنَا أَنَّهُ عَمِلَ بِذَلِكَ

This can take four forms: through approval, through transmitting a report from someone, through acting upon his report, or through giving judgement on his testimony. The highest is an explicit statement explaining the basis of his probity; below this is transmitting a report from him. The latter is valid only on the view that an attestation by itself suffices to establish probity, and only when the transmitter's practice is understood to be that of transmitting from authorities he regards as trustworthy. Acting upon a report, however, does not attest the transmitter's probity, since the action may rest on another proof—unless we know that he acted on

that report as received through that particular transmitter. This, too, follows the view that the grounds for criticism and attestation need not be stated.

الْخَبَرِ مِنْ طَرِيقِ ذَلِكَ النَّاقِلِ. وَهَذَا أَيْضًا عَلَى رَأْيِ مَنْ لَا يَشْتَرِطُ ذِكْرَ سَبَبِ الْجَرْحِ وَالتَّعْدِيلِ.

Giving judgement on someone's testimony is stronger than merely attesting his probity. Declining to give judgement on his testimony or report is not, however, a criticism of him: one may withhold acceptance of a slave's testimony or transmission for reasons other than an objection to his probity. In general, when no other reason presents itself for rejecting his testimony and transmission, the rejection is equivalent to an unspecified criticism.

وَأَمَّا الْحُكْمُ بِشَهَادَتِهِ فَذَلِكَ أَقْوَى مِنْ تَزْكِيَتِهِ. وَأَمَّا تَرْكُهُ الْحُكْمَ بِشَهَادَتِهِ أَوْ خَبَرِهِ، فَلَيْسَ جَرْحًا، إِذْ قَدْ يَتَوَقَّفُ فِي شَهَادَةِ الْعَبْدِ أَوْ رِوَايَتِهِ لِأَسْبَابٍ سِوَى الْجَرْحِ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ مَتَى لَمْ يَنْقَدِحْ لِرَدِّ شَهَادَتِهِ وَرِوَايَتِهِ سَبَبٌ آخَرُ، فَهُوَ كَالْجَرْحِ الْمُطْلَقِ.

Editorial notes

N039 [textual] The printed expression التجرح عن الثقات is difficult. It is rendered contextually as transmitting from persons considered trustworthy, without silently emending the Arabic. The reading بِالْقَبُولِ is retained, although the following sentence turns to explicit verbal attestation.

§ 098 The majority position on the Companions' probity

1994 Arabic p. 76 & 77 · BA §120 · 2015 Arabic p. 192 · French p. 193

The position of the great majority of the community and its acknowledged authorities is that the Companions' probity is established with certainty, through God's attestation of it—majestic and mighty is He—and that of His Messenger, in numerous verses of the Book of God, majestic and mighty, and numerous reports from the Messenger, God bless him and grant him peace.

وَالَّذِي عَلَيْهِ جَمَاهِيرُ الْأُمَّةِ وَالْمُعْتَمَدُ عَلَيْهِمْ أَنَّ عَدَالَتَهُمْ مَقْطُوعٌ بِهَا بِتَعْدِيلِ اللَّهِ جَلَّ وَعَزَّ لَهُمْ وَتَعْدِيلِ رَسُولِهِ، فِي غَيْرِ مَا آيَةٍ مِنْ كِتَابِ اللَّهِ جَلَّ وَعَزَّ وَفِي غَيْرِ مَا حَدِيثٍ عَنْهُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ.

§ 099 The civil wars and interpretive error

1994 Arabic p. 77 · BA §121 · 2015 Arabic p. 192 · French p. 193

Groups among the Khārijites, Mu'tazilites, and Qadarites—in general, the people of innovation and deviation—have rejected the Companions' testimony and transmission after dissension arose among them and wars and disputes broke out. The people of the Sunna understand these events on the basis that every practitioner of independent judgement is either free of sin or correct, according to the two respective positions. Some of the people of the Sunna maintain that 'Uthmān's killers were certainly mistaken, but did

وَقَدْ ذَهَبَتْ طَوَائِفُ مِنَ الْخَوَارِجِ وَالْمُعْتَزِلَةِ وَالْقَدَرِيَّةِ، وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ أَهْلِ الْبِدَعِ وَالزَّيْغِ، إِلَى رَدِّ شَهَادَتِهِمْ وَرِوَايَتِهِمْ بَعْدَ مَا شَجَرَ بَيْنَهُمُ الشَّتَاتُ وَظَهَرَتِ الْحُرُوبُ بَيْنَهُمْ وَالْخُصُومَاتُ، وَذَلِكَ عِنْدَ أَهْلِ السُّنَّةِ مَحْمُولٌ عَلَى أَنَّ كُلَّ مُجْتَهِدٍ إِمَّا غَيْرُ مَأْثُومٍ وَإِمَّا مُصِيبٌ بِحَسَبِ الرَّأْيَيْنِ. وَذَهَبَ قَوْمٌ مِنْ أَهْلِ السُّنَّةِ أَنَّ قَتَلَةَ عُثْمَانَ مُخْطِئُونَ قَطْعًا، لَكِنْ جَهِلُوا خَطَأَهُمْ،

not recognise their error and were acting on an interpretation. According to the majority, the testimony of a wrongdoer acting on an interpretation is not rejected.

وَكَانُوا مُتَأَوِّلِينَ. وَالْفَاسِقُ الْمُتَأَوِّلُ لَا تُرَدُّ شَهَادَتُهُ عَلَى رَأْيِ الْأَكْثَرِ.

§ 100 Five levels of receiving a report

1994 Arabic p. 77 · BA §122 · 2015 Arabic p. 194 · French p. 195

Our account of the solitary report still requires a discussion of the manner in which a transmitter reports from the person who is his source. This can occur at five levels.

وَقَدْ بَقِيَ عَلَيْنَا مِنَ الْقَوْلِ فِي الْخَبَرِ الْوَاحِدِ الْقَوْلُ فِي كَيْفِيَّةِ نَقْلِ الرَّاوِي عَنْ مَرْوِيِّهِ، وَذَلِكَ يُتَصَوَّرُ وُقُوعُهُ عَلَى خَمْسِ مَرَاتِبَ:

§ 101 Hearing the teacher read

1994 Arabic p. 77 · BA §123 · 2015 Arabic p. 194 · French p. 195

The teacher reads to him so that he may transmit from the teacher. He may then truthfully say, in the literal sense, ‘He related to us,’ ‘He informed us,’ and ‘I heard him.’ This is the highest level.

قِرَاءَةُ الشَّيْخِ عَلَيْهِ لِيُحَدِّثَ عَنْهُ، وَبِذَلِكَ يَصِحُّ قَوْلُهُ عَلَى الْحَقِيقَةِ حَدَّثَنَا وَأَخْبَرَنَا وَسَمِعْتُهُ، وَهِيَ أَعْلَى الْمَرَاتِبِ.

§ 102 Reading before a silent teacher

1994 Arabic p. 77 · BA §124 · 2015 Arabic p. 194 · French p. 195

The report is read to the teacher while he remains silent. Some Literalists dispute this, but the majority consider his silence and approval equivalent to his speaking, provided there is no reason to suppose that his silence results from inattention, coercion, or the like. They disagree, however, about whether the transmitter may say without qualification, ‘He related to us,’ or ‘I heard so-and-so.’ The correct position is that he may not, since this is plainly false—unless a contextual indication (قرينة حال) or an explicit statement makes it known that he means a reading before the teacher.

أَنْ يُقْرَأَ عَلَى الشَّيْخِ وَهُوَ سَاكِتٌ. فَهَذَا خَالَفَ فِيهِ بَعْضُ أَهْلِ الظَّاهِرِ، لَكِنْ عِنْدَ الْأَكْثَرِ سُكُوتُهُ وَإِقْرَارُهُ إِيَّاهُ يَتَنَزَّلُ مَنْزِلَةَ قَوْلِهِ. هَذَا إِذَا كَانَ بِحَيْثُ لَا يُخَالُ سُكُوتُهُ لِغَفْلَةٍ أَوْ إِكْرَاهٍ أَوْ مَا أَشْبَهَ ذَلِكَ. إِلَّا أَنَّهُمُ اخْتَلَفُوا هَلْ يَقُولُ حَدَّثَنَا مُطْلَقًا، أَوْ سَمِعْتُ فُلَانًا. وَالصَّحِيحُ أَنَّهُ لَا يَجُوزُ، لِأَنَّ ذَلِكَ كَذِبٌ مَحْضٌ، إِلَّا أَنْ يُعْلَمَ بِقَرِينَةِ حَالٍ مِنْهُ أَوْ تَصْرِيحٍ أَنَّهُ يُرِيدُ بِذَلِكَ الْقِرَاءَةَ عَلَى الشَّيْخِ.

§ 103 Authorization without a reading

1994 Arabic p. 77 · BA §125 · 2015 Arabic p. 194 · French p. 195

This is for the teacher to say, ‘I authorize you to transmit from me such-and-such a book,’ or ‘Whatever you have reliably identified among the reports I have heard.’ In such a case, ‘He related

to us’ or ‘He informed us’ may be used without qualification only in an extended sense.

وَهُوَ أَنْ يَقُولَ أُجِيزُ لَكَ أَنْ تَرْوِيَ عَنِّي الْكِتَابَ الْفُلَانِيَّ، أَوْ مَا صَحَّ عِنْدَكَ مِنْ تَعْيِينِ مَسْمُوعَاتِي. وَلَا يَجُوزُ فِي مِثْلِ هَذَا إِطْلَاقُ الْقَوْلِ بِحَدَّثَنَا أَوْ أَخْبَرَنَا إِلَّا تَجَوُّزًا.

§ 104 Handing over a book with permission to transmit it

1994 Arabic p. 77 & 78 · BA §126 · 2015 Arabic p. 194 · French p. 195

Its form is for the teacher to say, ‘Take this book and transmit it from me.’ Merely handing it over without speaking has no significance; the physical handing over is therefore an additional formality, and the transaction is in reality an authorization. Although it does not yield knowledge of the precise route of transmission, it does yield knowledge of the report’s authenticity.

وَصُورَتُهَا أَنْ يَقُولَ الشَّيْخُ خُذْ هَذَا الْكِتَابَ وَحَدِّثْ بِهِ عَنِّي. وَمُجَرَّدُ الْمُنَاوَلَةِ دُونَ اللَّفْظِ لَا مَعْنَى لَهُ، فَهِيَ زِيَادَةُ تَكَلُّفٍ، وَهِيَ فِي الْحَقِيقَةِ إِجَازَةٌ. وَهِيَ وَإِنْ لَمْ تُفِدْ مَعْرِفَةَ عَيْنِ الطَّرِيقِ الْمُوصِلِ، فَهِيَ تُفِيدُ مَعْرِفَةَ صِحَّةِ الْخَبَرِ.

§ 105 Handwriting, accurate copies, and acting without direct hearing

1994 Arabic p. 78 · BA §127 · 2015 Arabic p. 196 · French p. 197

He finds a statement in the teacher’s handwriting: ‘I transmitted such-and-such from so-and-so.’ He may not transmit it from the teacher, because handwriting can be confused with other handwriting. If the teacher says, ‘This is my handwriting,’ his statement is accepted, but one may not transmit from him unless he gives permission verbally or by a contextual indication.

بِأَنْ يَجِدَ بِخَطِّهِ مَكْتُوبًا إِنِّي رَوَيْتُ عَنْ فُلَانٍ كَذَا وَكَذَا. فَهَذَا لَا يَجُوزُ أَنْ يُرْوَى عَنْهُ لِأَنَّ الْخَطَّ يَشْتَبِهُ. وَأَمَّا إِذَا قَالَ الشَّيْخُ: هَذَا خَطِّي، قُبِلَ قَوْلُهُ، وَلَكِنْ لَا يَرْوِي عَنْهُ مَا لَمْ يَأْذَنْ لَهُ بِالْقَوْلِ أَوْ بِقَرِينَةِ حَالٍ.

If a person of probity says, ‘This is an accurate copy of al-Bukhārī’s book,’ and one sees in it ‘He related to us,’ one still may not transmit from its author. But must one act upon it? If one follows another’s judgement, one must ask a practitioner of independent judgement; this is undisputed. If one exercises independent judgement oneself, some say that one may not act upon it without having heard it. Others say that one may act upon it once the copy’s accuracy is known, since the Messenger’s Companions, God bless him and grant him peace, carried written sheets to the provinces, and people relied upon them on the testimony of their bearers.

وَأَمَّا إِذَا قَالَ عَدْلٌ: هَذِهِ نُسْخَةٌ صَحِيحَةٌ مِنْ كِتَابِ الْبُخَارِيِّ فَرَأَى فِيهَا حَدَّثَنَا، فَلَيْسَ لَهُ أَنْ يَرْوِيَ عَنْهُ. وَلَكِنْ هَلْ يَلْزَمُهُ الْعَمَلُ بِهِ؟ أَمَّا إِذَا كَانَ مُقَلِّدًا فَعَلَيْهِ أَنْ يَسْأَلَ الْمُجْتَهِدَ وَلَا خِلَافَ، وَإِنْ كَانَ مُجْتَهِدًا فَقَالَ قَوْمٌ لَا يَجُوزُ الْعَمَلُ لَهُ بِهِ مَا لَمْ يَسْمَعْهُ. وَقَالَ قَوْمٌ إِذَا عُلِمَ صِحَّةُ النُّسْخَةِ جَازَ الْعَمَلُ بِهِ، لِأَنَّ أَصْحَابَ الرَّسُولِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ كَانُوا يَحْمِلُونَ الصُّحُفَ إِلَى الْبِلَادِ، وَكَانَ النَّاسُ يَعْتَمِدُونَ عَلَيْهَا بِشَهَادَةِ حَامِلِ الصُّحُفِ.

In general, however, one should transmit only what one has heard and ascertained: the person

who transmitted to them entertained no doubt about anything they received from him. If he doubted anything, its transmission was abandoned.

وَلَكِنْ عَلَى الْجُمْلَةِ فَلَا يَنْبَغِي أَنْ يَرْوِيَ إِلَّا مَا سَمِعَ بَعْدَ الْمَعْرِفَةِ، فَإِنَّ الَّذِي رَوَاهُمْ لَمْ يَشُكَّ فِي شَيْءٍ مِمَّا أَخَذُوهُ عَنْهُ، فَإِنْ شَكَّ فِي شَيْءٍ تُرِكَتْ رِوَايَتُهُ.

Editorial notes

N040 [translation] Two reported positions must be distinguished: one denies reliance on what the recipient has not heard; another permits acting upon a written copy once its authenticity is established (إِذَا عَلِمَ صِحَّةَ النُّسْخَةِ جَازَ الْعَمَلُ بِهِ). This is not an unqualified permission asserted by Ibn Rushd.

§ 106 The narrator’s certainty is not the recipient’s probability

1994 Arabic p. 78 · BA §128–129 · 2015 Arabic p. 196 · French p. 197

Several questions branch from this. Suppose that among the reports recorded as having been heard by a transmitter there is one that he strongly believes he heard: may he transmit it? If he is in doubt, there is no disagreement that he may not. If he strongly believes that he heard it, some say that it may be received from him, since this field rests on predominant probability. This is implausible: predominant probability concerns the teacher’s truthfulness. Likewise, in testimony, predominant probability concerns the judge; the witness, however, should testify with certainty wherever certainty is possible. The same applies to a transmitter.

وَقَدْ يَتَفَرَّعُ عَنْ هَذَا مَسَائِلُ مِنْهَا: إِذَا كَانَ فِي مَسْمُوعَاتِهِ حَدِيثٌ يَغْلِبُ عَلَى ظَنِّهِ أَنَّهُ سَمِعَهُ هَلْ يَجُوزُ لَهُ أَنْ يَرْوِيَهُ؟ أَمَّا إِذَا شَكَّ فَلَا خِلَافَ فِي أَنَّهُ لَا يَجُوزُ لَهُ، وَأَمَّا إِذَا غَلَبَ عَلَى ظَنِّهِ أَنَّهُ سَمِعَهُ فَقَدْ قَالَ قَوْمٌ يَجُوزُ أَخْذُهُ عَنْهُ، لِأَنَّ الِاعْتِمَادَ فِي هَذَا الْبَابِ عَلَى غَلَبَةِ الظَّنِّ، وَهُوَ بَعِيدٌ، لِأَنَّ غَلَبَةَ الظَّنِّ إِنَّمَا نَتَصَوَّرُ فِي كَوْنِ الشَّيْخِ صَادِقًا. وَكَذَلِكَ غَلَبَةُ الظَّنِّ فِي الشَّهَادَةِ إِنَّمَا نَتَصَوَّرُ فِي حَقِّ الْحَاكِمِ، وَأَمَّا الشَّاهِدُ فَيَنْبَغِي أَنْ يَشْهَدَ عَلَى الْقَطْعِ فِيمَا الْقَطْعُ فِيهِ مُمْكِنٌ، وَكَذَلِكَ الرَّاوِي.

§ 107 When a teacher denies or forgets a report

1994 Arabic p. 78 & 79 · BA §130 · 2015 Arabic p. 198 · French p. 199

Another question arises when the teacher denies the report categorically, affirming that the transmitter has spoken falsely. The report is then not acted upon, but the transmitter is not thereby discredited, because they are two persons of probity whose statements conflict. If, however, the teacher’s denial expresses uncertainty, the report is acted upon: the transmitter is certain that he heard it, while the teacher does not categorically declare him false, and both possess probity.

وَمِنْهَا إِذَا أَنْكَرَ الشَّيْخُ الْحَدِيثَ إِنْكَارَ جَاحِدٍ قَاطِعٍ بِكَذِبِ الرَّاوِي فَإِنَّهُ لَا يُعْمَلُ بِهِ، وَلَكِنْ لَا يَصِيرُ الرَّاوِي مُجَرَّحًا، لِأَنَّهُمَا عَدْلَانِ تَعَارَضَ قَوْلُهُمَا. وَأَمَّا إِذَا أَنْكَرَ إِنْكَارَ مُتَوَقِّفٍ فَيُعْمَلُ بِالْخَبَرِ، لِأَنَّ الرَّاوِيَ جَازِمٌ فِي أَنَّهُ سَمِعَهُ، وَالشَّيْخُ لَيْسَ هُوَ قَاطِعًا بِتَكْذِيبِهِ وَهُمَا عَدْلَانِ.

Al-Karkhī holds that the teacher’s forgetting the report invalidates it. He argues that the teacher is not obliged to act upon it when a person of probity transmits it back to him from him and he

وَذَهَبَ الْكَرْخِيُّ إِلَى أَنَّ نِسْيَانَ الشَّيْخِ الْحَدِيثَ يُبْطِلُهُ، وَاحْتَجَّ بِأَنَّ الشَّيْخَ لَيْسَ يَجِبُ عَلَيْهِ الْعَمَلُ إِذَا رَوَاهُ لَهُ

does not remember it. The transmitter cannot be in this position, since he is certain; the position of someone other than these two lies between theirs.

الْعَدْلُ عَنْهُ وَهُوَ لَا يَذْكُرُهُ، وَهَذَا لَا يَتَصَوَّرُ فِي الرَّاوِي، لِأَنَّهُ قَاطِعٌ، وَأَمَّا غَيْرُهُمَا فَحَالَتُهُ بَيْنَ حَالَتَيْهِمَا.

It seems that the report's recipient is more likely to believe the transmitter truthful, given how commonly people forget and the fact that the teacher does not categorically declare him false. This is the position of Mālik, al-Shāfiʿī, and the great majority of the theologians. In their view, it resembles the teacher's uncertainty about an addition to a report or its grammatical inflection.

وَيُشْبِهُ أَنْ يَكُونَ أَغْلَبَ عَلَى ظَنِّهِ صِدْقُ الرَّاوِي لِلنِّسْيَانِ الْغَالِبِ عَلَى الْإِنْسَانِ، مَعَ أَنَّ الشَّيْخَ لَيْسَ بِقَاطِعٍ بِكَذِبِهِ. وَإِلَى هَذَا ذَهَبَ مَالِكٌ وَالشَّافِعِيُّ وَجَمَاهِيرُ الْمُتَكَلِّمِينَ، وَهُوَ يُشْبِهُ عِنْدَهُمْ شَكَّ الشَّيْخِ فِي زِيَادَةٍ فِي الْحَدِيثِ أَوْ إِعْرَابٍ فِيهِ.

§ 108 An addition reported by one reliable narrator

1994 Arabic p. 79 · BA §131 · 2015 Arabic p. 198 · French p. 199

Another question concerns a trustworthy transmitter who alone reports an addition to a report transmitted by a group of trustworthy persons with exact memories. Some say that the addition is accepted: if he alone had transmitted an entire report, it would have been accepted, and the addition is no different. You know that this is not so. His being alone in reporting an addition to a report they have also transmitted, despite their exact memories, is an indication (قرينة) weakening the probability of the addition's authenticity. This does not apply when he alone transmits an entire report.

وَمِنْهَا إِذَا انْفَرَدَ ثِقَةٌ بِزِيَادَةٍ فِي الْحَدِيثِ عَنْ جَمَاعَةِ ثِقَاتٍ حُفَّاظٍ فَقِيلَ: تُقْبَلُ الزِّيَادَةُ، لِأَنَّهُ لَوِ انْفَرَدَ دُونَهُمْ بِحَدِيثٍ قُبِلَ. وَكَذَلِكَ الزِّيَادَةُ. وَأَنْتَ تَعْلَمُ أَنَّ الْأَمْرَ لَيْسَ كَذَلِكَ، لِأَنَّ انْفِرَادَهُ دُونَهُمْ بِزِيَادَةٍ، فِي حَدِيثٍ رَوَوْهُ، مَعَ أَنَّهُمْ حُفَّاظٌ قَرِينَةٌ تُضْعِفُ الظَّنَّ الْوَاقِعَ بِالزِّيَادَةِ، وَلَيْسَ كَذَلِكَ إِذَا انْفَرَدَ بِحَدِيثٍ دُونَهُمْ،

Accordingly, some reject the addition; others accept it, though not for the reason just given. Their reason is that the others do not categorically deny the addition. They may have entered the gathering after part of the report had already been related, or they may have been present but failed to hear it because of some distraction or accident. In general, this is a matter for independent judgement, and its probability varies from case to case and report to report.

فَلِذَلِكَ رَأَى بَعْضُهُمْ أَلَّا تُقْبَلَ الزِّيَادَةُ، وَرَأَى بَعْضُهُمْ أَنْ تُقْبَلَ، لَكِنْ لَيْسَ لِهَذِهِ الْعِلَّةِ الَّتِي تَقَدَّمَتْ بَلْ لِأَنَّ أُولَئِكَ لَيْسُوا بِقَاطِعِينَ عَلَى نَفْيِ الزِّيَادَةِ، وَيُمْكِنُ أَنْ يَكُونُوا دَخَلُوا فِي الْمَجْلِسِ وَقَدْ مَضَى مِنَ الْحَدِيثِ شَيْءٌ، وَيُمْكِنُ أَنْ يَكُونُوا حَاضِرِينَ وَيَفُوتَ أَسْمَاعَهُمْ لِشَاغِلٍ أَوْ عَارِضٍ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَهِيَ مَسْأَلَةٌ اجْتِهَادِيَّةٌ، وَيَتَفَاوَتُ الظَّنُّ فِيهَا بِحَسَبِ نَازِلَةٍ نَازِلَةٍ وَحَدِيثٍ حَدِيثٍ.

§ 109 Reporting meaning: synonymy and translation

1994 Arabic p. 79 & 80 · BA §132 · 2015 Arabic p. 200 · French p. 201

وَمِنْهَا نَقْلُ الْحَدِيثِ بِالْمَعْنَى دُونَ اللَّفْظِ، فَقَوْمٌ أَجَازُوهُ لِلْعَالِمِ الْعَارِفِ بِمَوَاقِعِ الْخِطَابِ، وَقَالَ قَوْمٌ لَا يَجُوزُ لَهُ إِلَّا بِإِبْدَالِ الْقَوْلِ بِمَا يُرَادِفُهُ وَيُسَاوِيهِ فِي الْمَعْنَى، كَمَا نُبْدِلُ الْقُعُودَ مَثَلًا بِالْجُلُوسِ مِمَّا لَا يُشَكُّ فِي تَرَادُفِهِمَا لَا فِيمَا يُحْتَاجُ فِي ذَلِكَ إِلَى اسْتِدْلَالٍ.

Another question is the transmission of a report's meaning without its wording. Some permit this for a learned person who understands the applications of speech. Others allow only the substitution (الإبدال) of an expression synonymous with and equal in meaning to the original: for example, replacing qu'ūd with julūs, both meaning 'sitting,' where their synonymy is beyond doubt, and not where establishing it requires inference.

وَقَدِ احْتَجَّ الْفَرِيقُ الْأَوَّلُ بِالْإِجْمَاعِ عَلَى جَوَازِ شَرْحِ الْمَعَانِي الَّتِي فِي الشَّرْعِ لِلْعَجَمِ بِلِسَانِهِمْ، قَالُوا فَإِذَا جَازَ إِبْدَالُ الْعَرَبِيَّةِ بِعَجَمِيَّةٍ تُرَادِفُهَا أَنْ يَجُوزَ بِالْعَرَبِيَّةِ أَوْلَى وَأَحْرَى، وَلَمْ يُفَصِّلُوا بَيْنَ مَا كَانَ إِبْدَالُ اللَّفْظِ بِغَيْرِهِ بَيِّنًا بِنَفْسِهِ وَبَيْنَ مَا يُحْتَاجُ فِي ذَلِكَ إِلَى اسْتِدْلَالٍ. قَالُوا وَكَذَلِكَ كَانَ سُفَرَاءُ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ يُبَلِّغُونَ أَوَامِرَهُ إِلَى غَيْرِ الْعَرَبِ.

The first group appeals to the consensus permitting the meanings contained in the Law to be explained to non-Arabs in their own languages. They say that if Arabic may be replaced by synonymous non-Arabic wording, replacing it with Arabic wording is all the more permissible. They do not distinguish between a substitution whose validity is self-evident and one requiring inference. They add that the Messenger of God's emissaries, God bless him and grant him peace, likewise conveyed his commands to non-Arabs.

§ 110 Why an independent jurist needs the Lawgiver's wording

1994 Arabic p. 80 · BA §133–134 · 2015 Arabic p. 200 · French p. 201

وَأَنَا أَرَى أَنَّ فَهْمَ مَا تَدُلُّ عَلَيْهِ الْأَلْفَاظُ إِذَا كَانَ فِي مَحَلِّ الِاجْتِهَادِ فَلَا يَجُوزُ لِلْمُجْتَهِدِ الْعَمَلُ بِهِ حَتَّى يُنْقَلَ إِلَيْهِ لَفْظُ الشَّارِعِ، وَإِلَّا عَادَ الْمُجْتَهِدُ مِنْ حَيْثُ هُوَ مُجْتَهِدٌ مُقَلِّدًا، اللَّهُمَّ إِلَّا أَنْ يَقُولَ ذَلِكَ الْمَعْنَى صَحَابِيٌّ فَهَذَا يَرْجِعُ الْقَوْلُ فِيهِ إِلَى مَا تَقَدَّمَ مِنَ الْخِلَافِ الْمَذْكُورِ فِي ذَلِكَ. وَأَمَّا الْمُجْتَهِدُ الْمُقَلَّدُ فَيَجُوزُ لَهُ عِنْدِي إِبْدَالُ اللَّفْظِ بِلَفْظٍ غَيْرِهِ عِنْدَ مَنْ يُقَلِّدُهُ لِأَنَّ ذَلِكَ اجْتِهَادٌ مَا، وَعَلَى هَذَا حَالُ شَرْحِ الْعَرَبِيَّةِ وَتَبْدِيلِهَا بِالْعَجَمِيَّةِ.

I hold that when understanding what expressions signify is a matter for independent judgement, a practitioner of independent judgement may not act upon a reported meaning until the Lawgiver's wording has been transmitted to him. Otherwise, in the very capacity in which he exercises independent judgement, he becomes a follower of someone else's judgement. An exception might be made where that meaning is stated by a Companion; discussion of this returns to the disagreement mentioned earlier. A practitioner of independent judgement whose judgement others follow may, in my view, substitute one expression for another for those who follow him, since this itself is a kind of independent judgement. The explanation of Arabic and its replacement by another language stand on this same footing.

As for permitting the transmission of only part of a report, [I consider this permissible if that part conveys a meaning, is self-sufficient, and does not require what precedes it in order to be understood, or if the truth of what has been omitted does not cause its meaning to waver between two or more senses. This applies equally whether [we permit] the procedure on the view of those who allow transmission of a report's meaning without its wording, or of those who do not].

وَأَمَّا تَجْوِيزُ نَقْلِ بَعْضِ الْخَبَرِ فَهُوَ [عِنْدِي جَائِزٌ، إِذَا كَانَ مُفِيدًا وَمُكْتَفِيًا بِنَفْسِهِ وَغَيْرَ مُحْتَاجٍ فِي فَهْمِهِ إِلَى مَا قَبْلَهُ، أَوْ كَانَ لَيْسَ يُوجِبُ صِدْقُ مَا حُذِفَ مِنْهُ، تَرَدُّدَ الْمَفْهُومِ عَنْهُ بَيْنَ مَعْنَيَيْنِ أَوْ أَكْثَرَ مِنْ ذَلِكَ، وَسَوَاءٌ [جَوَّزْنَا] الْأَمْرَ فِي هَذَا عِنْدَ مَنْ أَجَازَ نَقْلَ الْحَدِيثِ بِالْمَعْنَى دُونَ اللَّفْظِ أَوْ لَمْ يُجِزْهُ].

Editorial notes

N041 [textual] The bracketed conclusion on p. 80 is a supplement printed in the edition from al-Zarkashī's al-Baḥr al-muḥīṭ, 4:364, as its editor's note states; brackets are retained and the supplement is not presented as unproblematic continuous manuscript text. That note explicitly prefers صدق to al-'Alawī's reading حذف. The difficult syntax is retained closely in translation.

N042 [translation] المجتهد المقلد is read al-mujtahid al-muqallad, 'the practitioner of independent judgement whom others follow,' as confirmed by عند من يقلده later in the sentence; reading al-muqallid would reverse the point.

§ 111 Omitted links, connected chains, and "from" formulae

1994 Arabic p. 80 & 81 · BA §135 · 2015 Arabic p. 202 · French p. 203

Another question concerns transmission with an omitted link and transmission with a connected chain. Opinions differ: Mālik, Abū Ḥanīfa, and the majority accept and act upon a report with an omitted link, whereas al-Shāfiʿī and the Qāḍī reject it. Its form is for someone who was not his contemporary to say, 'The Messenger of God said'—God bless him and grant him peace—or for someone who was not Abū Hurayra's contemporary to say, 'Abū Hurayra said.'

وَمِنْهَا النَّقْلُ الْمُرْسَلُ وَالْمُسْنَدُ. وَهَذَا قَدِ اخْتَلَفُوا فِيهِ، فَذَهَبَ مَالِكٌ وَأَبُو حَنِيفَةَ وَالْجَمَاهِيرُ إِلَى أَنَّ الْمُرْسَلَ مَقْبُولٌ وَمَعْمُولٌ بِهِ، وَذَهَبَ الشَّافِعِيُّ وَالْقَاضِي إِلَى أَنَّهُ غَيْرُ مَقْبُولٍ. وَصُورَتُهُ أَنْ يَقُولَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ مَنْ لَمْ يُعَاصِرْهُ، أَوْ قَالَ أَبُو هُرَيْرَةَ مَنْ لَمْ يُعَاصِرْهُ.

The first group argues that transmission by a person of probity attests his source's probity, especially when he states this explicitly, as in 'from a trustworthy person,' in their usage. The reply is that his transmission does not attest probity unless his circumstances indicate that he transmits only from persons of probity, or he expressly attests his source's probity; and even then it does not establish probity unless he states what probity means to him. In my view, this last requirement does not follow from the positions of al-Shāfiʿī and the Qāḍī, as explained earlier. Perhaps, however, they concede unspecified attestation only where the person is identified: an

أَمَّا الْفَرِيقُ الْأَوَّلُ فَاحْتَجُّوا بِأَنَّ رِوَايَةَ الْعَدْلِ تَعْدِيلٌ، لَا سِيَّمَا فِيمَا يُصَرِّحُ بِهِ، كَقَوْلِهِ عَنِ الثِّقَةِ عِنْدَهُمْ، فَرُوجِعُوا بِأَنَّ رِوَايَةَ الْعَدْلِ لَيْسَتْ بِتَعْدِيلٍ إِلَّا أَنْ يُعْلَمَ مِنْ قَرِينَةِ حَالِهِ أَنَّهُ لَا يَجْرَحُ إِلَّا عَنْ عَدْلٍ أَوْ يُصَرِّحَ بِعَدَالَتِهِ، ثُمَّ إِذَا عُلِمَ مِنْ قَرِينَةِ حَالِهِ أَنَّهُ لَا يَجْرَحُ إِلَّا عَنْ عَدْلٍ أَوْ صَرَّحَ بِعَدَالَتِهِ فَلَيْسَ بِتَعْدِيلٍ مَا لَمْ يَذْكُرْ مَا الْعَدَالَةُ عِنْدَهُ. وَهَذَا عِنْدِي غَيْرُ لَازِمٍ عَلَى مَذْهَبِ الشَّافِعِيِّ وَالْقَاضِي عَلَى مَا تَقَدَّمَ لَكِنْ عَسَاهُمْ لَا يُسَلِّمُونَ التَّعْدِيلَ الْمُطْلَقَ إِلَّا فِيمَنْ عُرِفَتْ عَيْنُهُ، إِذْ مَنْ لَمْ تُعْرَفْ عَيْنُهُ مُمْكِنٌ أَنْ لَوْ سُمِّيَ عَرَفْنَاهُ بِفِسْقٍ.

unidentified person might, if named, be someone we know to be morally unreliable.

The first group also argues for accepting reports with omitted links from the consensus of the Companions and Successors permitting action upon them. But the alleged consensus itself is disputed, because this position has not been transmitted from all of them, and the silence of those who said nothing does not have the standing of an express statement, especially in matters open to independent judgement, as will be explained later.

وَقَدِ احْتَجَّ الْفَرِيقُ الْأَوَّلُ أَيْضًا فِي قَبُولِ الْمَرَاسِيلِ بِإِجْمَاعِ الصَّحَابَةِ وَالتَّابِعِينَ عَلَى جَوَازِ الْعَمَلِ بِالْمَرَاسِيلِ. لَكِنْ نُوزِعُوا فِي نَفْسِ الْإِجْمَاعِ، إِذْ لَمْ يَتَّصِلْ ذَلِكَ عَنْ جَمِيعِهِمْ، وَسُكُوتُ مَنْ سَكَتَ مِنْهُمْ لَيْسَ يَتَنَزَّلُ مَنْزِلَةَ مَنْ قَالَ، لَا سِيَّمَا فِيمَا كَانَ فِي مَحَلِّ الِاجْتِهَادِ كَمَا سَيَأْتِي مِنْ بَعْدُ.

Some who reject reports with omitted links nevertheless accept such a report from a Companion, because he generally relates only from another Companion, and all of them possess probity. The same is said of the Successors' reports with omitted links, since they generally transmit from a Companion. The preferred position among those who reject such reports, however, is to accept one from neither a Companion nor a Successor until his explicit wording or a contextual indication makes it known that he transmits only from a Companion.

وَأَيْضًا فَإِنَّ مِنَ الْمُنْكِرِينَ لِلْمُرْسَلِ مَنْ قَبِلَ مُرْسَلَ الصَّحَابِيِّ لِأَنَّهُ فِي الْأَكْثَرِ لَا يُحَدِّثُ إِلَّا عَنْ صَحَابِيٍّ، وَكُلُّهُمْ عَدْلٌ، وَكَذَلِكَ مَرَاسِيلُ التَّابِعِينَ إِذْ فِي الْأَكْثَرِ إِنَّمَا يَرْوُونَ عَنْ صَحَابِيٍّ. لَكِنَّ الْمُخْتَارَ عِنْدَ مَنْ لَا يَقْبَلُ الْمَرَاسِيلَ أَنْ لَا يَقْبَلَ مُرْسَلَ الصَّحَابِيِّ أَوِ التَّابِعِيِّ حَتَّى يَعْلَمَ بِصَرِيحِ لَفْظِهِ أَوْ قَرِينَةِ حَالٍ أَنَّهُ لَا يَرْوِي إِلَّا عَنْ صَحَابِيٍّ.

An argument might be brought against those who refuse such reports from chains expressed simply by 'from,' which are treated as connected despite the possibility of an intermediary between the transmitter and his source. They may reply that a chain expressed by 'from' is treated as connected only where accompanying indications show that the transmitter heard directly from his source, or where he explicitly says so. In the absence of either an explicit statement or such indications, the report remains uncertain between an omitted-link report and a connected report.

وَأَمَّا مَا يُمْكِنُ أَنْ يُحْتَجَّ بِهِ عَلَى مَنْ مَنَعَ قَبُولَ الْمَرَاسِيلِ مِنَ الْعَنْعَنَةِ وَإِجْرَائِهَا مَجْرَى الْمُسْنَدِ مَعَ إِمْكَانِ أَنْ يَكُونَ بَيْنَ الرَّاوِي وَالْمَرْوِيِّ غَيْرُهُ، فَلَهُمْ أَنْ يُجِيبُوا عَنْ ذَلِكَ بِأَنَّ الْعَنْعَنَةَ إِنَّمَا أُجْرِيَتْ مَجْرَى الْمُسْنَدِ حَيْثُ تَقْتَرِنُ قَرَائِنُ تَدُلُّ عَلَى أَنَّهُ سَمِعَ مِنْهُ، أَوْ يُصَرِّحُ بِذَلِكَ، وَمَتَى لَمْ يُصَرِّحْ بِذَلِكَ وَلَا دَلَّتْ عَلَى ذَلِكَ قَرَائِنُ فَهُوَ مُتَرَدِّدٌ بَيْنَ الْمُرْسَلِ وَالْمُسْنَدِ.

Editorial notes

N043 [textual] At p. 81 the print twice has لا يجرح إلا عن عدل. The argument concerns transmission from a source, and the English renders that contextual sense; the anomalous printed verb is retained in the Arabic.

N044 [translation] Mursal and musnad are rendered according to Ibn Rushd's own broad definition here: a report with an omitted intermediary versus a report with a connected chain, rather than imposing a narrower later definition of mursal.

§ 112 Solitary reports concerning matters of widespread need

1994 Arabic p. 81 & 82 · BA §136 · 2015 Arabic p. 204 · French p. 205

وَأَمَّا قَبُولُ خَبَرِ الْوَاحِدِ فِيمَا تَعُمُّ بِهِ الْبَلْوَى كَحَدِيثِ مَسِّ الذَّكَرِ وَمَا أَشْبَهَهُ فَقَدْ تَقَدَّمَ الْقَوْلُ فِي وَجْهِ الِاسْتِرَابَةِ بِهِ، لِأَنَّ مَا تَعُمُّ بِهِ الْبَلْوَى يَنْتَشِرُ وَيَسْتَفِيضُ بِحَسَبِ عُرْفِ الْعَادَةِ. وَقَدْ رَدَّ هَذِهِ الْقَرِينَةَ مَنْ أَجَازَ الْعَمَلَ بِأَخْبَارِ الْآحَادِ فِيمَا تَعُمُّ بِهِ الْبَلْوَى بِأَنَّ الِاسْتِفَاضَةَ إِنَّمَا تَلْزَمُ فِيمَا تَعَبَّدَ فِيهِ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ بِإِشَاعَتِهِ فِي الْجَمِيعِ، وَأَمَّا مَا تَعَبَّدَ بِهِ بِاتِّصَالِهِ إِلَى الْآحَادِ وَرَدِّ الْخَلْقِ إِلَى أَخْبَارِهِمْ فَلَا يَلْزَمُ ذَلِكَ فِيهِ.

As for accepting a solitary report about something of widespread occurrence, such as the report concerning touching the penis and similar reports, the grounds for suspecting it have already been explained: what commonly affects people normally becomes widely circulated and known. Those who permit acting on solitary reports in such matters reject this indication. They say that widespread transmission is required only for what the Messenger of God, God bless him and grant him peace, was charged to disseminate among everyone; it is not required for what he was charged to convey to individuals while referring others to their reports.

وَيَحْتَجُّونَ لِتَجْوِيزِ رَدِّهِمْ إِلَى أَخْبَارِ الْآحَادِ فِي بَعْضِ النَّوَازِلِ مَعَ إِمْكَانِ اسْتِفَاضَةِ ذَلِكَ بِتَجْوِيزِ رَدِّهِمْ إِلَى الْقِيَاسِ فِيمَا يُمْكِنُ أَنْ يُنَصَّ عَلَيْهِ كَمَسْأَلَةِ الرِّبَا وَأَشْبَاهِهَا. قَالُوا وَلَيْسَ عُمُومُ الْبَلْوَى عِلَّةَ الْإِشَاعَةِ وَالِاسْتِفَاضَةِ، بَلْ عِلَّةُ ذَلِكَ جِهَةُ التَّكْلِيفِ.

To justify referring people to solitary reports in some cases even though widespread transmission would be possible, they invoke the permissibility of referring them to analogy where an express ruling could have been given, as in the question of usury and similar matters. They say that widespread occurrence is not the cause of dissemination and wide transmission; the cause is the manner in which the duty is imposed.

§ 113 Neither universal acceptance nor universal rejection is justified

1994 Arabic p. 82 & 83 · BA §137 · 2015 Arabic p. 204 · French p. 205

وَأَنَا أَرَى أَنَّ تَبْلِيغَهُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ فَرْضًا مِنْ فُرُوضِ اللَّهِ مِمَّا هُوَ وَاجِبٌ عَلَى الْأَعْيَانِ وَاحِدًا، وَسُكُوتَهُ عَنْ تَبْلِيغِهِ لِمَنْ يُرَاوِحُهُ وَيُغَادِيهِ مِنْ أَصْحَابِهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِمْ وَسَلَّمَ اتِّكَالًا مِنْهُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ عَلَى أَنَّهُ إِنْ وَصَلَهُمْ ذَلِكَ الْخَبَرُ عَمِلُوا بِهِ، وَإِنْ لَمْ يَصِلْهُمْ فَهُوَ سَاقِطٌ فِي حَقِّهِمْ غَيْرُ مَعْلُومٍ مِنْ قَرَائِنِ أَحْوَالِهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ مَعَ حِرْصِهِ عَلَى التَّعْلِيمِ وَالتَّبْيِينِ.

I hold that his conveying, God bless him and grant him peace, one of God’s individually binding obligations to a single person, while refraining from conveying it to the Companions who attended him morning and evening—may God bless them and grant them peace—would involve his relying, God bless him and grant him peace, on their acting upon the report if it reached them and on the obligation’s lapsing for them if it did not. Nothing in his circumstances, God bless him and grant him peace, indicates this, given his eagerness to teach and explain.

Whether or not such a thing is rationally possible, examining his conduct, God bless him and grant him peace, in explaining and clarifying the Law

brings one close to certainty that it could not have occurred in the revealed dispensation.

وَسَوَاءٌ جَازَ وُقُوعُ مِثْلِ هَذَا عَقْلًا أَوْ لَمْ يَجُزْ هُوَ مِمَّا يَكَادُ يُقْطَعُ بِامْتِنَاعِ وُقُوعِهِ شَرْعًا عِنْدَ تَصَفُّحِ أَحْوَالِهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ فِي الْبَيَانِ وَالتَّبْيِينِ.

The truth is that some reports can reach us only through solitary routes, even if their subject was formerly widespread and the reports widely circulated. Others can reach us by either route, and still others cannot reach us except through mass transmission. This varies from case to case and issue to issue, according to time, place, and other obstacles.

وَإِنَّمَا الْحَقُّ أَنَّ بَعْضَ الْأَخْبَارِ لَيْسَ يُمْكِنُ فِيهَا أَنْ تَصِلَ إِلَيْنَا إِلَّا بِطُرُقِ الْآحَادِ، وَإِنْ عَمَّتْ بِهَا الْبَلْوَى فِيمَا سَلَفَ وَاسْتَفَاضَتْ، وَبَعْضَهَا يُمْكِنُ أَنْ تَصِلَ بِهَذَا وَهَذَا، وَبَعْضَهَا مُمْتَنِعٌ أَنْ تَصِلَ بِغَيْرِ التَّوَاتُرِ، وَذَلِكَ يَخْتَلِفُ فِي نَازِلَةٍ نَازِلَةٍ وَقَضِيَّةٍ قَضِيَّةٍ، وَذَلِكَ بِحَسَبِ الزَّمَانِ وَالْمَكَانِ وَغَيْرِ ذَلِكَ مِنَ الْعَوَائِقِ.

Accordingly, in some reports a practitioner of independent judgement may find grounds for rejection because of widespread occurrence, while in others he may find no such grounds, especially in collective obligations. In each instance one should judge according to what the matter under discussion admits. Rejecting solitary routes in every case of widespread occurrence is incorrect, since the matter varies with the accompanying indications; acting upon them without qualification is likewise incorrect.

وَلِذَلِكَ رُبَّمَا انْقَدَحَ لِلْمُجْتَهِدِ فِي بَعْضِ الْأَخْبَارِ الْقَوْلُ بِرَدِّهِ لِعُمُومِ الْبَلْوَى، وَرُبَّمَا لَمْ يَنْقَدِحْ لَهُ رَدُّهُ، وَلَا سِيَّمَا فِي فُرُوضِ الْكِفَايَاتِ. وَيَنْبَغِي أَنْ يُقَالَ فِي كُلِّ مَوْضِعٍ بِحَسَبِ مَا يَحْتَمِلُ الْأَمْرُ الْمَقُولُ فِيهِ، فَإِنَّ رَدَّ الْإِنْسَانِ طُرُقَ الْآحَادِ فِيمَا تَعُمُّ بِهِ الْبَلْوَى فِي كُلِّ مَوْضِعٍ غَيْرُ صَوَابٍ، إِذْ يَتَفَاوَتُ ذَلِكَ بِحَسَبِ الْقَرَائِنِ وَكَذَلِكَ الْعَمَلُ بِهَا عَلَى الْإِطْلَاقِ.

This division does not have the nature of logical opposition, so that its two sides could be made contradictories and each party discuss them as though truth were confined to one side. You know how often they proceed in this way in many of these questions.

وَلَيْسَ لِهَذَا التَّقْسِيمِ طَبِيعَةُ التَّقَابُلِ حَتَّى يُجْعَلَ طَرَفَيْ نَقِيضٍ وَيَتَكَلَّمَ عَلَيْهَا كُلُّ وَاحِدٍ مِنَ الْفَرِيقَيْنِ عَلَى أَنَّ الصِّدْقَ مُنْحَصِرٌ فِي أَحَدِهِمَا. وَأَنْتَ تَعْلَمُ أَنَّ كَثِيرًا مَا يَفْعَلُونَ هَذَا فِي كَثِيرٍ مِنْ هَذِهِ الْمَسَائِلِ.

Editorial notes

N045 [textual] The unusual blessing on the Companions, صلى الله عليهم وسلم, is the wording printed at p. 82 and is translated as such.

§ 114 Both Qurʾān and Sunna are subject to abrogation

1994 Arabic p. 83 · BA §138 · 2015 Arabic p. 206 · French p. 207

Here the examination of the second source, the Sunna, comes to an end. You should know that both these sources are subject to abrogation; let us now discuss it.

وَهُنَا انْتَهَى النَّظَرُ فِي الْأَصْلِ الثَّانِي وَهُوَ السُّنَّةُ، وَيَنْبَغِي أَنْ تَعْلَمَ أَنَّ هَذَيْنِ الْأَصْلَيْنِ يَلْحَقُهُمَا النَّسْخُ، وَلْنَقُلْ فِي ذَلِكَ.

§ 115 Does abrogation remove a ruling or reveal its time limit?

1994 Arabic p. 84 · BA §139 · 2015 Arabic p. 206 · French p. 207

وَقَد اخْتُلِفَ فِي حَدِّ النَّسْخِ فَحَدَّهُ الْمُتَكَلِّمُونَ بِأَنَّهُ الْخِطَابُ الدَّالُّ عَلَى رَفْعِ الْحُكْمِ الثَّابِتِ بِالْخِطَابِ الْمُتَقَدِّمِ عَلَى وَجْهٍ لَوْلَاهُ لَكَانَ الْحُكْمُ ثَابِتًا مَعَ تَرَاخِي الْخِطَابِ الدَّالِّ عَلَى ارْتِفَاعِهِ. وَإِنَّمَا اشْتَرَطُوا فِيهِ هَذِهِ الْفُصُولَ لِأَنَّهُمْ يُجَوِّزُونَ عَلَى اللَّهِ تَعَالَى رَفْعَ الْحُكْمِ فِي وَقْتٍ مَا بَعْدَ الْأَمْرِ بِهِ عَلَى التَّأْبِيدِ مَثَلًا، وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَيَجُوزُ عِنْدَهُمُ النَّسْخُ قَبْلَ التَّمَكُّنِ مِنَ الْفِعْلِ. وَحَدَّهُ آخَرُونَ بِأَنَّهُ الْخِطَابُ الْكَاشِفُ عَنْ مُدَّةِ انْقِضَاءِ الْعِبَادَةِ، اعْتِقَادًا مِنْهُمْ أَنَّ النَّسْخَ إِنَّمَا يَرِدُ مُبَيِّنًا فِيمَا لَمْ يُقْصَدْ بِهِ مِنْ أَوَّلِ الْأَمْرِ عُمُومُ جَمِيعِ الزَّمَانِ وَلَا اسْتِغْرَاقُهُ.

There is disagreement over the definition of abrogation. The theologians define it as discourse indicating the removal of a ruling established by earlier discourse, such that the ruling would remain in force without it, with the discourse indicating its removal occurring later. They include these qualifications because they allow that God Most High may remove a ruling at some time after, for example, commanding it in perpetuity. In general, they allow abrogation before performance has become possible. Others define it as discourse disclosing when the term of an act of worship expires, because they believe that abrogation merely clarifies a prescription that was never intended from the outset to apply generally to, or encompass, all time.

وَحَدَّهُ أَيْضًا آخَرُونَ بِأَنَّهُ الْخِطَابُ الدَّالُّ عَلَى أَنَّ مِثْلَ الْحُكْمِ الثَّابِتِ بِالنَّصِّ زَائِلٌ عَلَى وَجْهٍ لَوْلَاهُ لَكَانَ ثَابِتًا. وَهَذَا الْحَدُّ وَإِنْ كَانَ فِيهِ تَثْبِيجٌ، لِأَنَّهُمْ جَعَلُوا الْمَرْفُوعَ مِثْلَ الْحُكْمِ وَلَمْ يَجْعَلُوهُ الْحُكْمَ نَفْسَهُ، فَإِنَّمَا اضْطَرَّهُمْ إِلَى ذَلِكَ أَنَّهُمْ لَا يُجَوِّزُونَ عَلَى اللَّهِ تَعَالَى النَّهْيَ عَنِ الشَّيْءِ الْوَاحِدِ بِعَيْنِهِ بَعْدَ الْأَمْرِ بِهِ.

Still others define it as discourse indicating that a ruling like the one established by the text ceases to hold, such that it would remain in force without that discourse. This definition is somewhat clumsy, because it makes what is removed a ruling like the original rather than the ruling itself. They were driven to this formulation only because they do not allow that God Most High may prohibit the very same thing after commanding it.

§ 116 What the jurist needs to know about abrogation

1994 Arabic p. 84 · BA §140–141 · 2015 Arabic p. 208 · French p. 209

وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَالنَّظَرُ فِيمَا يَجُوزُ مِنْ هَذَا عَلَى اللَّهِ تَعَالَى وَمَا لَا يَجُوزُ لَا يَخُصُّ الْفَقِيهَ بِمَا هُوَ فَقِيهٌ. وَالَّذِي يَكْفِي الْفَقِيهَ مِنْ هَذَا أَنْ يُسَلِّمَ أَنَّ فِي الشَّرْعِ أَحْكَامًا رُفِعَتْ بَعْدَ الْأَمْرِ بِهَا وَيَعْتَقِدَ ذَلِكَ سَوَاءٌ كَانَ ذَلِكَ كَشْفًا عَنِ انْقِضَاءِ مُدَّةِ الْعِبَادَةِ أَوْ لَمْ يَكُنْ، وَأَنَّ وُقُوعَ مِثْلِ هَذَا شَرْعًا مِمَّا ثَبَتَ تَوَاتُرًا. وَأَمَّا تَجْوِيزُ وُقُوعِهِ عَقْلًا فَلَيْسَ يَخُصُّهُ النَّظَرُ فِيهِ وَلَا

In general, inquiry into which of these things may or may not be attributed to God Most High does not belong to the jurist as jurist. It is sufficient for the jurist to concede and believe that the Law contains rulings removed after they had been commanded, whether or not this removal disclosed the expiry of the term of an act of worship, and that the occurrence of such abrogation in the Law is established by mass transmission. Inquiry into its rational possibility, or the manner of that possibility, does not belong specifically to him. Let us therefore begin with

what is necessary in this discipline. The discussion comprises several questions.

فِي جِهَةِ جَوَازِهِ، فَلْنَبْدَأْ مِنْ ذَلِكَ بِالضَّرُورِيِّ فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ، وَالْقَوْلُ فِي ذَلِكَ يَشْتَمِلُ عَلَى مَسَائِلَ:

§ 117 Removing a part, a condition, or a recommended observance

1994 Arabic p. 84 & 85 · BA §142 · 2015 Arabic p. 208 · French p. 209

If part of an act of worship, one of its conditions, or one of its recommended observances is abrogated, does this abrogate the act of worship itself? Opinions differ. The truth is that removing a part removes the whole, because a whole is a whole through its parts, and an act of worship is commanded insofar as it comprises all its parts. In general, removing a part removes the whole, since it no longer remains a whole; this applies to what cannot be divided into independent parts. Removing a condition seems to have the same effect, since it is through that condition that the act of worship is complete. Removing a recommended observance, however, does not entail removing the act's obligatory character.

إِذَا نُسِخَ بَعْضُ الْعِبَادَةِ أَوْ شَرْطٌ مِنْ شُرُوطِهَا أَوْ سُنَّةٌ مِنْ سُنَنِهَا هَلْ هُوَ نَسْخٌ لِأَصْلِ الْعِبَادَةِ أَمْ لَا؟ وَهَذِهِ الْمَسْأَلَةُ قَدِ اخْتَلَفُوا فِيهَا، وَالْحَقُّ أَنَّ رَفْعَ الْبَعْضِ رَفْعٌ لِلْكُلِّ، لِأَنَّ الْكُلَّ إِنَّمَا هُوَ كُلٌّ بِبَعْضِهِ، وَالْعِبَادَةُ إِنَّمَا هِيَ مَأْمُورٌ بِهَا مِنْ جِهَةِ مَا تَحْتَوِي عَلَى جَمِيعِ أَجْزَائِهَا. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ رَفْعُ الْجُزْءِ رَفْعٌ لِلْكُلِّ، لِأَنَّهُ لَا يَبْقَى كُلًّا وَذَلِكَ فِيمَا لَا يَتَبَعَّضُ. وَيُشْبِهُ أَنْ يَكُونَ كَذَلِكَ رَفْعُ الشَّرْطِ، لِأَنَّهُ الَّذِي بِهِ تَتِمُّ الْعِبَادَةُ. وَأَمَّا رَفْعُ السُّنَّةِ فَلَيْسَ يَلْزَمُ عَنْهَا رَفْعُ وُجُوبِ الْعِبَادَةِ.

§ 118 When an addition changes the identity of an obligation

1994 Arabic p. 85 · BA §143 · 2015 Arabic p. 208 · French p. 209

Question. Some regard an addition to a text as abrogation; others do not. The preferred position is that an addition constitutes abrogation when it makes what receives the addition different from what it was before and numerically a second thing. An example is prayer, if it is correct that two cycles were originally prescribed and further cycles were then added.

مَسْأَلَةٌ: الزِّيَادَةُ عَلَى النَّصِّ نَسْخٌ عِنْدَ قَوْمٍ، وَلَيْسَتْ بِنَسْخٍ عِنْدَ قَوْمٍ. وَالْمُخْتَارُ أَنَّ الزِّيَادَةَ إِذَا صَارَ بِهَا الْمَزِيدُ غَيْرَ مَا كَانَ قَبْلُ وَثَانِيًا بِالْعَدَدِ فَهِيَ نَسْخٌ، مِثْلَ الصَّلَاةِ إِنْ صَحَّ فِيهَا أَنَّهَا فُرِضَتْ أَوَّلًا رَكْعَتَيْنِ ثُمَّ زِيدَ فِيهَا.

If, however, the addition differs in kind from the act of worship to which it is added, it clearly is not abrogation—for example, prescribing prayer and then prescribing almsgiving. Likewise, if the addition and what receives it are one in kind, but the addition does not make the latter a different individual thing, it is not abrogation: for example, adding twenty lashes to a prescribed punishment of eighty. Abū Ḥanīfa, God have mercy on him, nevertheless regards such a case as abrogation.

فَأَمَّا إِذَا كَانَتِ الزِّيَادَةُ مُبَايِنَةً لِلْعِبَادَةِ الْمَزِيدِ عَلَيْهَا بِالنَّوْعِ فَبَيِّنٌ أَنَّهَا لَيْسَتْ بِنَسْخٍ، كَإِيجَابِ الصَّلَاةِ مَثَلًا، ثُمَّ إِيجَابِ الزَّكَاةِ. وَكَذَلِكَ إِنْ كَانَتِ الزِّيَادَةُ مَعَ الْمَزِيدِ عَلَيْهِ وَاحِدَةً بِالنَّوْعِ وَلَمْ يَصِرِ الْمَزِيدُ عَلَيْهِ بِهَا غَيْرًا بِالشَّخْصِ فَلَيْسَتْ أَيْضًا بِنَسْخٍ، كَزِيَادَةِ عِشْرِينَ جَلْدَةً فِي الْحَدِّ مَثَلًا عَلَى ثَمَانِينَ، وَإِنْ كَانَ أَبُو حَنِيفَةَ رَحِمَهُ اللَّهُ يَرَى مِثْلَ هَذَا نَسْخًا.

§ 119 Abrogation without a substitute

1994 Arabic p. 85 · BA §144 · 2015 Arabic p. 210 · French p. 211

مَسْأَلَةٌ: لَيْسَ مِنْ شَرْطِ النَّسْخِ إِثْبَاتُ بَدَلٍ لِلْمَنْسُوخِ يَقُومُ مَقَامَهُ وَيَتَنَزَّلُ مَنْزِلَتَهُ، وَذَلِكَ جَائِزٌ عَلَى مَذْهَبِ أَهْلِ السُّنَّةِ، وَوَاقِعٌ شَرْعًا، كَنَسْخِ ادِّخَارِ لُحُومِ الْأَضَاحِيِّ، وَتَقْدِمَةِ الصَّدَقَةِ أَمَامَ الْمُنَاجَاةِ.

Question. Abrogation does not require establishing a substitute for the abrogated ruling to take its place and occupy its position. Abrogation without such a substitute is permissible according to the people of the Sunna and has occurred in the Law, as in the abrogation concerning storing sacrificial meat and giving charity before private consultation.

وَأَمَّا قَوْلُ اللَّهِ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ: {مَا نَنْسَخْ مِنْ آيَةٍ أَوْ نُنْسِهَا نَأْتِ بِخَيْرٍ مِنْهَا} فَإِنَّهَا وَإِنْ كَانَتْ ظَاهِرَةً فِي إِثْبَاتِ بَدَلٍ لِلْمَنْسُوخِ الْمُتَنَزِّلِ مَنْزِلَتَهُ فَيُمْكِنُ أَنْ يُتَأَوَّلَ قَوْلُهُ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ: {نَأْتِ بِخَيْرٍ مِنْهَا} أَيْ نَأْتِي بِآيَةٍ أُخْرَى، وَإِنْ لَمْ تَتَضَمَّنْ بَدَلَهَا الْآيَةُ الْمَنْسُوخَةُ فِي الْحُكْمِ، بَلْ تَتَضَمَّنُ حُكْمًا آخَرَ لَيْسَ بِبَدَلٍ لِلْحُكْمِ الْمَرْفُوعِ.

As for God’s saying, mighty and majestic, ‘Whatever verse We abrogate or cause to be forgotten, We bring one better than it,’ although its apparent meaning establishes a substitute taking the abrogated verse’s place, ‘We bring one better than it’ may be interpreted to mean ‘We bring another verse,’ even if this does not contain a replacement for the abrogated verse in respect of its ruling, but instead contains another ruling that is not a substitute for the one removed.

Editorial notes

N046 [translation] The quotation is Qur’ān 2:106. The elliptical example نسخ ادخار لحوم الأضاحي is retained as ‘the abrogation concerning storing sacrificial meat’; the Arabic does not expressly repeat ‘the prohibition of’ storing it.

§ 120 Replacing a lighter duty with a heavier one

1994 Arabic p. 85 & 86 · BA §145 · 2015 Arabic p. 210 · French p. 211

مَسْأَلَةٌ: يَجُوزُ النَّسْخُ بِالْأَخَفِّ وَالْأَثْقَلِ، وَذَلِكَ جَائِزٌ عَقْلًا وَوَاقِعٌ شَرْعًا. مِثَالُ نَسْخِ الْأَخَفِّ بِالْأَثْقَلِ نَسْخُ التَّخْيِيرِ بَيْنَ الصَّوْمِ وَالْفِدْيَةِ بِالْإِطْعَامِ بِتَعْيِينِ الصِّيَامِ، وَتَحْرِيمُ الْخَمْرِ وَنِكَاحِ الْمُتْعَةِ، وَنَسْخُ صَوْمِ عَاشُورَاءَ بِإِيجَابِ رَمَضَانَ.

Question. Abrogation may replace a ruling with a lighter or a heavier one. This is rationally possible and has occurred in the Law. Examples of replacing a lighter requirement with a heavier one are replacing the choice between fasting and feeding others as compensation with fasting alone; prohibiting wine and temporary marriage; and replacing the fast of ʿĀshūrāʾ with the obligation to fast Ramaḍān.

§ 121 Abrogating recitation, ruling, or both—and the demand for proof

1994 Arabic p. 86 · BA §146 · 2015 Arabic p. 210 · French p. 211

Question. When a verse contains a ruling, its recitation may be abrogated while its ruling remains, its ruling may be abrogated while its

recitation remains, or both may be abrogated. This is rationally possible and has occurred in the Law. Its rational possibility follows because recitation comprises two aspects: first, reading the verse, writing it in the codex, and reciting it in prayer; second, the rulings it contains. A person may be charged with either aspect without the other, and both may be removed together, according to what the doctrines of the people of the Sunna entail.

مَسْأَلَةٌ: الْآيَةُ إِذَا تَضَمَّنَتْ حُكْمًا يَجُوزُ نَسْخُ تِلَاوَتِهَا دُونَ حُكْمِهَا وَنَسْخُ حُكْمِهَا دُونَ تِلَاوَتِهَا وَنَسْخُهُمَا جَمِيعًا، وَذَلِكَ جَائِزٌ عَقْلًا وَوَاقِعٌ شَرْعًا. أَمَّا جَوَازُهُ عَقْلًا فَإِنَّ التِّلَاوَةَ تَتَضَمَّنُ مَعْنَيَيْنِ: أَحَدُهُمَا قِرَاءَتُهَا وَكَتْبُهَا فِي الْمُصْحَفِ وَالصَّلَاةُ بِهَا. وَالثَّانِي مَا فِيهَا مِنَ الْأَحْكَامِ. وَكُلُّ وَاحِدٍ مِنْ هَذَيْنِ الْمَعْنَيَيْنِ جَائِزٌ أَنْ يُكَلَّفَهُ الْإِنْسَانُ دُونَ الثَّانِي، وَجَائِزٌ أَنْ يُرْفَعَا مَعًا بِحَسَبِ مَا تَقْتَضِيهِ مَذَاهِبُ أَهْلِ السُّنَّةِ.

Evidence from revelation that this has occurred is God's saying, 'For those who are able to bear it, a compensation: food for needy people,' and the rest of the verse. Its ruling was abrogated by making fasting the sole requirement, while its recitation remained. Likewise, 'A bequest for parents and close relatives' is abrogated by his saying, peace be upon him, 'No bequest for an heir.' This requires examination, however, because some do not permit the Qur'ān to be abrogated by the Sunna.

وَأَمَّا الَّذِي يَدُلُّ عَلَى وُقُوعِهِ سَمْعًا فَقَوْلُهُ تَعَالَى: {وَعَلَى الَّذِينَ يُطِيقُونَهُ فِدْيَةُ طَعَامِ مَسَاكِينَ} الْآيَةَ. وَقَدْ نُسِخَ حُكْمُهَا بِتَعْيِينِ الصَّوْمِ وَبَقِيَتْ تِلَاوَتُهَا. وَكَذَلِكَ قَوْلُهُ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ: {الْوَصِيَّةُ لِلْوَالِدَيْنِ وَالْأَقْرَبِينَ} مَنْسُوخٌ بِقَوْلِهِ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ: «لَا وَصِيَّةَ لِوَارِثٍ» لَكِنْ فِي هَذَا نَظَرٌ، لِأَنَّ مِنَ النَّاسِ مَنْ لَا يُجَوِّزُ نَسْخَ الْقُرْآنِ بِالسُّنَّةِ.

As for abrogating recitation while retaining the ruling, reports corroborate one another that the recitation of the stoning verse was abrogated while its ruling remained. Yet this, too, requires examination in my view: it should [not] be accepted that such wording was once part of the Qur'ān until it is established by mass transmission, and this should not be accepted through solitary routes.

وَأَمَّا نَسْخُ التِّلَاوَةِ وَبَقَاءُ الْحُكْمِ فَقَدْ تَظَاهَرَتِ الْأَخْبَارُ بِنَسْخِ تِلَاوَةِ آيَةِ الرَّجْمِ مَعَ بَقَاءِ حُكْمِهَا، لَكِنْ عِنْدِي فِي هَذَا نَظَرٌ، لِأَنَّهُ يَنْبَغِي أَنْ يُقْبَلَ أَنَّ مِثْلَ هَذَا كَانَ مِنَ الْقُرْآنِ حَتَّى يَتَوَاتَرَ وَلَا يُقْبَلُ ذَلِكَ بِطُرُقِ الْآحَادِ.

Editorial notes

N047 [textual] At p. 86 the print reads ينبغي أن يقبل ... حتى يتواتر ولا يقبل ذلك بطرق الآحاد, apparently lacking a negative in its first clause. The Arabic reproduces it; the English adopts the negative sense required by حتى يتواتر and the explicit rejection of solitary transmission, making this interpretive correction explicit here.

N048 [translation] The quotations are Qur'ān 2:184 and 2:180. The plural مساكين in the edition's first quotation is retained as 'needy people.'

N049 [quotation] The vocalisation فِدْيَةُ طَعَامِ مَسَاكِينَ is a transmitted construct reading, not a mistaken attempt to reproduce the familiar Ḥafṣ wording. Compare al-Ṭabarī, commentary on Q 2:184, and Ibn Ḥajar, Fatḥ al-bārī, commentary on al-Bukhārī no. 4506, who identifies the construct and plural reading with Nāfiʿ and Ibn Dhakwān. The printed plural is therefore retained. Sources: https://quran.ksu.edu.sa/tafseer/tabary/sura2-aya184.html ; https://hdith.com/encyclopedia/book/b-1/h/6726/service/6

§ 122 Consensus reveals earlier abrogation but cannot itself abrogate

1994 Arabic p. 86 · BA §147 · 2015 Arabic p. 212 · French p. 213

مَسْأَلَةٌ: الْإِجْمَاعُ لَا يُنْسَخُ بِهِ، إِذْ لَا نَسْخَ بَعْدَ انْقِطَاعِ الْوَحْيِ، وَإِنْ تُوُهِّمَ أَنَّ شَيْئًا مَا مَنْسُوخٌ بِالْإِجْمَاعِ فَذَلِكَ دَلِيلٌ عَلَى نَاسِخٍ سَبَقَ لَمْ يَبْلُغْنَا.

Question. Consensus (الإجماع) does not abrogate, because there is no abrogation after revelation has ceased. If something is supposed to have been abrogated by consensus, that consensus is evidence of an earlier abrogating text that has not reached us.

§ 123 The unequal force of reports during and after the Prophet’s life

1994 Arabic p. 86 & 87 · BA §148 · 2015 Arabic p. 212 · French p. 213

مَسْأَلَةٌ: نَسْخُ السُّنَّةِ الْمُتَوَاتِرَةِ بِالسُّنَّةِ الْمُتَوَاتِرَةِ، وَالْآحَادِ بِالْآحَادِ، وَالْآحَادِ بِالْمُتَوَاتِرِ، مِمَّا لَا خِلَافَ فِيهِ. فَأَمَّا نَسْخُ الْمُتَوَاتِرِ بِالْآحَادِ فَقَدِ اخْتَلَفُوا فِيهِ، وَالْمُخْتَارُ أَنَّهُ جَائِزٌ عَقْلًا وَوَاقِعٌ شَرْعًا فِي زَمَنِ النَّبِيِّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ بِتَحَوُّلِ أَهْلِ مَسْجِدِ قُبَاءَ إِلَى الْكَعْبَةِ بِخَبَرِ الْوَاحِدِ، وَقَدْ كَانَ ثَابِتًا عَنْهُمُ التَّوَجُّهُ إِلَى بَيْتِ الْمَقْدِسِ بِطَرِيقٍ قَطْعِيٍّ، وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَإِنْفَاذُ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ رُسُلَهُ إِلَى الْأَطْرَافِ بِالنَّاسِخِ وَالْمَنْسُوخِ مِمَّا تَوَاتَرَ.

Question. There is no disagreement over abrogating a Sunna established by mass transmission through another such Sunna, solitary reports through solitary reports, or solitary reports through mass transmission. Opinions differ about abrogating what is established by mass transmission through solitary reports. The preferred position is that this is rationally possible and occurred in the Law during the Prophet’s lifetime, God bless him and grant him peace: the people of the mosque at Qubāʾ turned toward the Kaʿba on a solitary report, although their facing Jerusalem had been established by a decisive route. In general, the Messenger of God’s sending emissaries to the outlying regions with abrogating and abrogated rulings, God bless him and grant him peace, is itself established by mass transmission.

فَأَمَّا وُقُوعُ ذَلِكَ بَعْدَهُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ فَمُمْتَنِعٌ بِإِجْمَاعِ الصَّحَابَةِ عَلَى أَنَّ الْقُرْآنَ لَا يُرْفَعُ بِخَبَرِ الْوَاحِدِ، وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ التَّوَاتُرُ. وَيُشْبِهُ أَنْ تَكُونَ الْعِلَّةُ فِي ذَلِكَ قَرَائِنَ تَقْتَرِنُ بِخَبَرِ الْمُخْبِرِينَ عَنْ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ فِي حَيَاتِهِ لَيْسَ تَقْتَرِنُ بِالْمُخْبِرِينَ عَنْهُ بَعْدَ مَوْتِهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ مِنْ إِمْكَانِ مُرَاجَعَتِهِ وَاسْتِفْهَامِهِ وَغَيْرِ ذَلِكَ.

Its occurrence after his death, God bless him and grant him peace, is excluded by the Companions’ consensus that the Qurʾān—and, in general, what is established by mass transmission—is not set aside by a solitary report. The reason seems to be indications accompanying reports from the Messenger of God during his lifetime, God bless him and grant him peace, which do not accompany reports from him after his death, God bless him and grant him peace: the possibility of going back to him, questioning him, and the like.

§ 124 May mass-transmitted Sunna abrogate the Qurʾān?

1994 Arabic p. 87 · BA §149 · 2015 Arabic p. 214 · French p. 215

As for abrogating the mass-transmitted Qurʾān through a mass-transmitted Sunna, it is reported that al-Shāfiʿī and some Ẓāhirīs did not permit this, on the evidence of God's saying, mighty and majestic, 'Whatever verse We abrogate or cause to be forgotten, We bring one better than it or like it.' Although the apparent meaning of this verse supports their view, we have already said that the new verse may contain no replacement for the abrogated verse's ruling, while the Sunna supplies the replacement for that ruling.

وَأَمَّا نَسْخُ الْمُتَوَاتِرِ مِنَ الْقُرْآنِ بِالْمُتَوَاتِرِ مِنَ السُّنَّةِ فَإِنَّهُ قَدْ نُقِلَ عَنِ الشَّافِعِيِّ وَعَنْ قَوْمٍ مِنْ أَهْلِ الظَّاهِرِ أَنَّهُمْ كَانُوا لَا يُجَوِّزُونَ ذَلِكَ بِدَلِيلِ قَوْلِهِ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ: {مَا نَنْسَخْ مِنْ آيَةٍ أَوْ نُنْسِهَا نَأْتِ بِخَيْرٍ مِنْهَا أَوْ مِثْلِهَا}. وَهَذِهِ الْآيَةُ وَإِنْ كَانَتْ ظَاهِرَةً فِيمَا رَأَوْا فَقَدْ قُلْنَا فِيمَا سَلَفَ إِنَّهُ يُمْكِنُ أَنْ لَا تَتَضَمَّنَ الْآيَةُ الْوَارِدَةُ بَدَلَ الْآيَةِ الْمَنْسُوخَةِ فِي الْحُكْمِ، وَتَكُونَ السُّنَّةُ هِيَ الْمُتَضَمِّنَةَ بَدَلَ حُكْمِ الْمَنْسُوخَةِ.

Those who permit this invoke the abrogation of God's saying, 'A bequest for parents and close relatives,' by the Prophet's saying, peace be upon him, 'No bequest for an heir.' They also invoke his saying, peace be upon him, 'God has now appointed a way for them: for the never-married with the never-married, a hundred lashes and a year's banishment; and for the previously married with the previously married, a hundred lashes and stoning.' This abrogates 'Confine them in the houses.' These arguments admit possible alternative interpretations and are not decisive.

وَمَنْ يُجَوِّزُ ذَلِكَ فَقَدِ احْتَجَّ بِنَسْخِ قَوْلِهِ تَعَالَى: {الْوَصِيَّةُ لِلْوَالِدَيْنِ وَالْأَقْرَبِينَ} بِقَوْلِهِ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ: «لَا وَصِيَّةَ لِوَارِثٍ». وَكَذَلِكَ احْتَجُّوا بِقَوْلِهِ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ أَيْضًا: «قَدْ جَعَلَ اللَّهُ لَهُنَّ سَبِيلًا الْبِكْرُ بِالْبِكْرِ جَلْدُ مِائَةٍ وَتَغْرِيبُ عَامٍ. وَالثَّيِّبُ بِالثَّيِّبِ جَلْدُ مِائَةٍ وَالرَّجْمُ» وَهُوَ نَسْخُ {فَأَمْسِكُوهُنَّ فِي الْبُيُوتِ}. وَهَذِهِ الِاحْتِجَاجَاتُ قَدْ يَتَمَكَّنُ أَنْ يَتَطَرَّقَ إِلَيْهَا الِاحْتِمَالُ وَلَيْسَتْ قَاطِعَةً.

Editorial notes

N050 [translation] The Qurʾānic quotations are 2:106, 2:180, and 4:15. The report's wording is translated as printed on p. 87; the editor's longer quotation from Bidāyat al-mujtahid is not substituted for it.

§ 125 Certainty itself can admit degrees

1994 Arabic p. 87 & 88 · BA §149 · 2015 Arabic p. 214 · French p. 215

Besides the argument already mentioned, what seems to have led those holding this position to exclude such abrogation is the greater weight we find them giving to the assent (التصديق) produced by the Book's mass transmission: this is the highest degree of mass transmission. As for other reports, even when mass-transmitted, assent to them may fall short of assent to the Book. Contrary to what many think, it is not impossible for certain assent to admit degrees, especially where it rests on transmission. As for the report that al-Shāfiʿī, God have mercy on him, did not

وَيُشْبِهُ أَنْ يَكُونَ الَّذِي أَصَارَ الْقَائِلِينَ بِهَذَا إِلَى امْتِنَاعِ ذَلِكَ، مَعَ مَا تَقَدَّمَ مِنْ حُجَّتِهِمْ، مَا نَجِدُ فِي أَنْفُسِهِمْ مِنْ تَرْجِيحِ التَّصْدِيقِ الْوَاقِعِ عَنْ تَوَاتُرِ الْكِتَابِ، إِذْ هُوَ أَرْفَعُ مَرَاتِبِ التَّوَاتُرِ، وَأَنَّ مَا عَدَا ذَلِكَ مِنَ الْأَحَادِيثِ فَإِنَّهَا وَإِنْ تَوَاتَرَتْ فَلَا يَمْتَنِعُ أَنْ يَكُونَ التَّصْدِيقُ بِهَا مُقَصِّرًا عَنِ التَّصْدِيقِ بِالْكِتَابِ. وَلَيْسَ بِمُحَالٍ عَلَى مَا يَرَى كَثِيرٌ مِنَ النَّاسِ أَنْ يَتَفَاضَلَ التَّصْدِيقُ الْيَقِينِيُّ لَا سِيَّمَا فِيمَا سَبِيلُهُ النَّقْلُ، فَأَمَّا مَا

permit a mass-transmitted Sunna to be abrogated by the Qur’ān, this has no intelligible basis if taken in its apparent sense—unless it is interpreted otherwise, for the possibilities of interpretation are ample.

نُقِلَ عَنِ الشَّافِعِيِّ رَحِمَهُ اللَّهُ أَنَّهُ كَانَ لَا يُجَوِّزُ نَسْخَ السُّنَّةِ الْمُتَوَاتِرَةِ بِالْقُرْآنِ، فَلَا مَعْنَى لَهُ، إِذَا أُخِذَ عَلَى ظَاهِرِهِ، اللَّهُمَّ إِلَّا أَنْ يُتَأَوَّلَ ذَلِكَ، فَإِنَّ وُجُوهَ التَّأْوِيلِ لَا تَضِيقُ.

Editorial notes

N051 [translation] At p. 88 على ما يرى كثير من الناس can attach to محال within the negation, yielding “contrary to what many think,” as translated, or to the entire negative assertion, yielding “as many hold, it is not impossible.” The attachment is uncertain; either reading preserves Ibn Rushd’s assertion that certain assent can admit degrees.

§ 126 Analogy may clarify a text but may not repeal it

1994 Arabic p. 88 · BA §150–151 · 2015 Arabic p. 216 · French p. 217

Question. A decisive, mass-transmitted text may not be abrogated by probable analogy, just as it may not be abrogated by a solitary report. Those who permit this argue from the permissibility of restricting the scope of a mass-transmitted text through analogy. Even if conceded, this is no proof: specification clarifies, whereas abrogation removes.

مَسْأَلَةٌ: لَا يَجُوزُ نَسْخُ النَّصِّ الْقَاطِعِ الْمُتَوَاتِرِ بِالْقِيَاسِ الْمَظْنُونِ، كَمَا لَا يَجُوزُ بِخَبَرِ الْوَاحِدِ. وَقَدِ احْتَجَّ مَنْ أَجَازَ ذَلِكَ بِجَوَازِ تَخْصِيصِ الْقِيَاسِ لِلنَّصِّ الْمُتَوَاتِرِ. وَهَذَا إِذَا سُلِّمَ فَلَيْسَ بِحُجَّةٍ، إِذِ التَّخْصِيصُ بَيَانٌ وَالنَّسْخُ رَفْعٌ.

The proof here is the Companions’ consensus invalidating every opinion contrary to a text, all the more a mass-transmitted text; and the report of Muʿādh, when he said, ‘I exercise my judgement’ in the absence of a text, and the Messenger of God, God bless him and grant him peace, commended him for it. If two decisive texts contradict one another and the matter is unclear, may a solitary report determine that one is later? This requires examination; the question is open to independent judgement.

وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَالْحُجَّةُ فِي ذَلِكَ إِجْمَاعُ الصَّحَابَةِ عَلَى إِبْطَالِ كُلِّ رَأْيٍ مُخَالِفٍ لِلنَّصِّ، فَكَيْفَ لِلنَّصِّ الْمُتَوَاتِرِ. وَحَدِيثُ مُعَاذٍ إِذْ قَالَ أَجْتَهِدُ رَأْيِي عِنْدَ عَدَمِ النَّصِّ وَتَزْكِيَةُ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ لَهُ عَلَى ذَلِكَ. فَأَمَّا إِذَا تَنَاقَضَ نَصَّانِ قَاطِعَانِ وَأَشْكَلَ فَهَلْ يُقْضَى بِتَأَخُّرِ أَحَدِهِمَا بِخَبَرِ الْآحَادِ؟ فِيهِ نَظَرٌ، وَالْمَسْأَلَةُ فِي مَحَلِّ الِاجْتِهَادِ.

§ 127 A Companion’s assertion of abrogation needs a transmitted basis

1994 Arabic p. 88 · BA §152 · 2015 Arabic p. 216 · French p. 217

Question. A ruling is not abrogated by a Companion’s saying, ‘Such-and-such a ruling was abrogated,’ unless he says, ‘I heard the Messenger of God, God bless him and grant him peace, say this.’ That applies when the ruling was established by a solitary report, because what is not abrogation is often thought to be abrogation, as some have regarded an addition to a text as abrogation. If the ruling was established through

مَسْأَلَةٌ: لَا يُنْسَخُ الْحُكْمُ بِقَوْلِ الصَّحَابِيِّ نُسِخَ حُكْمُ كَذَا مَا لَمْ يَقُلْ سَمِعْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ يَقُولُ ذَلِكَ. هَذَا إِذَا كَانَ الْحُكْمُ ثَابِتًا بِخَبَرِ الْوَاحِدِ، لِأَنَّ كَثِيرًا مَا يُظَنُّ بِمَا لَيْسَ بِنَسْخٍ أَنَّهُ نَسْخٌ، كَمَا ظَنَّ قَوْمٌ أَنَّ الزِّيَادَةَ عَلَى النَّصِّ نَسْخٌ. وَأَمَّا إِذَا كَانَ الْحُكْمُ ثَابِتًا بِطَرِيقِ التَّوَاتُرِ فَلَيْسَ

mass transmission, a Companion's statement does not abrogate it even if he transmits the Messenger of God's own words, God bless him and grant him peace, since solitary transmission does not abrogate mass transmission, as explained earlier.

قَوْلُ الصَّحَابِيِّ بِنَسْخٍ وَإِنْ نَقَلَ أَلْفَاظَ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ، لِأَنَّ الْآحَادَ لَا يُنْسَخُ بِهِ التَّوَاتُرُ كَمَا تَقَدَّمَ.

§ 128 Conditions implicit in the definition of abrogation

1994 Arabic p. 88 & 89 · BA §153 · 2015 Arabic p. 218 · French p. 219

In general, you should know that abrogation has conditions contained implicitly in the definition given earlier. First, what is removed must be a revealed ruling, not a rational judgement such as original freedom from liability (البراءة الأصلية), which is removed by the prescription of acts of worship. Second, abrogation must take place through discourse, rather than the discourse whose ruling is removed being limited by a time whose arrival itself entails this. In general, according to each of the definitions of abrogation we have enumerated, some conditions apply and must be considered, while others fall outside it.

وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَيَنْبَغِي أَنْ تَعْلَمَ أَنَّ لِلنَّسْخِ شَرَائِطَ يَتَضَمَّنُهَا الْحَدُّ الْمُتَقَدِّمُ وَهِيَ مَنْطَوِيَةٌ فِيهِ. أَوَّلُهَا: أَنْ يَكُونَ الْمَرْفُوعُ حُكْمًا شَرْعِيًّا لَا عَقْلِيًّا كَالْبَرَاءَةِ الْأَصْلِيَّةِ الَّتِي تَرْتَفِعُ بِإِيجَابِ الْعِبَادَاتِ. وَالثَّانِي أَنْ يَكُونَ النَّسْخُ بِخِطَابٍ لَا أَنْ يَكُونَ الْخِطَابُ الْمَرْفُوعُ حُكْمُهُ مُقَيَّدًا بِوَقْتٍ يَقْتَضِي دُخُولَهُ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَتَلْحَقُهُ شَرَائِطُ تُعْتَبَرُ فِيهِ بِحَسَبِ حَدٍّ حَدٍّ مِنْ حُدُودِ النَّسْخِ الَّتِي عَدَدْنَاهَا وَتَخْرُجُ عَنْهُ شَرَائِطُ.

§ 129 How the later of two conflicting texts is established

1994 Arabic p. 89 · BA §154 · 2015 Arabic p. 218 · French p. 219

Question. If two decisive texts conflict and it is unknown which abrogates the other, this can be established only by transmission. There are several possible routes. First, the wording of one may indicate the abrogation of the other, as in his saying, peace be upon him, 'I used to forbid you such-and-such; now do it.' Second, their respective dates may be known. This may also be known through the community's consensus that one of them has been abrogated. Other circumstances thought to establish abrogation do not do so, such as a transmitter's later conversion to Islam, his younger age, or the ending of his companionship with the Prophet.

مَسْأَلَةٌ: إِذَا تَعَارَضَ نَصَّانِ قَاطِعَانِ فَلَمْ يُعْلَمْ أَيُّهُمَا نَاسِخٌ لِصَاحِبِهِ، فَالْوُقُوفُ عَلَى ذَلِكَ لَيْسَ يَكُونُ بِشَيْءٍ سِوَى النَّقْلِ. وَذَلِكَ يُمْكِنُ بِطُرُقٍ: أَحَدُهَا أَنْ يَكُونَ فِي لَفْظِ أَحَدِهِمَا مَا يَدُلُّ عَلَى نَسْخِ الْآخَرِ، كَقَوْلِهِ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ «كُنْتُ نَهَيْتُكُمْ عَنْ كَذَا فَافْعَلُوهُ». الثَّانِي أَنْ يُعْلَمَ التَّارِيخُ فِيهِمَا. وَقَدْ تَقَعُ مَعْرِفَةُ ذَلِكَ بِأَنْ تَجْتَمِعَ الْأُمَّةُ عَلَى نَسْخِ أَحَدِهِمَا. وَمَا سِوَى هَذَا مِمَّا يُظَنُّ أَنَّهُ نَسْخٌ فَلَيْسَ بِنَسْخٍ، مِثْلَ تَأَخُّرِ الرَّاوِي فِي الْإِسْلَامِ، وَتَأَخُّرِهِ فِي السِّنِّ أَوِ انْقِطَاعِ صُحْبَتِهِ.

This concludes the discussion of the abrogating and the abrogated.

تَمَّ الْقَوْلُ فِي النَّاسِخِ وَالْمَنْسُوخِ.

§ 130 Consensus as certainty beyond surviving explicit texts

1994 Arabic p. 90 · BA §156 · 2015 Arabic p. 218 · French p. 219

وَالْإِجْمَاعُ هُوَ اتِّفَاقُ الْمُجْتَهِدِينَ مِنْ أُمَّةِ مُحَمَّدٍ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ عَلَى حُكْمٍ شَرْعِيٍّ وَسَوَاءٌ كَانَ ذَلِكَ الْحُكْمُ مِمَّا صَرَّحَ بِهِ صَاحِبُ الشَّرْعِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ فَدَثَرَ وَلَمْ يُنْقَلْ، أَوْ لَمْ يُصَرِّحْ بِهِ، فَوَقَعَ الْإِجْمَاعُ مِنْهُمْ عَلَى ذَلِكَ لِقَرِينَةِ حَالٍ أَوْ دَلِيلٍ أَوْ غَيْرِ ذَلِكَ مِمَّا يُوجِبُ الِاتِّفَاقَ. أَمَّا مَا صَرَّحَ بِهِ النَّبِيُّ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ وَنُقِلَ نَقْلَ تَوَاتُرٍ فَلَا غَنَاءَ لِلْإِجْمَاعِ فِي تَصْحِيحِهِ. وَأَمَّا مَا نُقِلَ نَقْلَ آحَادٍ فَإِنَّ الْإِجْمَاعَ يَنْقُلُهُ مِنْ رُتْبَةِ الظَّنِّ إِلَى رُتْبَةِ الْقَطْعِ.

Consensus (الإجماع) is the agreement of the practitioners of independent judgement within Muḥammad's community, God bless him and grant him peace, on a revealed ruling. This applies whether the bearer of the Law, God bless him and grant him peace, expressly stated the ruling but it was lost and not transmitted, or did not expressly state it, and they reached agreement through a contextual indication, a proof, or something else producing agreement. Consensus adds nothing to the authentication of what the Prophet, peace be upon him, expressly stated and which was transmitted by mass transmission. What was transmitted through solitary routes, however, consensus raises from the level of probability to that of certainty.

وَأَمَّا مَا لَمْ يُصَرِّحْ بِهِ أَوْ صَرَّحَ بِهِ وَلَمْ يَبْلُغْنَا فَإِنَّ الْإِجْمَاعَ يُسْتَعْمَلُ دَلِيلًا قَاطِعًا فِي تَثْبِيتِهِ. أَمَّا وُقُوعُ مِثْلِ هَذَا شَرْعًا فَمَوْجُودٌ وَأَمَّا اطِّلَاعُنَا عَلَيْهِ فَذَلِكَ يُمْكِنُ بِأَحَدِ وَجْهَيْنِ: أَمَّا إِنْ كَانَ الْمُجْمِعُونَ مُعَاصِرِينَ لَنَا فَبِلِقَائِهِمْ. وَأَمَّا إِنْ كَانُوا مِمَّنْ سَلَفَ فَبِالنَّقْلِ الْمُسْتَفِيضِ الَّذِي يُوقِعُ التَّصْدِيقَ.

Where a ruling was not expressly stated, or was expressly stated but has not reached us, consensus is used as a decisive proof establishing it. Such consensus has in fact occurred in the Law. We can learn of it in one of two ways: if those agreeing are our contemporaries, by meeting them; if they belong to earlier generations, through widespread transmission that produces assent (التصديق).

§ 131 Cumulative scriptural evidence for the authority of consensus

1994 Arabic p. 90 & 91 · BA §157 · 2015 Arabic p. 220 · French p. 221

وَأَمَّا الدَّلِيلُ عَلَى كَوْنِ الْإِجْمَاعِ حُجَّةً فَمَأْخُوذٌ مِنْ جِهَةِ النَّقْلِ مِنَ الْكِتَابِ وَالسُّنَّةِ. فَمِنْ ذَلِكَ قَوْلُهُ تَعَالَى: {وَمَنْ يُشَاقِقِ الرَّسُولَ مِنْ بَعْدِ مَا تَبَيَّنَ لَهُ الْهُدَى وَيَتَّبِعْ غَيْرَ سَبِيلِ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ نُوَلِّهِ مَا تَوَلَّى} الْآيَةَ. وَهَذِهِ أَقْوَى آيَةٍ فِي التَّمَسُّكِ بِالْإِجْمَاعِ. وَمِنْهَا قَوْلُهُ تَبَارَكَ وَتَعَالَى: {وَكَذَلِكَ جَعَلْنَاكُمْ أُمَّةً وَسَطًا لِتَكُونُوا شُهَدَاءَ عَلَى النَّاسِ وَيَكُونَ الرَّسُولُ عَلَيْكُمْ شَهِيدًا}. وَقَوْلُهُ: {كُنْتُمْ خَيْرَ أُمَّةٍ أُخْرِجَتْ لِلنَّاسِ}. وَقَوْلُهُ تَعَالَى: {وَمِمَّنْ خَلَقْنَا أُمَّةٌ يَهْدُونَ بِالْحَقِّ وَبِهِ يَعْدِلُونَ}.

The proof that consensus is authoritative is drawn from transmitted revelation, the Book and the Sunna. Among its texts is God's saying, 'Whoever opposes the Messenger after guidance has become clear to him and follows a way other than that of the believers, We shall turn him toward what he has chosen,' and the remainder of the verse. This is the strongest verse supporting reliance on consensus. There are also His sayings, blessed and exalted: 'Thus We made you a community of the middle, so that you may be witnesses over humankind and the Messenger a witness over you'; 'You are the best community

brought forth for humankind’; and ‘Among those We have created is a community that guides by truth and acts justly by it.’

وَهَذِهِ الْآيَاتُ وَإِنْ لَمْ تَكُنْ وَاحِدَةٌ وَاحِدَةٌ مِنْهَا نَصًّا فِي كَوْنِ الْإِجْمَاعِ دَلِيلًا شَرْعِيًّا فَإِنَّهَا بِمَجْمُوعِهَا تَقْتَضِي لِهَذِهِ الْأُمَّةِ التَّعْظِيمَ وَالتَّشْرِيفَ وَاتِّبَاعَ سَبِيلِهِمْ وَمُوَافَقَتَهُمْ وَالنَّهْيَ عَنْ مُخَالَفَتِهِمْ وَالْخُرُوجِ عَنْ جَمَاعَتِهِمْ.

Although none of these verses taken separately is unambiguous wording (نص) establishing consensus as a revealed proof, together they require this community to be esteemed and honored, its way followed and agreement maintained with it, and they forbid opposing it and departing from its congregation.

وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ إِذَا أُضِيفَ إِلَى هَذِهِ الْآيَاتِ مَا وَرَدَ مِنْ أَحَادِيثِ الْأَخْبَارِ فِي وُجُوبِ الْعِصْمَةِ لِهَذِهِ الْأُمَّةِ، وَإِنْ لَمْ تَكُنْ تَوَاتَرَتْ فِي اللَّفْظِ فَهِيَ مُتَوَاتِرَةٌ فِي الْمَعْنَى، كَقَوْلِهِ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ: «لَا تَجْتَمِعُ أُمَّتِي عَلَى الْخَطَأِ» وَقَوْلِهِ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ «لَمْ يَكُنِ اللَّهُ لِيَجْمَعَ أُمَّتِي عَلَى الْخَطَأِ وَمَنْ سَرَّهُ بُحْبُوحَةُ الْجَنَّةِ فَلْيَلْزَمِ الْجَمَاعَةَ». وَقَوْلِهِ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ «يَدُ اللَّهِ مَعَ الْجَمَاعَةِ»، إِلَى مَا سِوَى ذَلِكَ مِنَ الْأَحَادِيثِ، ثَبَتَ عَلَى الْقَطْعِ كَوْنُ الْإِجْمَاعِ دَلِيلًا شَرْعِيًّا.

In general, when these verses are joined to the transmitted reports affirming that this community is protected from error—reports mass-transmitted in meaning even if not in wording—consensus is established with certainty as a revealed proof. Such reports include his saying, peace be upon him: ‘My community does not agree upon error’; his saying, peace be upon him, ‘God would not bring my community into agreement upon error; whoever delights in the spacious heart of Paradise should keep to the congregation’; and his saying, peace be upon him, ‘God’s hand is with the congregation,’ together with the other reports of this kind.

Editorial notes

N052 [translation] The Qur’ānic quotations, in order, are 4:115, 2:143, 3:110, and 7:181. Reports are translated as quoted on p. 91, without replacing them by the editor’s parallel wording from al-Mustaṣfā.

§ 132 Why consensus is not merely a rational inference from numbers

1994 Arabic p. 91 · BA §158 · 2015 Arabic p. 222 · French p. 223

وَأَمَّا مَنِ احْتَجَّ عَلَى كَوْنِ الْإِجْمَاعِ حُجَّةً بِدَلِيلِ الْعَقْلِ فَضَعِيفٌ، لِأَنَّهُ وَإِنْ كَانَ يَبْعُدُ اجْتِمَاعُ الْكَثِيرِ عَلَى الْكَذِبِ، فَغَيْرُ بَعِيدٍ اجْتِمَاعُهُمْ عَلَى الْخَطَأِ. بَلْ نَقُولُ لَوْ بَقِيَ مِنْ أَهْلِ الِاجْتِهَادِ اثْنَانِ أَوْ ثَلَاثَةٌ وَأَجْمَعُوا عَلَى رَأْيٍ وَقَعَ الْإِجْمَاعُ بِهِمْ لِشَهَادَةِ الشَّرْعِ لَهُمْ بِالْعِصْمَةِ، مِنْ حَيْثُ يَنْطَلِقُ عَلَيْهِمُ اسْمُ الْأُمَّةِ فِي ذَلِكَ الْوَقْتِ.

An argument establishing the authority of consensus through reason is weak. Although it is unlikely that many people would agree upon a lie, their agreeing upon an error is not unlikely. Indeed, we say that if only two or three practitioners of independent judgement remained and agreed on an opinion, consensus would be established through them, because the Law attests their protection from error insofar as the name ‘community’ applies to them at that time.

§ 133 Why lay agreement adds no independent proof

1994 Arabic p. 91 & 92 · BA §159 · 2015 Arabic p. 222 · French p. 223

We specified practitioners of independent judgement in its definition because, although ordinary people can be conceived as participating in consensus, this is only in matters transmitted by mass transmission, such as the five prayers, fasting, and almsgiving, or in matters in which they are included as followers of the consensus of those practitioners. Their agreement therefore adds nothing to establishing the correctness of anything. Ordinary people always follow practitioners of independent judgement and agree with them, since this is their duty. There is no objection to calling this consensus, but such consensus is not a source used by a practitioner of independent judgement.

وَإِنَّمَا اشْتَرَطْنَا فِي حَدِّهِ الْمُجْتَهِدِينَ، لِأَنَّ الْعَوَامَّ وَإِنْ تُصُوِّرَ دُخُولُهُمْ فِي الْإِجْمَاعِ فَإِنَّمَا ذَلِكَ فِي الْأُمُورِ الَّتِي نُقِلَتْ نَقْلَ تَوَاتُرٍ كَالصَّلَوَاتِ الْخَمْسِ وَالصَّوْمِ وَالزَّكَاةِ، أَوْ فِيمَا كَانُوا فِيهِ مُسْتَصْحَبِينَ وَتَابِعِينَ لِإِجْمَاعِ الْمُجْتَهِدِينَ، فَلِذَلِكَ لَا غَنَاءَ لِإِجْمَاعِهِمْ فِي تَصْحِيحِ شَيْءٍ، بَلِ الْعَوَامُّ أَبَدًا مُتَّبِعُونَ لِلْمُجْتَهِدِينَ وَمُوَافِقُونَ لَهُمْ، إِذْ كَانَ ذَلِكَ فَرْضَهُمْ. فَإِنْ سُمِّيَ مِثْلُ هَذَا إِجْمَاعًا لَمْ يَمْتَنِعْ، لَكِنْ مِثْلُ هَذَا لَيْسَ بِأَصْلٍ يَسْتَعْمِلُهُ الْمُجْتَهِدُ.

Editorial notes

N053 [grammar] مُسْتَصْحَبِينَ is vocalised passively, “included or brought along,” in contrast to the jurists whose agreement is independently probative. The coordinated تَابِعِينَ explains their subordinate participation. An active reading is linguistically possible, but must not suggest that lay agreement supplies an independent proof.

§ 134 All qualified jurists of one age, not every age

1994 Arabic p. 92 · BA §160 · 2015 Arabic p. 222 · French p. 223

As for the number of those agreeing, there is no condition except that they comprise all qualified practitioners of independent judgement existing in a single age. If we required the agreement of people of every age—past, present, and future—no consensus could occur.

فَأَمَّا عَدَدُ الْمُجْمِعِينَ فَلَيْسَ فِيهِ شَرْطٌ سِوَى أَنْ يَكُونُوا جَمِيعَ الْمُجْتَهِدِينَ مِنْ أَهْلِ الْعِلْمِ الْمَوْجُودِينَ فِي عَصْرٍ وَاحِدٍ، لِأَنَّا لَوِ اشْتَرَطْنَا إِجْمَاعَ أَهْلِ الْأَعْصَارِ، مَنْ سَلَفَ مِنْهُمْ وَمَنْ هُوَ حَاضِرٌ وَمَنْ سَيَأْتِي، لَمْ يَقَعْ إِجْمَاعًا.

§ 135 Can later agreement override an earlier disagreement?

1994 Arabic p. 92 · BA §161 · 2015 Arabic p. 222 · French p. 223

If the people of our age agree on something about which their predecessors did not agree, is consensus established? This requires examination. If the preceding generation was silent and no opinion on the matter has been transmitted from it, the consensus of later generations is necessarily established. Discussion arises when a disagreement has been transmitted from the predecessors. Opinions differ, and the

فَأَمَّا إِنْ أَجْمَعَ أَهْلُ عَصْرِنَا عَلَى أَمْرٍ لَمْ يُجْمِعْ عَلَيْهِ مَنْ سَبَقَهُمْ هَلْ يَنْعَقِدُ الْإِجْمَاعُ أَمْ لَا؟ فَفِيهِ مَوْضِعُ نَظَرٍ. أَمَّا مَا سَكَتَ عَلَيْهِ أَهْلُ الْعَصْرِ الْمُتَقَدِّمِ، وَلَمْ يُنْقَلْ عَنْهُمْ فِيهِ قَوْلٌ، فَإِجْمَاعُ مَنْ بَعْدَهُمْ مُنْعَقِدٌ ضَرُورَةً. وَأَمَّا إِذَا نُقِلَ فِيهِ عَنْ مَنْ سَلَفَ خِلَافٌ، فَهَا هُنَا مَوْضِعُ الْقَوْلِ. وَقَدِ اخْتَلَفَ

question is determined through the verbal forms of the statements affirming this community's protection from error, such as his saying, peace be upon him, 'My community will not agree upon misguidance,' and the other reports we have cited.

النَّاسُ فِي ذَلِكَ، وَالْوُقُوفُ عَلَيْهِ يَكُونُ مِنْ جِهَةِ صِيَغِ الْأَلْفَاظِ الْوَارِدَةِ فِي مَعْنَى الْعِصْمَةِ لِهَذِهِ الْأُمَّةِ كَقَوْلِهِ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ «لَنْ تَجْتَمِعَ أُمَّتِي عَلَى الضَّلَالِ»، وَسَائِرِ الْأَحَادِيثِ الَّتِي أَوْرَدْنَاهَا.

Although these cannot be understood with unrestricted generality, since the term 'community' cannot here include those yet to come, the term remains authoritative with respect to the generality of what remains within its scope. On what grounds, I wonder, can the preceding generation be excluded from the requirements of consensus, when the remaining general scope of the expression includes them? This is possible only for someone who holds that a general expression (العام), once specified, is no longer authoritative for the generality of what remains.

فَإِنَّهَا وَإِنْ لَمْ يُمْكِنْ حَمْلُهَا عَلَى الْعُمُومِ، إِذْ هُوَ مِنَ الْمُمْتَنِعِ أَنْ يَتَنَاوَلَ هَهُنَا لَفْظُ الْأُمَّةِ مَنْ سَيَأْتِي، فَهُوَ حُجَّةٌ فِي عُمُومِ مَا بَقِيَ دَاخِلًا تَحْتَ تَنَاوُلِ اللَّفْظِ. فَبِأَيِّ جِهَةٍ لَيْتَ شِعْرِي يُخْرَجُ مِنْ شَرْطِ الْإِجْمَاعِ أَهْلُ الْعَصْرِ الْمُتَقَدِّمِ، وَعُمُومُ مَا بَقِيَ مِنْ دَلَالَةِ اللَّفْظِ يَتَنَاوَلُهُمْ، اللَّهُمَّ إِلَّا عِنْدَ مَنْ يَرَى أَنَّ الْعَامَّ إِذَا خُصِّصَ فَلَيْسَ بِحُجَّةٍ فِي عُمُومِ مَا بَقِيَ.

§ 136 Why the Ẓāhirīs restrict consensus to the Companions

1994 Arabic p. 92 & 93 · BA §162 · 2015 Arabic p. 224 · French p. 225

This disagreement cannot arise for the Ẓāhirīs, because they consider consensus to be solely the Companions' agreement on a ruling, may God be pleased with them. This follows necessarily from their principles, since they do not allow consensus based on analogy. On their view, consensus therefore arises either from a report that has disappeared and has not reached us, or from indications and circumstances witnessed in the Prophet, God bless him and grant him peace. Such a basis is conceivable only among the Companions. Those who permit consensus to arise from analogy must, however, confront the disagreement just mentioned. We shall explain this in the book on inference, when the meaning they intend by analogy in this discipline has become clear.

فَأَمَّا أَهْلُ الظَّاهِرِ فَلَيْسَ يَتَصَوَّرُ مَعَهُمْ هَذَا الْخِلَافُ لِأَنَّهُمْ يَرَوْنَ الْإِجْمَاعَ إِنَّمَا هُوَ اتِّفَاقُ الصَّحَابَةِ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمْ عَلَى حُكْمٍ مَا. وَذَلِكَ لَازِمٌ لِأُصُولِهِمْ. لِأَنَّهُمْ لَا يُجَوِّزُونَ الْإِجْمَاعَ بِالْقِيَاسِ. وَإِذَا كَانَ هَذَا هَكَذَا فَإِنَّمَا يَقَعُ الْإِجْمَاعُ عِنْدَهُمْ إِمَّا لِأَثَرٍ قَدْ عَفَا وَلَمْ يَصِلْ إِلَيْنَا، وَإِمَّا لِقَرَائِنَ وَأَحْوَالِ مُشَاهَدَةٍ مِنْهُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ، وَمِثْلُ هَذَا لَا يَتَصَوَّرُ فِي غَيْرِ الصَّحَابَةِ. وَأَمَّا مَنْ يُجَوِّزُ وُقُوعَ الْإِجْمَاعِ عَنِ الْقِيَاسِ فَيَلْزَمُهُ الْخِلَافُ الْمَذْكُورُ وَسَنُبَيِّنُ هَذَا فِي كِتَابِ الِاسْتِنْبَاطِ، إِذَا تَبَيَّنَ مَا هُوَ الْمَعْنَى الَّذِي يَعْنُونَهُ بِالْقِيَاسِ فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ.

§ 137 Unanimity, majority, and the evidential limits of silence

1994 Arabic p. 93 · BA §163–164 · 2015 Arabic p. 224 · French p. 225

Does the term ‘community’ also include every individual practitioner of independent judgement in that age, so that a single dissenter prevents consensus, or does it mean the majority? The apparent sense of the transmitted formulas includes them all. In general, examination of these conditions of consensus seems to be a matter for independent judgement. There is also disagreement when an opinion is transmitted from most of them and the rest are silent. The more evident view, as al-Shāfiʿī says, is that a speaker’s position should not be attributed to someone silent—unless the silent persons’ circumstances indicate that their silence may have expressed approval of, and agreement with, that opinion.

وَأَمَّا هَلْ يَتَنَاوَلُ أَيْضًا لَفْظَةُ الْأُمَّةِ جَمِيعَ الشُّخُوصِ الْمُجْتَهِدِينَ فِي ذَلِكَ الْعَصْرِ حَتَّى إِنْ شَذَّ مِنْهُمْ وَاحِدٌ لَمْ يَكُنْ إِجْمَاعًا، أَمْ يُرَادُ بِهِ الْأَكْثَرُ، فَالظَّاهِرُ مِنَ الصِّيَغِ الْوَارِدَةِ فِي ذَلِكَ تَنَاوُلُ جَمِيعِهِمْ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَالنَّظَرُ فِي هَذِهِ الْأَحْوَالِ الْمُشْتَرَطَةِ فِي الْإِجْمَاعِ يُشْبِهُ أَنْ يَكُونَ اجْتِهَادِيًّا. وَأَمَّا إِذَا نُقِلَ عَنْ أَكْثَرِهِمْ أَيْضًا قَوْلٌ، وَسَكَتَ الْبَاقُونَ فَمُخْتَلَفٌ فِيهِ. وَالْأَظْهَرُ كَمَا يَقُولُ الشَّافِعِيُّ أَلَّا يُنْسَبَ إِلَى سَاكِتٍ قَوْلُ قَائِلٍ، اللَّهُمَّ إِلَّا أَنْ يُعْلَمَ مِنْ قَرَائِنِ أَحْوَالِ السَّاكِتِينَ أَنَّ سُكُوتَهُمْ رُبَّمَا كَانَ رِضًا مِنْهُمْ بِالْقَوْلِ وَاتِّفَاقًا عَلَيْهِ.

A person may remain silent for many reasons: he may have no opinion on the matter at that time; or, if he has an opinion, obstacles may prevent him from stating it. He may think that the ruling is open to independent judgement, or that every practitioner of independent judgement is correct; he may be inhibited by awe, or by other accompanying circumstances.

فَإِنَّ الْإِنْسَانَ قَدْ يَسْكُتُ لِأَسْبَابٍ شَتَّى: إِمَّا أَنَّهُ لَيْسَ عِنْدَهُ فِي ذَلِكَ الْوَقْتِ فِي الشَّيْءِ رَأْيٌ، وَإِمَّا إِنْ كَانَ عِنْدَهُ رَأْيٌ فِي الشَّيْءِ فَقَدْ تَمْنَعُهُ عَنِ التَّصْرِيحِ بِهِ مَوَانِعُ: مِنْهَا أَنَّهُ لَعَلَّهُ يَرَى أَنَّ الْحُكْمَ فِي مَحَلِّ الِاجْتِهَادِ، أَوْ أَنَّ كُلَّ مُجْتَهِدٍ مُصِيبٌ، أَوْ هَيْبَةً مَا، أَوْ غَيْرُ ذَلِكَ مِنْ قَرَائِنَ تَقْتَرِنُ لَهُ.

§ 138 Medinan practice must be traced as transmission

1994 Arabic p. 93 & 94 · BA §165 · 2015 Arabic p. 226 · French p. 227

Since this is so, and consensus requires agreement among all practitioners of independent judgement existing in the age, there is no basis for treating the agreement of the people of Medina as authoritative because they were the majority at the beginning of Islam.

وَإِذَا كَانَ هَذَا هَكَذَا وَكَانَ مِنْ شَرْطِ الْإِجْمَاعِ اتِّفَاقُ جَمِيعِ الْمُجْتَهِدِينَ الْمَوْجُودِينَ فِي ذَلِكَ الْعَصْرِ، فَمَنْ رَأَى إِجْمَاعَ أَهْلِ الْمَدِينَةِ حُجَّةً لِأَنَّهُمُ الْأَكْثَرُ فِي أَوَّلِ الْإِسْلَامِ فَلَا مَعْنَى لَهُ.

The discerning Mālikīs, however, regard it as authoritative on the ground of transmission. If an argument for its authority is to be built on this, it seems to me that the transmission of the practice must be explicitly stated, generation after generation, until it reaches the Messenger of God’s time, God bless him and grant him peace. It would then be authoritative through his approval,

لَكِنَّ حُذَّاقَ الْمَالِكِيِّينَ إِنَّمَا يَرَوْنَهُ حُجَّةً مِنْ جِهَةِ النَّقْلِ وَهَذَا إِذَا بُنِيَ فِيهِ أَنْ يُجْعَلَ حُجَّةً فِيمَا يَظْهَرُ لِي، فَيَنْبَغِي أَنْ يُصَرَّحَ فِيهِ بِنَقْلِ الْعَمَلِ قَرْنًا بَعْدَ قَرْنٍ حَتَّى يُوصَلَ بِذَلِكَ إِلَى زَمَنِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ، فَيَكُونَ ذَلِكَ حُجَّةً بِإِقْرَارِهِ لَهُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ. مِثْلَ أَنْ يَقُولُوا: هَكَذَا وَجَدْنَا آبَاءَنَا

God bless him and grant him peace. For example, they would say, ‘This is how we found our fathers acting,’ tracing this back to the Messenger of God’s time, God bless him and grant him peace.

يَفْعَلُونَ، إِلَى أَنْ يَنْتَهِيَ ذَلِكَ إِلَى زَمَنِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ.

Such was the encounter between Mālik and Abū Yūsuf in al-Rashīd’s presence concerning the ṣāʿ measure. If this requirement is neither imposed nor carefully maintained, their agreement may concern a practice forced upon them by some caliph or governor. In general, it is clear that reaching a legal judgement on this basis does not refer back to a source established with certainty in the Law, as a probable indication ought to do—unless transmission of the practice is explicitly stated as we have described, in which case it belongs to transmitted evidence.

مِثْلَ مَا اتَّفَقَ لِمَالِكٍ مَعَ أَبِي يُوسُفَ بِحَضْرَةِ الرَّشِيدِ فِي مَسْأَلَةِ الصَّاعِ. وَإِلَّا مَتَى لَمْ يُشْتَرَطْ هَذَا، وَلَمْ يُحْتَفَظْ بِهِ، لَمْ يَكُنْ مُمْتَنِعًا أَنْ يَكُونَ إِجْمَاعُهُمْ عَلَى أَمْرٍ حَمَلَهُمْ عَلَيْهِ بَعْضُ الْخُلَفَاءِ وَالْأُمَرَاءِ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَالْحُكْمُ فِي الشَّرْعِ بِمِثْلِ هَذَا الْحُكْمِ بَيِّنٌ أَنَّهُ لَيْسَ يَرْجِعُ إِلَى أَصْلٍ مَقْطُوعٍ بِهِ فِي الشَّرْعِ عَلَى مَا شَأْنُهَا أَنْ تَرْجِعَ إِلَيْهِ الْأَمَارَةُ الظَّنِّيَّةُ، اللَّهُمَّ إِلَّا أَنْ يُصَرَّحَ بِنَقْلِ الْعَمَلِ كَمَا قُلْنَا فَيَكُونَ مِنْ بَابِ النَّقْلِ.

§ 139 Must an agreeing generation die out before consensus binds?

1994 Arabic p. 94 & 95 · BA §166 · 2015 Arabic p. 228 · French p. 229

The requirement that the generation of practitioners of independent judgement must die out without disagreement intervening is not entailed by the wording of the reports establishing the authority of consensus. Rather, anyone who dissents after consensus has existed for even a single moment is disregarded and is certainly in error.

وَأَمَّا مَنْ يَشْتَرِطُ فِي الْإِجْمَاعِ انْقِرَاضَ عَصْرِ الْمُجْتَهِدِينَ دُونَ أَنْ يَقْطَعَ بَيْنَهُمْ خِلَافٌ فَلَيْسَ تَقْتَضِيهِ صِيَغُ الْأَحَادِيثِ الْوَارِدَةِ بِكَوْنِ الْإِجْمَاعِ حُجَّةً، بَلْ مَنْ خَالَفَ مِنْ بَعْدِ وُقُوعِ الْإِجْمَاعِ فِي لَحْظَةٍ مَا فَغَيْرُ مُلْتَفَتٍ إِلَيْهِ وَمَقْطُوعٌ بِخَطَئِهِ.

§ 140 The essential account is enough to understand further objections

1994 Arabic p. 95 · BA §167 · 2015 Arabic p. 228 · French p. 229

This is our account, as concise as we could make it, of what consensus is and of its requirements. Someone who has grasped consensus to the extent set out here can readily understand the further questions and objections connected with it, which Abū Ḥāmid has discussed at such length.

فَهَذَا هُوَ الْقَوْلُ فِي الْإِجْمَاعِ مَا هُوَ، وَسَائِرِ مَا يُشْتَرَطُ فِيهِ بِأَوْجَزِ مَا أَمْكَنَنَا، وَسَائِرُ مَا يَلْحَقُهُ مِنَ الْمَسَائِلِ وَالِاعْتِرَاضَاتِ الَّتِي كَثَّرَ أَبُو حَامِدٍ بِذِكْرِهَا فَقَدْ يَقِفُ عَلَيْهَا بِسُهُولَةٍ مَنْ تَصَوَّرَ مِنَ الْإِجْمَاعِ هَذَا الْمِقْدَارَ الَّذِي كَتَبْنَاهُ.

§ 141 Original freedom from liability and the burden of proof

1994 Arabic p. 96 · BA §168 · 2015 Arabic p. 228 · French p. 229

This is rational evidence for presuming the continuation (الاستصحاب) of freedom from obligations and the absence of blame for people where no command or prohibition has been received: for example, the absence of an obligation to perform a sixth prayer, eating during Shawwāl, and the like. In general, calling this a proof is a loose use of language. They were led to it by straining to make revealed matters require proof for both negation and affirmation, just as rational matters do. Thus you see them wavering: sometimes they say, ‘The absence of proof is proof’; sometimes, ‘It is established by analogy or consensus that, if no proof concerning it is found in the Law, original freedom from liability is presumed to continue.’

وَهُوَ دَلِيلُ الْعَقْلِ فِي اسْتِصْحَابِ بَرَاءَةِ الذِّمَّةِ عَنِ الْوَاجِبَاتِ، وَسُقُوطِ الْحَرَجِ عَنِ الْخَلْقِ فِيمَا لَمْ يَأْتِ فِيهِ أَمْرٌ أَوْ نَهْيٌ، كَسُقُوطِ الصَّلَاةِ السَّادِسَةِ مَثَلًا، وَأَكْلِ شَوَّالٍ وَمَا أَشْبَهَ ذَلِكَ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَتَسْمِيَةُ هَذَا دَلِيلًا تَجُوزُ فِيهِ الْعِبَارَةُ. وَالَّذِي أَصَارَهُمْ إِلَى هَذَا تَكَلُّفُهُمْ أَنْ يَجْعَلُوا السَّمْعِيَّاتِ فِي وُجُوبِ الدَّلِيلِ فِي حَالَتَيِ النَّفْيِ وَالْإِثْبَاتِ كَوُجُوبِ ذَلِكَ فِي الْعَقْلِيَّاتِ، حَتَّى تَرَاهُمْ يَضْطَرِبُونَ، فَمَرَّةً يَقُولُونَ: «عَدَمُ الدَّلِيلِ دَلِيلٌ»، وَمَرَّةً يَقُولُونَ: «ثَبَتَ بِالْقِيَاسِ أَوْ بِالْإِجْمَاعِ إِنْ لَمْ يُلْفَ دَلِيلٌ عَلَيْهِ فِي الشَّرْعِ فَتُسْتَصْحَبُ فِيهِ الْبَرَاءَةُ الْأَصْلِيَّةُ».

The correct view is otherwise. Anything whose existence can be established only by revelation is presumed absent until something to the contrary is received; its absence is the better-known state. In such a case, either no proof at all should be demanded from people, or, if proof is demanded, it should be less than that demanded from someone affirming its existence, as with a claimant and a defendant.

وَالصَّوَابُ غَيْرُ هَذَا، لِأَنَّ مَا كَانَ طَرِيقُ وُجُودِهِ السَّمْعَ فَهُوَ عَلَى الْعَدَمِ مَحْمُولٌ حَتَّى يَرِدَ غَيْرُ ذَلِكَ، وَالْعَدَمُ فِيهِ أَشْهَرُ. وَمَا كَانَ هَذَا إِمَّا أَنْ لَا يُطْلَبَ مِنَ النَّاسِ دَلِيلٌ عَلَيْهِ أَصْلًا، وَأَمَّا إِنْ طُلِبَ فَدُونَ دَلِيلِ الْمُثْبِتِ، كَالْحَالِ فِي الْمُدَّعِي وَالْمُدَّعَى عَلَيْهِ.

Editorial notes

N054 [translation] أكل شوال, p. 96, means eating in the month of Shawwāl, with no Ramadan-like fasting obligation presumed for it; the elliptical example is retained without silently changing أكل to صوم.

N055 [grammar] The printed تجوز فيه العبارة is read verbally, تَجُوزُ فِيهِ الْعِبَارَةُ: the expression permits an extended usage. The alternative nominal reading تَجَوُّزٌ would require a different construction, such as فِي الْعِبَارَةِ. The English “a loose use of language” conveys the argument without silently changing the consonants.

§ 142 Five forms of continuity and the problem of a changed subject

1994 Arabic p. 96 & 97 · BA §169–170 · 2015 Arabic p. 230 · French p. 231

Presumption of continuity (الاستصحاب) has several applications in this discipline. First is the continuation of original freedom from liability (البراءة الأصلية), discussed earlier. Second is retaining general scope until a specification is received. Third is retaining the text until abrogation is received. Fourth is retaining a ruling when the

وَالِاسْتِصْحَابُ فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ يُطْلَقُ عَلَى وُجُوهٍ: أَحَدُهَا اسْتِصْحَابُ الْبَرَاءَةِ الْأَصْلِيَّةِ الَّذِي تَقَدَّمَ. وَالثَّانِي اسْتِصْحَابُ الْعُمُومِ حَتَّى يَرِدَ تَخْصِيصٌ. وَالثَّالِثُ اسْتِصْحَابُ النَّصِّ حَتَّى يَرِدَ نَسْخٌ. وَالرَّابِعُ اسْتِصْحَابُ حُكْمٍ عِنْدَ أَمْرٍ قَرَنَهُ الشَّرْعُ بِهِ

لِتَكَرُّرِ ذَلِكَ الْأَمْرِ. وَالْخَامِسُ اسْتِصْحَابُ الْإِجْمَاعِ، أَوْ بِالْجُمْلَةِ الْحُكْمُ الشَّرْعِيُّ الثَّابِتُ بِالنَّقْلِ فِي مَوْضِعٍ يُظَنُّ أَنَّ الْمَحْكُومَ عَلَيْهِ قَدْ تَغَيَّرَ حُكْمُهُ لِتَغَيُّرِهِ فِي نَفْسِهِ، كَبَيْعِ أُمِّ الْوَلَدِ وَمَا أَشْبَهَ ذَلِكَ.

circumstance to which the Law attached it recurs. Fifth is retaining consensus—or, more generally, a revealed ruling established by transmission—in a case where the subject's ruling is thought to have changed because the subject itself has changed, as with selling a slave woman who has borne her master a child, and similar cases.

وَهَذَا الِاسْتِصْحَابَ يَرَاهُ أَهْلُ الظَّاهِرِ وَهُمْ لَازِمُونَ فِي ذَلِكَ لِأُصُولِهِمْ، لِأَنَّ مَنْ لَا يُجَوِّزُ فِي الشَّرْعِ النَّوْعَ مِنَ النَّظَرِ الَّذِي يُسَمَّى عِنْدَ أَهْلِ هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ بِالْقِيَاسِ، فَالْأَشْيَاءُ كَمَا أَنَّهَا عِنْدَهُمْ عَلَى الْبَرَاءَةِ الْأَصْلِيَّةِ حَتَّى يَرِدَ دَلِيلُ السَّمْعِ، كَذَلِكَ إِذَا وَرَدَ دَلِيلُ الشَّرْعِ بَقِيَ عَلَى حُكْمِهِ وَإِنْ تَغَيَّرَتْ أَوْصَافُهُ حَتَّى يَرِدَ دَلِيلُ الِارْتِفَاعِ.

The Ẓāhirīs accept this presumption of continuity and thereby remain consistent with their principles. Those who do not allow in the Law the kind of reasoning called analogy by practitioners of this discipline hold that things remain in their original freedom from liability until revealed evidence is received. Similarly, once revealed evidence is received, the subject retains its ruling even if its attributes change, until evidence removing the ruling is received.

وَكَانَ الْحَالُ هَهُنَا بِالْعَكْسِ فِي اسْتِصْحَابِ الْبَرَاءَةِ الْأَصْلِيَّةِ لِأَنَّ هُنَاكَ كَانَ الْعَدَمُ أَظْهَرَ فَوَجَبَ الدَّلِيلُ عَلَى الْمُثْبِتِ، وَهَهُنَا الْوُجُودُ أَظْهَرُ فَوَجَبَ الدَّلِيلُ عَلَى النَّافِي. وَأَمَّا مَنْ يَرَى الْقِيَاسَ فِي الشَّرْعِ فَيَلْزَمُهُ أَلَّا يَقُولَ بِمِثْلِ هَذَا الِاسْتِصْحَابِ، لِأَنَّ لَهُ أَنْ يَقُولَ نَحْنُ مُكَلَّفُونَ بِالنَّظَرِ بِالْقِيَاسِ فِيمَا لَيْسَ فِيهِ نَصٌّ، وَهَذَا قَدْ تَغَيَّرَ وَصْفُهُ، فَلَهُ حُكْمُ مَا لَمْ يَرِدْ فِيهِ نَصٌّ، إِذْ تَغَيُّرُ الْوَصْفِ يُوجِبُ تَغَيُّرَ الْحُكْمِ.

The situation here is the reverse of presuming original freedom from liability. There, absence was more evident, so proof was required from whoever affirmed; here, existence is more evident, so proof is required from whoever denies. Someone who accepts analogy in the Law must reject this kind of continuity, since he can say: we are charged to reason by analogy where there is no text. This subject's attribute has changed, so it has the status of a case for which no text has been received, because a change of attribute requires a change of ruling.

§ 143 Conclusion of the four sources

1994 Arabic p. 97 · BA §171 · 2015 Arabic p. 230 · French p. 231

وَهُنَا انْقَضَى الْقَوْلُ فِي الْأَصْلِ الرَّابِعِ وَهُوَ مُنْتَهَى الْكَلَامِ فِي الْجُزْءِ الثَّانِي مِنْ هَذَا الْكِتَابِ وَهُوَ الْمُشْتَمِلُ عَلَى أُصُولِ الْأَدِلَّةِ.

Here the discussion of the fourth source ends, and with it the discussion of the second part of this book, which comprises the sources of proofs.

Editorial notes

N056 [textual] The paragraph beginning وهنا انقضى on p. 97 has no printed numeral. It is assigned §143 from the sequence between printed §§142 and 146; the next two unnumbered paragraphs are §§144–145.

§ 144 A Companion’s opinion attracts weight but is not infallible

1994 Arabic p. 97 · BA §172 · 2015 Arabic p. 232 · French p. 233

وَقَدْ يُظَنُّ أَنَّ هٰهُنَا أُصُولًا غَيْرَ هٰذِهِ نَحْنُ ذَاكِرُوهَا: مِنْهَا قَوْلُ الصَّحَابِيِّ يُظَنُّ بِهِ أَنَّهُ حُجَّةٌ وَلَيْسَ بِحُجَّةٍ، لِأَنَّ مَنْ لَمْ تَثْبُتْ عِصْمَتُهُ لَمْ يَجُزْ تَقْلِيدُهُ، فَالْعِصْمَةُ إِنَّمَا تَثْبُتُ بِالْمُعْجِزَةِ أَوْ بِقَوْلِ صَاحِبِ الْمُعْجِزَةِ فِيهِ إِنَّهُ مَعْصُومٌ. وَقَدْ تَفَرَّقَ النَّاسُ فِي ذَلِكَ عَلَى أَقْوَالٍ: فَبَعْضُهُمْ خَصَّ بِذَلِكَ بَعْضَ الصَّحَابَةِ، وَبَعْضُهُمْ رَآهُ فِي كُلِّ صَاحِبٍ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَالصَّاحِبُ مُجْتَهِدٌ مِنَ الْمُجْتَهِدِينَ، لَكِنَّ النَّفْسَ أَمْيَلُ إِلَى أَقْوَالِهِمْ لِمَا انْضَافَتْ إِلَيْهِمْ مِنَ الْقَرَائِنِ، وَهِيَ الَّتِي أَوْقَعَتْ مَنْ رَأَى أَقْوَالَهُمْ حُجَّةً فِي ذَلِكَ.

Other sources may be supposed to exist, and we shall mention them. One is a Companion’s statement, which is thought authoritative but is not. One may not follow uncritically someone whose protection from error has not been established; such protection is established only by a miracle, or by the bearer of a miracle declaring that the person is protected from error. Opinions differ: some confine this authority to particular Companions; others extend it to every Companion. In general, a Companion is one practitioner of independent judgement among others. The mind nevertheless inclines more readily to their opinions because of the indications accompanying them, and these indications led those who regard their statements as authoritative to that view.

Editorial notes

N057 [textual] Unnumbered paragraph at p. 97; its place between §§142 and 146 identifies it as §144.

§ 145 Earlier revealed laws are not an independent source

1994 Arabic p. 97 & 98 · BA §173 · 2015 Arabic p. 232 · French p. 233

وَمِنْهَا شَرْعُ مَنْ قَبْلَنَا، وَالدَّلِيلُ عَلَى أَنَّهُ لَيْسَ بِأَصْلٍ أَنَّهُ لَوْ كَانَ كَذَلِكَ لَكَانَ نَقْلُهُ مِنْ فُرُوضِ الْكِفَايَاتِ. وَلَيْسَ يَصِحُّ عَلَى الْأُمَّةِ أَنْ يَذْهَبَ عَلَيْهَا فِي وَقْتٍ مَا فَرْضٌ مِنْ فُرُوضِ الْكِفَايَاتِ بِدَلِيلِ الْعِصْمَةِ لَهُمْ، وَلَوْ كَانَ فَرْضًا مِنْ فُرُوضِ الْكِفَايَاتِ لَأَخْبَرَ بِهِ الصَّحَابَةُ وَنُقِلَ إِلَى الْيَوْمِ. فَأَمَّا مَا مِنْهَا فِي الْكِتَابِ وَنَحْنُ مَأْمُورُونَ بِهِ فَإِنَّمَا نَحْنُ مَأْمُورُونَ بِهِ مِنْ جِهَةِ مَا هُوَ فِي الْكِتَابِ لَا مِنْ جِهَةِ مَا هُوَ شَرْعُ مَنْ قَبْلَنَا.

Another is the law of those before us. The proof that this is not a source is that, were it a source, transmitting it would be a collective obligation. It cannot be right that the community should, at any time, lose knowledge of a collective obligation, given the proof of its protection from error. Had its transmission been a collective obligation, the Companions would have reported it and it would have been transmitted down to the present. As for provisions of earlier laws contained in the Book and commanded of us, they are commanded of us insofar as they are in the Book, not insofar as they are the law of those before us.

Editorial notes

N058 [textual] Earlier al-ʿAlawī 1994 text had a lacuna and suggested ويستحيل in a note. Bou Akl 2015 (BA §173, Arabic p.232, bottom apparatus) prints the surviving marginal manuscript words وليس يصح, explicitly contrasting [أ] with the [ع] conjecture يستحيل. We therefore restore a transmitted sentence rather than retaining the lacuna or silently adopting the conjecture. Bou Akl identifies this as the 1994 editor’s proposed reading, not the manuscript wording.

BA15-V145 [textual] 2015 full-edition control completed for R §145 = Bou Akl §173, Arabic p.232, French p.233. Distinguish manuscript-attested changes as detailed in the preceding notes. See the source-verified change ledger for exact old and new Arabic/English strings.

§ 146 Preference and welfare require a recognized legal warrant

1994 Arabic p. 98 · BA §174 · 2015 Arabic p. 232 · French p. 233

Others are juristic preference and consideration of welfare. If these mean a kind of analogy, evident or subtle, permissible in the Law in the manner allowed by its proponents, then it is a source on their view. If they do not mean that, they are not a source. In general, the Law has encouraged consideration of benefits, but to a certain extent and within a certain limit: where it has attested that they, or their kind, constitute a benefit. Whether analogy itself is a source will be discussed later.

وَمِنْهَا الِاسْتِحْسَانُ وَالِاسْتِصْلَاحُ وَهَذَانِ إِنْ أُرِيدَ بِهِمَا نَوْعٌ مِنْ أَنْوَاعِ الْقِيَاسِ، جَلِيٌّ أَوْ خَفِيٌّ مِمَّا يَجُوزُ فِي الشَّرْعِ عَلَى الْجِهَةِ الَّتِي يُجَوِّزُهُ الْقَائِلُونَ بِهِ، فَهُوَ عَلَى رَأْيِهِمْ أَصْلٌ، وَأَمَّا إِنْ لَمْ يُرَدْ بِهِ ذَلِكَ فَلَيْسَ بِأَصْلٍ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ النَّظَرُ فِي الْمَصَالِحِ قَدْ نَدَبَ إِلَيْهَا الشَّرْعُ لَكِنْ بِمِقْدَارٍ مَا وَبِحَدٍّ مَا، وَهُوَ مَا شَهِدَ لَنَا بِكَوْنِهَا أَوْ كَوْنِ جِنْسِهَا مَصْلَحَةً. وَأَمَّا هَلِ الْقِيَاسُ أَصْلٌ فَسَيَأْتِي الْقَوْلُ فِيهِ فِيمَا بَعْدُ.

§ 147 Conclusion of Part Two

1994 Arabic p. 98 · BA §175 · 2015 Arabic p. 234 · French p. 235

Here the examination of the second part of this science ends. Praise be to God.

وَهُنَا انْتَهَى النَّظَرُ فِي الْجُزْءِ الثَّانِي مِنْ هَذَا الْعِلْمِ وَالْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ.

Expressions, interpretation and analogy

§ 148 The distinctive task: understanding prophetic indications

1994 Arabic p. 99 & 101 · BA §176 · 2015 Arabic p. 236 · French p. 237

This part concerns the inquiry most distinctive of this science, as we explained earlier. It is divided according to the things through which the Prophet’s meaning is understood, God bless him and grant him peace: either wording or an indication (قرينة).

وَهَذَا الْجُزْءُ هُوَ الَّذِي النَّظَرُ فِيهِ أَخَصُّ بِهَذَا الْعِلْمِ عَلَى مَا قَدَّمْنَا فِيمَا سَلَفَ، وَهُوَ يَنْقَسِمُ بِحَسَبِ الْأَشْيَاءِ الَّتِي يَقَعُ بِهَا الْفَهْمُ عَنِ النَّبِيِّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ، وَذَلِكَ إِمَّا لَفْظٌ أَوْ قَرِينَةٌ.

§ 149 Verbal form and intelligible import

1994 Arabic p. 101 · BA §176 · 2015 Arabic p. 236 · French p. 237

Wording is divided into what indicates a ruling through its verbal form, and what indicates it through its understood import and intelligible meaning.

وَاللَّفْظُ يَنْقَسِمُ إِلَى مَا يَدُلُّ عَلَى الْحُكْمِ بِصِيغَتِهِ، وَإِلَى مَا يَدُلُّ بِمَفْهُومِهِ وَمَعْقُولِهِ.

Editorial notes

BA002 [scholarship] In distinguishing verbal form from understood/intelligible import, read mafhūm and maʿqūl together here rather than treating them as two independently stipulated methods. Bou Akl highlights Ibn Rushd’s compression of al-Ghazālī’s three ways of indication (ṣīgha, mafhūm, maʿqūl) into an opposition between form and intended import. His revised-edition citation to this exact sentence is 2015 §176, not the §149 of this al-ʿAlawī-based reader. Source: Bou Akl, “Averroes on Juridical Reasoning,” in Interpreting Averroes: Critical Essays (Cambridge UP, 2018), pp. 47–50.

BA15-I05 [interpretive] Linguistic rather than syllogistic inference. Bou Akl 2015 intro pp.50–76 stresses two categories of the indication of legal discourse: form (ṣīgha) and intelligible or understood import (mafhūm/maʿqūl), a significant reduction of al-Ghazālī’s initial tripartite scheme.

§ 150 Action and approval as nonverbal indications

1994 Arabic p. 101 · BA §176 · 2015 Arabic p. 236 · French p. 237

Indication is divided into two kinds: one is his action, God bless him and grant him peace; the other is his approval of a ruling.

وَالْقَرِينَةُ تَنْقَسِمُ إِلَى قِسْمَيْنِ: أَحَدُهُمَا فِعْلُهُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ، وَالْآخَرُ إِقْرَارُهُ عَلَى الْحُكْمِ.

§ 151 Four classes of verbal indication

1994 Arabic p. 101 · BA §177 · 2015 Arabic p. 236 · French p. 237

Let us begin by examining wording. We say: practitioners of this discipline customarily divide expressions and statements into the indeterminate (المجمل), the unambiguous (النص), what has an apparent meaning (الظاهر), and what is

وَلْنَبْدَأْ مِنْ ذَلِكَ بِالنَّظَرِ فِي الْأَلْفَاظِ فَنَقُولُ: إِنَّ الْعَادَةَ قَدْ جَرَتْ عِنْدَهُمْ فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ أَنْ يُقَسِّمُوا الْأَلْفَاظَ وَالْأَقَاوِيلَ إِلَى الْمُجْمَلِ وَالنَّصِّ وَالظَّاهِرِ وَالْمُؤَوَّلِ. وَيَنْبَغِي

interpreted beyond that apparent meaning (المؤول). We should examine each division and explain what they signify by each. We say:

أَنْ نَنْظُرَ فِي وَاحِدٍ وَاحِدٍ مِنْ هَذِهِ الْأَقْسَامِ، وَنُبَيِّنَ الْمَعْنَى الَّذِي يَدُلُّونَ عَلَيْهِ فِي وَاحِدٍ وَاحِدٍ مِنْهَا، فَنَقُولُ:

§ 152 Simple expressions, compounds, and complete utterances

1994 Arabic p. 101 · BA §178 · 2015 Arabic p. 236 · French p. 237

Expressions are either simple or compound. A simple expression is a noun, a verb, or a particle. A compound expression is composed of these, with a part of it signifying part of its meaning. Some compound expressions do not independently convey a complete meaning; others do. The latter divide into statements whose composition admits truth or falsehood, and ⟨utterances which do not⟩. The latter include commands, prohibitions, requests, entreaties, and calls.

إِنَّ الْأَلْفَاظَ مِنْهَا مُفْرَدَةٌ وَمِنْهَا مُرَكَّبَةٌ، وَالْمُفْرَدُ إِمَّا اسْمٌ وَإِمَّا فِعْلٌ وَإِمَّا حَرْفٌ. وَالْمُرَكَّبَةُ مَا تَرَكَّبَ مِنْ هَذِهِ وَكَانَ يَدُلُّ جُزْؤُهُ عَلَى جُزْءٍ مِنَ الْمَعْنَى. وَمِنْ هَذِهِ مَا هُوَ غَيْرُ مُسْتَقِلٍّ بِنَفْسِهِ فِي الْفَهْمِ، وَمِنْهَا مَا هُوَ مُسْتَقِلٌّ بِنَفْسِهِ. وَهَذَا يَنْقَسِمُ إِلَى مَا تَرْكِيبُهُ تَرْكِيبٌ يَدْخُلُهُ الصِّدْقُ وَالْكَذِبُ ⟨وَإِلَى مَا لَا يَدْخُلُ ذَلِكَ⟩ فِيهِ، وَهَذَا يَنْقَسِمُ إِلَى أَمْرٍ وَنَهْيٍ وَطَلِبَةٍ وَتَضَرُّعٍ وَنِدَاءٍ.

Editorial notes

N059 [lexical] طَلِبَة, “a request,” is vocalized on the pattern كَلِمَة, following al-Fayyūmī, al-Miṣbāḥ al-munīr, s.v. طلب. This is not طَلَبَة, the plural “students.” The same choice is used in §197. https://ar.wikisource.org/wiki/المصباح_المنير/كتاب_الطاء#طلب

BA15-R04 [textual] Logical speech acts. Restored distinction between compositions that admit truth/falsity and those that do not; commands, prohibitions, entreaties and calls are in the latter class. Bou Akl 2015 Arabic p.236, French p.237, commentary §178; compare Aristotle, De Interpretatione 4. The words between angles are conjectural.

§ 153 Original assignment, transfer, and specialized legal usage

1994 Arabic p. 101 & 102 · BA §179–181 · 2015 Arabic p. 238 · French p. 239

Among expressions—whether nouns, particles, or verbs, simple or compound—some invariably convey one meaning through their forms in every context. These constitute part of what is meant by unambiguous wording (النص) in this discipline; let us call it unambiguous wording in respect of form. Others can convey more than one meaning. If they signify all these meanings equally, so that one can be understood only through proof or an indication, they constitute part of what this discipline calls indeterminate wording (المجمل); let us call it indeterminate wording in respect of form.

وَالْأَلْفَاظُ، سَوَاءٌ كَانَتْ أَسْمَاءً أَوْ حُرُوفًا أَوْ أَفْعَالًا أَوْ مُفْرَدَةً أَوْ مُرَكَّبَةً، مِنْهَا مَا يُفْهَمُ عَنْهَا بِصِيَغِهَا فِي كُلِّ مَوْضِعٍ مَعْنًى وَاحِدٌ أَبَدًا، وَهَذِهِ بَعْضُ مَا يَعْنُونَ بِالنَّصِّ فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ، وَلِنُسَمِّهِ نَحْنُ النَّصَّ مِنْ جِهَةِ الصِّيَغِ. وَمِنْهَا أَلْفَاظٌ يُمْكِنُ أَنْ يُفْهَمَ عَنْهَا أَكْثَرُ مِنْ مَعْنًى وَاحِدٍ، وَهَذِهِ إِذَا كَانَتْ دَلَالَتُهَا عَلَى جَمِيعِ الْمَعَانِي بِالسَّوَاءِ، حَتَّى لَا يُفْهَمَ أَحَدُهَا إِلَّا بِدَلِيلٍ أَوْ قَرِينَةٍ فَهُوَ أَيْضًا بَعْضُ مَا يَعْنُونَ بِالْمُجْمَلِ فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ، وَلِنُسَمِّهِ نَحْنُ مُجْمَلًا مِنْ جِهَةِ الصِّيَغِ.

Some expressions originally apply to one thing and signify it more commonly, but are later transferred to something else because it resembles the original meaning; or one expression is substituted for another, relying on

وَمِنْ هَذِهِ الْأَلْفَاظِ مَا يُقَالُ مِنْ أَوَّلِ الْأَمْرِ عَلَى شَيْءٍ مِنْهَا وَيَكُونُ أَشْهَرَ فِي الدَّلَالَةِ عَلَيْهِ، ثُمَّ يُسْتَعَارُ حِينًا مَا لِشَيْءٍ آخَرَ لِشَبَهٍ بِالْمَعْنَى الْأَوَّلِ، أَوْ يُبْدَلُ بَعْضُهَا مَكَانَ بَعْضٍ اتِّكَالًا فِي

ذَلِكَ عَلَى قَرِينَةٍ تُفْهِمُ الْمَعْنَى الْمُسْتَعَارَ أَوِ الْمُبْدَلَ. وَهَذِهِ إِذَا وَرَدَتْ خِلْوًا مِنَ الْقَرَائِنِ حُمِلَتْ عَلَى وَضْعِهَا الْأَوَّلِ، وَهِيَ بَعْضُ مَا يَعْنُونَ فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ بِالظَّاهِرِ، وَلْنُسَمِّهِ نَحْنُ عَلَى عَادَتِنَا الظَّاهِرَ مِنْ جِهَةِ الصِّيَغِ. وَإِذَا دَلَّتِ الْقَرَائِنُ عَلَى اسْتِعَارَتِهَا أَوْ تَبْدِيلِهَا فَهُوَ بَعْضُ مَا يُسَمَّى فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ مُؤَوَّلًا، وَلْنُسَمِّهِ الْمُؤَوَّلَ مِنْ جِهَةِ الصِّيَغِ.

an indication to disclose the transferred or substituted meaning. When such expressions occur without accompanying indications, they are understood according to their original assignment. These constitute part of what this discipline calls apparent wording (الظاهر); following our practice, let us call it apparent wording in respect of form. When indications establish transfer or substitution, this constitutes part of what the discipline calls interpreted wording (المؤول); let us call it interpreted wording in respect of form.

وَفِي هَذَا الصِّنْفِ تَدْخُلُ الْأَسْمَاءُ الْعُرْفِيَّةُ، وَهِيَ أَسْمَاءُ اسْتُعْمِلَتْ فِي الْوَضْعِ عَلَى أَشْيَاءَ ثُمَّ نُقِلَتْ فِي الشَّرْعِ إِلَى أَشْيَاءَ أُخَرَ لِشَبَهِهَا بِالْمَعَانِي الْأُوَلِ أَوْ لِتَعَلُّقِهَا بِهَا بِوَجْهٍ مِنْ أَوْجُهِ التَّعَلُّقِ. وَهَذِهِ إِذَا وَرَدَتْ فِي الشَّرْعِ كَانَتْ ظَاهِرَةً فِي الْمَعَانِي الشَّرْعِيَّةِ، وَلَمْ تُحْمَلْ عَلَى الْمَعَانِي اللُّغَوِيَّةِ إِلَّا بِالتَّأْوِيلِ.

This class includes terms established by specialised usage: terms originally assigned to certain things, then transferred in the Law to other things because of their resemblance to the original meanings or some relation to them. When these occur in the Law, their apparent meanings are the legal meanings; they are understood in their ordinary linguistic meanings only through interpretation.

§ 154 Omission, addition, and substitution in figurative speech

1994 Arabic p. 102 · BA §182 · 2015 Arabic p. 240 · French p. 241

وَمِنْ هَذِهِ الْأَلْفَاظِ وَالْأَقَاوِيلِ مَا تَدُلُّ بِمَفْهُومَاتِهَا لَا بِصِيَغِهَا وَذَلِكَ لِتَغْيِيرِهَا بِالنَّقْصِ وَالْحَذْفِ أَوِ الزِّيَادَةِ، وَكَذَلِكَ أَيْضًا بِالتَّبْدِيلِ وَالِاسْتِعَارَةِ. وَهَذَا الصِّنْفُ مِنَ الْأَلْفَاظِ يُسَمَّى مَجَازًا.

Some expressions and statements signify through their understood imports, rather than through their verbal forms, because they have been altered by abridgement and omission or addition, and likewise by substitution and transfer. This class of expressions is called figurative usage (مجاز).

§ 155 Clarity and obscurity arise from meaning as well as form

1994 Arabic p. 102 & 103 · BA §182 · 2015 Arabic p. 240 · French p. 241

وَهَذِهِ يُوجَدُ فِيهَا أَيْضًا مَا يُشْبِهُ النَّصَّ وَالْمُجْمَلَ وَالظَّاهِرَ وَالْمُؤَوَّلَ، وَإِنَّمَا يُوجَدُ ذَلِكَ فِيهَا مِنْ جِهَةِ الْقَرَائِنِ لَا مِنْ صِيَغِهَا. فَيَكُونُ إِذًا النَّصُّ الْمُسْتَعْمَلُ فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ يُعْنَى بِهِ صِنْفَانِ: أَحَدُهُمَا مَا كَانَ نَصًّا مِنْ جِهَةِ الصِّيَغِ، وَالثَّانِي مَا

Within these, too, there are counterparts to the unambiguous, the indeterminate, the apparent, and the interpreted; but they possess these characteristics through accompanying indications, not through their forms. Thus ‘unambiguous wording’ as used in this discipline signifies two kinds: what is unambiguous in respect of form and what is unambiguous in respect of understood import. The apparent, the

indeterminate, and the interpreted admit the same division.

كَانَ نَصًّا مِنْ جِهَةِ الْمَفْهُومِ. وَبِمِثْلِ هَذِهِ الْقِسْمَةِ يَنْقَسِمُ الظَّاهِرُ وَالْمُجْمَلُ وَالْمُؤَوَّلُ.

§ 156 A classification useful for legal inference

1994 Arabic p. 103 · BA §183 · 2015 Arabic p. 240 · French p. 241

This division of expressions into these classes seems to be the useful one in this discipline. We should examine them following the practitioners' customary procedure, explain the authority of each as a revealed proof, and investigate statements thought to be uncertain between more than one of these classes. Let us begin with the divisions belonging to an expression by virtue of its form, and among these with simple expressions and expressions compounded as assertions.

وَيُشْبِهُ أَنْ تَكُونَ قِسْمَةُ الْأَلْفَاظِ إِلَى هَذِهِ الْأَصْنَافِ هِيَ النَّافِعَةَ فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ. وَيَنْبَغِي أَنْ نَنْظُرَ فِيهَا عَلَى عَادَتِهِمْ، وَنُبَيِّنَ فِي وَاحِدٍ وَاحِدٍ مِنْهَا كَوْنَهُ دَلِيلًا شَرْعِيًّا، وَنَفْحَصَ عَمَّا يُظَنُّ بِهِ مِنَ الْأَقَاوِيلِ أَنَّهُ مُتَرَدِّدٌ بَيْنَ أَكْثَرَ مِنْ صِنْفٍ وَاحِدٍ مِنْ هَذِهِ الْأَصْنَافِ. وَلْنَبْدَأْ مِنْ هَذِهِ الْأَقْسَامِ بِمَا يُوجَدُ لِلَّفْظِ مِنْ جِهَةِ صِيغَتِهِ وَمِنْ هَذِهِ فِي الْمُفْرَدَةِ وَالْمُرَكَّبَةِ تَرْكِيبَ إِخْبَارٍ.

§ 157 Unambiguous expressions and determinate pronoun reference

1994 Arabic p. 103 · BA §184 · 2015 Arabic p. 240 · French p. 241

As we have said, wording is unambiguous only when it conveys one meaning in every context. This occurs in both simple and compound expressions. Examples of simple expressions are 'human being,' 'horse,' and 'animal.' A compound example is God's saying, 'Say: He is God, One.' In general, this includes every expression composed of unambiguous simple expressions, provided that its pronouns cannot refer to more than one meaning.

وَاللَّفْظُ كَمَا قُلْنَا إِنَّمَا يَكُونُ نَصًّا إِذَا فُهِمَ عَنْهُ فِي كُلِّ مَوْضِعٍ مَعْنًى وَاحِدٌ، وَهَذَا يُوجَدُ فِي الْمُفْرَدِ وَالْمُرَكَّبِ. أَمَّا مِثَالُ الْمُفْرَدِ فَكَالْإِنْسَانِ وَالْفَرَسِ وَالْحَيَوَانِ، وَأَمَّا فِي الْمُرَكَّبِ فَمِثْلُ قَوْلِهِ تَعَالَى: {قُلْ هُوَ اللَّهُ أَحَدٌ} وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ كُلُّ مَا تَرَكَّبَ عَنِ الْمُفْرَدَاتِ النُّصُوصِ، وَلَمْ تَكُنِ الضَّمَائِرُ فِيهِ مُحْتَمِلَةً أَنْ تَعُودَ عَلَى مَعْنًى أَكْثَرَ مِنْ وَاحِدٍ.

Editorial notes

N060 [translation] The quotation is Qur'ān 112:1. 'Every context' translates في كل موضع within Ibn Rushd's own account; it does not add a later hierarchy of degrees of textual clarity.

§ 158 Equivocation: qurʾ, ʿayn, and the marriage bond

1994 Arabic p. 103 · BA §185 · 2015 Arabic p. 240 · French p. 241

Indeterminate wording in respect of form is the opposite. Among simple expressions, an example is ʿayn, used equivocally for a spring of water, the eye of a balance, the eye with which one sees, and other things. A term may even signify a thing and its opposite, as qurʾ sometimes means a

وَالْمُجْمَلُ مِنْ جِهَةِ الصِّيغَةِ فِي مُقَابَلَةِ هَذَا. أَمَّا فِي الْأَلْفَاظِ الْمُفْرَدَةِ فَكَمِثْلِ اسْمِ الْعَيْنِ الَّذِي يُقَالُ بِاشْتِرَاكٍ عَلَى عَيْنِ الْمَاءِ، وَعَلَى عَيْنِ الْمِيزَانِ، وَالْعَيْنِ الَّتِي يُبْصَرُ بِهَا، وَغَيْرِ ذَلِكَ. وَرُبَّمَا قِيلَ عَلَى الشَّيْءِ وَضِدِّهِ كَالْقُرْءِ الَّذِي يُعْنَى بِهِ مَرَّةً

period of purity and sometimes menstruation. Indeterminacy in composition occurs in expressions compounded from such terms, or where the pronouns connecting the statement are ambiguous. An example is His saying, blessed and exalted, ‘Or the one in whose hand is the marriage bond remits it’: the pronoun here may refer either to the guardian or to the husband.

الطُّهْرُ وَمَرَّةً الْحَيْضُ. وَأَمَّا الْمُجْمَلُ مِنْ جِهَةِ التَّرْكِيبِ فَمَا تَرَكَّبَ عَنْ مِثْلِ هَذِهِ الْأَلْفَاظِ، أَوْ كَانَتِ الضَّمَائِرُ الَّتِي يَرْتَبِطُ بِهَا الْقَوْلُ مُحْتَمِلَةً، كَقَوْلِهِ تَبَارَكَ وَتَعَالَى: {أَوْ يَعْفُوَ الَّذِي بِيَدِهِ عُقْدَةُ النِّكَاحِ}. فَإِنَّ الضَّمِيرَ مُحْتَمِلٌ هَهُنَا أَنْ يَعُودَ عَلَى الْوَلِيِّ أَوِ النَّاكِحِ.

Editorial notes

N061 [translation] The quotation is Qur’ān 2:237. ‘Eye of a balance’ preserves the technical example عين الميزان rather than replacing it with an unrelated modern meaning of ‘ayn.

§ 159 Clarification encompasses every valid means of understanding

1994 Arabic p. 103 & 104 · BA §186 · 2015 Arabic p. 242 · French p. 243

In this discipline they apply the term ‘clarification’ to everything through which rulings may be established and understanding produced: an expression’s form, its understood import, and the other things enumerated earlier, according to their degrees in producing assent (التصديق). We shall discuss the authority of each as a revealed proof.

وَاسْمُ الْبَيَانِ يَقَعُ عِنْدَهُمْ فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ عَلَى كُلِّ مَا يُمْكِنُ أَنْ تُثْبَتَ بِهِ الْأَحْكَامُ، وَيَقَعُ فِي الْأَفْهَامِ، مِنْ صِيغَةِ لَفْظٍ أَوْ مَفْهُومِهِ، وَمَا سِوَى ذَلِكَ مِمَّا عَدَدْنَاهُ قَبْلُ عَلَى مَرَاتِبِهِ فِي إِفَادَةِ التَّصْدِيقِ. وَسَنَقُولُ فِي كَوْنِ وَاحِدٍ وَاحِدٍ مِنْهَا دَلِيلًا شَرْعِيًّا.

§ 160 May clarification be delayed when action is required?

1994 Arabic p. 104 · BA §187–188 · 2015 Arabic p. 242 · French p. 243

Indeterminate wording is not clarification, by consensus, and establishes no ruling at all. A question arises here: may an instruction be addressed through indeterminate wording pending clarification, or through apparent wording pending specification, at the time when clarification is needed? This is the question they designate as the permissibility of delaying clarification beyond the time of need. Some permit it, while others forbid it. Our account is as follows.

فَأَمَّا الْمُجْمَلُ فَلَيْسَ بِبَيَانٍ بِإِجْمَاعٍ، وَلَا يَثْبُتُ بِهِ حُكْمٌ أَصْلًا. وَيَتَطَرَّقُ إِلَى هَذَا مَسْأَلَةٌ وَهِيَ: هَلْ تَجُوزُ الْمُخَاطَبَةُ عَلَى مَعْنَى الْأَمْرِ بِالْمُجْمَلِ حَتَّى يَرِدَ الْبَيَانُ، أَوْ بِالظَّاهِرِ حَتَّى يَرِدَ التَّخْصِيصُ، وَذَلِكَ فِي وَقْتِ الْحَاجَةِ؟ وَهَذِهِ الْمَسْأَلَةُ هِيَ الَّتِي يَرْسُمُونَهَا بِجَوَازِ تَأْخِيرِ الْبَيَانِ عَنْ وَقْتِ الْحَاجَةِ. وَقَدْ أَجَازَ ذَلِكَ قَوْمٌ، وَمَنَعَهُ آخَرُونَ. وَنَحْنُ نَقُولُ فِي ذَلِكَ:

Editorial notes

N062 [textual] The print at p. 104 says عن وقت الحاجة (‘beyond the time of need’), whereas §163 repeatedly distinguishes delay إلى وقت الحاجة (‘until the time of need’) and ends by denying any dispute over delay beyond it. The translation preserves the edition’s distinct prepositions rather than silently regularising the problem’s label.

§ 161 How speakers rely on context and hearers seek clarification

1994 Arabic p. 104 & 105 · BA §189 · 2015 Arabic p. 242 · French p. 243

وَهَذِهِ الْمَسْأَلَةُ الْفَحْصُ عَنْهَا لُغَوِيٌّ، فَلِذَلِكَ يَنْبَغِي أَنْ نَجْعَلَ نَظَرَنَا فِيهَا مِنَ الْجِهَةِ الَّتِي تَنْظُرُ فِي اللُّغَةِ فَنَقُولُ: إِنَّهُ إِذَا اسْتُقْرِئَ كَلَامُ الْعَرَبِ ظَهَرَ مِنْ أَمْرِهِمْ أَنَّهُمْ لَا يُخَاطِبُونَ بِالِاسْمِ الْمُشْتَرَكِ إِلَّا حَيْثُ يَدُلُّ الدَّلِيلُ عَلَى الْمَعْنَى الْمَقْصُودِ مِنْ سَائِرِ مَا يُقَالُ عَلَيْهِ ذَلِكَ الِاسْمُ، إِمَّا لِقَرِينَةٍ حَاضِرَةٍ مُبْتَذَلَةٍ، أَوْ مَوْجُودَةٍ فِي نَفْسِ اللَّفْظِ. فَإِنَّ قَوْلَ اللَّهِ تَبَارَكَ وَتَعَالَى: {فَأَصْبَحَتْ كَالصَّرِيمِ} قَدْ تَقَدَّمَ مِنْ صِفَاتِ الْمُشَبَّهِ مَا يَدُلُّ عَلَى أَنَّ الصَّرِيمَ هَهُنَا اللَّيْلُ. وَكَذَلِكَ إِذَا أَرَادُوا بِالصَّرِيمِ الصُّبْحَ قَالُوا ضَوْءُ الصَّرِيمِ، وَمَا أَشْبَهَ ذَلِكَ.

Inquiry into this question is linguistic, so we should examine it from the standpoint appropriate to language. Surveying Arabic speech shows that Arabs address others with an equivocal term only where evidence indicates the intended meaning from among its other meanings, whether through a readily available contextual indication or something present in the wording itself. In God's saying, blessed and exalted, 'Then it became like al-ṣarīm,' preceding descriptions of the thing compared indicate that al-ṣarīm here means night. Similarly, when they mean morning by al-ṣarīm, they say 'the light of al-ṣarīm,' or something comparable.

وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَالْمُخَاطَبَةُ بِالْأَلْفَاظِ الْمُجْمَلَةِ وَالْمُخَاطِبُ يَعْلَمُ قَطْعًا أَنَّهَا مُجْمَلَةٌ مِمَّا لَمْ يَقَعْ بَعْدُ، وَلَوْ وَقَعَ لَكَانَ هَذْرًا، اللَّهُمَّ إِلَّا أَنَّ الْمُخَاطِبَ بِالِاسْمِ الْمُجْمَلِ قَدْ يُخَاطِبُ بِهِ وَيَغْلِبُ عَلَى ظَنِّهِ فَهْمُ ذَلِكَ عَنْهُ اتِّكَالًا مِنْهُ عَلَى الْقَرَائِنِ وَلَا يَفْهَمُ ذَلِكَ عَنْهُ الْمُخَاطَبُ، فَهُنَا يَصْلُحُ الِاسْتِفْهَامُ مِنَ الْمُخَاطَبِ وَالْبَيَانُ مِنَ الْمُخَاطِبِ. وَإِنْ رَأَى الْمُخَاطَبُ أَنَّ اقْتِضَاءَ ذَلِكَ خُوطِبَ بِهِ لَمْ يُطْلَبْ مِنْهُ فِي ذَلِكَ الْوَقْتِ، أَخَّرَ السُّؤَالَ إِلَى وَقْتِ الْحَاجَةِ فَيَتَأَخَّرُ الْبَيَانُ.

In general, addressing someone with indeterminate expressions while knowing with certainty that they remain indeterminate has never occurred; if it did, it would be idle speech. A speaker may, however, use an indeterminate term believing it very likely that he will be understood, relying on accompanying indications, while the addressee fails to understand him. The addressee may then seek clarification, and the speaker provide it. If the addressee sees that fulfilment of what he was addressed with is not required at that moment, he postpones his question until the time of need, and clarification is correspondingly delayed.

فَأَمَّا أَنْ يَرِدَ الْخِطَابُ بِالْأَلْفَاظِ الْمُجْمَلَةِ، وَالْمُخَاطِبُ يَعْلَمُ قَطْعًا أَنَّهَا مُجْمَلَةٌ، وَأَنَّ الْمُخَاطَبَ لَا يَفْهَمُ عَنْهُ شَيْئًا تَعْوِيلًا مِنَ الْمُخَاطِبِ عَلَى أَنَّهُ سَيُبَيِّنُ ذَلِكَ الْمَعْنَى الْمَقْصُودَ عِنْدَ وَقْتِ الْحَاجَةِ، فَهُوَ شَيْءٌ كَمَا قُلْنَا لَمْ يَقَعْ مِنْ عَرَبِيٍّ قَطُّ وَلَا مِنْ غَيْرِهِ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَلَيْسَ تَقَعُ الْمُخَاطَبَةُ بِالْأَلْفَاظِ الْمُجْمَلَةِ اللَّهُمَّ إِلَّا أَنْ يُرَادَ بِهَا اللُّغْزُ وَالِاسْتِهْزَاءُ لِطَبِيعَةِ الْمُخَاطَبِ. وَكَذَلِكَ مَا كَانَ مُجْمَلًا مِنْ جِهَةِ مَفْهُومِهِ. وَأَمَّا الشَّرْعُ فَإِنَّهُ لَمْ يَتَصَرَّفْ فِي ذَلِكَ بِوَضْعٍ عُرْفِيٍّ.

But for a speaker to address someone in indeterminate expressions, knowing with certainty that they are indeterminate and that the addressee understands nothing by them, while relying on explaining the intended meaning when the time of need arrives—this, as we have said, has never occurred among Arabs or anyone else. In general, such indeterminate address occurs only when a riddle or mockery of the addressee's disposition is intended. The same holds of wording indeterminate in its understood import. The Law has introduced no specialised convention altering this.

Editorial notes

N063 [grammar] The unvocalized المُخَاطَب can designate the speaker or addressee depending on its reading. The clause وَالْمُخَاطَبُ يَعْلَمُ قَطْعًا أَنَّهَا مُجْمَلَةٌ concerns knowledge that the expression is indeterminate; the translation assigns the roles according to the surrounding argument.

N064 [translation] The quotation is Qur’ān 68:20. Al-ṣarīm is retained because the example depends on a single Arabic expression having opposed temporal meanings.

BA15-I06 [interpretive] Communicative intention. Bou Akl 2015 intro pp.70–76 reads discussion of delaying clarification as a theory of ordinary speakers who intend their addressees to understand one determinate sense. The resulting disagreement concerns accessibility of a prior intended meaning, not a literal indeterminate divine volition.

§ 162 A figurative meaning needs an intelligible indication

1994 Arabic p. 105 · BA §190 · 2015 Arabic p. 244 · French p. 245

Apparent wording in respect of form also has, in my view, the same status as an equivocal term. This concerns what originally applies to something and has its apparent meaning in it, but is later transferred to another thing because of resemblance to the first meaning or some relation to it. When an Arab uses the word ‘sky’ without qualification, he is invariably understood to mean the starry sky. If he means rain, he indicates this through a contextual clue, as in ‘We kept treading the sky until we reached you,’ or ‘When the sky falls upon a people’s land.’

وَأَمَّا الظَّاهِرُ أَيْضًا مِنْ جِهَةِ الصِّيغَةِ فَحُكْمُهُ عِنْدِي حُكْمُ الِاسْمِ الْمُشْتَرَكِ، وَذَلِكَ مِنْهُ فِيمَا قِيلَ مِنْ أَوَّلِ الْأَمْرِ عَلَى شَيْءٍ مَا، وَكَانَ ظَاهِرًا فِيهِ، ثُمَّ اسْتُعِيرَ وَقْتًا مَا لِشَيْءٍ مَا آخَرَ لِشَبَهٍ بِالْمَعْنَى الْأَوَّلِ أَوْ لِتَعَلُّقٍ بِهِ بِوَجْهٍ مِنْ أَوْجُهِ التَّعَلُّقِ. فَإِنَّ الْعَرَبِيَّ إِذَا أَطْلَقَ لَفْظَ السَّمَاءِ لَمْ يُفْهَمْ عَنْهُ أَبَدًا إِلَّا السَّمَاءُ الْمَكْوَكَبَةُ، فَإِذَا أَرَادَ بِذَلِكَ الْمَطَرَ دَلَّ عَلَى ذَلِكَ بِقَرِينَةٍ كَقَوْلِهِمْ: «مَا زِلْنَا نَطَأُ السَّمَاءَ حَتَّى أَتَيْنَاكُمْ»، وَكَقَوْلِهِمْ «إِذَا سَقَطَ السَّمَاءُ بِأَرْضِ قَوْمٍ».

Otherwise, whenever such terms are used without qualification while something other than their established meaning is intended, this can occur only as an error; if deliberate, it is misleading. This concerns the time of need. If it is not yet the time of need, what benefit is there in speech that makes a person believe the opposite of what the subsequent clarification will convey? Apparent wording in respect of understood import seems to stand on the same footing.

وَإِلَّا مَتَى خُوطِبَ بِمِثْلِ هَذِهِ الْأَسْمَاءِ وَأُطْلِقَتْ إِطْلَاقًا، وَالْمُرَادُ بِهَا غَيْرُ مَا هِيَ رَاتِبَةٌ عَلَيْهِ، لَمْ يَقَعْ ذَلِكَ إِلَّا غَلَطًا، وَإِنْ قُصِدَ ذَلِكَ كَانَ تَغْلِيطًا. هَذَا إِذَا كَانَ وَقْتُ الْحَاجَةِ. وَأَمَّا إِنْ لَمْ يَكُنْ وَقْتُ الْحَاجَةِ فَأَيُّ فَائِدَةٍ لِمُخَاطَبَةٍ يَعْتَقِدُ الْإِنْسَانُ مِنْهَا خِلَافَ مَا يَأْتِي بِهِ الْبَيَانُ. وَيُشْبِهُ أَنْ يَكُونَ كَذَلِكَ الظَّاهِرُ مِنْ جِهَةِ الْمَفْهُومِ.

§ 163 Partial knowledge can precede a more specific explanation

1994 Arabic p. 105 & 106 & 107 · BA §191–194 · 2015 Arabic p. 246 · French p. 247

As for apparent wording involving substitution (الإبدال)—general expressions by which something falling under them is intended—addressing people with these expressions without qualification or an accompanying indication identifying the specific meaning intended, deliberately postponing clarification until the

وَأَمَّا الظَّاهِرُ مِنْ جِهَةِ الْإِبْدَالِ وَذَلِكَ مِنْهُ فِيمَا يَأْتِي مِنَ الْأَلْفَاظِ الْعَامَّةِ الَّتِي الْمُرَادُ بِهَا مَا تَحْتَهَا، فَالْمُخَاطَبَةُ بِهَا دُونَ أَنْ تُقَيَّدَ أَوْ تَقْتَرِنَ بِهَا قَرِينَةٌ تَدُلُّ عَلَى فَهْمِ ذَلِكَ الْمَعْنَى الْمُخَصَّصِ قَصْدًا بِتَأْخِيرِ الْبَيَانِ فِيهَا إِلَى وَقْتِ الْحَاجَةِ،

time of need, does occur in language and in the Law. This is so when the addressees understand from contextual indications that there remains a question to ask, and that the speaker did not intend to confine himself to what he has already said.

وَاقِعٌ لُغَةً وَشَرْعًا، إِذَا فَهِمَ الْمُخَاطَبُونَ مِنْ قَرَائِنِ الْأَحْوَالِ أَنَّ هَهُنَا أَيْضًا مَوْضِعًا لِلسُّؤَالِ، وَأَنَّ الْمُخَاطِبَ لَمْ يَكُنْ قَصْدُهُ الِاقْتِصَارَ عَلَى مَا خَاطَبَ بِهِ.

God's saying, mighty and majestic, 'God commands you to slaughter a cow,' was of this kind. They kept asking, and the answers supplied specifications until the particular cow was identified for them. If the addressees do not know from contextual indications that there is a question to ask, this does not occur. It is permissible with general wording, but not with indeterminate wording or the first kind of apparent wording, because someone who knows a thing through a universal description (كلي) knows it in some respect, while awaiting a more specific knowledge of it.

وَعَلَى ذَلِكَ وَرَدَ قَوْلُهُ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ: {إِنَّ اللَّهَ يَأْمُرُكُمْ أَنْ تَذْبَحُوا بَقَرَةً} فَإِنَّهُمْ لَمْ يَزَالُوا يَسْأَلُونَ وَالْجَوَابُ يَرِدُ بِالتَّخْصِيصِ إِلَى أَنْ تَعَيَّنَتْ لَهُمُ الْبَقَرَةُ الْمَخْصُوصَةُ. فَأَمَّا إِذَا لَمْ يَعْلَمِ الْمُخَاطَبُونَ مِنْ قَرَائِنِ الْأَحْوَالِ أَنَّ هَهُنَا مَوْضِعًا لِلسُّؤَالِ فَذَلِكَ غَيْرُ وَاقِعٍ. وَإِنَّمَا سَاغَ مِثْلُ هَذَا فِي الْعَامِّ، وَلَمْ يَسُغْ فِي الْمُجْمَلِ، وَلَا فِي الْجِنْسِ الْأَوَّلِ مِنَ الظَّاهِرِ لِأَنَّ مَنْ عَرَفَ الشَّيْءَ بِأَمْرٍ كُلِّيٍّ فَقَدْ عَرَفَهُ بِوَجْهٍ مَا، مَعَ أَنَّهُ يَنْتَظِرُ مَعْرِفَتَهُ بِوَجْهٍ أَخَصَّ.

Statements composed of such descriptions are often clearer than names, or indispensable for things that have no names, as with the cow they were commanded to slaughter. On this basis, terms established by specialised usage may be used before the meanings signified by them are understood, relying on the addressees' knowledge that those terms signify meanings additional to their original assignment. The benefit is a resolve to perform the command, while clarification is postponed until the time of need—as with commanding almsgiving and pilgrimage before they become obligatory.

وَكَثِيرًا مَا تَكُونُ الْأَقَاوِيلُ الْمُؤَلَّفَةُ عَنْ مِثْلِ هَذِهِ أَبْيَنَ مِنَ الْأَسْمَاءِ أَوْ مُضْطَرًّا إِلَيْهَا فِيمَا لَمْ تَكُنْ لَهَا أَسْمَاءٌ، كَمَا اتَّفَقَ فِي الْبَقَرَةِ الْمَأْمُورِ بِذَبْحِهَا. وَعَلَى هَذَا تَجُوزُ الْمُخَاطَبَةُ بِالْأَسْمَاءِ الْعُرْفِيَّةِ قَبْلَ فَهْمِ الْمَعَانِي الَّتِي يَدُلُّ عَلَيْهَا بِتِلْكَ الْأَسْمَاءِ، اتِّكَالًا عَلَى أَنَّ الْمُخَاطَبِينَ يَعْلَمُونَ أَنَّ تِلْكَ الْأَسْمَاءَ تَدُلُّ عَلَى مَعَانٍ زَائِدَةٍ إِلَى مَا كَانَتْ تَدُلُّ عَلَيْهِ فِي الْوَضْعِ الْأَوَّلِ، وَفَائِدَةُ ذَلِكَ الْعَزْمُ عَلَى الْأَمْرِ وَيَتَأَخَّرُ الْبَيَانُ إِلَى وَقْتِ الْحَاجَةِ، كَالْأَمْرِ بِالزَّكَاةِ وَالْحَجِّ قَبْلَ وُجُوبِهِمَا.

If you examine the cases cited by those who permit delaying clarification until the time of need without distinguishing among cases, you will find them included in the classes we have enumerated. Likewise, if you examine the evidence cited by those who [do not] permit it, you will find that it concerns wholly indeterminate wording admitting alternatives, and the first kind of apparent wording. In general, both positions, taken without qualification, are partly false, as positions supported by an induction that does not exhaust all particulars are liable to be false. That

وَإِذَا أَنْتَ تَصَفَّحْتَ الْأَشْيَاءَ الَّتِي يَحْتَجُّ بِهَا مَنْ يُجَوِّزُ تَأْخِيرَ الْبَيَانِ إِلَى وَقْتِ الْحَاجَةِ مِنْ غَيْرِ تَفْصِيلٍ وَجَدْتَهَا دَاخِلَةً تَحْتَ هَذِهِ الَّتِي عَدَدْنَاهَا، وَكَذَلِكَ إِذَا نَظَرْتَ إِلَى مَا يَحْتَجُّ بِهِ مَنْ ⟨لَا⟩ يُجَوِّزُهُ وَجَدْتَ ذَلِكَ إِنَّمَا هُوَ فِي الْمُجْمَلِ الْمَحْضِ الِاحْتِمَالِ، وَفِي الصِّنْفِ الْأَوَّلِ مِنَ الظَّاهِرِ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَكِلَا الرَّأْيَيْنِ إِذَا أُخِذَا بِإِطْلَاقٍ كَاذِبٌ بِالْجُزْءِ، عَلَى مَا مِنْ شَأْنِهَا أَنْ تَكْذِبَ الْآرَاءُ الْمُصَحَّحَةُ بِالِاسْتِقْرَاءِ الَّذِي

clarification may not be delayed beyond the time of need, however, is undisputed.

لَا تُسْتَوْفَى فِيهِ جَمِيعُ الْجُزْئِيَّاتِ. فَأَمَّا أَنَّ الْبَيَانَ لَا يَتَأَخَّرُ عَنْ وَقْتِ الْحَاجَةِ فَذَلِكَ مَا لَا خِلَافَ فِيهِ.

Having discussed indeterminate and unambiguous wording, let us turn to apparent and interpreted wording.

وَإِذَا قُلْنَا فِي الْمُجْمَلِ وَالنَّصِّ، فَلْنَقُلْ فِي الظَّاهِرِ وَالْمُؤَوَّلِ.

Editorial notes

N065 [textual] Bou Akl 2015 §194 (Arabic p.248, French p.249) restores the omitted negative (lā) in "those who do NOT permit postponing clarification". The earlier English supplied the negation in square brackets while the Arabic still lacked it; both columns now register the conjectural restoration.

N066 [translation] The quoted command is Qur'ān 2:67. Until the time of need (إلى) and beyond it (عن) are distinguished throughout, especially in the closing sentence on p. 107.

BA15-R05 [textual] The negative in the second contrasted view of postponed clarification is conjectural, but required for coherence. Bou Akl 2015 Arabic p.248, French p.249, commentary §194. Older English included a bracketed not; Arabic is now aligned.

§ 164 Transfer through resemblance, relation, and indirect expression

1994 Arabic p. 107 · BA §196 · 2015 Arabic p. 250 · French p. 251

As we have said, apparent wording in respect of form is of two kinds. The first comprises expressions originally applied to one thing, then transferred to another because of resemblance or some relation between them. Transfer through resemblance is exemplified by calling a bed a 'nest'; transfer through another relation, by calling vegetation 'dew,' because it arises from dew. This class includes indirect expression, such as referring to excrement as 'the low ground' and sexual intercourse as 'touching.'

وَالظَّاهِرُ كَمَا قُلْنَا مِنْ جِهَةِ الصِّيغَةِ قِسْمَانِ: أَحَدُهُمَا الْأَلْفَاظُ الْمَقُولَةُ مِنْ أَوَّلِ الْأَمْرِ عَلَى شَيْءٍ ثُمَّ اسْتُعِيرَتْ لِغَيْرِهِ لِتَشَابُهٍ بَيْنَهُمَا أَوْ تَعَلُّقٍ بِوَجْهٍ مِنْ أَوْجُهِ التَّعَلُّقِ. أَمَّا الَّذِي اسْتُعِيرَ لِتَشَابُهٍ بَيْنَهُمَا فَمِثْلُ تَسْمِيَتِهِمُ الْفِرَاشَ عُشًّا، وَأَمَّا الَّذِي اسْتُعِيرَ لِتَعَلُّقِهِ بِوَجْهٍ آخَرَ فَكَتَسْمِيَتِهِمُ النَّبْتَ نَدًى، لِأَنَّهُ عَنِ النَّدَى يَكُونُ. وَمِنْ هَذَا الصِّنْفِ الْكِنَايَةُ، كَتَعْبِيرِهِمْ عَنِ الرَّجِيعِ بِالْغَائِطِ وَعَنِ النِّكَاحِ بِالْمَسِيسِ.

§ 165 Substituting a universal for a particular, or the reverse

1994 Arabic p. 107 · BA §197 · 2015 Arabic p. 250 · French p. 251

The second class of apparent expressions consists of substituted expressions. By substitution here we mean placing the universal (الكلي) in place of the particular (الجزئي), or the particular in place of the universal. Strictly speaking, substitution applies to all transferred expressions, which are then divided into the classes we have enumerated. We have nevertheless chosen to reserve the name 'substitution' (التبديل) for this class, namely the universal and the particular, although in reality everything substituted is

وَأَمَّا الْقِسْمُ الثَّانِي مِنْ أَقْسَامِ الْأَلْفَاظِ الظَّاهِرَةِ فَهِيَ الْمُبْدَلَةُ، وَنَعْنِي هَهُنَا بِالْمُبْدَلَةِ إِبْدَالَ الْكُلِّيِّ مَكَانَ الْجُزْئِيِّ، وَالْجُزْئِيِّ مَكَانَ الْكُلِّيِّ. وَعَلَى التَّحْقِيقِ فَالتَّبْدِيلُ يَلْحَقُ جَمِيعَ الْأَلْفَاظِ الْمُسْتَعَارَةِ، ثُمَّ تَنْقَسِمُ هَذِهِ الْأَقْسَامَ الَّتِي أَحْصَيْنَاهَا، لَكِنْ رَأَيْنَا أَنْ نَخُصَّ هَذَا الصِّنْفَ بِاسْمِ التَّبْدِيلِ، أَعْنِي الْكُلِّيَّ وَالْجُزْئِيَّ، وَإِنْ كَانَ فِي الْحَقِيقَةِ كُلُّ مُبْدَلٍ مُسْتَعَارٌ وَكُلُّ مُسْتَعَارٍ مُبْدَلٌ.

transferred, and everything transferred is substituted.

Editorial notes

N067 [translation] Ibdāl/tabdīl is translated “substitution” in accordance with the explicit definition at p. 107. The universal/particular relation is preserved throughout the following discussion.

§ 166 Why apparent meanings bind and interpretation needs proportionate proof

1994 Arabic p. 107 & 108 · BA §198–199 · 2015 Arabic p. 250 · French p. 251

When these two classes occur without qualification in the Law, they are understood in their apparent meanings until evidence indicates otherwise—that is, indicates that they should be understood in a transferred meaning, which is what is called interpretation (تأويل). That these expressions have these apparent significations is known necessarily through a survey of language. Their authority as revealed proof is known through the Companions’ consensus on adopting apparent meanings and through the fact that the Law has introduced no specialised convention altering this.

وَهَذَانِ الصِّنْفَانِ إِذَا وَرَدَا بِإِطْلَاقٍ فِي الشَّرْعِ حُمِلَا عَلَى ظَاهِرِهِمَا حَتَّى يَدُلَّ الدَّلِيلُ عَلَى غَيْرِ ذَلِكَ، وَهُوَ حَمْلُهُمَا عَلَى الْمَعْنَى الْمُسْتَعَارِ، وَهُوَ الْمُسَمَّى تَأْوِيلًا. وَكَوْنُ هَذِهِ الْأَلْفَاظِ ظَاهِرَةً فِي هَذِهِ الدَّلَالَاتِ يُعْرَفُ ذَلِكَ ضَرُورَةً مِنَ اسْتِقْرَاءِ اللُّغَةِ. وَكَوْنُهَا دَلِيلًا شَرْعِيًّا يُعْرَفُ بِإِجْمَاعِ الصَّحَابَةِ عَلَى الْأَخْذِ بِالظَّوَاهِرِ، وَأَنَّ الشَّرْعَ لَمْ يَتَصَرَّفْ فِي ذَلِكَ بِوَضْعٍ عُرْفِيٍّ.

Moreover, if we did not adopt apparent meanings, many acts of worship would lapse, because unambiguous texts (النصوص) are extremely scarce. The necessity calling for action upon solitary reports is here the necessity calling for action upon the apparent meanings of expressions. These expressions admit degrees of apparentness: the stronger an expression’s apparent meaning, the stronger the evidence required to interpret it otherwise; conversely, the weaker its apparent meaning, the slighter the evidence sufficient for interpretation. Let us give three examples, one at the first degree, a second at the intermediate degree, and a third at the last degree, for both classes of apparent wording.

وَأَيْضًا فَلَوْ لَمْ نَصِرْ إِلَى الْأَخْذِ بِالظَّوَاهِرِ لَكَانَ سَيَبْطُلُ كَثِيرٌ مِنَ الْعِبَادَاتِ لِأَنَّ النُّصُوصَ مُعْوِزَةٌ جِدًّا. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ الضَّرُورَةُ الدَّاعِيَةُ إِلَى الْعَمَلِ بِأَخْبَارِ الْآحَادِ هِيَ هَهُنَا الضَّرُورَةُ الدَّاعِيَةُ إِلَى الْعَمَلِ بِظَوَاهِرِ الْأَلْفَاظِ. وَهَذِهِ الْأَلْفَاظُ الظَّاهِرَةُ لَهَا مَرَاتِبُ فِي الظُّهُورِ. وَكُلَّمَا كَانَ اللَّفْظُ أَظْهَرَ احْتِيجَ فِي تَأْوِيلِهِ إِلَى دَلِيلٍ أَقْوَى، وَبِالْعَكْسِ مَتَى كَانَ اللَّفْظُ قَلِيلَ الظُّهُورِ انْصَرَفَ إِلَى التَّأْوِيلِ بِأَيْسَرِ دَلِيلٍ. وَلْنَضْرِبْ فِي ذَلِكَ ثَلَاثَةَ أَمْثِلَةٍ، وَاحِدًا فِي الرُّتْبَةِ الْأُولَى وَثَانِيًا فِي الرُّتْبَةِ الْوُسْطَى وَثَالِثًا فِي الرُّتْبَةِ الْأَخِيرَةِ، وَذَلِكَ فِي صِنْفَيِ الظَّاهِرِ جَمِيعًا.

§ 167 Three degrees: clothing, the balance, and touching women

1994 Arabic p. 108 · BA §200–202 · 2015 Arabic p. 252 · French p. 253

At the first degree among transferred terms is the interpretation of God’s saying, mighty and

majestic, ‘Children of Adam, We have sent down upon you clothing to cover your nakedness,’ as meaning rain by ‘clothing.’ Such an interpretation requires evidence, since ‘clothing’ very strongly signifies what covers a person. The second degree is exemplified by interpreting God’s saying, ‘We sent Our messengers with clear proofs and sent down with them the Book and the balance,’ as meaning justice by ‘the balance.’

أَمَّا الَّذِي فِي الْمَرْتَبَةِ الْأُولَى مِنَ الْأَسْمَاءِ الْمُسْتَعَارَةِ فَمِثْلُ مَنْ حَمَلَ قَوْلَهُ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ: {يَا بَنِي آدَمَ قَدْ أَنْزَلْنَا عَلَيْكُمْ لِبَاسًا يُوَارِي سَوْءَاتِكُمْ} عَلَى أَنَّ اللِّبَاسَ هَهُنَا الْمَطَرُ، فَإِنَّ مِثْلَ هَذَا التَّأْوِيلِ يَحْتَاجُ إِلَى دَلِيلٍ فَإِنَّ اللِّبَاسَ ظَاهِرٌ جِدًّا فِيمَا يُوَارِي الْإِنْسَانَ. وَالثَّانِي مِثْلُ حَمْلِ قَوْلِهِ تَعَالَى: {لَقَدْ أَرْسَلْنَا رُسُلَنَا بِالْبَيِّنَاتِ وَأَنْزَلْنَا مَعَهُمُ الْكِتَابَ وَالْمِيزَانَ} عَلَى أَنَّ الْمِيزَانَ هَهُنَا الْعَدْلُ.

The third degree is exemplified by God’s saying, ‘Or you have touched women.’ Some jurists understand this as touching with the hand; others as sexual intercourse. Although its apparent meaning is touching with the hand, it can quite plausibly mean intercourse, since this accords with Arab usage, and God Most High has referred indirectly to intercourse by massīs, which has the meaning of touching.

وَالثَّالِثُ مِثْلُ قَوْلِهِ تَعَالَى: {أَوْ لَامَسْتُمُ النِّسَاءَ} فَإِنَّ بَعْضَ الْفُقَهَاءِ حَمَلَهُ عَلَى اللَّمْسِ الَّذِي بِالْيَدِ، وَحَمَلَهُ بَعْضُهُمْ عَلَى الْجِمَاعِ. وَهَذَا وَإِنْ كَانَ الظَّاهِرُ فِيهِ اللَّمْسَ بِالْيَدِ فَقَدْ يَحْتَمِلُ أَنْ يُرَادَ بِهِ الْجِمَاعُ احْتِمَالًا قَرِيبًا، إِذْ ذَلِكَ مِنْ عَادَةِ الْعَرَبِ، وَقَدْ كَنَى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَنِ الْجِمَاعِ بِالْمَسِيسِ، وَهُوَ فِي مَعْنَى اللَّمْسِ.

Editorial notes

N068 [translation] The quotations are Qur’ān 7:26, 57:25, and 4:43/5:6. The three degrees concern the strength of an expression’s apparent meaning and the evidence needed to depart from it.

§ 168 Established usage, ambiguity, and certain interpretation

1994 Arabic p. 108 & 109 · BA §203 · 2015 Arabic p. 254 · French p. 255

In general, degrees of apparentness in expressions depend on frequency or rarity of use. If use in the transferred meaning becomes as frequent as use in the original meaning, the expression stands equivocally between the first and second meanings and is indeterminate. The less frequently it is used in the second meaning, the more apparent it is in the first.

وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَمَرَاتِبُ الظُّهُورِ فِي الْأَلْفَاظِ إِنَّمَا هُوَ بِحَسَبِ كَثْرَةِ الِاسْتِعْمَالِ وَقِلَّتِهِ، فَإِنْ بَلَغَتْ كَثْرَةُ الِاسْتِعْمَالِ فِي الْمَعْنَى الَّذِي اسْتُعِيرَ لَهُ أَنْ يُعَادِلَ اسْتِعْمَالَهُ فِي الْمَعْنَى الْأَوَّلِ بَقِيَ اللَّفْظُ بَيْنَ الْأَوَّلِ وَالثَّانِي مُشْتَرَكًا وَمُجْمَلًا، وَمَهْمَا نَقَصَتْ كَثْرَةُ الِاسْتِعْمَالِ فِي الثَّانِي كَانَ أَظْهَرَ فِي الْأَوَّلِ.

Interpretation of apparent wording may be self-evident or may require an explanation; it may amount to predominant probability or to certainty. A self-evident and certain example is their saying, ‘We kept treading the sky until we reached you.’ An example made clear by decisive proof is God’s saying, ‘The All-Merciful is established over the Throne’: decisive proof has

وَرُبَّمَا كَانَ التَّأْوِيلُ فِي الظَّاهِرِ بَيِّنًا بِنَفْسِهِ، وَرُبَّمَا احْتِيجَ إِلَى تَبْيِينٍ، وَرُبَّمَا كَانَ ذَلِكَ ظَنًّا أَكْثَرِيًّا، وَرُبَّمَا كَانَ قَطْعًا. مِثَالُ مَا كَانَ مِنْ ذَلِكَ بَيِّنًا بِنَفْسِهِ وَكَانَ قَطْعًا قَوْلُهُمْ: «مَا زِلْنَا نَطَأُ السَّمَاءَ حَتَّى أَتَيْنَاكُمْ»، وَمِثَالُ مَا كَانَ مِنْ ذَلِكَ بَيِّنًا بِدَلِيلٍ قَطْعِيٍّ قَوْلُهُ تَعَالَى: {الرَّحْمَانُ عَلَى الْعَرْشِ اسْتَوَى} فَإِنَّهُ قَدْ عُلِمَ بِدَلِيلٍ قَطْعِيٍّ أَنَّ الِاسْتِوَاءَ هَهُنَا لَيْسَ هُوَ التَّمَكُّنَ.

established that ‘being established’ here is not occupying a place.

Editorial notes

N069 [translation] The quotation is Qur’ān 20:5. Ibn Rushd states here what الاستواء is not—التمكن, occupying or being established in a place—without supplying a complete affirmative interpretation of the verse.

§ 169 General meaning is a real feature of language

1994 Arabic p. 109 · BA §204 · 2015 Arabic p. 254 · French p. 255

The second class of apparent wording, which we called substituted wording, also has two kinds: universal wording (الكلي) and particular wording (الجزئي). Let us first examine the universal, which is the general (العام). General wording has many forms. Some dispute that expressions signify generality and that, when unqualified, they apparently encompass everything falling under them. Their objection has no basis: the matter is evident, and indeed shared by all tongues and languages. The Law has introduced no specialised convention changing it. The argument establishing its authority as revealed proof is the argument establishing the authority of apparent wording as such, which has already been given.

وَأَمَّا الصِّنْفُ الثَّانِي مِنَ اللَّفْظِ الظَّاهِرِ، وَهُوَ الَّذِي سَمَّيْنَاهُ الْمُبْدَلَ، فَهُوَ أَيْضًا صِنْفَانِ: أَحَدُهُمَا اللَّفْظُ الْكُلِّيُّ، وَالثَّانِي اللَّفْظُ الْجُزْئِيُّ. وَلْنَجْعَلْ نَظَرَنَا مِنْ ذَلِكَ أَوَّلًا فِي الْكُلِّيِّ وَهُوَ الْعَامُّ. وَالْعَامُّ أَصْنَافُهُ كَثِيرَةٌ، وَقَدْ نَازَعَ قَوْمٌ فِي وُجُودِ مَعْنَى الْعُمُومِ فِي الْأَلْفَاظِ وَكَوْنِهِ إِذَا وَرَدَ مُطْلَقًا ⟨كَانَ⟩ ظَاهِرًا فِي حَصْرِ جَمِيعِ مَا يَدُلُّ تَحْتَهُ. وَلَا مَعْنَى لِمُنَازَعَتِهِمْ، فَإِنَّ الْأَمْرَ ظَاهِرٌ، بَلْ هُوَ شَيْءٌ مُشْتَرَكٌ لِجَمِيعِ الْأَلْسِنَةِ وَاللُّغَاتِ. وَالشَّرْعُ لَمْ يَتَصَرَّفْ فِي تَغْيِيرِهِ بِوَضْعٍ عُرْفِيٍّ. وَالْحُجَّةُ عَلَى كَوْنِهِ دَلِيلًا شَرْعِيًّا هِيَ الْحُجَّةُ عَلَى كَوْنِ الظَّاهِرِ بِمَا هُوَ ظَاهِرٌ دَلِيلًا شَرْعِيًّا. وَقَدْ تَقَدَّمَ ذَلِكَ.

Editorial notes

BA15-R06 [textual] Bou Akl 2015 Arabic p.254, French p.255 supplies a copula ⟨kāna⟩ in discussion of general wording whose unqualified use apparently encompasses its extension. This is predominantly grammatical rather than a new legal doctrine.

§ 170 Forms of generality and their unequal apparent force

1994 Arabic p. 109 · BA §205–206 · 2015 Arabic p. 256 · French p. 257

These expressions have many forms. They include plural nouns, with or without the definite article; names of genera, species, and classes when they have the definite article and do not end in the feminine ending, such as ‘the fruit,’ ‘the date palm,’ and ‘the woman’; man and mā (‘whoever’ and ‘whatever’) when used ⟨in conditional and consequential clauses⟩, together with ayna and matā (‘wherever’ and ‘whenever’); negative particles; and emphatic expressions such as ‘all of them’ and ‘every one.’

وَأَصْنَافُ هَذِهِ الْأَلْفَاظِ كَثِيرَةٌ: فَمِنْهَا أَسْمَاءُ الْجُمُوعِ، دَخَلَتْهَا الْأَلِفُ وَاللَّامُ أَوْ لَمْ تَدْخُلْهَا. وَمِنْهَا أَسْمَاءُ الْأَجْنَاسِ وَالْأَنْوَاعِ وَالْأَصْنَافِ إِذَا كَانَ فِيهَا الْأَلِفُ وَاللَّامُ وَلَمْ تَكُنْ فِي آخِرِهَا هَاءُ التَّأْنِيثِ مِثْلَ الثَّمَرَةِ وَالنَّخْلَةِ وَالْمَرْأَةِ. وَمِنْهَا مَنْ وَمَا، إِذَا أُورِدَتْ ⟨لِلشَّرْطِ وَالْجَزَاءِ⟩، وَأَيْنَ وَمَتَى. وَمِنْهَا حُرُوفُ النَّفْيِ. وَمِنْهَا الْأَلْفَاظُ الْمُؤَكِّدَةُ كَقَوْلِهِمْ كُلُّهُمْ وَأَجْمَعُونَ.

وَهَذِهِ الْأَصْنَافُ إِذَا أُطْلِقَتْ إِطْلَاقًا حُمِلَتْ عَلَى الْأَكْثَرِ عَلَى عُمُومِهَا إِلَى أَنْ يَدُلَّ الدَّلِيلُ عَلَى تَخْصِيصِهَا، وَلَهَا أَيْضًا مَرَاتِبُ فِي الظُّهُورِ، كَمَا كَانَ الصِّنْفُ الْأَوَّلُ. وَلِأَدِلَّتِهَا أَيْضًا مَرَاتِبُ بِحَسَبِهَا لِأَنَّهُ أَبَدًا يُشْتَرَطُ فِي الدَّلِيلِ الْمُؤَوِّلِ أَنْ يَكُونَ أَقْوَى دَلَالَةً مِنْ صِيغَةِ اللَّفْظِ، مِثَالُ مَا مِنْهَا فِي:

When these forms are used without qualification, they are generally understood in their full generality until evidence establishes a specification. They, too, admit degrees of apparentness, as did the first class. Their interpretive proofs have corresponding degrees, because evidence for interpretation must always signify more strongly than the expression’s form. Examples at the respective degrees follow.

Editorial notes

N070 [textual] The print at p. 109 excludes a final feminine ending, ولم تكن في آخرها هاء التأنيث, but immediately gives الثمرة والنخلة والمرأة, all with that ending. Both statement and examples are retained. The apparent internal inconsistency is not silently repaired by changing the examples or deleting the negative.

BA15-R07 [textual] The universality of man/mā here applies to their conditional-consequential construction; the 2015 text restores that specifying phrase. Arabic p.256, French p.257, commentary §205. A separate inherited problem concerning the examples of feminine endings is not resolved by this addition.

§ 171 A remote restriction of the guardian-permission report

1994 Arabic p. 110 · BA §207 · 2015 Arabic p. 256 · French p. 257

الْمَرْتَبَةِ الْأُولَى مِنَ الظُّهُورِ قَوْلُهُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ «أَيُّمَا امْرَأَةٍ نَكَحَتْ بِغَيْرِ إِذْنِ وَلِيِّهَا فَنِكَاحُهَا بَاطِلٌ» حَمَلَهُ قَوْمٌ عَلَى الْأَمَةِ، فَلَمَّا لَمْ يَسُغْ لِقَوْلِهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ «فَلَهَا الْمَهْرُ وَإِنَّمَا مَهْرُ الْأَمَةِ لِسَيِّدِهَا» حَمَلُوهُ عَلَى الْمُكَاتَبَةِ، وَهَذَا يَبْعُدُ مِنْ جِهَةِ التَّأْوِيلِ.

At the first degree of apparentness is his saying, God bless him and grant him peace, ‘Any woman who marries without her guardian’s permission, her marriage is invalid.’ Some apply this to a slave woman. When that proved untenable because of his saying, God bless him and grant him peace, ‘She is entitled to the dower’—whereas a slave woman’s dower belongs to her master—they applied it to a slave woman under a contract for emancipation. This is a remote interpretation.

Editorial notes

N071 [textual] On p. 110 the quotation marks run around فلها المهر وإنما مهر الأمة لسيدها. The English distinguishes the quoted ruling ‘She is entitled to the dower’ from the explanatory reason that follows, while retaining every clause.

§ 172 Restricting the requirement of a nightly fasting intention

1994 Arabic p. 110 · BA §208 · 2015 Arabic p. 256 · French p. 257

الْمَرْتَبَةِ الثَّانِيَةِ قَوْلُهُ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ: «لَا صِيَامَ لِمَنْ لَمْ يُبَيِّتِ الصِّيَامَ» حَمَلَهُ قَوْمٌ عَلَى الْقَضَاءِ وَالنَّذْرِ وَهَذَا التَّأْوِيلُ أَقْرَبُ مِنَ الْأَوَّلِ.

The second degree is his saying, peace be upon him, ‘There is no fasting for someone who has not resolved upon the fast during the night.’ Some apply this to a fast making up a missed obligation and to a vowed fast. This interpretation is closer than the first.

§ 173 Does the tithe report include vegetables?

1994 Arabic p. 110 · BA §209 · 2015 Arabic p. 258 · French p. 259

The third degree is his saying, God bless him and grant him peace, ‘On what the sky waters, a tenth; on what is irrigated by drawing water, half a tenth.’ Some apply this to everything, even taking almsgiving from vegetables. Others say that it is confined to the various grains from which almsgiving is taken.

الْمَرْتَبَةِ الثَّالِثَةِ قَوْلُهُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: «فِيمَا سَقَتِ السَّمَاءُ الْعُشْرُ وَفِيمَا سُقِيَ بِالنَّضْحِ نِصْفُ الْعُشْرِ» حَمَلَهُ قَوْمٌ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ حَتَّى أَخَذُوا الزَّكَاةَ مِنَ الْخُضَرِ، وَقَالَ آخَرُونَ هُوَ مَقْصُورٌ عَلَى سَائِرِ الْحُبُوبِ الَّتِي تُؤْخَذُ مِنْهَا الزَّكَاةُ.

§ 174 General wording with a known or unknown specific intention

1994 Arabic p. 110 · BA §210 · 2015 Arabic p. 258 · French p. 259

These are the kinds of general expressions and their degrees of apparentness. Sometimes general wording (العام) occurs with a specific meaning (الخاص) intended, and this is clear from the outset—as when someone beating his child says, ‘There is no good in children.’ This understanding may be predominantly probable or certain, according to the particular indication. It may also become clear through proof, which itself may be decisive or predominantly probable. Sometimes we know that general wording is intended specifically without knowing which specific meaning is intended; its force may then be that of indeterminate wording (المجمل).

فَهَذِهِ أَصْنَافُ أَلْفَاظِ الْعُمُومِ وَمَرَاتِبُهَا فِي الظُّهُورِ. وَرُبَّمَا وَرَدَ اللَّفْظُ الْعَامُّ وَالْمُرَادُ بِهِ الْخَاصُّ، وَيَكُونُ ذَلِكَ فِيهِ بَيِّنًا مِنْ أَوَّلِ الْأَمْرِ، كَقَوْلِ الْقَائِلِ عِنْدَمَا يَضْرِبُ وَلَدَهُ لَيْسَ فِي الْأَوْلَادِ خَيْرٌ. وَرُبَّمَا كَانَ ذَلِكَ ظَنًّا أَكْثَرِيًّا، وَرُبَّمَا كَانَ قَطْعِيًّا، وَذَلِكَ بِحَسَبِ قَرِينَةٍ قَرِينَةٍ. وَرُبَّمَا تَبَيَّنَ ذَلِكَ بِدَلِيلٍ. وَالدَّلِيلُ أَيْضًا إِمَّا قَطْعِيٌّ وَإِمَّا أَكْثَرِيٌّ، وَرُبَّمَا عَلِمْنَا أَنَّهُ عَامٌّ أُرِيدَ بِهِ الْخَاصُّ، وَلَمْ نَعْلَمْ أَيُّ خَاصٍّ هُوَ، وَرُبَّمَا كَانَتْ قُوَّتُهُ قُوَّةَ الْمُجْمَلِ.

§ 175 Disputed boundaries of generality

1994 Arabic p. 110 · BA §211 · 2015 Arabic p. 258 · French p. 259

It remains to discuss kinds of expressions thought to have general scope when they do not, or thought not to have general scope when they do. We shall set out several questions on this.

وَقَدْ بَقِيَ عَلَيْنَا أَنْ نَقُولَ فِيمَا يُظَنُّ بِهِ مِنْ أَصْنَافِ الْأَلْفَاظِ أَنَّ لَهَا عُمُومًا، وَلَيْسَ لَهَا عُمُومٌ، أَوْ فِيمَا يُظَنُّ مِنْهَا أَنْ لَيْسَ لَهَا عُمُومٌ وَلَهَا عُمُومٌ، وَنَرْسُمُ فِي ذَلِكَ مَسَائِلَ:

§ 176 A particular occasion does not confine a general answer

1994 Arabic p. 111 · BA §212 · 2015 Arabic p. 258 · French p. 259

Question. Generality in wording occurs when the Lawgiver uses it in an independent statement, or in reply to a question arising from a specific circumstance but frames the answer generally.

مَسْأَلَةٌ: الْعُمُومُ فِي الْأَلْفَاظِ إِنَّمَا يَتَصَوَّرُ إِذَا كَانَ مِنْ لَفْظِ الشَّارِعِ عَلَى سَبِيلِ الِابْتِدَاءِ، أَوْ وَرَدَ عِنْدَ السُّؤَالِ عَلَى سَبَبٍ

For example, when asked about the well of Buḍāʿa, he said, God bless him and grant him peace, ‘God created water as purifying; nothing renders it impure.’ This statement is understood to concern all water, not only that well. Some regard such a statement as specific and confine it to the thing asked about, even when it is framed generally. Their position has no basis, for the matter is clear.

خَاصٍّ فَأُخْرِجَ مَخْرَجَ الْعَامِّ. مِثْلَ قَوْلِهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ، وَقَدْ سُئِلَ عَنْ بِئْرِ بُضَاعَةَ فَقَالَ: «خَلَقَ اللَّهُ الْمَاءَ طَهُورًا لَا يُنَجِّسُهُ شَيْءٌ» فَإِنَّ هَذَا الْقَوْلَ لَيْسَ يُحْمَلُ عَلَى بِئْرِ بُضَاعَةَ وَحْدَهُ، بَلْ عَلَى جَمِيعِ الْمِيَاهِ. وَقَدْ رَأَى قَوْمٌ أَنَّ مِثْلَ هَذَا الْقَوْلِ خَاصٌّ وَيُقْتَصَرُ بِهِ عَنِ الشَّيْءِ الْمَسْؤُولِ عَنْهُ، وَإِنْ أُخْرِجَ مَخْرَجَ الْعُمُومِ. وَلَا مَعْنَى لِقَوْلِهِمْ، فَإِنَّ الْأَمْرَ فِي ذَلِكَ بَيِّنٌ.

§ 177 Equivocation is not the generality of a universal

1994 Arabic p. 111 · BA §213 · 2015 Arabic p. 260 · French p. 261

Question. An equivocal term does not have general scope encompassing everything to which it applies. Some hold otherwise, as do those who understand ‘Or you have touched women’ to cover both intercourse and touching with the bodily member, the hand. A survey of Arabic speech shows the contrary: Arabs do not use the term ‘ayn, for example, intending their hearer to understand all the meanings to which it applies. This is clearest in terms used for opposites. Someone might claim that such an inclusive meaning is understood through a specialised legal convention, but anyone making that claim must establish it.

مَسْأَلَةٌ: لَيْسَ لِلِاسْمِ الْمُشْتَرَكِ عُمُومٌ لِجَمِيعِ مَا يُقَالُ عَلَيْهِ، وَإِنْ كَانَ قَدْ يَرَى ذَلِكَ بَعْضُهُمْ مِثْلَ مَنْ حَمَلَ قَوْلَهُ تَعَالَى: {أَوْ لَامَسْتُمُ النِّسَاءَ} عَلَى الْأَمْرَيْنِ جَمِيعًا، أَعْنِي النِّكَاحَ وَاللَّمْسَ بِالْجَارِحَةِ الَّتِي هِيَ الْيَدُ. وَهَذَا يَتَبَيَّنُ خِلَافُهُ بِاسْتِقْرَاءِ كَلَامِ الْعَرَبِ، فَإِنَّهُمْ لَيْسَ يُطْلِقُونَ فِي مُخَاطَبَتِهِمُ اسْمَ الْعَيْنِ مَثَلًا وَيُرِيدُونَ بِهِ أَنْ يَفْهَمَ السَّامِعُ عَنْهُمْ جَمِيعَ الْمَعَانِي الَّتِي يُقَالُ عَلَيْهَا اسْمُ الْعَيْنِ. وَأَبْيَنُ مَا يَظْهَرُ ذَلِكَ فِي الْأَسْمَاءِ الْمَقُولَةِ عَلَى الْمُتَضَادَّاتِ، اللَّهُمَّ إِلَّا أَنْ يَدَّعِيَ مُدَّعٍ أَنَّ ذَلِكَ مَفْهُومٌ بِالْعُرْفِ الشَّرْعِيِّ، لَكِنْ إِنِ ادَّعَى ذَلِكَ فَعَلَيْهِ إِثْبَاتُهُ.

Editorial notes

N072 [translation] The quotation is Qur’ān 4:43/5:6. The issue is whether equivocal meanings are jointly intended, distinguished from the extension of a universal term to the particulars under it.

§ 178 Who is included by “people” and by a masculine plural?

1994 Arabic p. 111 · BA §214 · 2015 Arabic p. 260 · French p. 261

Question. The expressions ‘people’ and ‘human being’ include the slave, the unbeliever, the male, and the female. ‘The believers’ includes the slave but does not include women, since its form is specifically a masculine plural.

مَسْأَلَةٌ: يَدْخُلُ تَحْتَ لَفْظِ النَّاسِ وَالْإِنْسَانِ الْعَبْدُ وَالْكَافِرُ وَالذَّكَرُ وَالْأُنْثَى. وَأَمَّا الْمُؤْمِنُونَ فَيَدْخُلُ تَحْتَهُ الْعَبْدُ وَلَا يَدْخُلُ تَحْتَهُ النِّسَاءُ، إِذْ هِيَ صِيغَةٌ خَاصَّةٌ بِجَمْعِ الْمُذَكَّرِ.

Editorial notes

N073 [grammar] The expression خَاصَّةٌ بِجَمْعِ الْمُذَكَّرِ concerns the grammatical masculine plural as analysed here; it should not be generalized without qualification to every plural expression.

§ 179 Can a plural be restricted below its minimum?

1994 Arabic p. 111 · BA §215 · 2015 Arabic p. 260 · French p. 261

مَسْأَلَةٌ: صَرْفُ الْعُمُومِ إِلَى غَيْرِ الِاسْتِغْرَاقِ جَائِزٌ. وَأَمَّا رَدُّهُ إِلَى مَا دُونَ أَقَلِّ الْجَمْعِ عِنْدَ مَنْ يَرَى أَنَّ أَقَلَّ مَا يُدَلُّ بِلَفْظِ الْجَمِيعِ عَلَيْهِ اثْنَانِ، فَزَعَمَ أَبُو حَامِدٍ أَنَّ ذَلِكَ مُمْتَنِعٌ، وَفِيهِ نَظَرٌ.

Question. General wording may be understood without exhaustive inclusion. Abū Ḥāmid claims, however, that it cannot be reduced to less than the minimum denoted by a plural, on the view that the least number a plural denotes is two. This requires examination.

Editorial notes

N074 [textual] The print has الْجَمِيع in §§179–180 where the discussion concerns the grammatical plural (جَمْع), not merely the lexical expression “all.” Its consonants are retained; the English identifies the grammatical subject from the surrounding references to dual and plural forms.

§ 180 Three is the normal plural; two or one requires a clue

1994 Arabic p. 112 · BA §216 · 2015 Arabic p. 260 · French p. 261

مَسْأَلَةٌ: لَفْظُ الْجَمِيعِ إِذَا وَرَدَ مُطْلَقًا فَأَقَلُّ مَا يَتَنَاوَلُ الثَّلَاثَةُ فَمَا فَوْقَهَا، وَهُوَ فِيهَا أَظْهَرُ مِنْهُ فِي الِاثْنَيْنِ، وَإِنَّمَا يُحْمَلُ عَلَى الِاثْنَيْنِ بِقَرِينَةٍ. وَالْعَجَبُ مِمَّنْ يَحْمِلُ أَلْفَاظَ الْجُمُوعِ إِذَا وَرَدَتْ مُطْلَقَةً عَلَى الِاثْنَيْنِ، مَعَ أَنَّ لِلِاثْنَيْنِ صِيغَةً خَاصَّةً. فَأَمَّا أَنَّ لَفْظَ الْجَمْعِ قَدْ يُتَجَوَّزُ فِيهِ وَيُرَادُ بِهِ الِاثْنَانِ، فَذَلِكَ غَيْرُ مَدْفُوعٍ. لَكِنْ عَلَى جِهَةِ الْإِبْدَالِ وَالتَّجَوُّزِ عَلَى نَحْوِ مَا يُفْعَلُ فِي سَائِرِ الْأَلْفَاظِ الرَّاتِبَةِ عَلَى شَيْءٍ مَا. وَإِذَا أَنْتَ تَصَفَّحْتَ الْمَوَاضِعَ الَّتِي يَحْتَجُّ بِهَا مَنْ يُجَوِّزُ ذَلِكَ وَجَدْتَهَا مِنْ هَذَا الْقَبِيلِ.

Question. A plural expression, when unqualified, denotes at least three or more, and is more apparent in that sense than in the sense of two; it is understood as two only through an accompanying indication. It is remarkable that anyone should understand unqualified plural expressions as denoting two, when two has its own distinctive form. That a plural may be used figuratively to mean two is not denied, but this is substitution and extended usage, like what occurs with other expressions conventionally assigned to something. Examining the cases cited by those who permit this shows them to be of that kind.

لَكِنْ قَدْ جَرَتْ عَادَةُ النُّظَّارِ فِي هَذَا الشَّأْنِ عِنْدَمَا يَتَكَلَّمُونَ فِي دَلَالَاتِ الْأَلْفَاظِ أَلَّا يُفَرِّقُوا بَيْنَ مَا تَدُلُّ عَلَيْهِ الْأَلْفَاظُ دَلَالَةً رَاتِبَةً، وَبَيْنَ مَا تَدُلُّ عَلَيْهِ تَجَوُّزًا وَاسْتِعَارَةً. فَلِذَلِكَ نَرَاهُمْ يَقُولُونَ إِنَّ لَفْظَ الْجَمْعِ يَنْطَلِقُ عَلَى الِاثْنَيْنِ كَمَا يَنْطَلِقُ عَلَى الثَّلَاثَةِ فَمَا فَوْقَهَا. وَهَذَا هُوَ الَّذِي غَلَّطَ النَّاظِرِينَ فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ فِي هَذِهِ الْمَسْأَلَةِ عِنْدَمَا يَحْتَجُّونَ فِي ذَلِكَ بِقَوْلِ سِيبَوَيْهِ وَغَيْرِهِ مِنَ النَّحْوِيِّينَ، وَبِمَا وَرَدَ مِنْ ذَلِكَ فِي كَلَامِ الْعَرَبِ.

Investigators in this field, however, customarily fail, when discussing verbal signification, to distinguish an expression’s established signification from what it signifies by extended use and transfer. Thus we see them saying that a plural applies to two just as it applies to three or more. This is what has misled those investigating this question in this discipline when they appeal to Sībawayh and other grammarians, and to examples occurring in Arabic speech.

Nor is this alone found in their speech—I mean using a plural form to signify two. They may also

use it to signify one, but do so by way of magnification, as when they say, ‘He is all people,’ or ‘He is the young man, the whole of a young man.’

وَلَيْسَ هَذَا مَوْجُودًا وَحْدَهُ فِي كَلَامِهِمْ، أَعْنِي أَنْ يَدُلَّ عَلَى الِاثْنَيْنِ بِصِيغَةِ الْجَمْعِ. لَكِنْ قَدْ يَدُلُّ بِذَلِكَ عَلَى الْوَاحِدِ وَإِنَّمَا يُخْرِجُونَ ذَلِكَ مَخْرَجَ التَّعْظِيمِ كَمَا يَقُولُونَ هُوَ كُلُّ النَّاسِ، وَهُوَ الْفَتَى كُلُّ الْفَتَى.

§ 181 Specification or contradiction? The importance of chronology

1994 Arabic p. 112 & 113 · BA §217–218 · 2015 Arabic p. 262 · French p. 263

As explained earlier, these general expressions may occur with a specific meaning intended. Sometimes this is clear from the outset; sometimes it is not and requires evidence: wording, an action, an approval, or one of the other proofs used in this discipline. Accordingly, when one seeks to specify general wording through any of these, one must consider which has the stronger rank in producing predominant probability.

وَلِأَنَّ هَذِهِ الْأَلْفَاظَ الْعَامَّةَ كَمَا تَقَدَّمَ قَدْ تَرِدُ وَالْمُرَادُ بِهَا التَّخْصِيصُ، فَرُبَّمَا كَانَ ذَلِكَ فِيهَا بَيِّنًا مِنْ أَوَّلِ الْأَمْرِ، وَرُبَّمَا لَمْ يَكُنْ بَيِّنًا، بَلْ يُحْتَاجُ فِي ذَلِكَ إِلَى دَلِيلٍ، وَذَلِكَ إِمَّا لَفْظٌ وَإِمَّا فِعْلٌ وَإِمَّا إِقْرَارٌ أَوْ وَاحِدٌ مِنَ الْأَدِلَّةِ الْمُسْتَعْمَلَةِ فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ فَيَنْبَغِي إِذَا أُرِيدَ الْمَصِيرُ إِلَى تَخْصِيصِ الْعَامِّ بِوَاحِدٍ وَاحِدٍ مِنْهَا أَنْ نَنْظُرَ إِلَى أَيِّهَا أَقْوَى رُتْبَةً فِي غَلَبَةِ الظَّنِّ إِلَيْهِ.

Opinions differ concerning the specification of general wording through these other revealed proofs. Some hold that when a general statement concerning something is received together with a specification—whether through verbal form, understood import, action, or approval—the two have the status of conflicting evidence. The general statement may, for example, have come later than the specifying evidence, whether wording, action, or approval, and thus abrogate it, unless it is known that the specification followed the general statement as clarification delayed until the time of need. This is the position of Dāwūd and his followers.

وَقَدِ اخْتَلَفَ النَّاسُ فِي تَخْصِيصِ الْعَامِّ لِغَيْرِهِ مِنْ هَذِهِ الْأَدِلَّةِ الشَّرْعِيَّةِ، فَذَهَبَ بَعْضُهُمْ أَنَّ الْعَامَّ إِذَا وَرَدَ فِي شَيْءٍ ثُمَّ وَرَدَ تَخْصِيصُهُ، وَذَلِكَ إِمَّا بِصِيغَةِ لَفْظٍ أَوْ مَفْهُومٍ أَوْ بِفِعْلٍ أَوْ إِقْرَارٍ، أَنَّ ذَلِكَ يَجْرِي مَجْرَى التَّعَارُضِ، لِأَنَّهُ جَائِزٌ مَثَلًا أَنْ يَرِدَ الْعَامُّ مُتَأَخِّرًا عَنِ الْمُخَصِّصِ، سَوَاءٌ كَانَ لَفْظًا أَوْ فِعْلًا أَوْ إِقْرَارًا، فَيَكُونَ وُرُودُ الْعَامِّ نَسْخًا لَهُ، إِلَّا أَنْ يُعْلَمَ أَنَّ التَّخْصِيصَ وَرَدَ بَعْدَ التَّعْمِيمِ عَلَى جِهَةِ تَأْخِيرِ الْبَيَانِ إِلَى وَقْتِ الْحَاجَةِ. وَإِلَى هَذَا ذَهَبَ دَاوُدُ وَأَصْحَابُهُ.

Editorial notes

N075 [translation] The transition لِغَيْرِهِ مِنْ هَذِهِ الْأَدِلَّةِ الشَّرْعِيَّةِ، فَذَهَبَ بَعْضُهُمْ establishes that the following argument about conflicting evidence is a position being reported, not necessarily an assertion in Ibn Rushd’s own voice.

§ 182 Specific evidence can govern without a known chronological order

1994 Arabic p. 113 · BA §219 · 2015 Arabic p. 264 · French p. 265

Those who permit specifying general wording through such proofs without knowing their chronological order appeal to the Companions’

وَقَدِ احْتَجَّ مَنْ أَجَازَ تَخْصِيصَ الْعَامِّ بِمِثْلِ هَذِهِ الْأَدِلَّةِ دُونَ أَنْ يُعْلَمَ الْمُتَقَدِّمُ مِنْهَا وَالْمُتَأَخِّرُ بِمَصِيرِ الصَّحَابَةِ إِلَى ذَلِكَ،

practice of doing so and of making the specific govern the general. On this view, the general and specific have one of two relations: either the general expression comes after the specific, which then serves as an indication specifying the general, since the wording admits this; or the specific comes after the general and is acted upon.

وَحُكْمِهِمْ بِالْخَاصِّ عَلَى الْعَامِّ، فَيَكُونُ عَلَى رَأْيِ هَؤُلَاءِ حَالَةُ الْعَامِّ مَعَ الْخَاصِّ إِحْدَى حَالَتَيْنِ: إِمَّا أَنْ يَرِدَ اللَّفْظُ الْعَامُّ وَقَدْ تَقَدَّمَهُ الْخَاصُّ، فَيَكُونَ ذَلِكَ قَرِينَةً يُخَصَّصُ بِهَا الْعَامُّ لِاحْتِمَالِ اللَّفْظِ لِذَلِكَ. وَإِمَّا أَنْ يَرِدَ الْخَاصُّ بَعْدَ الْعَامِّ فَيَكُونَ مَعْمُولًا عَلَيْهِ.

In general, as we have said, whoever permits specification through such proofs should follow whichever ranks highest in predominant probability. This predominance may arise from the wording or from its transmission. Thus someone may permit specifying general wording through an unambiguous text, yet refuse this in the Qurʾān because the Qurʾān is established by mass transmission—when the specifying text is transmitted through solitary routes.

وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ كَمَا قُلْنَا فَيَنْبَغِي لِمَنْ يُجَوِّزُ التَّخْصِيصَ بِمِثْلِ هَذِهِ الْأَدِلَّةِ أَنْ يَصِيرَ إِلَى أَقْوَاهَا رُتْبَةً فِي غَلَبَةِ الظَّنِّ. وَهَذَا النَّوْعُ مِنْ غَلَبَةِ الظَّنِّ قَدْ يَقَعُ مِنْ جِهَةِ الْأَلْفَاظِ، وَمِنْ جِهَةِ النَّقْلِ، كَمَنْ يُجِيزُ تَخْصِيصَ الْعَامِّ بِالنَّصِّ وَيَمْنَعُهُ فِي الْقُرْآنِ لِكَوْنِ الْقُرْآنِ مِمَّا ثَبَتَ تَوَاتُرًا، هَذَا إِذَا كَانَ الْخَاصُّ وَارِدًا بِطُرُقِ الْآحَادِ.

§ 183 Why an exception must accompany its statement

1994 Arabic p. 113 · BA §220 · 2015 Arabic p. 264 · French p. 265

Exception is a kind of specification of general wording, but differs from specification in that it does not occur separately from the expression to which it belongs. There is therefore no basis for permitting an exception to be postponed. We should discuss this. The forms of exception are well known; the kinds that require examination here are the following.

وَلِأَنَّ الِاسْتِثْنَاءَ تَخْصِيصٌ مَا لِلْعَامِّ، إِلَّا أَنَّ الْفَرْقَ بَيْنَهُ وَبَيْنَ التَّخْصِيصِ أَنَّهُ لَا يَرِدُ مُنْفَرِدًا عَنِ الْمُسْتَثْنَى. وَلِذَلِكَ لَا مَعْنَى لِقَوْلِ مَنْ أَجَازَ تَأْخِيرَ الِاسْتِثْنَاءِ، فَقَدْ يَنْبَغِي أَنْ نَقُولَ فِي ذَلِكَ: وَصِيَغُ الِاسْتِثْنَاءِ مَعْرُوفَةٌ. فَأَمَّا أَصْنَافُهُ الَّتِي يَجِبُ أَنْ نَنْظُرَ فِيهَا هَهُنَا فَهِيَ هَذِهِ:

Editorial notes

N076 [textual] At p. 113 the edition prints عن المستثنى, without منه. ‘The expression to which it belongs’ renders the attachment required by the argument, without silently adding منه to the Arabic.

§ 184 Connected and disconnected exceptions; one or several sentences

1994 Arabic p. 113 & 114 · BA §221 · 2015 Arabic p. 264 · French p. 265

An exception may be connected, where the thing excepted belongs to the same genus as that from which it is excepted; or disconnected, where it belongs to a different genus. Language specialists call the latter a discontinuous exception. An exception may also follow a single complete

الِاسْتِثْنَاءُ مِنْهُ مُتَّصِلٌ، وَهُوَ الَّذِي الْمُسْتَثْنَى فِيهِ مِنْ جِنْسِ الْمُسْتَثْنَى مِنْهُ، وَمِنْهُ مَقْطُوعٌ، وَهُوَ الَّذِي الْمُسْتَثْنَى فِيهِ مِنْ غَيْرِ جِنْسِ الْمُسْتَثْنَى مِنْهُ. وَهَذَا يُسَمِّيهِ أَهْلُ اللِّسَانِ بِالِاسْتِثْنَاءِ الْمُتَقَطِّعِ. وَأَيْضًا مِنَ الِاسْتِثْنَاءِ مَا يَرِدُ بَعْدَ جُمْلَةٍ

sentence, or several sentences. We shall examine both these divisions.

وَاحِدَةٍ مُفِيدَةٍ، وَمِنْهُ مَا يَرِدُ بَعْدَ جُمَلٍ. وَنَحْنُ نَنْظُرُ فِي هَذَيْنِ الصِّنْفَيْنِ جَمِيعًا فَنَقُولُ:

§ 185 How can an exception belong to another genus?

1994 Arabic p. 114 & 115 · BA §222 · 2015 Arabic p. 264 · French p. 265

There is no disagreement over an exception belonging to the same genus as that from which it is excepted. Disagreement concerns an exception belonging to another genus. Some reject it, saying that there is no sense in excepting what the preceding statement did not include, and that calling such a thing an exception is idle speech. Those who permit it appeal to its occurrence in language, as in God's sayings, 'For they are enemies to me, except the Lord of the worlds,' and 'Do not consume your wealth among yourselves wrongfully, except that it be an immediate transaction.'

إِنَّ الِاسْتِثْنَاءَ الَّذِي مِنْ جِنْسِ الْمُسْتَثْنَى مِنْهُ مِمَّا لَا خِلَافَ فِيهِ. وَإِنَّمَا الْخِلَافُ فِي وُقُوعِ الْمُسْتَثْنَى مِنْ غَيْرِ جِنْسِ الْمُسْتَثْنَى مِنْهُ. وَهَذَا قَدْ مَنَعَهُ قَوْمٌ، وَقَالُوا لَا مَعْنَى لِاسْتِثْنَاءِ مَا لَمْ يَتَضَمَّنْهُ الْقَوْلُ الْمُتَقَدِّمُ، وَتَسْمِيَةُ مِثْلِ هَذَا اسْتِثْنَاءً هَذْرٌ. وَأَمَّا الَّذِينَ أَجَازُوهُ فَقَدْ تَمَسَّكُوا بِوُقُوعِ ذَلِكَ لُغَةً، مِنْ ذَلِكَ قَوْلُهُ تَعَالَى: {فَإِنَّهُمْ عَدُوٌّ لِي إِلَّا رَبَّ الْعَالَمِينَ}، وَقَوْلُهُ تَعَالَى: {وَلَا تَأْكُلُوا أَمْوَالَكُمْ بَيْنَكُمْ بِالْبَاطِلِ إِلَّا أَنْ تَكُونَ تِجَارَةً حَاضِرَةً}.

A comparable instance is the poet's saying, 'No one is at the campsite except the horse tethering places.' The term 'anyone' does not apply to tethering places. Another poet says, 'And a land with no companion in it, except gazelles and except white camels.' Arabs also customarily say, 'There is no man in the house except a woman.' In general, this is well known and frequent in their speech.

وَفِي مِثْلِ هَذَا قَوْلُ الشَّاعِرِ: «وَمَا بِالرَّبْعِ مِنْ أَحَدٍ إِلَّا الْأَوَارِيَّ». وَالْأَوَارِيُّ لَيْسَ يَنْطَلِقُ عَلَيْهَا اسْمُ أَحَدٍ، وَقَوْلُ الْآخَرِ: «وَبَلْدَةٍ لَيْسَ بِهَا أَنِيسٌ إِلَّا الْيَعَافِيرُ وَإِلَّا الْعِيسُ». وَمِنْ عَادَةِ الْعَرَبِ أَنْ تَقُولَ: مَا فِي الدَّارِ رَجُلٌ إِلَّا امْرَأَةٌ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَهُوَ فِي كَلَامِهِمْ مَشْهُورٌ وَمَوْجُودٌ كَثِيرًا.

The first group rejects it on theoretical grounds; the second appeals to its actual occurrence, but has been unable to explain how it is valid in speech according to known Arab usage, and thereby resolve the difficulty raised earlier.

وَالْفِرْقَةُ الْأُولَى دَفَعُوا ذَلِكَ مِنْ جِهَةِ النَّظَرِ، وَالثَّانِيَةُ تَمَسَّكُوا بِالْوُجُودِ وَلَمْ يَقْدِرُوا أَنْ يُعْطُوا الْجِهَةَ الَّتِي بِهَا يَصِحُّ ذَلِكَ فِي الْكَلَامِ بِمَا هُوَ مَعْرُوفٌ مِنْ عَادَةِ الْعَرَبِ وَيَنْحَلُّ بِهَا الشَّكُّ الْمُتَقَدِّمُ.

Editorial notes

N077 [textual] The first scriptural quotation is Qur'ān 26:77. The second, as printed at p. 114, combines wording corresponding to 4:29 with تجارة حاضرة from 2:282; it is translated as printed rather than silently replaced by the standard wording of either verse. Both poetic excerpts are likewise translated in the forms actually quoted in the main text, not the longer parallel versions in the editor's notes.

N078 [translation] الأوارِي is rendered 'horse tethering places,' consistent with the edition's explanatory note at p. 114. اليعافير is rendered 'gazelles,' an attested sense in Ibn Manẓūr, Lisān al-ʿArab, s.v. عفر (https://www.islamweb.net/ar/library/content/122/5572/عفر); lexical alternatives include young wild cattle. This vocabulary lookup does not replace or expand the quoted poem.

§ 186 A disconnected exception belongs to the understood wider meaning

1994 Arabic p. 115 · BA §223 · 2015 Arabic p. 266 · French p. 267

وَنَحْنُ نَقُولُ فِي ذَلِكَ: إِنَّ مِنْ عَادَةِ الْعَرَبِ، كَمَا تَقَدَّمَ، إِبْدَالَ الْكُلِّيِّ مَكَانَ الْجُزْئِيِّ، وَالْجُزْئِيِّ مَكَانَ الْكُلِّيِّ اتِّكَالًا عَلَى الْقَرَائِنِ وَتَجَوُّزًا. فَالْأَعْرَابِيُّ مَثَلًا إِذَا قَالَ: مَا فِي الدَّارِ رَجُلٌ أَمْكَنَ أَنْ يُفْهَمَ عَنْهُ فَمَا سِوَاهُ، فَلِذَلِكَ اسْتَثْنَى فَقَالَ: إِلَّا امْرَأَةً، وَكَذَلِكَ قَوْلُهُ: وَبَلْدَةٍ لَيْسَ بِهَا أَنِيسٌ. وَعَلَى هَذَا الْوَجْهِ الَّذِي قُلْنَاهُ لَيْسَ يَكُونُ الْمُسْتَثْنَى مِنْ غَيْرِ جِنْسِ الْمُسْتَثْنَى مِنْهُ.

Our account is this: as explained earlier, Arabs customarily substitute the universal for the particular and the particular for the universal, relying on accompanying indications and extended usage. If a Bedouin says, for example, ‘There is no man in the house,’ his negation may be understood to extend beyond men; hence he adds the exception, ‘except a woman.’ The same holds of ‘And a land with no companion in it.’ On the account we have given, the thing excepted does not belong to a genus different from that from which it is excepted.

لَكِنَّ الْفَرْقَ بَيْنَهُ وَبَيْنَ الْأَوَّلِ أَنَّ ذَلِكَ اسْتِثْنَاءٌ مِنْ عُمُومِ مَا اقْتَضَاهُ اللَّفْظُ بِصِيغَتِهِ، وَهَذَا مِنْ عُمُومِ مَا اقْتَضَاهُ اللَّفْظُ بِمَفْهُومِهِ لَا بِصِيغَتِهِ. وَإِذَا تَصَفَّحْتَ الْمَوَاضِعَ الْوَاقِعَ فِيهَا مِثْلُ هَذَا الِاسْتِثْنَاءِ وَجَدْتَهَا عَلَى مَا قُلْنَاهُ، وَإِلَّا كَانَ خُلْفًا فِي الْقَوْلِ وَهَذْرًا لَا تَصِحُّ بِمِثْلِهِ مُحَاوَرَةٌ.

The difference from the first kind is that the first excepts something from the general scope conveyed by the expression’s form, whereas this excepts it from the general scope conveyed by its understood import, not its form. If you examine the occurrences of such exceptions, you will find them to be as we have described; otherwise, the statement would be contradictory and idle, incapable of sustaining intelligible conversation.

§ 187 How far does an exception reach over coordinated clauses?

1994 Arabic p. 116 · BA §224 · 2015 Arabic p. 268 · French p. 269

وَأَمَّا الِاسْتِثْنَاءُ الَّذِي يَرِدُ بَعْدَ جُمْلَةٍ أَكْثَرَ مِنْ وَاحِدَةٍ مَنْسُوقَةٍ بِالْوَاوِ، فَإِنْ كَانَتِ الْوَاوُ أَعْطَتِ التَّشْرِيكَ بَيْنَهُمَا أَوِ الْجَمْعَ فِي مَعْنًى وَاحِدٍ، فَالْأَظْهَرُ فِيهِ أَنَّ الِاسْتِثْنَاءَ يَعُودُ عَلَى جَمِيعِ الْمَذْكُورِينَ. وَأَمَّا إِنْ كَانَتِ الْوَاوُ تَنْسُقُ مِنْ غَيْرِ أَنْ تُعْطِيَ التَّشْرِيكَ فِي مَعْنًى وَاحِدٍ، وَكَانَتِ الْمَعَانِي الْمَنْسُوقَةُ كَثِيرَةً، كَقَوْلِهِ تَعَالَى: {وَالَّذِينَ يَرْمُونَ الْمُحْصَنَاتِ ثُمَّ لَمْ يَأْتُوا بِأَرْبَعَةِ شُهَدَاءَ فَاجْلِدُوهُمْ ثَمَانِينَ جَلْدَةً وَلَا تَقْبَلُوا لَهُمْ شَهَادَةً أَبَدًا وَأُولَئِكَ هُمُ الْفَاسِقُونَ إِلَّا الَّذِينَ تَابُوا مِنْ بَعْدِ ذَلِكَ وَأَصْلَحُوا}.

If an exception follows several sentences joined by ‘and,’ and ‘and’ makes them share or combine in one meaning, the more evident reading is that the exception refers to everything mentioned. If ‘and’ joins them without making them share one meaning, and the joined meanings are multiple, the case is different. An example is God’s saying, ‘Those who accuse chaste women and then do not produce four witnesses: lash them eighty times, never accept their testimony, and they are the wrongdoers—except those who repent thereafter and make amends.’

وَكَقَوْلِهِ تَعَالَى: {فَكَفَّارَتُهُ إِطْعَامُ عَشَرَةِ مَسَاكِينَ مِنْ أَوْسَطِ مَا تُطْعِمُونَ أَهْلِيكُمْ أَوْ كِسْوَتُهُمْ أَوْ تَحْرِيرُ رَقَبَةٍ فَمَنْ لَمْ يَجِدْ فَصِيَامُ ثَلَاثَةِ أَيَّامٍ}. فَالْأَظْهَرُ فِي مِثْلِ هَذَا أَنْ يُتَوَقَّفَ حَتَّى يَدُلَّ الدَّلِيلُ مِنْ قَرِينَةِ حَالٍ أَوْ غَيْرِ ذَلِكَ عَلَى الَّذِي إِلَيْهِ يَعُودُ الِاسْتِثْنَاءُ.

Another example is His saying, ‘Its expiation is feeding ten needy people from the average of what you feed your families, or clothing them, or freeing a slave; whoever cannot find the means must fast three days.’ In such cases the more evident course is to suspend judgement until evidence, whether a contextual indication or something else, shows what the exception refers to.

Editorial notes

N079 [translation] The quotations are Qur’ān 24:4–5 and 5:89. The second uses a conditional qualification, which Ibn Rushd includes here within his discussion of the scope of an exception; the examples are retained without silently replacing its conjunctions.

§ 188 An exception larger than the remainder

1994 Arabic p. 116 · BA §225 · 2015 Arabic p. 268 · French p. 269

وَأَمَّا هَلْ يَكُونُ الْمُسْتَثْنَى مِنْهُ أَقَلَّ مِنَ الْمُسْتَثْنَى، فَهُوَ شَيْءٌ لَمْ يَقَعْ فِي كَلَامِ الْعَرَبِ بَعْدُ، لِأَنَّ وُقُوعَ مِثْلِ هَذَا يَكَادُ أَنْ يَكُونَ عِيًّا، فَإِنَّهُ مِنْ خُلْفِ الْقَوْلِ أَنْ يَقُولَ الْإِنْسَانُ رَأَيْتُ مِائَةً إِلَّا تِسْعَةً وَتِسْعِينَ.

As for whether the amount remaining after an exception may be smaller than the amount excepted, this is something that has not occurred in Arabic speech, since such an expression would almost amount to an inability to express oneself. It is an incongruous way of speaking to say, ‘I saw a hundred, except ninety-nine.’

Editorial notes

N080 [translation] The comparison of المستثنى منه with المستثنى at p. 116 is understood of the remaining and excepted amounts, as required by the author’s example of a hundred minus ninety-nine.

§ 189 Unqualified and qualified wording in the same or different contexts

1994 Arabic p. 116 & 117 · BA §226 · 2015 Arabic p. 268 · French p. 269

مَسْأَلَةٌ: إِذَا وَرَدَ الْعَامُّ مُقَيَّدًا بِصِفَةٍ أَوْ مُشْتَرَطًا فِيهِ شَرْطٌ مَا فَالْمَصِيرُ إِلَى الْعَمَلِ بِهِ عَلَى الْجِهَةِ الَّتِي اشْتُرِطَ فِيهِ مِمَّا لَا يَنْبَغِي أَنْ يَقَعَ فِيهِ خِلَافٌ. وَأَمَّا إِذَا وَرَدَ مُطْلَقًا فِي مَكَانٍ، ثُمَّ وَرَدَ مَرَّةً أُخْرَى فِي ذَلِكَ الْمَكَانِ مُقَيَّدًا، وَهُوَ الَّذِي يَعْرِفُونَهُ بِحَمْلِ الْمُطْلَقِ عَلَى الْمُقَيَّدِ، كَقَوْلِهِ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ: «لَا نِكَاحَ إِلَّا بِشَاهِدَيْنِ» وَقَوْلِهِ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ: «لَا نِكَاحَ إِلَّا بِشَاهِدَيْ عَدْلٍ»، فَقَدْ رَأَى أَكْثَرُ النَّاسِ فِي ذَلِكَ حَمْلَ الْمُطْلَقِ عَلَى الْمُقَيَّدِ.

Question. When general wording is qualified by an attribute or made conditional on something, there should be no disagreement about acting upon it subject to that condition. If it occurs unqualified in one context and then qualified in the same context—what they call construing the unqualified in light of the qualified—the majority adopt that construction. An example is his saying, peace be upon him, ‘There is no marriage without two witnesses,’ alongside his saying, peace be upon him, ‘There is no marriage without two witnesses of probity.’

وَرَأَى بَعْضُهُمْ أَنَّ الْمُطْلَقَ بَاقٍ عَلَى إِطْلَاقِهِ، وَأَنَّ التَّقْيِيدَ مَحْمُولٌ عَلَى التَّأْكِيدِ، وَأَنَّهُ لَيْسَ يُعَارِضُهُ إِلَّا مِنْ جِهَةِ دَلِيلِ الْخِطَابِ. وَالْعُمُومُ أَقْوَى مِنْ دَلِيلِ الْخِطَابِ، أَعْنِي الْعُمُومَ الَّذِي فِي الْمُطْلَقِ. وَأَمَّا إِذَا وَرَدَ الْعَامُّ مُقَيَّدًا فِي مَكَانٍ غَيْرِ الْمَكَانِ الَّذِي أُطْلِقَ فِيهِ فَلَا مَعْنَى لِحَمْلِهِ عَلَى التَّقْيِيدِ إِلَّا بِدَلِيلٍ أَوْ قَرِينَةِ حَالٍ.

Some hold that the unqualified statement retains its unqualified scope, that the qualification serves to emphasize, and that it conflicts with the unqualified statement only through contrary implication (دليل الخطاب). Generality is stronger than contrary implication—I mean the generality present in the unqualified statement. If, however, the general expression is qualified in a context different from the one in which it was unqualified, there is no basis for construing it as qualified without proof or a contextual indication.

§ 190 From general to specific expressions

1994 Arabic p. 117 · BA §227 · 2015 Arabic p. 270 · French p. 271

فَهَذَا هُوَ الْقَوْلُ فِي الصِّيَغِ الْعَامَّةِ، وَفِي أَيِّ الْأَحْوَالِ تُحْمَلُ عَلَى عُمُومِهَا، وَفِي أَيِّهَا لَا. وَبَقِيَ عَلَيْنَا الْقَوْلُ فِي الصِّنْفِ الثَّانِي مِنَ الظَّاهِرِ، وَهُوَ الْأَلْفَاظُ الْخَاصَّةُ، فَلْنَقُلْ فِيهَا:

This is the account of general verbal forms, and of the circumstances in which they are understood generally and those in which they are not. It remains to discuss the second class of apparent wording, namely specific expressions. Let us turn to them.

§ 191 Specific expressions may stand for an intended universal

1994 Arabic p. 117 & 118 · BA §228–233 · 2015 Arabic p. 270 · French p. 271

وَهَذِهِ مِنْهَا مَا هِيَ أَسْمَاءُ أَشْخَاصٍ، وَمِنْهَا مَا هِيَ أَسْمَاءُ أَجْنَاسٍ وَأَنْوَاعٍ. وَقَوْلُنَا فِي مِثْلِ هَذِهِ الْأَلْفَاظِ خَاصَّةٌ إِنَّمَا هُوَ بِالْإِضَافَةِ، فَإِنَّ الْخَاصَّ إِنَّمَا يُقَالُ بِالْإِضَافَةِ إِلَى الْعَامِّ الَّذِي فَوْقَهُ، وَالْعَامُّ بِالْإِضَافَةِ إِلَى الْخَاصِّ الَّذِي تَحْتَهُ.

Some of these are names of individuals, and others are names of genera and species. When we call such expressions “specific” (خاص), we do so relatively: something is called specific in relation to the general term above it, and general in relation to the specific term below it.

وَهَذِهِ الْأَلْفَاظُ إِذَا كَانَتْ أَسْمَاءَ أَشْخَاصٍ فَإِنَّهَا تُحْمَلُ عَلَى مَا تَقْتَضِيهِ صِيَغُهَا مِنَ الْمَعْنَى الْخَاصِّ دُونَ أَنْ تُحْمَلَ عَلَى مَا يَعُمُّ ذَلِكَ الْمَعْنَى الْخَاصَّ، وَهِيَ فِي ذَلِكَ ظَاهِرَةٌ، كَمَا كَانَتْ أَلْفَاظُ الْعُمُومِ ظَاهِرَةً فِي عُمُومِهَا، إِلَى أَنْ يَرِدَ دَلِيلُ التَّخْصِيصِ. وَكَذَلِكَ إِذَا كَانَتْ أَسْمَاءَ أَجْنَاسٍ وَأَنْوَاعٍ فَإِنَّهَا كَمَا كَانَتْ ظَاهِرَةً فِي تَعْمِيمِ مَا تَحْتَهَا، كَذَلِكَ هِيَ ظَاهِرَةٌ فِي تَخْصِيصِ مَعَانِيهَا الَّتِي دَلَّتْ عَلَيْهَا أَوَّلًا بِصِيَغِهَا عَمَّا هُوَ أَعَمُّ مِنْهَا إِلَى أَنْ يَدُلَّ دَلِيلُ التَّعْمِيمِ، وَهُنَا أَيْضًا مَرَاتِبُ فِي الظُّهُورِ.

When these expressions name individuals, they are construed as bearing the specific meaning required by their forms, rather than a meaning encompassing that specific meaning. This is their prima facie import (ظاهر), just as expressions of generality prima facie retain their general scope until evidence of restriction appears. Similarly, names of genera and species prima facie encompass what falls under them, while delimiting the meanings their forms initially signify from anything more general, until evidence requires generalization. Here too there are degrees of prima facie clarity.

وَكَمَا أَنَّ مِنْ عَادَتِهِمْ إِبْدَالَ الْكُلِّيِّ الْعَامِّ مَكَانَ الْجُزْئِيِّ الْخَاصِّ، كَذَلِكَ مِنْ عَادَتِهِمْ هٰهُنَا إِبْدَالُ الْجُزْئِيِّ الْخَاصِّ مَكَانَ الْعَامِّ تَعْوِيلًا فِي ذَلِكَ عَلَى الْقَرَائِنِ. وَهٰذَا أَيْضًا رُبَّمَا كَانَ بَيِّنًا بِنَفْسِهِ وَقَطْعًا، وَرُبَّمَا كَانَ ظَنِّيًّا أَكْثَرِيًّا، وَرُبَّمَا لَمْ يَكُنْ بَيِّنًا بِنَفْسِهِ. وَرُبَّمَا كَانَ بَيِّنًا بِنَفْسِهِ أَنَّهُ مُبْدَلٌ وَلَمْ يَكُنْ بَيِّنًا أَيُّ كُلِّيٍّ أُبْدِلَ الْجُزْئِيُّ مَكَانَهُ.

Just as speakers customarily substitute the general universal for the specific particular, so here they customarily substitute the specific particular for the general, relying on contextual indications (قرائن). This too may be evident in itself and certain, or it may rest on a preponderant probability, or it may not be evident in itself. Sometimes the occurrence of substitution is itself evident, while it remains unclear which universal the particular has been substituted for.

مِثَالُ مَا كَانَ مِنْ ذَلِكَ بَيِّنًا بِنَفْسِهِ وَقَطْعًا قَوْلُهُ تَعَالَى: «وَلَا تَقُلْ لَهُمَا أُفٍّ». وَقَوْلُهُ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ: «أَدُّوا الْخَائِطَ وَالْمِخْيَطَ». وَمِثْلُ مَا كَانَ مِنْ ذَلِكَ بَيِّنًا بِنَفْسِهِ وَلَمْ يَكُنْ قَطْعًا النَّهْيُ عَنْ دُخُولِ الْمَسْجِدِ بِرِيحِ الثُّومِ أَوْ عَنِ الشُّرْبِ بِآنِيَةِ الْفِضَّةِ. وَمِثَالُ مَا لَمْ يَكُنْ مِنْ ذَلِكَ بَيِّنًا بِنَفْسِهِ فَنَهْيُهُ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ عَنْ بَيْعِ الْبُرِّ بِالْبُرِّ الْأَرْبَعَةِ الْمَذْكُورَةِ. فَإِنَّ قَوْمًا حَمَلُوهُ عَلَى الْمُقْتَاتِ وَآخَرُونَ عَلَى الْمَطْعُومِ، وَآخَرُونَ عَلَى الْمَكِيلِ، وَقَوْمٌ قَصَرُوا الْحُكْمَ عَلَى النَّصِّ.

An example evident in itself and certain is His exalted saying, “Do not say ‘Uff’ to the two of them,” and the Prophet’s saying, peace be upon him, “Hand over the thread and the needle.” Examples evident in themselves but not certain are the prohibition of entering the mosque smelling of garlic, and of drinking from silver vessels. An example not evident in itself is his prohibition, peace be upon him, concerning wheat exchanged for wheat—the four commodities mentioned. Some understood it as referring to staple nourishment, others to food, and others to goods measured by volume; others confined the ruling to the stated text.

Editorial notes

N081 [translation] Ibdāl is the substitution of a particular expression for an intended universal meaning. The direction of substitution is retained throughout; it is not silently reversed into the direction in which a jurist extends a ruling.

N082 [textual] The edition quotes Qur’ān 17:23 with ولا; the standard verse has فلا. Arabic reproduces the quotation as printed. The wording about wheat and “the four mentioned” is elliptical in the printed text; compare §218. The editor’s separate hadith variant is not incorporated into Ibn Rushd’s text.

N083 [textual] The edition prints الخائط in §§191 and 215. The English “thread” reads the intended الخياط in this hadith; الخائط ordinarily means a person who sews. Ibn Manẓūr, Lisān al-ʿArab, root خيط, explicitly explains the hadith أدوا الخياط والمخيط as thread and needle: https://islamweb.net/ar/library/content/122/2404/خيط (displayed vol.5, p190). The printed Arabic is retained rather than silently standardized.

BA003 [scholarship] This discussion of how particular expressions can stand for the intended general class is basic to Ibn Rushd’s later separation of semantic inclusion from genuine particular-to-particular qiyās. Bou Akl tests the distinction through the ribā commodity cases, comparing al-Ḍarūrī with the Bidāya and al-Fārābī’s classification. Do not assume that all analogical reasoning concerning ribā transfers a rule without an implicit general meaning. Source: Bou Akl, “Averroes on Juridical Reasoning,” in Interpreting Averroes: Critical Essays (Cambridge UP, 2018), pp. 54–59.

§ 192 From verbal form to understood meaning

1994 Arabic p. 118 · BA §234 · 2015 Arabic p. 274 · French p. 275

فَهٰذَا هُوَ الْقَوْلُ فِي الْأَلْفَاظِ الْمُجْمَلَةِ وَالنُّصُوصِ الظَّاهِرَةِ وَالْمُؤَوَّلَةِ مِنْ جِهَةِ صِيَغِهَا، وَقَدْ بَقِيَ الْقَوْلُ فِي ذَلِكَ مِنْ جِهَةِ الْمَفْهُومِ.

This completes the discussion of indeterminate, unambiguous, prima facie, and interpreted expressions with respect to their forms. It remains to discuss them with respect to their understood meaning (مفهوم).

Editorial notes

N084 [textual] The printed النصوص الظاهرة lacks the conjunction expected in this fourfold classification. The translation follows the four categories repeatedly distinguished by the author.

§ 193 Context determines the force of an implied meaning

1994 Arabic p. 118 · BA §235 · 2015 Arabic p. 274 · French p. 275

As we said before, an expression signifies through its understood meaning when some of its parts are omitted, something is added to it, or it is used metaphorically or by substitution. In such cases its signification comes only through contextual indications. If the contextual indication is unvarying and decisive as to its understood meaning, the expression is again called unambiguous (نص). If it supplies a preponderant probability, it is called prima facie (ظاهر); if it supplies probability without preponderance, it is called indeterminate (مجمل), and evidence for it is sought elsewhere.

وَاللَّفْظُ كَمَا تَقَدَّمَ مِنْ قَوْلِنَا إِنَّمَا يَصِيرُ دَالًّا بِمَفْهُومِهِ عِنْدَمَا تُحْذَفُ بَعْضُ أَجْزَائِهِ، أَوْ يُزَادُ فِيهِ أَوْ يُسْتَعَارُ وَيُبْدَلُ، وَلِذَلِكَ لَا تَكُونُ دَلَالَتُهُ عِنْدَ ذَلِكَ إِلَّا مِنْ جِهَةِ الْقَرَائِنِ، فَإِنْ كَانَتِ الْقَرِينَةُ غَيْرَ مُتَبَدِّلَةٍ وَقَاطِعَةً عَلَى مَفْهُومِهِ سُمِّيَ أَيْضًا هَهُنَا نَصًّا، وَإِنْ كَانَتْ ظَنِّيَّةً أَكْثَرِيَّةً سُمِّيَ أَيْضًا ظَاهِرًا، وَإِنْ كَانَتْ ظَنِّيَّةً غَيْرَ مُتَرَجِّحَةٍ سُمِّيَ مُجْمَلًا، وَطُلِبَ دَلِيلُهُ مِنْ مَوْضِعٍ آخَرَ.

Examples involving metaphor and substitution have already been given. What remains for us here is the case in which this occurs through omission. We say:

وَقَدْ تَقَدَّمَتْ أَمْثِلَةُ ذَلِكَ فِي الْمُسْتَعَارِ وَالْمُبْدَلِ، وَالَّذِي بَقِيَ عَلَيْنَا الْقَوْلُ فِيهِ هَا هُنَا هُوَ مَا كَانَ كَذَلِكَ مِنْ أَجْلِ الْحَذْفِ فَنَقُولُ:

§ 194 Omitted meanings: villagers, marriage, fasting, and a prayer cycle

1994 Arabic p. 118 & 119 · BA §236–239 · 2015 Arabic p. 274 · French p. 275

An example having the status of an unambiguous expression is His exalted saying, “Ask the village in which we were.” It is known with certainty that He means the inhabitants of the village. Likewise, in His exalted saying, “Forbidden to you are your mothers,” what is certainly understood here is marriage.

أَمَّا مِثَالُ مَا كَانَ مِنْ ذَلِكَ بِمَنْزِلَةِ النَّصِّ فَقَوْلُهُ تَعَالَى: «وَاسْأَلِ الْقَرْيَةَ الَّتِي كُنَّا فِيهَا». فَإِنَّهُ يُعْلَمُ قَطْعًا أَنَّهُ أَرَادَ أَهْلَ الْقَرْيَةِ، وَكَذَلِكَ قَوْلُهُ تَعَالَى: «حُرِّمَتْ عَلَيْكُمْ أُمَّهَاتُكُمْ». فَإِنَّ الْمَفْهُومَ هَهُنَا قَطْعًا إِنَّمَا هُوَ النِّكَاحُ.

An example in this class resembling a prima facie expression is his saying, peace be upon him, “There is no fast for one who has not resolved upon the fast overnight.” This may mean that the fast is not complete, or that the fast is not accepted at all; the latter is more apparent. An example thought indeterminate is his saying, peace be upon him, “Whoever has caught one cycle of the prayer has caught the prayer.” It is

وَمِثَالُ مَا هُوَ مِنْ هَذَا الْجِنْسِ كَالظَّاهِرِ قَوْلُهُ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ: «لَا صِيَامَ لِمَنْ لَمْ يُبَيِّتِ الصِّيَامَ». فَإِنَّهُ مُحْتَمِلٌ أَنْ يُرِيدَ لَا صِيَامَ كَامِلٌ وَيَحْتَمِلُ أَنْ يُرِيدَ انْتِفَاءَ قَبُولِ الصِّيَامِ أَصْلًا وَهُوَ الْأَظْهَرُ. وَمِثَالُ مَا يُظَنُّ بِهِ مُجْمَلًا قَوْلُهُ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ:

undecided whether this means obtaining the prayer's merit, its legal effect, or its appointed time.

«مَنْ أَدْرَكَ رَكْعَةً مِنَ الصَّلَاةِ فَقَدْ أَدْرَكَ الصَّلَاةَ» فَإِنَّهُ مُتَرَدِّدٌ بَيْنَ إِدْرَاكِ فَضِيلَةِ الصَّلَاةِ أَوْ حُكْمِهَا أَوْ وَقْتِهَا.

A particularly well-known kind within this class is what they call inference from the discourse (دليل الخطاب). Something is mentioned subject to a qualification or condition, and a ruling is attached to it. It is then judged probable that the ruling belongs to it insofar as it bears that qualification or description, and that, when the description is absent, the ruling ceases to apply and its contradictory applies instead.

وَمِنْ أَشْهَرِ مَا يَدْخُلُ فِي هَذَا الْجِنْسِ النَّوْعُ الَّذِي يَعْرِفُونَهُ بِدَلِيلِ الْخِطَابِ وَهُوَ أَنْ يَرِدَ الشَّيْءُ مُقَيَّدًا بِأَمْرٍ مَا، أَوْ مُشْتَرَطًا فِيهِ شَرْطٌ مَا، وَقَدْ عُلِّقَ بِهِ حُكْمٌ، فَيُظَنَّ أَنَّ ذَلِكَ الْحُكْمَ لَازِمٌ لِذَلِكَ الشَّيْءِ مِنْ جِهَةِ مَا هُوَ مُقَيَّدٌ وَمَوْصُوفٌ، وَأَنَّ الْحُكْمَ مُرْتَفِعٌ عَنْهُ بِارْتِفَاعِ تِلْكَ الصِّفَةِ وَلَازِمٌ نَقِيضُهُ.

This class has several kinds. They disagree over whether these constitute legal evidence. Some have allowed none of them as evidence at all; some have allowed all of them; others have allowed some and denied others. We say concerning this:

وَهَذَا الْجِنْسُ تَحْتَهُ أَصْنَافٌ. وَقَدِ اخْتَلَفُوا فِي كَوْنِهَا أَدِلَّةً شَرْعِيَّةً، فَبَعْضُهُمْ لَمْ يُجِزْ ذَلِكَ فِي جَمِيعِهَا أَصْلًا، وَبَعْضٌ أَجَازَ ذَلِكَ فِي كُلِّهَا، وَبَعْضٌ أَجَازَهُ فِي الْبَعْضِ وَنَفَاهُ عَنِ الْبَعْضِ، وَنَحْنُ نَقُولُ فِي ذَلِكَ:

Editorial notes

N085 [translation] The omitted object in Qur'ān 4:23 is supplied by Ibn Rushd himself as marriage; the contextual character of this certainty is central to his use of naṣṣ. The other Qur'ānic quotation is 12:82.

N086 [translation] Dalīl al-khiṭāb here is contrary implication: the ruling for the unmentioned case is inferred from the qualification of the stated case. It differs from the a fortiori faḥwā al-khiṭāb of §215.

§ 195 Description, condition, restriction, and endpoint

1994 Arabic p. 119 & 120 · BA §240–241 · 2015 Arabic p. 276 · French p. 277

Its kinds include mentioning something qualified by a description, as in his saying, peace be upon him, "Zakāt is due on grazing sheep." Another is to make something conditional through one of the conditional particles, as in "Whoever enters the house, give him a dirham." This, in their view, occupies a stronger rank.

أَمَّا أَصْنَافُهُ فَمِنْهَا أَنْ يَرِدَ الشَّيْءُ مُقَيَّدًا بِصِفَةٍ كَقَوْلِهِ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ: «فِي سَائِمَةِ الْغَنَمِ الزَّكَاةُ». وَمِنْهَا أَنْ يَرِدَ مُشْتَرَطًا فِيهِ شَرْطٌ مَا بِأَحَدِ حُرُوفِ الشَّرْطِ، كَقَوْلِهِ: مَنْ دَخَلَ الدَّارَ فَأَعْطِهِ دِرْهَمًا، وَهَذَا عِنْدَهُمْ أَقْوَى فِي الْمَرْتَبَةِ.

Another restricts a ruling through a restrictive particle: innamā or the definite article al-, as in his saying, peace be upon him, "The rights of clientage belong only to the emancipator," or in "The property belongs to Zayd." Another qualifies something by an endpoint, expressed by "until" or "up to." It seems that everyone has accepted this kind. Examples are His exalted sayings, "Do not approach them until they become pure," "until she marries a husband other than him," and His exalted saying, "Complete the fast until nightfall."

وَمِنْهَا أَنْ يَرِدَ الْحُكْمُ مَحْصُورًا بِأَحَدِ حُرُوفِ الْحَصْرِ، وَهِيَ إِنَّمَا وَالْأَلِفُ وَاللَّامُ، فِي مِثْلِ قَوْلِهِ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ: «إِنَّمَا الْوَلَاءُ لِمَنْ أَعْتَقَ». وَفِي مِثْلِ قَوْلِهِ: الْمَالُ لِزَيْدٍ. وَمِنْهَا أَنْ يُقَيَّدَ الشَّيْءُ بِصِفَةٍ غَائِيَّةٍ، وَتِلْكَ هِيَ الَّتِي يُدَلُّ عَلَيْهَا بِحَتَّى وَإِلَى، وَهَذَا الصِّنْفُ كَأَنَّ جَمِيعَهُمْ قَدْ أَقَرَّ بِالْقَوْلِ بِهِ مِثْلَ قَوْلِهِ تَعَالَى:

«وَلَا تَقْرَبُوهُنَّ حَتَّى يَطْهُرْنَ»، وَ«حَتَّى تَنْكِحَ زَوْجًا غَيْرَهُ». وَقَوْلِهِ تَعَالَى: «وَأَتِمُّوا الصِّيَامَ إِلَى اللَّيْلِ».

فَإِنَّهُ يَكَادُ أَنْ يُعْلَمَ أَنَّ اللَّيْلَ بِخِلَافِ النَّهَارِ فِي انْتِفَاءِ الصَّوْمِ عَنْهُ، وَكَذَلِكَ حَالُ الْحَائِضِ إِذَا طَهُرَتْ بِخِلَافِهَا قَبْلَ أَنْ تَطْهُرَ، وَكَذَلِكَ الْمُطَلَّقَةُ إِذَا نَكَحَتْ زَوْجًا. وَهَذَا النَّوْعُ مِنَ الْكَلَامِ وَجَمِيعُ أَصْنَافِهِ يَنْبَغِي أَنْ يُعْتَقَدَ أَنَّ فِيهِ مَا يُشْبِهُ النَّصَّ وَيَقْوَى قُوَّتَهُ، وَذَلِكَ حَيْثُ يُعْلَمُ أَنَّ ذَلِكَ الْحُكْمَ إِنَّمَا تَعَلَّقَ بِالشَّيْءِ مِنْ جِهَةِ مَا قُيِّدَ أَوِ اشْتُرِطَ فِيهِ ذَلِكَ الشَّرْطُ. وَفِيهِ مَا يُشْبِهُ الظَّاهِرَ، وَفِيهِ مَا يُشْبِهُ الْمُجْمَلَ، وَسَنُشِيرُ إِلَى مَرَاتِبِ الْقَرَائِنِ الَّتِي يَتَرَتَّبُ بِهَا هَذَا التَّرْتِيبُ فِي الدَّلَالَةِ فِي كِتَابِ الْقِيَاسِ.

It is virtually known that night differs from day in that fasting does not extend to it; likewise the menstruating woman's condition after purification differs from her condition beforehand, as does that of the divorced woman after marrying a husband. Within this manner of speaking and all its kinds, some cases must be recognised as resembling the unambiguous and possessing its force: those in which the ruling is known to depend on the qualification or condition. Others resemble the prima facie or the indeterminate. In the discussion of qiyās we shall indicate the ranks of contextual indications that establish these degrees of signification.

Editorial notes

N087 [translation] The Qur'ānic citations are 2:222, 2:230, and 2:187. "Endpoint" renders غائية here; it does not mean a purposive or final cause.

§ 196 From assertions to prescriptions

1994 Arabic p. 120 · BA §242 · 2015 Arabic p. 278 · French p. 279

وَهُنَا انْتَهَى الْكَلَامُ فِي الْأَخْبَارِ وَأَجْزَائِهَا، وَبَعْدَ ذَلِكَ فَلْنَنْظُرْ فِي الْأَوَامِرِ وَالنَّوَاهِي.

Here ends the discussion of assertions and their components. Let us now examine commands and prohibitions.

§ 197 Command, request, and supplication depend on the relation of speakers

1994 Arabic p. 120 · BA §243 · 2015 Arabic p. 278 · French p. 279

وَيَنْبَغِي أَنْ نَنْظُرَ أَيْضًا فِي هَذِهِ هَلْ تَنْقَسِمُ الْقِسْمَةَ الْمُتَقَدِّمَةَ، أَعْنِي هَلْ يُوجَدُ فِيهَا النَّصُّ وَالظَّاهِرُ وَالْمُجْمَلُ، وَإِنْ كَانَ ذَلِكَ مَوْجُودًا فِيهَا فَهَلْ ذَلِكَ مِنْ جِهَةِ صِيَغِهَا أَوْ مِنْ جِهَةِ مَفْهُومِهَا.

We must also examine whether these admit the preceding division: whether unambiguous, prima facie, and indeterminate cases occur among them; and, if so, whether this is through their forms or through their understood meaning.

وَالْكَلَامُ الْمُفِيدُ كَمَا قِيلَ يَنْقَسِمُ إِلَى خَبَرٍ وَأَمْرٍ وَطَلِبَةٍ وَنِدَاءٍ وَتَضَرُّعٍ. وَظَاهِرٌ أَنَّ الْأَمْرَ وَالطَّلِبَةَ وَالتَّضَرُّعَ لَيْسَ لِوَاحِدٍ وَاحِدٍ مِنْهَا فِي اللِّسَانِ الْعَرَبِيِّ صِيَغٌ خَاصَّةٌ، وَإِنَّمَا تَتَمَيَّزُ بِقَرَائِنِ

Meaningful speech, as has been said, divides into assertion, command, request, address, and supplication. Plainly, Arabic does not possess a distinct form for each of command, request, and supplication: they are distinguished by circumstantial indications. Addressed by a

superior to a subordinate, it is a command; by a subordinate to a superior, a supplication; and by an equal to an equal, a request. Each of these three has an opposite. The opposite of command is prohibition, but the opposites of request and supplication have no names.

الْأَحْوَالِ. فَإِذَا كَانَ مِنْ رَئِيسٍ إِلَى مَرْؤُوسٍ كَانَ أَمْرًا، وَإِنْ كَانَ مِنْ مَرْؤُوسٍ إِلَى رَئِيسٍ كَانَ تَضَرُّعًا، وَإِنْ كَانَ مِنْ مُسَاوٍ إِلَى مُسَاوٍ كَانَ طَلِبَةً. وَلِكُلِّ وَاحِدٍ مِنْ هَذِهِ الثَّلَاثَةِ مُقَابِلٌ. فَمُقَابِلُ الْأَمْرِ النَّهْيُ وَلَيْسَ لِمُقَابِلِ الطَّلَبِ وَالتَّضَرُّعِ اسْمٌ.

§ 198 Questions about obligation, timing, and repetition

1994 Arabic p. 121 · BA §244 · 2015 Arabic p. 280 · French p. 281

Our purpose here is to discuss command and prohibition among these divisions. A legal demand (اقتضاء) cannot be conceived as taking the form of a request—unless "request" is taken here as a generic term divided into obligation and recommendation. It is preferable, however, that "command" should admit this division.

وَقَصْدُنَا نَحْنُ هَهُنَا مِنْ هَذِهِ الْأَقْسَامِ أَنْ نَتَكَلَّمَ فِي الْأَمْرِ وَالنَّهْيِ، إِذِ الِاقْتِضَاءُ الشَّرْعِيُّ لَيْسَ يَتَصَوَّرُ وُقُوعُهُ عَلَى جِهَةِ الطَّلَبِ اللَّهُمَّ إِلَّا أَنْ نَجْعَلَ الطَّلَبَ هَهُنَا كَأَنَّهُ اسْمُ جِنْسٍ يَنْقَسِمُ إِلَى الْوَاجِبِ وَالنَّدْبِ، لَكِنَّ الْأَوْلَى أَنْ يَكُونَ الْأَمْرُ يَنْقَسِمُ هَذِهِ الْقِسْمَةَ.

They have disagreed whether the meanings of commands [subsisting] in the soul have particular forms that signify them intrinsically and primarily. If they have forms, do these unambiguously require obligation or recommendation? Or is one of the two more apparent, with the form directed to the other by interpretation, in the manner of interpreting a prima facie expression? Or are the forms indeterminate between obligation and recommendation?

وَقَدِ اخْتَلَفُوا فِي مَعَانِي الْأَوَامِرِ الْعَامَّةِ بِالنَّفْسِ هَلْ لَهَا صِيَغٌ خَاصَّةٌ تَدُلُّ عَلَيْهَا بِالذَّاتِ وَأَوَّلًا، وَإِنْ كَانَ لَهَا صِيَغٌ فَهَلْ تَقْتَضِي الْإِيجَابَ أَوِ النَّدْبَ عَلَى جِهَةِ النَّصِّ، أَمْ هِيَ أَظْهَرُ فِي أَحَدِهِمَا وَمَصْرُوفَةٌ إِلَى الثَّانِي بِالتَّأْوِيلِ، عَلَى جِهَةِ مَا يُؤَوَّلُ الظَّاهِرُ، أَوْ هِيَ مُجْمَلَةٌ بَيْنَ الْإِيجَابِ وَالنَّدْبِ.

Those who hold that commands possess signifying forms also disagree whether those forms require immediate performance, allow delay, or remain undecided between these. Likewise, they disagree whether the forms require repetition or performance once.

وَكَذَلِكَ اخْتَلَفَ الَّذِينَ رَأَوْا أَنَّ لَهَا صِيَغًا دَالَّةً فِي هَلْ تَقْتَضِي أَيْضًا بِصِيَغِهَا الْفَوْرَ، أَمِ التَّرَاخِيَ، أَمْ هِيَ مُتَرَدِّدَةٌ بَيْنَ ذَلِكَ. وَكَذَلِكَ أَيْضًا هَلْ تَقْتَضِي التَّكْرَارَ أَمِ الْفِعْلَ مَرَّةً وَاحِدَةً.

Editorial notes

N088 [textual] The printed reading العامة بالنفس is awkward. The English tentatively understands القائمة بالنفس, "subsisting in the soul," the familiar formulation of the issue whether an inward command has a distinct verbal form. The Arabic preserves the printed reading; this is a conjectural interpretation, not a verified manuscript correction.

§ 199 Linguistic convention and legal usage must be distinguished

1994 Arabic p. 121 · BA §244 · 2015 Arabic p. 280 · French p. 281

We begin this inquiry by considering how these forms stand in linguistic convention and in legal usage. We say:

وَنَحْنُ نَبْتَدِئُ بِالنَّظَرِ فِي ذَلِكَ بِأَنْ نَتَأَمَّلَ كَيْفَ حَالُهَا فِي الْوَضْعِ اللُّغَوِيِّ وَالْعُرْفِ الشَّرْعِيِّ فَنَقُولُ:

§ 200 The imperative’s legal force must be learned from revelation

1994 Arabic p. 121 & 122 · BA §245–247 · 2015 Arabic p. 280 · French p. 281

No one denies that Arabic has forms expressing a demand, such as “Go out! Depart!” These forms can nevertheless occur with the intention of threatening and deterring an action, as in His exalted saying, “Eat and enjoy yourselves a little.” Generally, however, permission is their more apparent import; they signify threat only metaphorically. Likewise, when speakers intend prohibition, they combine the particle lā with these forms, and the resulting combination signifies prohibition through its structure and form.

أَمَّا أَنَّ لِلِاقْتِضَاءِ صِيَغًا فِي كَلَامِ الْعَرَبِ فَذَلِكَ مَا لَا يَدْفَعُهُ أَحَدٌ، كَقَوْلِهِمْ «اخْرُجْ انْطَلِقْ»، وَإِنْ كَانَ قَدْ تَأْتِي هَذِهِ الصِّيَغُ فِي كَلَامِهِمْ وَالْمَقْصُودُ بِهَا التَّهْدِيدُ وَالْكَفُّ عَنِ الْفِعْلِ، كَقَوْلِهِ تَعَالَى: «كُلُوا وَتَمَتَّعُوا قَلِيلًا». وَلَكِنْ بِالْجُمْلَةِ هِيَ أَظْهَرُ فِي الْإِذْنِ، وَإِنَّمَا تَدُلُّ عَلَى التَّهْدِيدِ بِاسْتِعَارَةٍ. وَكَذَلِكَ أَيْضًا إِذَا أَرَادُوا النَّهْيَ قَرَنُوا بِهَذِهِ الصِّيَغِ حَرْفَ لَا، فَصَارَ مَجْمُوعُهَا يَدُلُّ بِشَكْلِهِ وَصِيغَتِهِ عَلَى النَّهْيِ.

Whether these forms signify command intrinsically by linguistic convention is not evident from them; still less is it evident that there are forms signifying obligation or recommendation as such. These are legal meanings, not meanings of ordinary usage. By legal usage, however, the forms undoubtedly contain the meaning of command. Whether they contain obligation or recommendation is disputed. Most jurists hold that commands prima facie signify obligation in the Law, and are directed to recommendation by evidence. Some suspend judgement and regard them as indeterminate.

فَأَمَّا هَلْ تَدُلُّ هَذِهِ الصِّيَغُ بِذَاتِهَا وَضْعًا لُغَوِيًّا عَلَى الْأَمْرِ فَذَلِكَ مِمَّا لَا يَتَبَيَّنُ فِيهَا، وَأَحْرَى مِنْ ذَلِكَ أَنْ تَكُونَ لَهَا صِيَغٌ تَدُلُّ بِهَا عَلَى الْوُجُوبِ أَوِ النَّدْبِ، لِأَنَّ هَذِهِ الْمَعَانِيَ هِيَ مَعَانٍ شَرْعِيَّةٌ وَلَيْسَتْ بِمَعَانٍ جُمْهُورِيَّةٍ. فَأَمَّا بِالْعُرْفِ الشَّرْعِيِّ فَهِيَ لَا شَكَّ مُتَضَمِّنَةٌ مَعْنَى الْأَمْرِ، وَأَمَّا هَلْ تَتَضَمَّنُ الْوُجُوبَ أَوِ النَّدْبَ فَقَدِ اخْتَلَفُوا فِي ذَلِكَ، فَذَهَبَ أَكْثَرُ الْفُقَهَاءِ إِلَى أَنَّ الْأَوَامِرَ ظَاهِرَةٌ فِي مَعْنَى الْإِيجَابِ فِي الشَّرْعِ وَمَصْرُوفَةٌ إِلَى النَّدْبِ بِدَلِيلٍ. وَذَهَبَ بَعْضُهُمْ إِلَى التَّوَقُّفِ فِي ذَلِكَ وَأَنَّهَا مُجْمَلَةٌ.

This should be investigated inductively in the Law, examining how the Companions, may God be pleased with them, received commands when they appeared without contextual indications. Construing them as obligatory seems more prudent, since the circumstances of the Law show that its commands have a firm and decisive character. There is no sense in assigning them

وَيَنْبَغِي أَنْ يُسْتَقْرَأَ ذَلِكَ فِي الشَّرْعِ، وَيُنْظَرَ كَيْفَ كَانَ قَبُولُ الصَّحَابَةِ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمْ لِلْأَوَامِرِ إِذَا وَرَدَتْ مُجَرَّدَةً عَنِ الْقَرَائِنِ. وَيُشْبِهُ أَنْ يَكُونَ حَمْلُهَا عَلَى الْإِيجَابِ أَحْوَطَ، إِذْ قَدْ عُرِفَ مِنْ قَرَائِنِ أَحْوَالِ الشَّرْعِ أَنَّ الْأَوَامِرَ فِيهِ عَلَى جِهَةِ الْجَزْمِ وَالْقَطْعِ. وَأَمَّا مَنْ جَعَلَ ذَلِكَ عَلَى أَقَلِّ مَا يَدُلُّ

what someone claims is the least that a command signifies—recommendation—on the alleged ground that this always accompanies command.

عَلَيْهِ الْأَمْرُ وَهُوَ النَّدْبُ، لِأَنَّهُ زَعَمَ أَنَّ ذَلِكَ هُوَ الَّذِي يَلْزَمُ الْأَمْرَ دَائِمًا، فَلَا مَعْنَى لَهُ.

Editorial notes

N089 [translation] Qur'ān 77:46. The contrast here is between ordinary linguistic usage (جمهورية) and legal usage, not between political regimes.

§ 201 Neither timing nor repetition follows from the form alone

1994 Arabic p. 122 · BA §247–248 · 2015 Arabic p. 282 · French p. 283

Obligation and recommendation are two distinct meanings. Either the expression is equivocal between them or one is its more apparent meaning. If no established legal convention can be shown for these forms, commands remain indeterminate between recommendation and obligation until evidence indicates one of them.

وَالْوَاجِبُ وَالنَّدْبُ مَعْنَيَانِ اثْنَانِ، فَإِمَّا أَنْ يَكُونَ اللَّفْظُ مُشْتَرَكًا بَيْنَهُمَا، أَوْ أَظْهَرَ فِي أَحَدِهِمَا. وَإِمَّا إِنْ لَمْ يَصِحَّ فِيهَا وَضْعٌ شَرْعِيٌّ فَصِيَغُ الْأَوَامِرِ مُجْمَلَةٌ بَيْنَ النَّدْبِ وَالْإِيجَابِ حَتَّى يَدُلَّ الدَّلِيلُ عَلَى أَحَدِهِمَا.

As for whether their forms signify immediacy or delay, this is not contained in them: the determination depends upon circumstantial indications. Hence, when the person commanded is uncertain, it is appropriate to ask "When?" Nor does a command require repetition of the action. It requires at least one performance, and is as it were prima facie in that sense, and it is construed ⟨as repeated⟩ only when a further indication is subsequently supplied.

وَأَمَّا هَلْ تَدُلُّ صِيَغُهَا عَلَى الْفَوْرِ أَوِ التَّرَاخِي فَلَيْسَ ذَلِكَ مَوْجُودًا فِيهَا، وَإِنَّمَا يَتَّكِلُ الْأَمْرُ فِي ذَلِكَ عَلَى قَرَائِنِ الْأَحْوَالِ. وَلِذَلِكَ إِذَا أَشْكَلَ عَلَى الْمَأْمُورِ حَسُنَ أَنْ يَسْتَفْهِمَ بِمَتَى، وَكَذَلِكَ لَا يَقْتَضِي تَكْرَارَ الْفِعْلِ، وَإِنَّمَا تَقْتَضِي أَقَلَّ ذَلِكَ مَرَّةً وَاحِدَةً وَهِيَ كَالظَّاهِرَةِ فِيهَا، وَتُحْمَلُ ⟨عَلَى التَّكْرَارِ⟩ بَعْدَ أَنْ تَرِدَ الزِّيَادَةُ.

Editorial notes

BA15-R08 [textual] Bou Akl's 2015 manuscript-based Arabic p.282 and French p.283 construe the later qualifying addition as indicating repetition, whereas the bare imperative requires only one performance. Read the latter as default, not as a necessary limit.

§ 202 Further questions about command forms

1994 Arabic p. 122 · BA §249 · 2015 Arabic p. 282 · French p. 283

Several questions attach to this discussion; we shall set them out in their customary manner.

وَقَدْ يَتَعَلَّقُ بِالْكَلَامِ فِي هَذَا مَسَائِلُ نَحْنُ نَرْسُمُهَا عَلَى عَادَتِهِمْ.

§ 203 A command after prohibition may merely remove the restriction

1994 Arabic p. 122 & 123 · BA §250 · 2015 Arabic p. 284 · French p. 285

Question. When a command to do something follows a prohibition, some hold that this circumstance redirects the demand which, standing alone, would signify either [obligation]

مَسْأَلَةٌ: إِذَا وَرَدَ الْأَمْرُ بِالشَّيْءِ بَعْدَ الْحَظْرِ، ذَهَبَ قَوْمٌ أَنَّ ذَلِكَ قَرِينَةٌ تَصْرِفُ الِاقْتِضَاءَ الَّذِي شَأْنُهُ أَنْ يَقَعَ لَوْ وَرَدَ

or recommendation, so that it now signifies permission. Others hold that this is not a contextual indication: the form of demand retains its original understood meaning.

مُجَرَّدًا، إِمَّا عَلَى جِهَةِ ⟨الْوُجُوبِ⟩ وَإِمَّا عَلَى جِهَةِ النَّدْبِ إِلَى الْإِبَاحَةِ. وَذَهَبَ قَوْمٌ إِلَى أَنَّ ذَلِكَ لَيْسَ بِقَرِينَةٍ بَلْ تَبْقَى صِيغَةُ الِاقْتِضَاءِ عَلَى مَفْهُومِهَا الْأَوَّلِ.

Abū Ḥāmid says: The preferred view is that, when the prohibition arises for a particular ground and the imperative “Do!” is made conditional upon its cessation—as in His exalted saying, “When you leave the state of consecration, hunt”—customary usage indicates the removal of restriction. It may admit recommendation or [obligation], but the meaning just mentioned is more apparent.

قَالَ أَبُو حَامِدٍ وَالْمُخْتَارُ أَنَّهُ إِذَا كَانَ النَّهْيُ عَارِضًا لِعِلَّةٍ وَعُلِّقَتْ صِيغَةُ افْعَلْ بِزَوَالِهِ، كَقَوْلِهِ تَعَالَى: «وَإِذَا حَلَلْتُمْ فَاصْطَادُوا» فَعُرْفُ الِاسْتِعْمَالِ يَدُلُّ عَلَى أَنَّهُ لِرَفْعِ الْحَرَجِ، وَإِنِ احْتَمَلَ أَنْ يَكُونَ نَدْبًا أَوْ ⟨إِيجَابًا⟩، لَكِنَّهُ أَظْهَرُ فِيمَا ذَكَرْنَا.

Editorial notes

N090 [textual] Bou Akl 2015, BA §250 (Arabic p.284; French p.285), records الاقتضاء as the Escorial [أ] reading against al-ʿAlawī’s [ع] الاقتصار, now adopted. In the same sentence both [أ] and [ع] repeat الندب; Bou Akl conjectures الوجوب for the first occurrence, which the present text represents as ⟨الوجوب⟩, not as manuscript evidence. The bracketed “obligation” in English reproduces that conjecture; it was already recognized as a necessary alternative in the earlier English draft.

N091 [translation] Qur’ān 5:2. The critical crux is at the end of Abū Ḥāmid’s view: both Escorial [أ] and al-ʿAlawī [ع] read إباحةً (“permission”), whereas Bou Akl (2015, BA §250, Arabic p.284, apparatus citing the Mustaṣfā) conjectures إيجابًا (“obligation”). The new reading is therefore ⟨إيجابًا⟩ and [obligation], visibly editorial. The transmitted “permission” remains in the audit; the legal alternatives must not be misrepresented as securely transmitted.

N092 [grammar] The imperative paradigm is printed أفعل. Here it is normalized as اِفْعَلْ (“Do!”), with hamzat al-waṣl and fatḥa on the second radical, rather than the distinct form-IV command أَفْعِل. This is an explicitly recorded orthographic correction; it does not change the quoted command فَاصْطَادُوا.

BA15-V203 [textual] 2015 full-edition control completed for R §203 = Bou Akl §250, Arabic p.284, French p.285. Distinguish manuscript-attested plus conjectural changes as detailed in the preceding notes. See the source-verified change ledger for exact old and new Arabic/English strings.

§ 204 Does making up a timed observance need a new command?

1994 Arabic p. 123 · BA §251 · 2015 Arabic p. 284 · French p. 285

Question. The jurists’ position is that an obligation to make up a missed observance (قضاء) does not require a [renewed] command. Those who carefully distinguish the issues hold that a command to worship at a specified time does not require making it up. Specifying a time for worship—prayer at midday or fasting in Ramadan—is like specifying a place for pilgrimage or a direction for prayer. If the commanded condition is absent, the command ceases to apply, when it was on account of that condition that the command concerning the act was issued.

مَسْأَلَةٌ: مَذْهَبُ الْفُقَهَاءِ أَنَّ وُجُوبَ الْقَضَاءِ لَا يَفْتَقِرُ إِلَى أَمْرٍ مُجَدَّدٍ. وَمَذْهَبُ الْمُحَصِّلِينَ أَنَّ الْأَمْرَ بِعِبَادَةٍ فِي وَقْتٍ مُعَيَّنٍ لَا يَقْتَضِي الْقَضَاءَ، لِأَنَّ تَخْصِيصَ الْعِبَادَةِ بِالزَّمَانِ كَالصَّلَاةِ فِي وَقْتِ الزَّوَالِ وَالصِّيَامِ فِي رَمَضَانَ كَتَخْصِيصِ الْحَجِّ بِالْمَكَانِ وَالصَّلَاةِ بِالْجِهَةِ. وَإِذَا فُقِدَ الشَّرْطُ الْمَأْمُورُ بِهِ ارْتَفَعَ الْأَمْرُ إِذَا كَانَ وُرُودُ الْأَمْرِ بِالشَّيْءِ مِنْ جِهَتِهِ.

Editorial notes

N093 [textual] Printed محدد (“specified”) is retained in Arabic. The English understands the customary issue as requiring an أمر مجدد, a renewed command; this is a conjectural correction of the printed reading.

§ 205 Compliance discharges a duty only when all its conditions are met

1994 Arabic p. 123 · BA §252 · 2015 Arabic p. 284 · French p. 285

مَسْأَلَةٌ: ذَهَبَ الْفُقَهَاءُ إِلَى أَنَّ الْأَمْرَ يَقْتَضِي وُقُوعَ الْجَزَاءِ بِالْمَأْمُورِ بِهِ إِذَا امْتُثِلَ مِنْ غَيْرِ أَنْ يَلْزَمَ قَضَاءٌ. وَقَالَ آخَرُونَ لَا يَقْتَضِي إِلَّا جَزَاءً بِدَلِيلِ أَنَّ مَنْ أَفْسَدَ حَجَّهُ مَأْمُورٌ بِالْإِتْمَامِ وَلَا يُجْزِئُهُ بَلْ يَلْزَمُهُ الْقَضَاءُ.

Question. The jurists hold that a command entails the sufficiency of the commanded act (إجزاء) when it is fulfilled, without an obligation to make it up. Others say that a command does not entail sufficiency: someone who has invalidated his pilgrimage is commanded to complete it, yet this does not suffice, and he must perform it again.

وَالصَّوَابُ أَنْ يُقَالَ إِنَّ الْأَمْرَ يَقْتَضِي إِجْزَاءَ الْمَأْمُورِ بِهِ إِذَا أُدِّيَ بِكَمَالِهِ وَوَصْفِهِ وَجَمِيعِ شُرُوطِهِ، وَأَمَّا إِنْ تَطَرَّقَ إِلَيْهِ خَلَلٌ كَالْحَجِّ الْفَاسِدِ فَلَا يَدُلُّ الْأَمْرُ عَلَى الْإِجْزَاءِ. فَهَذَا هُوَ الْقَوْلُ فِي صِيَغِ الْأَمْرِ.

The correct formulation is that a command entails the sufficiency of the commanded act when it is performed completely, with its prescribed character and all its conditions. If a defect affects it, as with an invalidated pilgrimage, the command does not indicate sufficiency. This completes the discussion of command forms.

Editorial notes

N094 [textual] The first two occurrences of the technical term are printed الجزاء and إلا جزاء. Their sense is الإجزاء, "sufficiency/discharge," as the paragraph's final sentences make explicit. The second is read لا يقتضي الإجزاء, "does not entail sufficiency"; reading an exception ("nothing but recompense") would destroy the argument.

§ 206 Does prohibition entail invalidity?

1994 Arabic p. 123 · BA §253 · 2015 Arabic p. 286 · French p. 287

وَيَنْبَغِي أَنْ تَعْلَمَ أَنَّ الْقَوْلَ فِي صِيَغِ النَّهْيِ كَالْقَوْلِ فِي الْأَمْرِ، وَأَنَّ مَسَائِلَهُ مُعَادِلَةٌ لِتِلْكَ. فَمَنْ يَحْمِلُ صِيغَةَ الْأَمْرِ عَلَى الْإِيجَابِ يَحْمِلُ صِيغَةَ النَّهْيِ عَلَى الْحَظْرِ وَالتَّحْرِيمِ عَلَى فَسَادِ الْمَنْهِيِّ. وَسَوَاءٌ كَانَ النَّهْيُ فِي الشَّيْءِ مُطْلَقًا أَوْ مُقَيَّدًا بِصِفَةٍ أَوْ شَرْطٍ، فَإِنَّهُ يَعُودُ النَّهْيُ بِفَسَادِ الْأَصْلِ مِنْ جِهَةِ مَا قُيِّدَ بِهِ وَاشْتُرِطَ.

Know that the discussion of prohibitive forms parallels that of commands, and its questions correspond to theirs. Whoever construes a command form as imposing obligation construes a prohibitive form as imposing interdiction, and prohibition as indicating the invalidity of the prohibited act. Whether the prohibition concerns the act without qualification or with a description or condition, it renders the underlying act invalid insofar as it bears that qualification or condition.

§ 207 Returning to the earlier account of the forbidden

1994 Arabic p. 123 · BA §253 · 2015 Arabic p. 286 · French p. 287

وَهَذِهِ هِيَ الْمَسْأَلَةُ الَّتِي تَقَدَّمَ ذِكْرُهَا فِي الْجُزْءِ الْأَوَّلِ، وَقُلْنَا إِنَّ الْأَلْيَقَ بِالتَّكَلُّمِ فِيهَا هُوَ هَذَا الْمَوْضِعُ.

This is the question mentioned earlier in Part One, where we said that the present place would be more appropriate for discussing it.

§ 208 Absolute prohibition and dislike: the need for an indication

1994 Arabic p. 124 · BA §254 · 2015 Arabic p. 286 · French p. 287

Anyone who considers a command form undecided between obligation and recommendation must likewise consider a prohibitive expression undecided between interdiction and disapproval. This holds whether it concerns the underlying act without qualification or with a description or a cause external to it.

وَأَمَّا مَنْ كَانَ عِنْدَهُ صِيغَةُ الْأَمْرِ مُتَرَدِّدَةً بَيْنَ الْإِيجَابِ وَالنَّدْبِ، فَإِنَّهُ يَلْزَمُهُ أَنْ يَكُونَ لَفْظُ النَّهْيِ أَيْضًا مُتَرَدِّدًا بَيْنَ الْحَظْرِ وَالْكَرَاهَةِ، وَسَوَاءٌ وَرَدَ فِي أَصْلِ الشَّيْءِ مُطْلَقًا أَوْ مُقَيَّدًا بِصِفَةٍ أَوْ سَبَبٍ خَارِجٍ عَنْهُ.

Some who hold that commands and prohibitions have forms requiring obligation and interdiction nevertheless treat their application to an act qualified by an external cause as a contextual indication. On this account the forms cease to convey obligation and interdiction and instead convey recommendation and disapproval. This completes the discussion of evidence received through expressions.

اللَّهُمَّ إِلَّا أَنَّ بَعْضَ النَّاسِ مِمَّنْ يَرَى أَنَّ لِلْأَمْرِ وَالنَّهْيِ صِيغَةً تَقْتَضِي الْإِيجَابَ وَالْحَظْرَ يَجْعَلُ كَوْنَهَا إِذَا وَرَدَتْ فِي شَيْءٍ مُقَيَّدٍ بِسَبَبٍ مَا خَارِجٍ عَنِ الشَّيْءِ، قَرِينَةً تَخْرُجُ بِهَا الصِّيَغُ عَنْ كَوْنِهَا مُفِيدَةً لِلْإِيجَابِ وَالْحَظْرِ إِلَى النَّدْبِ وَالْكَرَاهِيَةِ. فَهَذَا هُوَ الْقَوْلُ فِي الْأَدِلَّةِ الْمُتَلَقَّاةِ مِنْ جِهَةِ الْأَلْفَاظِ.

§ 209 From commands to the contextual indications called qiyās

1994 Arabic p. 124 · BA §255 · 2015 Arabic p. 286 · French p. 287

It remains for us to discuss signifying contextual indications, such as the Prophet’s silence and tacit approval, God bless him and grant him peace. Before that, however, we must examine the evidence they call qiyās.

وَقَدْ بَقِيَ عَلَيْنَا الْقَوْلُ فِي الْقَرَائِنِ الدَّالَّةِ كَسُكُوتِهِ وَإِقْرَارِهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ، لَكِنْ قَبْلَ ذَلِكَ يَجِبُ أَنْ نَنْظُرَ فِي الدَّلِيلِ الَّذِي يَعْرِفُونَهُ بِالْقِيَاسِ.

§ 210 The jurists’ definition of analogy: original, derivative and ground

1994 Arabic p. 124 & 125 · BA §256–257 · 2015 Arabic p. 288 · French p. 289

We must examine whether qiyās is legal evidence and, if it is, whether it belongs to the kinds already discussed. Our approach will be to investigate what the term qiyās signifies for them in this discipline. We say:

وَيَنْبَغِي أَنْ نَنْظُرَ فِيهِ هَلْ هُوَ دَلِيلٌ شَرْعِيٌّ أَمْ لَا، وَإِنْ كَانَ دَلِيلًا شَرْعِيًّا فَهَلْ هُوَ مِنْ جِنْسِ مَا تَقَدَّمَ أَمْ لَا، وَنَجْعَلَ سَبِيلَنَا فِي الْفَحْصِ عَنْ ذَلِكَ مِمَّا يَدُلُّ عَلَيْهِ اسْمُ الْقِيَاسِ عِنْدَهُمْ فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ فَنَقُولُ:

They describe it as assimilating one of two things to the other in affirming or denying a ruling, when the affirmation or denial is more apparent in one than in the other, because they share a

إِنَّهُمْ يَرْسُمُونَ هَذَا الْمَعْنَى بِأَنَّهُ حَمْلُ شَيْئَيْنِ أَحَدِهِمَا عَلَى الْآخَرِ فِي إِثْبَاتِ حُكْمٍ أَوْ نَفْيِهِ، إِذَا كَانَ الْإِثْبَاتُ أَوِ النَّفْيُ فِي

ground or attribute. They call the thing in which the ruling is more apparent the original case (أصل); the thing assigned the ruling because it holds in the original case, the derivative case (فرع); and the shared attribute or cause, the operative ground (علة).

أَحَدِهِمَا أَظْهَرَ مِنْهُ فِي الْآخَرِ، وَذَلِكَ لِأَمْرٍ جَامِعٍ بَيْنَهُمَا مِنْ عِلَّةٍ أَوْ صِفَةٍ. وَالشَّيْءَ الَّذِي وُجُودُ الْحُكْمِ فِيهِ أَظْهَرُ يُسَمُّونَهُ الْأَصْلَ، وَالشَّيْءَ الَّذِي يُوجَبُ لَهُ الْحُكْمُ مِنْ أَجْلِ وُجُودِهِ فِي الْأَصْلِ يُسَمُّونَهُ الْفَرْعَ. وَالصِّفَةَ الْجَامِعَةَ بَيْنَهُمَا أَوِ السَّبَبَ يُسَمُّونَهُ الْعِلَّةَ.

Editorial notes

BA004 [scholarship] The jurists' initial account names an original case (aṣl), a derivative case (far'), and a shared 'illa. Ibn Rushd then subjects the extension of the term qiyās itself to analysis: the issue is what mental operation is really being performed, not merely which inference label jurists conventionally use. Compare Bou Akl's distinction between qiyās as juristic umbrella term and as syllogismos in strict logic: Bou Akl, "Averroes on Juridical Reasoning," in Interpreting Averroes: Critical Essays (Cambridge UP, 2018), pp. 45–48.

§ 211 Nonexistence, negation and the scope of the definition

1994 Arabic p. 125 · BA §258 · 2015 Arabic p. 288 · French p. 289

One should not object to our saying "two things" rather than, as in their description, "two objects of knowledge," on the alleged ground that "thing" does not apply to the nonexistent: the nonexistent is scarcely ever made a basis of comparison. Even granting their point, nothing prevents calling the nonexistent a thing insofar as it exists in the soul. Some things are in the soul as they are outside it; others are in the soul without existing outside it. In general, the theologians should not have quibbled with the Mu'tazila over this.

وَيَنْبَغِي أَنْ لَا تَأْخُذَ عَلَيْنَا لِقَوْلِنَا حَمْلُ شَيْئَيْنِ، وَلَمْ نَقُلْ مَعْلُومَيْنِ عَلَى رَسْمِهِمْ، مِنْ قِبَلِ أَنَّ الشَّيْءَ — زَعَمُوا — لَا يَنْطَلِقُ عَلَى الْمَعْدُومِ، فَإِنَّ الْمَعْدُومَ يَكَادُ لَا يُقَاسُ عَلَيْهِ. وَأَيْضًا فَلَوْ سَلَّمْنَا لَهُمْ هَذَا لَمْ يَكُنْ مُمْتَنِعًا أَنْ يُسَمَّى الْمَعْدُومُ شَيْئًا إِذْ كَانَ لَهُ وُجُودٌ فِي النَّفْسِ، لِأَنَّا نَقُولُ مِنَ الْأَشْيَاءِ مَا هُوَ فِي النَّفْسِ كَمَا لَهُ خَارِجَ النَّفْسِ، وَمِنْهَا مَا هُوَ فِي النَّفْسِ مِنْ غَيْرِ أَنْ يَكُونَ خَارِجَ النَّفْسِ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَقَدْ كَانَ يَنْبَغِي لِلْمُتَكَلِّمِينَ أَلَّا يُشَاحُّوا الْمُعْتَزِلَةَ فِي مِثْلِ هَذَا.

Nor should one attend to their saying, "because of a common factor, whether an attribute or a cause, or the negation of these in both." Negation as negation does not require one ruling for two things—except where negation has the force of privation, and privation follows an attribute that requires a ruling for both things. Our discussion has carried us away from our initial purpose. Let us return to where we were and say:

وَكَذَلِكَ أَيْضًا لَا يُلْتَفَتُ إِلَى قَوْلِهِمْ: لِأَمْرٍ جَامِعٍ بَيْنَهُمَا مِنْ صِفَةٍ أَوْ سَبَبٍ أَوْ نَفْيِهِمَا عَنْهُمَا. فَإِنَّ النَّفْيَ مِنْ جِهَةِ مَا هُوَ نَفْيٌ لَا يُوجِبُ حُكْمًا وَاحِدًا لِشَيْئَيْنِ، اللَّهُمَّ إِلَّا مِنْ جِهَةِ أَنَّ النَّفْيَ فِي مَوَاضِعَ قُوَّتُهُ قُوَّةُ الْعَدَمِ، وَالْعَدَمُ تَابِعٌ لِصِفَةٍ مَا تَقْتَضِي حُكْمًا لِشَيْئَيْنِ. وَقَدْ جَمَحَ بِنَا الْقَوْلُ عَمَّا كُنَّا قَصَدْنَا إِلَيْهِ مِنْ أَوَّلِ الْأَمْرِ فَلْنَرْجِعْ إِلَى حَيْثُ كُنَّا فَنَقُولُ:

Editorial notes

N095 [translation] The contrast between نفي (negation) and عدم (privation/nonbeing) is retained. Here عدم functions as a privation associated with a positive attribute, not simply as the logical operation of negating.

BA15-E258 [textual] Bou Akl 2015 prints one or more editorial angle-bracket additions in his §258 (Arabic edition around p.288, corresponding French translation around p.289). They are not automatically adopted here: some were already present in the al-'Alawī-based reading text, others are uncertain. Check his footnotes and the 1994 printed base before treating these

as independent manuscript readings. This entry records editorial intervention, not verified word-for-word collation of every line in that section.

§ 212 Most legal qiyās is substitution within an understood meaning

1994 Arabic p. 125 & 126 · BA §259–260 · 2015 Arabic p. 290 · French p. 291

Examining what they mean by qiyās here shows that it is not a syllogism, but belongs to using a particular expression in place of the intended universal. The evidence is that the original case receives its ruling through a text or consensus. If the operative ground requiring the ruling is expressly stated and is more general than the original case, this belongs to general expression. An example is his saying, God bless him and grant him peace, concerning water left by a cat: “[The cat] is not impure, because it is among those that circulate around you, male or female.” This too has degrees; many who reject qiyās allow such cases.

إِنَّهُ إِذَا تُؤُمِّلَ هَذَا الْمَعْنَى الَّذِي يَعْنُونَهُ بِالْقِيَاسِ فِي هَذَا الْمَوْضِعِ ظَهَرَ أَنَّ ذَلِكَ لَيْسَ بِقِيَاسٍ، وَأَنَّهُ مِنْ جِنْسِ إِبْدَالِ الْجُزْئِيِّ مَكَانَ الْكُلِّيِّ. وَالدَّلِيلُ عَلَى ذَلِكَ أَنَّ الْأَصْلَ إِنَّمَا تَعَلَّقَ بِهِ الْحُكْمُ بِالنَّصِّ أَوْ بِالْإِجْمَاعِ، فَإِنْ صُرِّحَ بِالْعِلَّةِ الْمُوجِبَةِ لِلْحُكْمِ، وَكَانَتْ أَعَمَّ مِنَ الْأَصْلِ، فَهَذَا يَلْتَحِقُ بِالْعَامِّ، مِثْلَ قَوْلِهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ فِي سُؤْرِ الْهِرَّةِ: «إِنَّهَا لَيْسَتْ بِنَجَسٍ لِأَنَّهَا مِنَ الطَّوَّافِينَ عَلَيْكُمْ أَوِ الطَّوَّافَاتِ» وَلَهَا أَيْضًا مَرَاتِبُ، وَقَدْ أَجَازَ مِثْلَ هَذَا كَثِيرٌ مِمَّنْ نَفَى الْقِيَاسَ.

If the ground requiring the ruling is not expressly stated, but the expression’s understood meaning requires it and it is more general than the original case, this is using a particular expression in place of the intended universal. We then assign the ruling to anything shown, through independent inquiry or sense perception, to fall under that universal. An example is his prohibition of drinking from silver vessels, God bless him and grant him peace. Extravagance is understood from it; hence we extend the ruling to gold vessels.

وَأَمَّا إِذَا لَمْ يَكُنْ صَرَّحَ بِالْعِلَّةِ الْمُوجِبَةِ لِلْحُكْمِ وَاقْتَضَاهَا مَفْهُومُ اللَّفْظِ، وَكَانَتْ أَعَمَّ مِنَ الْأَصْلِ، كَانَ مِنْ بَابِ إِبْدَالِ الْجُزْئِيِّ مَكَانَ الْكُلِّيِّ. وَعِنْدَ ذَلِكَ أَيُّمَا صَحَّ بِالِاجْتِهَادِ أَوْ بِالْحِسِّ أَنَّهُ دَاخِلٌ تَحْتَ ذَلِكَ الْكُلِّيِّ أَلْحَقْنَا بِهِ ذَلِكَ الْحُكْمَ. وَمِثَالُهُ نَهْيُهُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ عَنِ الشُّرْبِ فِي آنِيَةِ الْفِضَّةِ، فَإِنَّ الْمَفْهُومَ مِنْهُ السَّرَفُ، فَلِذَلِكَ أَلْحَقْنَا بِهِ آنِيَةَ الذَّهَبِ.

Editorial notes

N096 [translation] The Arabic قياس in the denial is rendered “syllogism,” preserving Ibn Rushd’s distinction between actual inference and the jurists’ broader use of qiyās. The editor’s suggestion on p126 that الكلي and الجزئي should be reversed is not adopted: the printed order agrees with §§191 and 221. The particular wording stands in for an intended universal meaning.

N097 [translation] سؤر is the liquid remaining after an animal has drunk. The cat hadith’s masculine/feminine alternatives are preserved rather than silently replaced with a different transmitted wording.

BA005 [scholarship] Here the particular expression stands in the discourse where the intended universal could have stood; the judge/reader recovers that universal through the indication of the expression or its recognized contextual sign. This is not the construction of an extra-textual universal from natural causality. Bou Akl describes the procedure as ibdāl, or substitution, and contrasts it with strict inferential qiyās. The corresponding reference in his 2015 numbering is §259; this reader’s §212 follows al-ʿAlawī 1994. Source: Bou Akl, “Averroes on Juridical Reasoning,” in Interpreting Averroes: Critical Essays (Cambridge UP, 2018), pp. 49–51.

BA15-I07 [interpretive] Strict vs broad analogy. Bou Akl 2015 intro pp.57–70 distinguishes deriving a ruling by recovering an intended universal from a case where a legal relation between two particulars cannot be supported by such an indicated universal. The narrow genuine qiyās is not denied; his reading is a scholarly argument and needs case-by-case Bidaya testing.

§ 213 What warrants substitution: relevant contextual indications

1994 Arabic p. 126 · BA §261 · 2015 Arabic p. 290 · French p. 291

Since this is so, what they mean by qiyās in this discipline generally comes back to what expressions require through their understood meanings. Expressions require this only through accompanying contextual indications—not just any indications, but those whose kind the Law demonstrably takes into account. The situation is thus like that of ordinary communication.

وَإِذَا كَانَ هَذَا هَكَذَا، وَكَانَ مَا يَعْنُونَهُ بِالْقِيَاسِ فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ فِي الْأَكْثَرِ رَاجِعًا إِلَى مَا تَقْتَضِيهِ الْأَلْفَاظُ بِمَفْهُومَاتِهَا، وَكَانَتِ الْأَلْفَاظُ إِنَّمَا تَقْتَضِي ذَلِكَ بِالْقَرَائِنِ الَّتِي تَقْتَرِنُ بِهَا، وَلَكِنْ لَيْسَ أَيَّ قَرِينَةٍ اتَّفَقَتْ لَكِنِ الْقَرَائِنَ الَّتِي يَشْهَدُ الشَّرْعُ بِالِالْتِفَاتِ إِلَى جِنْسِهَا، فَإِنَّ الْحَالَ فِي ذَلِكَ كَالْحَالِ فِي الْمُخَاطَبَةِ الْجُمْهُورِيَّةِ.

Just as the contextual indications on which a Bedouin relies when addressing another must be known to the addressee, and the speaker's attention to them in speaking must be known, so it must be in the Law. We shall indicate them individually and arrange them according to their degrees of clarity.

فَكَمَا أَنَّ الْقَرَائِنَ الَّتِي يُعَوِّلُ عَلَيْهَا الْأَعْرَابِيُّ عِنْدَ مُخَاطَبَةِ غَيْرِهِ تَكُونُ مَعْلُومَةً عِنْدَ الْمُخَاطَبِ، وَقَدْ عَرَفَ الْتِفَاتَ الْمُخَاطِبِ فِي حِينِ مُخَاطَبَتِهِ إِلَيْهَا، كَذَلِكَ يَنْبَغِي أَنْ يَكُونَ فِي الشَّرْعِ. وَنَحْنُ نُشِيرُ إِلَى وَاحِدَةٍ وَاحِدَةٍ مِنْهَا، وَنُرَتِّبُهَا بِحَسَبِ مَرَاتِبِهَا فِي الْبَيَانِ.

Editorial notes

BA006 [scholarship] The qualification "not just any contextual indication" is decisive. Ibn Rushd restricts extension to a class of qarā'in whose relevance the Law itself witnesses. Thus interpreting implied legal meaning is neither private guesswork nor an unrestricted appeal to similarity. Bou Akl quotes and analyzes this passage as 2015 §261; current §213. Source: Bou Akl, "Averroes on Juridical Reasoning," in Interpreting Averroes: Critical Essays (Cambridge UP, 2018), pp. 49–50.

§ 214 Certain, probable and indeterminate extensions

1994 Arabic p. 126 & 127 · BA §262 · 2015 Arabic p. 292 · French p. 293

As we said, contextual indications can make a statement unambiguous through its understood meaning, when they establish its metaphor or substitution decisively; or prima facie through its understood meaning, when they are preponderant rather than decisive; or indeterminate, when they remain undecided. We should therefore indicate their ranks here, although they are difficult to delimit precisely. We say:

وَلِأَنَّ الْقَرَائِنَ كَمَا تَقَدَّمَ مِنْ قَوْلِنَا أَحَدُ مَا يَجْعَلُ الْقَوْلَ كَالنَّصِّ بِمَفْهُومِهِ، وَذَلِكَ إِذَا كَانَتْ قَاطِعَةً فِي اسْتِعَارَتِهِ وَإِبْدَالِهِ، أَوْ كَالظَّاهِرِ بِمَفْهُومِهِ إِذَا لَمْ تَكُنْ قَاطِعَةً بَلْ أَكْثَرِيَّةً، أَوْ كَالْمُجْمَلِ إِذَا كَانَتْ مُتَرَدِّدَةً، فَقَدْ يَنْبَغِي هَهُنَا أَنْ نُشِيرَ إِلَى مَرَاتِبِهَا وَإِنْ كَانَتْ عَسِيرًا مَا تَنْضَبِطُ فَنَقُولُ:

Editorial notes

BA15-E262 [textual] Bou Akl 2015 prints one or more editorial angle-bracket additions in his §262 (Arabic edition around p.292, corresponding French translation around p.293). They are not automatically adopted here: some were already present in the al-'Alawī-based reading text, others are uncertain. Check his footnotes and the 1994 printed base before treating these as independent manuscript readings. This entry records editorial intervention, not verified word-for-word collation of every line in that section.

§ 215 The stronger case: a fortiori indication

1994 Arabic p. 127 · BA §263 · 2015 Arabic p. 292 · French p. 293

أَمَّا الْمَرْتَبَةُ الْأُولَى وَهِيَ فِي حُكْمِ النَّصِّ فَأَنْ يَكُونَ الْمَسْكُوتُ عَنْهُ أَحْرَى مِنَ الْمَنْطُوقِ بِهِ فِي تَعَلُّقِ الْحُكْمِ بِهِ كَقَوْلِهِ تَعَالَى: «إِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يَظْلِمُ مِثْقَالَ ذَرَّةٍ»، وَقَوْلِهِ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ: «وَلَا تَقُلْ لَهُمَا أُفٍّ». وَمِثْلُ هَذَا قَوْلُهُ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ: «أَدُّوا الْخَائِطَ وَالْمِخْيَطَ»، وَمَا أَشْبَهَهَا، وَلِهَذَا عَرَضٌ فِي الْبَيَانِ. وَهَذَا يُسَمُّونَهُ بِفَحْوَى الْخِطَابِ، وَأَكْثَرُهُمْ لَيْسَ يُسَمِّيهِ قِيَاسًا.

The first rank has the status of an unambiguous expression: the ruling applies with greater reason to the unmentioned case than to the stated one. Examples are His exalted saying, “God does not wrong anyone by an atom’s weight,” and His saying, mighty and exalted, “Do not say ‘Uff’ to the two of them”; likewise the Prophet’s saying, peace be upon him, “Hand over the thread and the needle,” and similar expressions. This has a range of clarity. They call it the purport of the discourse (فحوى الخطاب), and most do not call it qiyās.

Editorial notes

N098 [translation] Qur’ān 4:40 and 17:23. The relation is a fortiori: forbidding the lesser harm indicates the graver harm with greater reason. عرض here means a range or breadth of degrees, not an accidental property.

N099 [textual] Printed الخائط is retained; English “thread” understands الخياط. See the lexical and textual note at §191.

BA007 [scholarship] The a fortiori treatment shows how a prohibition against a lesser case may semantically include a more serious unstated case. Bou Akl distinguishes this mode of apprehending the legislator’s intention from moving directly between two particular cases by an inferred resemblance. “No qiyās” in the strict sense here does not mean “no interpretive reasoning.” Source: Bou Akl, “Averroes on Juridical Reasoning,” in Interpreting Averroes: Critical Essays (Cambridge UP, 2018), pp. 47–50, 52–54.

BA15-E263 [textual] Bou Akl 2015 prints one or more editorial angle-bracket additions in his §263 (Arabic edition around p.292, corresponding French translation around p.293). They are not automatically adopted here: some were already present in the al-ʿAlawī-based reading text, others are uncertain. Check his footnotes and the 1994 printed base before treating these as independent manuscript readings. This entry records editorial intervention, not verified word-for-word collation of every line in that section.

§ 216 Equal extension: the legal meaning beyond a named individual

1994 Arabic p. 127 · BA §264 · 2015 Arabic p. 292 · French p. 293

الْمَرْتَبَةُ الثَّانِيَةُ: أَنْ يَكُونَ الْمَسْكُوتُ عَنْهُ فِي مَعْنَى الْمَنْطُوقِ بِهِ فِي الْحُكْمِ، كَقَوْلِهِ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ: «مَنْ أَعْتَقَ شِرْكًا لَهُ فِي عَبْدٍ قُوِّمَ عَلَيْهِ الْبَاقِي»، فَإِنَّ الْأَمَةَ تَلْتَحِقُ بِالْعَبْدِ وَهِيَ فِي مَعْنَاهُ. وَهَذَا يُسَمُّونَهُ بِالْقِيَاسِ فِي مَعْنَى الْأَصْلِ. وَلِهَذَا أَيْضًا عَرَضٌ فِي الظُّهُورِ وَقِلَّةِ الظُّهُورِ.

The second rank is where the unmentioned case has the same relevant meaning as the stated case with respect to the ruling. An example is his saying, peace be upon him, “Whoever emancipates his share in a slave must have the remainder assessed against him.” The case of a female slave is included with that of a male slave, since it has the same relevant meaning. They call this analogy within the meaning of the original case (القياس في معنى الأصل). This too has a range of greater and lesser clarity.

§ 217 Suitable grounds, recognised goods and the limit of legislation

1994 Arabic p. 127 & 128 · BA §265–266 · 2015 Arabic p. 292 · French p. 293

The third rank is of the same kind as the second: it is prima facie. In most cases, however, its clarity is weaker, so we have placed it third. Here the unmentioned case is joined to the stated one because of a shared benefit (مصلحة), whose kind the Law has acknowledged as beneficial. They call this analogy from a plausible, suitable ground (القياس المخيل والمناسب).

الْمَرْتَبَةُ الثَّالِثَةُ: وَهَذِهِ الْمَرْتَبَةُ مِنْ جِنْسِ الثَّانِيَةِ، أَعْنِي أَنَّهَا ظَاهِرَةٌ، لَكِنَّهَا فِي أَكْثَرِ الْمَوَاضِعِ تَضْعُفُ عَنْ مَرْتَبَتِهَا فِي الْبَيَانِ، فَلِذَلِكَ جَعَلْنَاهَا ثَالِثَةً. وَهِيَ أَنْ يَكُونَ الْمَسْكُوتُ عَنْهُ يَلْتَحِقُ بِالْمَنْطُوقِ بِهِ لِمَصْلَحَةٍ جَامِعَةٍ قَدْ شَهِدَ الشَّرْعُ لِجِنْسِهَا بِأَنَّهُ مَصْلَحَةٌ. وَهَذَا يُسَمُّونَهُ الْقِيَاسَ الْمُخَيَّلَ وَالْمُنَاسِبَ.

This kind has degrees of proximity and remoteness. When it is very close, they call it a congruent suitable ground (المناسب الملائم); many proponents of qiyās stop here. When it is intermediate, they do not call it congruent, but suitable and plausible. When it is very remote and completely general, as when we simply say “benefit,” many proponents of qiyās reject it. Some jurists reason in this way when holding that divorce pronounced by a sick man does not cut off inheritance.

وَلِهَذَا الْجِنْسِ مَرَاتِبُ فِي الْقُرْبِ وَالْبُعْدِ، فَمَتَى كَانَ قَرِيبًا جِدًّا سَمَّوْهُ الْمُنَاسِبَ الْمُلَائِمَ، وَهُنَا انْتَهَى كَثِيرٌ مِنَ الْقَائِلِينَ بِالْقِيَاسِ. وَمَتَى كَانَ مُتَوَسِّطًا فِي الْقُرْبِ وَالْبُعْدِ لَمْ يُطْلِقُوا عَلَيْهِ اسْمَ الْمُلَائِمِ، وَسَمَّوْهُ الْمُنَاسِبَ وَالْمُخَيَّلَ. وَمَتَى كَانَ بَعِيدًا جِدًّا وَأَعَمَّ شَيْءٍ، كَقَوْلِنَا مَصْلَحَةٌ، فَإِنَّ كَثِيرًا مِنَ الْقَائِلِينَ بِالْقِيَاسِ لَا يَقُولُ بِهِ. وَمِثْلُ هَذَا يَرَاهُ بَعْضُ الْفُقَهَاءِ فِي طَلَاقِ الْمَرِيضِ أَنَّهُ لَا يَقْطَعُ الْمِيرَاثَ.

This last kind rightly deserves rejection as legal evidence, since benefits often diverge and vary with each time and circumstance. Those who reason this way are in fact legislating, rather than deriving rulings from the Law. An example is someone’s saying, “New rulings arise for people in proportion to the new wickedness they introduce,” or words to that effect. Mālik, God have mercy upon him, has been reproached for this, because he often attends to this kind.

وَحَقٌّ لِهَذَا الصِّنْفِ أَنْ يُرْفَضَ وَلَا يُجْعَلَ دَلِيلًا شَرْعِيًّا لِأَنَّهُ كَثِيرًا مَا تَتَشَعَّبُ الْمَصَالِحُ وَتَخْتَلِفُ، وَذَلِكَ بِحَسَبِ وَقْتٍ وَقْتٍ وَحَالَةٍ حَالَةٍ. وَالْقَائِلُونَ بِمِثْلِ هَذَا لَيْسَ هُمْ فِي الْحَقِيقَةِ مُسْتَنْبِطِينَ عَنِ الشَّرْعِ، بَلْ هُمْ شَارِعُونَ. وَمِثْلُ هَذَا قَوْلُ بَعْضِهِمْ: يَحْدُثُ لِلنَّاسِ أَحْكَامٌ بِقَدْرِ مَا أَحْدَثُوا مِنَ الْفُجُورِ، أَوْ قَوْلٌ شَبِيهٌ بِهَذَا. وَقَدْ عُذِلَ مَالِكٌ رَحِمَهُ اللَّهُ عَلَى هَذَا، لِأَنَّهُ كَثِيرًا مَا يَلْتَفِتُ إِلَى هَذَا الْجِنْسِ.

Editorial notes

N100 [project] The project glossary’s “imaginal/persuasive analogy” has been corrected here. The local definition concerns a plausible legal ground made suitable by benefit and recognition in the Law. Ghazālī explicitly connects المعنى المخيل والمناسب with the preservation of legal objectives in Mustaṣfā, p174, https://ablibrary.net/book_content/b/4388/174?lang=ar. This is not the poetic imagination.

N101 [translation] The rejection concerns the last, remote and unrestricted appeal to benefit; it should not be expanded into rejection of every legally grounded consideration of maṣlaḥa. The inheritance example concerns the effect of a sick husband’s divorce on the wife’s claim.

BA008 [scholarship] The suitable ground or recognized maṣlaḥa in this section is restricted by the explicit condition that the Law acknowledges the relevant kind. Bou Akl’s analysis of semantic substitution cautions against treating an independently posited worldly benefit as a free-standing source of legal status. The passage also requires care: a jurist can reason about which general meaning the legal discourse indicates, without identifying this act with a demonstrative deduction. Source:

Bou Akl, “Averroes on Juridical Reasoning,” in Interpreting Averroes: Critical Essays (Cambridge UP, 2018), pp. 49–52. This is a comparison, not a report of a passage-specific 2015 French translation variant.

BA15-E266 [textual] Bou Akl 2015 prints one or more editorial angle-bracket additions in his §266 (Arabic edition around p.294, corresponding French translation around p.295). They are not automatically adopted here: some were already present in the al-ʿAlawī-based reading text, others are uncertain. Check his footnotes and the 1994 printed base before treating these as independent manuscript readings. This entry records editorial intervention, not verified word-for-word collation of every line in that section.

§ 218 Resemblance and uncertainty about the operative ground

1994 Arabic p. 128 & 129 · BA §267 · 2015 Arabic p. 294 · French p. 295

The fourth rank is what they call analogy by resemblance (قياس الشبه). The unmentioned case is joined to the stated one neither because it has a stronger claim, nor because it shares the same relevant meaning, nor because of a suitable operative ground. Rather, a resemblance between them suggests that it contains a ground common to both cases and appropriate to the ruling, although that ground has not been identified.

الْمَرْتَبَةُ الرَّابِعَةُ: وَهِيَ الَّتِي يَعْرِفُونَهَا بِقِيَاسِ الشَّبَهِ وَهُوَ أَنْ يَلْحَقَ الْمَسْكُوتُ عَنْهُ بِالْمَنْطُوقِ بِهِ، لَا لِأَنَّهُ أَوْلَى، وَلَا لِأَنَّهُ فِي مَعْنَاهُ، وَلَا لِعِلَّةٍ مُنَاسِبَةٍ، بَلْ يَلْحَقُ الْمَسْكُوتُ عَنْهُ بِالْمَنْطُوقِ بِهِ لِشَبَهٍ بَيْنَهُمَا يُظَنُّ بِهِ أَنَّهُ يَحْتَوِي عَلَى عِلَّةٍ جَامِعَةٍ بَيْنَهُمَا مُنَاسِبَةٍ لِلْحُكْمِ مِنْ غَيْرِ أَنْ يُوقَفَ عَلَيْهَا.

Most cases of this kind seem indeterminate, unless they join the second rank, which is within the meaning of the original case. An example is his saying, God bless him and grant him peace, “Do not sell wheat for wheat—the four known commodities—except hand to hand.” Some say he intended staple nourishment, some food, and some goods measured by volume. All this is their probable judgement: nourishment, measure, or edibility circumscribes the suitable factor requiring prohibition. To me this seems the remotest contextual indication used to understand a universal meaning from a particular expression. Many therefore confine such a report to what its wording requires.

وَيُشْبِهُ أَنْ يَكُونَ جُلُّ مَا يَقَعُ فِي هَذَا الْجِنْسِ مُجْمَلًا، إِلَّا أَنْ يَلْتَحِقَ بِالْمَرْتَبَةِ الثَّانِيَةِ وَهِيَ الَّتِي فِي مَعْنَى الْأَصْلِ. وَمِثْلُ هَذَا قَوْلُهُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: «لَا تَبِيعُوا الْبُرَّ بِالْبُرِّ الْأَرْبَعَةَ الْمَعْلُومَةَ إِلَّا هَاءَ بِهَاءَ»، فَإِنَّ قَوْمًا قَالُوا أَرَادَ بِذَلِكَ الْمُقْتَاتَ، وَقَوْمًا قَالُوا الْمَطْعُومَ، وَقَوْمًا قَالُوا الْمَكِيلَ. وَهَذَا كُلُّهُ ظَنٌّ مِنْهُمْ، فَإِنَّ الِاقْتِيَاتَ أَوِ الْكَيْلَ أَوِ الطَّعْمَ صِفَةٌ حَاصِرَةٌ لِلْأَمْرِ الْمُنَاسِبِ الْمُوجِبِ لِلتَّحْرِيمِ، وَهِيَ بِالْجُمْلَةِ فِيمَا يَظْهَرُ لِي أَبْعَدُ قَرِينَةٍ يُصَارُ إِلَيْهَا إِلَى أَنْ يُفْهَمَ عَنِ اللَّفْظِ الْجُزْئِيِّ الْمَعْنَى الْكُلِّيُّ، وَلِهَذَا كَثِيرٌ مِنَ النَّاسِ اقْتَصَرَ بِمِثْلِ هَذَا الْحَدِيثِ عَلَى مُقْتَضَى اللَّفْظِ.

Editorial notes

N102 [textual] Corrected against the critical apparatus at Bou Akl 2015, BA §267, Arabic p.294 (facing French p.295): the Escorial manuscript [أ] reads الثانية (“second”), while al-ʿAlawī 1994 [ع] prints الثالثة (“third”). The second rank is indeed the one Ibn Rushd called “within the meaning of the original case.” This is a substantive manuscript-attested correction, not merely a conjectural harmonization. The wheat report remains elliptical as witnessed.

N103 [textual] The editor reports that the manuscript read قياس السنة and emends it to قياس الشبه. The main text and translation follow the edited reading; the manuscript variant belongs to the editor’s apparatus.

N104 [lexical] الطَّعْم here denotes being consumable as food, not merely having a taste. Al-Fayyūmī expressly prefers fatḥa in the juristic phrase “al-ṭaʿm is the cause of ribā,” because it includes consumable liquids as well as solids; al-Miṣbāḥ al-munīr, s.v. طعم. https://ar.wikisource.org/wiki/المصباح_المنير/كتاب_الطاء#طعم

BA009 [scholarship] “Analogy by resemblance” is contested because the shared ground has not been specified: an apparent resemblance does not automatically supply a valid legal generalization. For Bou Akl, genuine analogical exemplum is the particular-to-particular operation whose universal middle is not independently extracted; the article reconstructs this in conversation with al-Fārābī’s logical works. It is Bou Akl’s historical thesis, not an explicit acknowledgment by Ibn Rushd of

his source. Source: Bou Akl, “Averroes on Juridical Reasoning,” in Interpreting Averroes: Critical Essays (Cambridge UP, 2018), pp. 56–62.

BA15-E267 [textual] Bou Akl 2015, BA §267, Arabic p.294, manuscript [أ] versus 1994 [ع]: restores manuscript-attested مناسبة للحكم (the relative cause is “appropriate to the ruling”) omitted in al-ʿAlawī and corrects الثالثة to manuscript الثانية. Both changes have been explicitly applied to the Arabic and facing English. The nearby قياس الشبه vs manuscript قياس السنة editorial emendation is separately disclosed by N103.

BA15-V218 [textual] 2015 full-edition control completed for R §218 = Bou Akl §267, Arabic p.294, French p.295. Distinguish manuscript-attested changes as detailed in the preceding notes. See the source-verified change ledger for exact old and new Arabic/English strings.

§ 219 Analogy in fixed penalties and expiations

1994 Arabic p. 129 · BA §268–269 · 2015 Arabic p. 296 · French p. 297

Know that the classes of prescribed matters differ in how clearly these contextual indications appear within them. Hence Abū Ḥanīfa did not permit qiyās in fixed penalties and expiations. It is clearer in matters of necessity, such as sale, marriage, and the like. As we said before, when an expression first appears it may be unknown whether it is a specific expression substituted for a general one. In some cases that is known, but the universal for which it has been substituted is unknown.

وَيَنْبَغِي أَنْ تَعْلَمَ أَنَّ أَجْنَاسَ الْمَفْرُوضَاتِ تَتَفَاوَتُ فِي ظُهُورِ هَذِهِ الْقَرَائِنِ فِيهَا، وَلِهَذَا لَمْ يُجِزْ أَبُو حَنِيفَةَ الْقِيَاسَ فِي الْحُدُودِ وَالْكَفَّارَاتِ وَهُوَ فِي الْأُمُورِ الضَّرُورِيَّةِ أَبْيَنُ كَالْبَيْعِ وَالنِّكَاحِ وَمَا شَاكَلَهُمَا. وَرُبَّمَا كَانَ اللَّفْظُ، كَمَا تَقَدَّمَ مِنْ قَوْلِنَا، أَوَّلَ مَا يَرِدُ لَا يُعْلَمُ هَلْ هُوَ خَاصٌّ أُبْدِلَ بَدَلَ الْعَامِّ، وَفِي بَعْضِهَا يُعْلَمُ ذَلِكَ، وَلَكِنْ لَا يُعْلَمُ أَيُّ كُلِّيٍّ أُبْدِلَ بَدَلَهُ.

Editorial notes

BA010 [scholarship] Fixed penalties make the distinction especially consequential. Bou Akl uses the comparison of wine-drinking and slander punishments to explain a genuine weak particular-to-particular analogy, alongside the limits Abū Ḥanīfa imposes on analogy in ḥudūd. His note refers to 2015 §268, corresponding to this reader’s §219. Do not confuse disallowing one kind of analogy with a global refusal of linguistic implications. Source: Bou Akl, “Averroes on Juridical Reasoning,” in Interpreting Averroes: Critical Essays (Cambridge UP, 2018), pp. 52–55.

§ 220 Testing, division and concomitance

1994 Arabic p. 129 · BA §269 · 2015 Arabic p. 296 · French p. 297

Here proponents of qiyās employ the kind of inference called testing and division (السبر والتقسيم). Some, though fewer, also employ positive and negative concomitance (الطرد والعكس). We must explain how they use these.

وَالْقَائِلُونَ بِالْقِيَاسِ يَسْتَعْمِلُونَ فِي هَذَا الْمَوْضِعِ مِنْ أَجْنَاسِ الْقِيَاسِ النَّوْعَ الَّذِي يَعْرِفُونَهُ بِالسَّبْرِ وَالتَّقْسِيمِ وَرُبَّمَا اسْتَعْمَلَ بَعْضُهُمْ، لَكِنْ هُمُ الْأَقَلُّ، الطَّرْدَ وَالْعَكْسَ. وَيَنْبَغِي أَنْ نُبَيِّنَ كَيْفَ يَسْتَعْمِلُونَ ذَلِكَ.

§ 221 Eliminating candidates for the universal meaning

1994 Arabic p. 130 · BA §270 · 2015 Arabic p. 296 · French p. 297

When it is unknown whether a particular expression has been used to express a universal meaning, testing and division proceeds as follows. We say: either this particular expression is used

أَمَّا السَّبْرُ وَالتَّقْسِيمُ فِيمَا لَمْ يُعْلَمْ هَلْ هُوَ لَفْظٌ جُزْئِيٌّ أُخْرِجَ مَخْرَجَ الْكُلِّيِّ أَمْ لَا، فَهُوَ أَنْ نَقُولَ: لَا يَخْلُو أَنْ يَكُونَ هَذَا

to express a universal meaning or it retains its original meaning. We then show that it does not retain that meaning. Next we must determine which universal is intended. We enumerate all the universal meanings probably intended by the particular expression, eliminate them one by one until only one remains, and judge that this is the universal intended by that particular.

اللَّفْظُ الْجُزْئِيُّ أُخْرِجَ مَخْرَجَ الْكُلِّيِّ أَمْ هُوَ عَلَى أَصْلِهِ، ثُمَّ نُبَيِّنَ أَنَّهُ لَيْسَ عَلَى أَصْلِهِ، فَيَنْبَغِي بَعْدَ ذَلِكَ أَنْ نَسْتَنْبِطَ أَيَّ كُلِّيٍّ أُرِيدَ بِهِ، وَذَلِكَ بِأَنْ نُقَسِّمَ جَمِيعَ الْمَعَانِي الْكُلِّيَّةِ الَّتِي يَغْلِبُ عَلَى الظَّنِّ أَنَّهُ أُرِيدَ بِذَلِكَ اللَّفْظِ الْجُزْئِيِّ، وَنُبْطِلَ وَاحِدًا وَاحِدًا مِنْهَا، حَتَّى نُبْقِيَ وَاحِدًا، فَنَحْكُمَ أَنَّ ذَلِكَ هُوَ الْكُلِّيُّ الْمُرَادُ بِذَلِكَ الْجُزْئِيِّ.

If it is apparent from the outset that a particular expression has been substituted for a universal, but not apparent which universal, we employ testing and division to determine it.

وَإِنْ كَانَ ظَاهِرًا مِنْ أَوَّلِ الْأَمْرِ أَنَّهُ لَفْظٌ جُزْئِيٌّ أُبْدِلَ بَدَلَ الْكُلِّيِّ، وَلَمْ يَكُنْ ظَاهِرًا أَيُّ كُلِّيٍّ هُوَ، اسْتَعْمَلْنَا السَّبْرَ وَالتَّقْسِيمَ فِي اسْتِنْبَاطِهِ.

§ 222 Positive and negative concomitance are not enough

1994 Arabic p. 130 · BA §271 · 2015 Arabic p. 296 · French p. 297

Positive concomitance (طرد) occurs when a ruling is given concerning something and we assign it to another thing because of a resemblance we find between them, applying it uniformly to the latter. On this basis we judge that the expression has been cast in particular form while intending the universal in which the two resemble one another.

فَأَمَّا الطَّرْدُ فَهُوَ أَنْ يَرِدَ الْحُكْمُ مُتَعَلِّقًا بِأَمْرٍ مَا فَنَحْكُمَ بِوُجُودِهِ لِأَمْرٍ آخَرَ لِلتَّشَابُهِ الَّذِي نَجِدُهُ بَيْنَهُمَا وَنَطْرُدَهُ فِيهِ، وَنَحْكُمَ لِأَجْلِ ذَلِكَ بِأَنَّهُ لَفْظٌ أُخْرِجَ مَخْرَجَ الْجُزْئِيِّ وَالْمُرَادُ بِهِ ذَلِكَ الْكُلِّيُّ الَّذِي تَشَابَهَا بِهِ.

This procedure may be strengthened by considering both presence and absence: any universal whose presence brings the ruling and whose absence removes it is taken as the ground on which the ruling depends (مناط الحكم). This is what they call negative concomitance (عكس). Most proponents of qiyās agree in rejecting the determination of a ruling's ground through positive and negative concomitance.

وَقَدْ يُشَدُّ هَذَا الْمَوْضِعُ بِأَنْ يُسْتَعْمَلَ فِيهِ الْوُجُودُ وَالِارْتِفَاعُ، وَذَلِكَ أَنَّ أَيَّ كُلِّيٍّ وُجِدَ الْحُكْمُ بِوُجُودِهِ وَارْتَفَعَ بِارْتِفَاعِهِ فَهُوَ مَنَاطُ الْحُكْمِ وَهَذَا هُوَ الَّذِي يُسَمُّونَهُ الْعَكْسَ، وَأَكْثَرُ الْقَائِلِينَ بِالْقِيَاسِ مُجْمِعُونَ عَلَى إِبْطَالِ اسْتِنْبَاطِ مَنَاطِ الْحُكْمِ بِالطَّرْدِ وَالْعَكْسِ.

Editorial notes

N105 [translation] Ṭard and ʿaks here refer to alleged concomitance of a property and a ruling in presence and absence. They do not mean logical conversion of a categorical proposition in this passage. Ibn Rushd reports the rejection of using such correlation alone to identify the operative ground.

§ 223 Why much juristic qiyās is not a syllogism

1994 Arabic p. 130 & 131 · BA §272–273 · 2015 Arabic p. 298 · French p. 299

In general, it appears that in most cases proponents of qiyās in the Law do not use it to derive an unknown ruling from a known one, in

وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَإِنَّهُ مِمَّا يَظْهَرُ أَنَّ أَكْثَرَ الْمَوَاضِعِ الَّتِي يَسْتَعْمِلُ الْقِيَاسَ فِيهَا الْقَائِلُونَ بِالْقِيَاسِ فِي الشَّرْعِ لَيْسَ يَسْتَعْمِلُونَهُ فِي

the way an unknown conclusion is derived from intellectually apprehended premises. They use it to establish the correctness of substituting expressions in each context and case. What they call analogy from a plausible, suitable ground and analogy by resemblance are contextual indications of verbal substitution. They are not syllogisms and perform no syllogistic operation, although those studying this discipline have not clearly recognised the distinction.

اسْتِنْبَاطِ حُكْمٍ مَجْهُولٍ عَنْ مَعْلُومٍ، عَلَى جِهَةِ مَا يُسْتَنْبَطُ عَنِ الْمُقَدِّمَاتِ الْمَعْقُولَةِ مَطْلَبٌ مَجْهُولٌ، لَكِنْ فِي تَصْحِيحِ إِبْدَالِ الْأَلْفَاظِ فِي مَكَانٍ مَكَانٍ وَنَازِلَةٍ نَازِلَةٍ، فَإِنَّ الْأَنْوَاعَ الَّتِي يُسَمُّونَهَا بِالْقِيَاسِ الْمُخَيِّلِ وَالْمُنَاسِبِ وَقِيَاسِ الشَّبَهِ هِيَ قَرَائِنُ تَدُلُّ عِنْدَهُمْ عَلَى إِبْدَالِ الْأَلْفَاظِ، وَلَيْسَتْ أَقْيِسَةً، وَلَا يُوجَدُ لَهَا فِعْلُ الْقِيَاسِ، وَإِنْ كَانَ لَمْ يَتَمَيَّزْ لِلنَّاظِرِينَ فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ أَمْرُ هَذَا التَّمْيِيزِ،

This is evident from their arguments against those who reject qiyās, whom they call the Ẓāhirīs (أهل الظاهر, "People of the Apparent"). The latter confronted them with a difficulty they could not escape: where knowledge comes through revelation and God's command, intellects have no part in affirming or denying anything of it. Moreover, rulings are not attributes of things' essences that intellects can apprehend. In general, qiyās has no part in whatever depends upon authoritative instruction (توقيف); its means of knowledge is transmitted communication (سمع), as with languages and similar things.

وَذَلِكَ ظَاهِرٌ مِنْ أَقَاوِيلِهِمُ الَّتِي يَسْتَعْمِلُونَهَا فِي مُنَاقَضَةِ الْقَائِلِينَ بِرَدِّ الْقِيَاسِ، وَهُمُ الْمُسَمَّوْنَ عِنْدَهُمْ أَهْلَ الظَّاهِرِ، لِأَنَّ هَؤُلَاءِ الْقَوْمَ أَلْزَمُوا الْقَائِلِينَ بِالْقِيَاسِ أَمْرًا لَمْ يَجِدُوا عَنْهُ مَحِيصًا، وَهُوَ أَنَّ مَا سَبِيلُ الْمَعْرِفَةِ بِهِ الْوَحْيُ وَالْأَمْرُ مِنَ اللَّهِ فَإِنَّهُ لَيْسَ لِلْعُقُولِ فِي إِثْبَاتِ شَيْءٍ مِنْ ذَلِكَ وَإِبْطَالِهِ مَدْخَلٌ، وَأَيْضًا فَإِنَّ الْأَحْكَامَ لَيْسَتْ صِفَاتِ ذَوَاتٍ فَتُدْرِكَهَا الْعُقُولُ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ كُلُّ مَا طَرِيقُهُ التَّوْقِيفُ لَا مَدْخَلَ لِلْقِيَاسِ فِيهِ، وَإِنَّمَا طَرِيقُ الْمَعْرِفَةِ بِهِ السَّمْعُ كَاللُّغَاتِ وَغَيْرِ ذَلِكَ.

This objection applies only to someone who reasons from an original case whose wording contains no indication pointing to the underlying ground—for example, analogising the penalty for wine drinking to that for an unsubstantiated accusation of illicit intercourse (قذف). It does not apply to someone whose original case includes its operative ground in the understood meaning, even if the verbal form does not contain it. Most legal instances of qiyās belong to this kind. Had they understood this point, they could have answered their opponents.

وَهَذَا إِنَّمَا هُوَ لَازِمٌ لِمَنْ يَقِيسُ عَلَى أَصْلٍ لَمْ يَتَضَمَّنْ بِاللَّفْظِ قَطُّ التَّنْبِيهَ عَلَى الْأَصْلِ، مِثْلَ قِيَاسِ حَدِّ الْخَمْرِ عَلَى الْقَذْفِ. وَأَمَّا مَنْ يَقِيسُ عَلَى أَصْلٍ يَتَضَمَّنُ بِمَفْهُومِهِ عِلَّةَ الْأَصْلِ، وَإِنْ لَمْ يَتَضَمَّنْ ذَلِكَ بِصِيغَةِ اللَّفْظِ، فَلَيْسَ يَلْزَمُهُ هَذَا الِاعْتِرَاضُ. وَأَكْثَرُ مَقَايِيسِ الشَّرْعِ هِيَ مِنْ هَذَا الْبَابِ، وَلِذَلِكَ لَوْ فَهِمُوا هَذَا الْمَعْنَى لَأَمْكَنَهُمُ الِانْفِصَالُ عَنْهُمْ.

Editorial notes

N106 [translation] The Arabic repeats الأصل in the phrase التنبيه على الأصل. "Underlying ground" conveys its function without silently supplying a new Arabic word. The relevant contrast is an extension indicated by the source's meaning versus a comparison unsupported by that source's signification.

BA011 [scholarship] Critical interpretive point: Ibn Rushd repeatedly says "in most cases" (akthar al-mawāḍiʿ), not "in every case." His denial that the familiar suitable/resemblance operations are aqyisa in the strict logical sense is compatible with accepting a narrower kind of genuine juristic analogy where no textual tanbīh gives the underlying ground. This is the distinction Bou Akl argues was already present here, and became clearer in the Bidāya. Article p. 50 cites this as 2015 §272; here it is §223. Source: Bou Akl, "Averroes on Juridical Reasoning," in Interpreting Averroes: Critical Essays (Cambridge UP, 2018), pp. 46, 49–55, 62–63. This remains an interpretive argument; not a silently adopted manuscript reading.

BA15-I08 [interpretive] Juristic inference and Farabi. Bou Akl 2015 pp.57–70 compares the classification with al-Fārābī's exemplum (mithāl) and the rhetorical particular-to-particular inference. Ibn Rushd's "in most cases" qualification matters: treating all legal qiyās as linguistic substitution would erase the limited residual genuine analogy.

§ 224 Meaning can be apparent without an apparent verbal form

1994 Arabic p. 131 & 132 · BA §273 · 2015 Arabic p. 298 · French p. 299

The Ẓāhirīs, and anyone allowing inference from expressions' prima facie forms, should therefore not deny analogy within the original case's meaning, or analogy from a plausible and congruently suitable ground, when the Law demonstrably attends to its proximate kind. These are all contextual indications that [make] expressions prima facie through their understood meanings, even when they are not so through their forms. There is no sense in recognising prima facie signification only in verbal form.

وَأَمَّا أَهْلُ الظَّاهِرِ وَمَنْ يُجَوِّزُ الِاسْتِدْلَالَ بِظَوَاهِرِ الْأَلْفَاظِ مِنْ جِهَةِ صِيَغِهَا، فَقَدْ يَنْبَغِي لَهُ أَلَّا يُنْكِرَ الْقِيَاسَ الَّذِي فِي مَعْنَى الْأَصْلِ، وَالْمُخَيِّلَ وَالْمُنَاسِبَ الْمُلَائِمَ إِذَا شَهِدَ الشَّرْعُ بِالِالْتِفَاتِ إِلَى جِنْسِهِ الْقَرِيبِ. فَإِنَّ هَذِهِ كُلَّهَا قَرَائِنُ نَظِيرَ الْأَلْفَاظِ ظَاهِرَةً بِمَفْهُومَاتِهَا، وَإِنْ لَمْ تَكُنْ بِصِيَغِهَا، وَلَا مَعْنَى لِقَوْلِ مَنْ لَا يَرَى الظَّاهِرَ إِلَّا فِي الصِّيغَةِ.

Editorial notes

N107 [textual] The scan prints قرائن نظير الألفاظ ظاهرة. The syntax is defective. English tentatively reads نظير as تصير, "make," consistent with the repeated account of contextual indications making expressions prima facie through their understood meaning. The Arabic preserves نظير, and the supplied English verb is bracketed.

N108 [textual] The vowels on the retained defective phrase do not repair its syntax. The reading نظير remains a crux (†); the English's contextual supplement is not a recovered Arabic verb.

BA012 [scholarship] The objection to recognizing only a wording's surface form targets an overly narrow account of verbal signification. Intended import may be apparent through contextual indications although the overt expression is particular. In Bou Akl's account the Ẓāhirīs can dispute a genuine exemplum but cannot consistently exclude ordinary semantic substitution without rejecting recognized usages of speech. The 2015 article concordance is §273 = reader §224. Source: Bou Akl, "Averroes on Juridical Reasoning," in Interpreting Averroes: Critical Essays (Cambridge UP, 2018), pp. 51–54.

§ 225 The disputed claim of Companion consensus on qiyās

1994 Arabic p. 132 · BA §274 · 2015 Arabic p. 300 · French p. 301

Proponents of qiyās have sought to establish it through the Companions' consensus. They transmitted statements from many Companions which, they claimed, support qiyās. The Ẓāhirīs challenged them on two grounds. First, consensus itself was unestablished: such statements were not transmitted from all the Companions, and, as explained earlier, a speaker's statement cannot be attributed to someone silent. Second, had consensus occurred, disagreement would not have been transmitted from the Successors. They also cited reports from the Companions rejecting qiyās. In general, its proponents could not establish their claimed consensus.

وَقَدْ رَامَ الْقَائِلُونَ بِالْقِيَاسِ أَنْ يُثْبِتُوهُ مِنْ جِهَةِ إِجْمَاعِ الصَّحَابَةِ عَلَى ذَلِكَ، فَنَقَلُوا عَنْ كَثِيرٍ مِنْهُمْ أَقَاوِيلَ تَدُلُّ فِيمَا زَعَمُوا عَلَى الْقَوْلِ بِالْقِيَاسِ، فَعَانَدَهُمْ أَهْلُ الظَّاهِرِ فِي مَوْضِعَيْنِ: أَحَدُهُمَا: فِي نَفْسِ الْإِجْمَاعِ، وَذَلِكَ أَنَّهُ لَمْ يُنْقَلْ ذَلِكَ عَنْ جَمِيعِهِمْ، وَلَيْسَ يُنْسَبُ إِلَى سَاكِتٍ قَوْلُ قَائِلٍ كَمَا تَقَدَّمَ. وَالثَّانِي: أَنَّهُ لَوْ وَقَعَ مِنْهُمْ فِي ذَلِكَ إِجْمَاعٌ لَمَا وَرَدَ عَنِ التَّابِعِينَ فِي ذَلِكَ خِلَافٌ. وَأَيْضًا فَقَدْ تَمَسَّكَ أَهْلُ الظَّاهِرِ بِأَحَادِيثَ نُقِلَتْ عَنِ الصَّحَابَةِ فِي دَفْعِ الْقِيَاسِ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَلَمْ

يَقْدِرِ الْقَائِلُونَ بِالْقِيَاسِ أَنْ يُصَحِّحُوا الْإِجْمَاعَ الَّذِي ادَّعَوْهُ فِي ذَلِكَ.

وَأَيْضًا فَإِنَّ الْأَلْفَاظَ الْوَارِدَةَ عَنِ الصَّحَابَةِ فِي الْقِيَاسِ مُحْتَمِلَةٌ، وَيُشْبِهُ إِذَا تُؤُمِّلَتْ أَنْ يَظْهَرَ مِنْ أَمْرِهَا هَذَا الْمَعْنَى الَّذِي قُلْنَاهُ فِي الْقِيَاسِ، وَإِنَّ ذَلِكَ إِنَّمَا كَانَ مِنْهُمُ اجْتِهَادًا فِي مَفْهُومِ الْأَلْفَاظِ. وَالَّذِي يُشْبِهُ أَنْ يَكُونَ لِأَهْلِ الظَّاهِرِ فِيهِ مَدْفَعٌ اسْتِنْبَاطُ الْإِبْدَالِ وَالِاسْتِعَارَةِ بِطَرِيقِ السَّبْرِ وَالتَّقْسِيمِ أَوْ بِغَيْرِهَا مِنَ الطُّرُقِ، إِذَا لَمْ تَكُنْ هُنَالِكَ بَعْضُ الْقَرَائِنِ الَّتِي عَدَدْنَاهَا.

Moreover, the Companions' transmitted expressions about qiyās admit several interpretations. On examination they seem likely to disclose the meaning we have assigned to qiyās: the Companions were exercising independent inquiry into expressions' understood meanings. What the Ẓāhirīs seem entitled to resist is deriving substitution or metaphor through testing and division, or through other procedures, when none of the contextual indications we have enumerated is present.

وَيَنْبَغِي لِمَنْ أَجَازَ ذَلِكَ أَنْ يُجِيزَهُ فِي جَمِيعِ الْأَلْفَاظِ الْمُبْدَلَةِ أَوِ الْمُسْتَعَارَةِ وَالْمَحْذُوفَةِ، وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ الْمُغَيَّرَةِ. وَكَمَا أَنَّ هَذِهِ الْقَرَائِنَ قَدْ يُعَمَّمُ بِهَا الْخَاصُّ كَذَلِكَ قَدْ يُخَصَّصُ بِهَا الْعَامُّ.

Anyone who permits that procedure should permit it for all expressions involving substitution, metaphor, omission, or, generally, alteration. Just as these contextual indications can generalise a specific expression, they can also restrict a general one.

Editorial notes

BA013 [scholarship] This authorial qualification helps explain why the dispute is not disposed of by asserting consensus: what the Companions called qiyās may denote interpretation of intended sense, while an inference not grounded in the indicated class is still contestable. Bou Akl's reading addresses the resulting fault line between anti-analogists and proponents of qiyās rather than assuming the schools have only a terminological disagreement in every case. Source: Bou Akl, "Averroes on Juridical Reasoning," in Interpreting Averroes: Critical Essays (Cambridge UP, 2018), pp. 51–55.

§ 226 The class and limits of qiyās; action and approval remain

1994 Arabic p. 132 · BA §275 · 2015 Arabic p. 300 · French p. 301

فَقَدْ ظَهَرَ مِنْ هَذَا الْقَوْلِ مَا هُوَ الْمَعْنَى الْمَدْلُولُ عَلَيْهِ بِاسْمِ الْقِيَاسِ فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ، وَفِي أَيِّ جِنْسٍ دُخُولُهُ مِنْ أَجْنَاسِ الْأَدِلَّةِ الشَّرْعِيَّةِ، وَفِي أَيِّ الْمَوَاضِعِ يُسْتَعْمَلُ، وَفِي أَيِّهَا لَا. وَقَدْ بَقِيَ عَلَيْنَا مِنْ طُرُقِ الْأَدِلَّةِ الشَّرْعِيَّةِ الدَّلِيلُ الَّذِي هُوَ فِعْلُهُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ وَإِقْرَارُهُ. وَهَذَانِ الصِّنْفَانِ لَيْسَ هُمَا أَدِلَّةً مِنْ جِهَةِ صِيَغِ الْأَلْفَاظِ أَوْ مَفْهُومَاتِهَا، بَلْ مِنْ جِهَةِ مَا هِيَ قَرَائِنُ. وَنَحْنُ نَقُولُ فِي وَاحِدٍ وَاحِدٍ مِنْهَا، وَمَا قُوَّتُهُ.

This discussion has shown what the term qiyās signifies in this discipline, which class of legal evidence it belongs to, and where it may and may not be used. Among the ways of legal evidence, there remain the Prophet's action and tacit approval, God bless him and grant him peace. These are evidence through their character as contextual indications, rather than through verbal forms or understood meanings. We shall discuss each of them and its force.

§ 227 What tacit approval establishes

1994 Arabic p. 133 · BA §276 · 2015 Arabic p. 302 · French p. 303

أَمَّا إِقْرَارُهُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ عَلَى فِعْلٍ فُعِلَ بِمُشَاهَدَتِهِ وَعُلِمَ قَطْعًا أَنَّهُ رَآهُ فَأَقَرَّهُ، فَإِنَّهُ يَدُلُّ عَلَى جَوَازِ وُقُوعِ ذَلِكَ الْفِعْلِ عَلَى تِلْكَ الصِّفَةِ وَإِيجَابِهِ إِنْ كَانَ حُكْمًا شَرْعِيًّا، أَوْ عَلَى إِبَاحَةِ ذَلِكَ إِنْ تُخُيِّلَ فِيهِ أَنَّهُ مَحْظُورٌ لِثُبُوتِ عِصْمَتِهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ فِيمَا دَعَا إِلَيْهِ، وَفِيمَا أَقَرَّ عَلَيْهِ.

As for his tacit approval, God bless him and grant him peace: when an act is done in his presence and it is certainly known that he saw and approved it, this shows that the act may occur in that manner and—if it is a legal judgement—that it is binding. Or it shows permissibility when the act had been supposed forbidden. This follows from his established protection from error in what he called people to and in what he approved, God bless him and grant him peace.

Editorial notes

N109 [translation] The clause إن كان حكما شرعيا qualifies the reference to binding force; the passage is not translated as making every tacitly approved act obligatory.

§ 228 Actions that explain a revealed command

1994 Arabic p. 133 · BA §277 · 2015 Arabic p. 302 · French p. 303

أَمَّا أَفْعَالُهُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ فَعَلَى ضُرُوبٍ: أَحَدُهَا مَا كَانَ بَيَانًا لِعَامٍّ أَوْ مُجْمَلٍ، فَذَلِكَ مِنْهُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ مَحْمُولٌ عَلَى حُكْمِ ذَلِكَ الْعَامِّ، إِنْ كَانَ مَنْدُوبًا إِلَيْهِ فَالْفِعْلُ مَنْدُوبٌ إِلَيْهِ، وَإِنْ كَانَ وَاجِبًا فَوَاجِبٌ. وَذَلِكَ بِدَلِيلِ قَوْلِهِ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ: «صَلُّوا كَمَا رَأَيْتُمُونِي أُصَلِّي وَخُذُوا عَنِّي مَنَاسِكَكُمْ».

His actions, God bless him and grant him peace, are of several kinds. One explains a general or indeterminate expression. Such an action by him, God bless him and grant him peace, bears the ruling of the general expression: if that is recommended, the action is recommended; if obligatory, the action is obligatory. The evidence is his saying, peace be upon him, “Pray as you have seen me pray, and take your pilgrimage rites from me.”

§ 229 Peculiar, unexplained and conflicting Prophetic actions

1994 Arabic p. 133 & 134 · BA §278–279 · 2015 Arabic p. 302 · French p. 303

وَالثَّانِي فِي مُقَابِلِ هَذَا وَهُوَ أَنْ يُعْلَمَ بِقَرِينَةِ حَالٍ أَوْ لَفْظٍ ⟨أَنَّهُ مُخْتَصٌّ. وَالثَّالِثُ هُوَ⟩ كَالْمُتَوَسِّطِ بَيْنَ هَذَيْنِ، وَهُوَ مَا وَرَدَ مِنْ أَفْعَالِهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ مِنْ غَيْرِ أَنْ يُعْلَمَ أَنَّ ذَلِكَ تَفْسِيرٌ مِنْهُ لِمُجْمَلٍ أَوْ بَيَانٌ لِعَامٍّ أَوْ مُخْتَصٌّ بِهِ. وَهُنَا اخْتَلَفَ النَّاسُ فَقَوْمٌ رَأَوْا حَمْلَهَا عَلَى الْوُجُوبِ، وَقَوْمٌ عَلَى النَّدْبِ، وَقَوْمٌ رَأَوُا التَّوَقِّيفَ، وَهُوَ الْمُخْتَارُ عِنْدَ أَبِي حَامِدٍ، لِأَنَّ الْفِعْلَ لَا صِيغَةَ لَهُ.

The second kind is the opposite: it is known through a circumstantial or verbal indicator ⟨that the action is peculiar to him. The third is⟩ intermediate between these two: actions of his, God bless him and grant him peace, for which it is unknown whether they explain an indeterminate expression, clarify a general one, or are peculiar to him. Here people disagree. Some construe them as obligatory, others as recommended, and others withhold judgement.

This is Abū Ḥāmid's preferred view, because an action has no verbal form.

وَأَمَّا مَنْ حَمَلَهُ عَلَى الْوُجُوبِ فَقَدِ اسْتَشْهَدَ عَلَى ذَلِكَ بِظَوَاهِرَ، لَكِنَّهَا مُحْتَمِلَةٌ، مِثْلَ قَوْلِهِ تَعَالَى: «لَقَدْ كَانَ لَكُمْ فِي رَسُولِ اللَّهِ أُسْوَةٌ حَسَنَةٌ». وَأَمَّا مَنْ رَأَى أَنَّهَا عَلَى النَّدْبِ فَتَمَسَّكًا بِاقْتِدَاءِ الصَّحَابَةِ بِهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ فِي أَفْعَالِهِ، كَخَلْعِهِمْ نِعَالَهُمْ فِي الصَّلَاةِ لَمَّا خَلَعَ، وَتَوَقُّفِهِمْ عَنِ الْحَلْقِ عَامَ الْحُدَيْبِيَةِ حَتَّى حَلَقَ. وَلِلْقَائِلِينَ بِالْوُجُوبِ أَيْضًا التَّمَسُّكُ بِمِثْلِ هَذَا مِنْ أَفْعَالِ الصَّحَابَةِ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمْ.

Those construing the action as obligatory cite prima facie expressions that nevertheless admit other meanings, such as His exalted saying, "In God's Messenger you have a good example." Those construing it as recommended appeal to the Companions' imitation of his actions, God bless him and grant him peace: removing their sandals in prayer when he removed his, and refraining from shaving in the year of al-Ḥudaybiyya until he shaved. Proponents of obligation can also appeal to these actions of the Companions, may God be pleased with them.

وَيُمْكِنُ أَنْ نَقُولَ رَدًّا عَلَى هَؤُلَاءِ مِمَّنْ لَا يَرَى الْفِعْلَ حُكْمًا بِأَنَّ هَذَا إِنَّمَا كَانَ مِنْ فِعْلِ الصَّحَابَةِ فِيمَا عَلِمُوا أَنَّهُ بَيَانٌ مِنْهُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ لِلْمَفْرُوضَاتِ أَوِ الْمَنْدُوبَاتِ، وَذَلِكَ إِمَّا بِقَرَائِنِ أَحْوَالٍ أَوْ بِقَوْلٍ. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ فَالْمَسْأَلَةُ اجْتِهَادِيَّةٌ. وَالْأَظْهَرُ أَلَّا يَكُونَ لِهَذَا النَّوْعِ مِنْ فِعْلِهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ حُكْمٌ لِتَرَدُّدِهِ بَيْنَ الْإِيجَابِ وَالنَّدْبِ وَالْإِبَاحَةِ، وَكَوْنِهِ مُخْتَصًّا بِهِ.

In reply, someone who holds that an action establishes no ruling may say: the Companions acted this way only where they knew, from either circumstantial indications or a statement, that he, God bless him and grant him peace, was explaining obligations or recommendations through his action. In general, the question admits independent judgement. The more apparent view is that no ruling can be assigned on the basis of this kind of action by him, God bless him and grant him peace, since it remains undecided between obligation, recommendation, permission, and being peculiar to him.

وَإِذَا وَرَدَتْ أَفْعَالُهُ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ تَفْسِيرًا أَوْ بَيَانًا لِعَامٍّ وَتَعَارَضَتْ، كَانَ حُكْمُهَا حُكْمَ الْقَوْلَيْنِ إِذَا تَعَارَضَا، وَسَيَأْتِي الْقَوْلُ فِي هَذَا وَكَذَلِكَ إِذَا تَعَارَضَ الْفِعْلُ وَالْقَوْلُ. وَهُنَا انْتَهَى الْقَوْلُ فِي الْجُزْءِ الثَّالِثِ مِنْ هَذَا الْكِتَابِ.

When his actions, peace be upon him, explain [an indeterminate expression] or clarify a general one and conflict, they have the same status as two conflicting statements. We shall discuss this later, as also the conflict of an action with a statement. Here ends the discussion in Part Three of this book.

Editorial notes

N110 [textual] The broken opening of the action taxonomy is restored with a marked conjecture from Bou Akl 2015 §278 (Arabic p.302, French p.303): second = action known to be exclusively prophetic; third = action of undetermined normative kind. The English no longer implies that the third kind belongs to the second.

N111 [translation] Qur'ān 33:21. "Withhold judgement" renders the printed التوقيف in this context.

BA15-R09 [textual] Proponent's actions fall into (1) explanatory, (2) distinctly peculiar to the Prophet, and (3) unclassified acts; this context requires the conjectural words adopted by Bou Akl 2015 §278, Arabic p.302, French p.303, commentary §278. The lack of formula in the third class explains the dispute.

Ijtihād, taqlīd and evidential preference

§ 230 Inquiry, authority and weighing evidence

1994 Arabic p. 135 & 137 · BA §281 · 2015 Arabic p. 306 · French p. 307

وَهُوَ يَشْتَمِلُ عَلَى ثَلَاثَةِ فُصُولٍ: فَصْلٍ فِي الِاجْتِهَادِ، وَفَصْلٍ فِي التَّقْلِيدِ، وَفَصْلٍ فِي تَرْجِيحِ الْأَدِلَّةِ.

It comprises three chapters: one on independent juristic inquiry, one on following authority, and one on weighing the evidence.

§ 231 The jurist, the question and the act of inquiry

1994 Arabic p. 137 · BA §282 · 2015 Arabic p. 306 · French p. 307

وَيَنْقَسِمُ الْقَوْلُ فِيهِ إِلَى النَّظَرِ فِي الْمُجْتَهِدِ، وَالْمُجْتَهَدِ فِيهِ، وَنَفْسِ الِاجْتِهَادِ. أَمَّا الِاجْتِهَادُ فَهُوَ بَذْلُ الْمُجْتَهِدِ وُسْعَهُ فِي الطَّلَبِ بِالْآلَاتِ الَّتِي تُشْتَرَطُ فِيهِ.

Its discussion divides into examination of the independent jurist (مجتهد), the subject of his inquiry, and independent inquiry itself (اجتهاد). Independent inquiry is the jurist's exertion of his utmost capacity in seeking an answer by means of the instruments required of him.

وَأَمَّا حَدُّ الْمُجْتَهِدِ فَهُوَ أَنْ يَكُونَ عَارِفًا بِالْأُصُولِ الَّتِي يُسْتَنْبَطُ عَنْهَا، وَأَنْ تَكُونَ عِنْدَهُ الْقَوَانِينُ وَالْأَحْوَالُ الَّتِي بِهَا يَسْتَنْبِطُ. وَلِأَنَّ الْأُصُولَ ثَلَاثَةٌ الْكِتَابُ وَالسُّنَّةُ وَالْإِجْمَاعُ فَقَدْ يَنْبَغِي أَنْ نَقُولَ فِيمَا يَكْفِيهِ مِنْ مَعْرِفَةِ وَاحِدٍ وَاحِدٍ مِنْهَا.

The definition of the independent jurist is that he knows the sources from which he derives rulings and possesses the rules and requisite conditions by which he derives them. Since the sources are three—the Book, the Sunna, and consensus—we must state how much knowledge of each suffices for him.

§ 232 How much Qurʾānic knowledge is required?

1994 Arabic p. 137 · BA §283 · 2015 Arabic p. 306 · French p. 307

أَمَّا مَا يَكْفِيهِ مِنْ مَعْرِفَةِ الْكِتَابِ فَمَعْرِفَةُ الْآيَاتِ الْمُتَضَمِّنَةِ لِلْأَحْكَامِ، وَمَعْرِفَةُ النَّاسِخِ مِنْهَا مِنَ الْمَنْسُوخِ، وَهِيَ نَحْوُ خَمْسِ مِئَةِ آيَةٍ، هَذَا عَلَى وَجْهِ التَّخْفِيفِ، وَالْأَفْضَلُ لَهُ مَعْرِفَةُ الْكِتَابِ كُلِّهِ. وَقَدْ رُخِّصَ لَهُ فِي حِفْظِ الْآيَاتِ الْمُتَضَمِّنَةِ لِلْأَحْكَامِ إِذَا كَانَتْ مَوَاضِعُهَا مَعْلُومَةً عِنْدَهُ بِحَيْثُ إِذَا وَرَدَتْ مَسْأَلَةٌ فِي أَمْرٍ مَا عَلِمَ أَيْنَ يَطْلُبُهَا.

Sufficient knowledge of the Book consists in knowing the verses containing rulings and distinguishing the abrogating from the abrogated among them; they number about five hundred verses. This is a concession: knowing the whole Book is preferable. He is also excused from memorising the verses containing rulings if he knows where they occur, so that when a question arises he knows where to look for them.

§ 233 Hadith competence, collections and transmitter evaluation

1994 Arabic p. 137 · BA §284 · 2015 Arabic p. 306 · French p. 307

وَأَمَّا مَا يَكْفِيهِ مِنْ مَعْرِفَةِ السُّنَّةِ، فَمَعْرِفَةُ الْأَحَادِيثِ الَّتِي تَتَضَمَّنُ الْأَحْكَامَ. وَقَدْ يُخَفَّفُ عَنْهُ فِي أَنْ لَا يَحْفَظَهَا، بَلْ يَكْفِيهِ أَنْ يَكُونَ عِنْدَهُ أَصْلٌ مُصَحَّحٌ بِجَمِيعِ الْأَحَادِيثِ الْمُتَضَمِّنَةِ لِلْأَحْكَامِ يَرْجِعُ إِلَيْهِ وَقْتَ الْحَاجَةِ إِلَى الْفَتْوَى، وَالْأَفْضَلُ لَهُ أَنْ يَحْفَظَهَا.

Sufficient knowledge of the Sunna consists in knowing the reports that contain rulings. He may be excused from memorising them: it is enough to possess a corrected collection of all the reports containing rulings, to which he can refer when a legal opinion is needed. Memorizing them is preferable.

وَأَمَّا مَعْرِفَةُ صِحَّةِ أَسَانِيدِهَا، فَإِنْ هُوَ عَوَّلَ فِي صِحَّتِهَا عَلَى مَنْ يُحْسِنُ ظَنَّهُ بِهِ كَالْبُخَارِيِّ وَمُسْلِمٍ كَانَ مُقَلِّدًا، وَإِنْ هُوَ أَيْضًا احْتَاجَ أَنْ يُعَدِّلَ الرُّوَاةَ وَيَتَّبِعَ سِيَرَهُمْ وَأَحْوَالَهُمْ وَأَوْقَاتَهُمْ طَالَ عَلَيْهِ وَتَشَعَّبَ جِدًّا، وَلَا سِيَّمَا مَا تَبَاعَدَ الزَّمَانُ. وَالتَّخْفِيفُ عَنْهُ فِي ذَلِكَ أَنْ يَكْتَفِيَ بِتَعْدِيلِ الْإِمَامِ فِي ذَلِكَ إِنْ عَلِمَ مَذْهَبَهُ فِي التَّجْرِيحِ وَالتَّعْدِيلِ، وَكَانَ ذَلِكَ مُوَافِقًا لِمَذْهَبِهِ.

As for knowing the soundness of their transmission chains, if he relies on someone he trusts, such as al-Bukhārī or Muslim, he is following authority. Yet if he must himself establish the transmitters' uprightness and investigate their biographies, circumstances, and dates, the task becomes protracted and immensely intricate, especially as time grows distant. The concession is to accept a leading scholar's accreditation, provided he knows that scholar's approach to discrediting and accrediting transmitters and it agrees with his own.

§ 234 Consensus and the indispensable knowledge of Arabic

1994 Arabic p. 138 · BA §285 · 2015 Arabic p. 308 · French p. 309

وَأَمَّا الْإِجْمَاعُ فَأَنْ يَعْرِفَ جَمِيعَ الْمَسَائِلِ الْمُجْمَعَ عَلَيْهَا، وَقَدْ يَكْفِيهِ أَنْ يَعْلَمَ أَنَّ قَوْلَهُ فِي الْمَسْأَلَةِ الَّتِي يُفْتِي فِيهَا لَيْسَ هُوَ مُخَالِفًا لِلْإِجْمَاعِ بِأَنْ يَعْلَمَ أَنَّ قَوْلَهُ يُوَافِقُ قَوْلَ قَائِلٍ. وَقَبْلَ هَذَا كُلِّهِ فَيَنْبَغِي أَنْ يَكُونَ عِنْدَهُ مِنْ عِلْمِ اللُّغَةِ وَاللِّسَانِ مَا يَفْهَمُ بِهِ كِتَابَ اللَّهِ تَعَالَى وَسُنَّةَ نَبِيِّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ وَلَا يَلْحَنُ.

As for consensus, he should know all the questions on which consensus has been reached. It may suffice that he knows his opinion on the question he is answering does not oppose consensus, by knowing that it agrees with an opinion someone has held. Before all this, he must possess enough knowledge of vocabulary and language to understand the Book of God, exalted is He, and the Sunna of His Prophet, God bless him and grant him peace, without linguistic error.

§ 235 Theology and detailed fiqh: what is actually required?

1994 Arabic p. 138 · BA §286 · 2015 Arabic p. 308 · French p. 309

They also require knowledge of theology (علم الكلام): possession of the evidence giving

knowledge of God and His attributes, leading to knowledge of the world's origination, and the other matters theology contains. This is required only on the view that the first obligation is rational examination and inference. On the other view, faith based simply on the Law suffices without rational examination. As for the derived details of jurisprudence, he has no need of them, because it is the independent jurist who generates them.

وَقَدِ اشْتَرَطُوا مَعَ هَذَا أَنْ يَكُونَ عَالِمًا بِعِلْمِ الْكَلَامِ، وَذَلِكَ أَنْ تَكُونَ عِنْدَهُ الْأَدِلَّةُ الْمُعَرِّفَةُ بِاللَّهِ وَبِصِفَاتِهِ، وَالْمُوصِلَةُ إِلَى الْعِلْمِ بِحَدَثِ الْعَالَمِ، وَغَيْرِ ذَلِكَ مِمَّا يَتَضَمَّنُ عِلْمُ الْكَلَامِ. وَهَذَا إِنَّمَا يَلْزَمُ عَلَى رَأْيِ مَنْ يَرَى أَنَّ أَوَّلَ الْوَاجِبَاتِ النَّظَرُ وَالِاسْتِدْلَالُ، وَأَمَّا مَنْ لَا يَرَى ذَلِكَ فَيَكْفِيهِ الْإِيمَانُ بِمُجَرَّدِ الشَّرْعِ دُونَ نَظَرِ الْعَقْلِ. وَأَمَّا تَفَارِيعُ الْفِقْهِ فَلَا حَاجَةَ بِهِ إِلَيْهَا، لِأَنَّ الْمُجْتَهِدَ هُوَ الَّذِي يُوَلِّدُهَا.

§ 236 Issue-specific independent inquiry

1994 Arabic p. 138 · BA §287 · 2015 Arabic p. 308 · French p. 309

These requirements as a whole apply to the independent jurist in the unrestricted sense, who can give a legal opinion in every case. Someone who possesses only some of them may exercise independent inquiry in a question for which the requirements he possesses are sufficient. His relation to that question is the same as that of the unrestricted independent jurist to all questions.

وَهَذِهِ الشَّرَائِطُ بِالْجُمْلَةِ إِنَّمَا هِيَ فِي حَقِّ الْمُجْتَهِدِ بِإِطْلَاقٍ الَّذِي تُمْكِنُهُ الْفَتْوَى فِي كُلِّ نَازِلَةٍ، وَأَمَّا مَنْ لَمْ تَكُنْ عِنْدَهُ كُلُّ هَذِهِ الشَّرَائِطِ، وَكَانَ عِنْدَهُ بَعْضُهَا، وَكَانَتِ الْمَسْأَلَةُ الْمَنْظُورُ فِيهَا يَكْفِي فِيهَا مَا عِنْدَهُ مِنْ تِلْكَ الشَّرَائِطِ، جَازَ لَهُ الِاجْتِهَادُ فِيهَا، لِأَنَّ نِسْبَتَهُ إِلَى هَذِهِ الْمَسْأَلَةِ نِسْبَةُ الْمُجْتَهِدِ بِإِطْلَاقٍ إِلَى جَمِيعِ الْمَسَائِلِ.

Editorial notes

BA014 [scholarship] Qualifications for ijtihād are relative to the problem investigated, not merely an indivisible rank. Bou Akl emphasizes the analogy between domain-specific mujtahids in legal practice and competent specialists in theoretical inquiry; he invokes al-Ghazālī's al-Mustaṣfā alongside the present discussion. Source: Bou Akl, "Splitting the Process and the Result," in Philosophy and Jurisprudence in the Islamic World (De Gruyter, 2019), pp. 139–141.

§ 237 Is there a determinate ruling to be found?

1994 Arabic p. 138 · BA §288 · 2015 Arabic p. 310 · French p. 311

The subject of independent inquiry is every legal ruling for which there is no decisive evidence. We must consider whether the ruling sought is determinate in itself and one is charged with attaining it, or whether no determinate ruling exists toward which the inquiry is directed, the obligation resting solely on attaining a preponderant judgement. On the latter account, every independent jurist would be correct, even when their opinions on the same thing contradict one another. We say:

وَأَمَّا الْمُجْتَهَدُ فِيهِ فَهُوَ كُلُّ حُكْمٍ شَرْعِيٍّ لَيْسَ فِيهِ دَلِيلٌ قَطْعِيٌّ. وَقَدْ يَنْبَغِي أَنْ نَنْظُرَ هَهُنَا فِي هَذَا الْحُكْمِ الْمَطْلُوبِ: هَلْ هُوَ مُتَعَيِّنٌ فِي نَفْسِهِ وَمُكَلَّفٌ إِصَابَتَهُ أَمْ لَيْسَ هَهُنَا حُكْمٌ مُتَعَيِّنٌ يَتَوَجَّهُ الطَّلَبُ إِلَيْهِ، وَإِنَّمَا مَنَاطُ التَّكْلِيفِ فِي طَلَبِهِ غَلَبَةُ الظَّنِّ، فَيَكُونُ عَلَى هَذَا كُلُّ مُجْتَهِدٍ مُصِيبًا، وَإِنْ تَضَادَّتْ آرَاؤُهُمْ فِي الشَّيْءِ الْوَاحِدِ، فَنَقُولُ:

Editorial notes

N112 [grammar] The compressed phrase وَمُكَلَّف إِصَابَتُهُ is vocalised as a passive nominal construction, with attainment itself treated as the thing required. The English makes the implicit responsible inquirer explicit. This does not settle a possible ellipsis in the source wording.

BA015 [scholarship] Distinguish two questions rather than collapsing both into “every mujtahid is correct”: (a) is there a determinate true ruling independent of an individual judgement? and (b) is the mistaken, diligent jurist morally/legal culpable? Bou Akl calls these the alethic and juridical levels. His distinction provides a useful map of §§237–245, but the scheme is modern scholarly analysis, not vocabulary Ibn Rushd himself employs. Source: Bou Akl, “Splitting the Process and the Result,” in Philosophy and Jurisprudence in the Islamic World (De Gruyter, 2019), pp. 140–143.

BA15-I09 [interpretive] Fallibilism with a determinate object. Bou Akl 2015 intro pp.88–99 argues that Ibn Rushd’s consistent juristic fallibilism presupposes a determinate intended legal judgement even when evidence remains probable; this is different from a claim that the individual’s knowledge is infallible.

§ 238 Essential attributes, Ẓāhirī restraint and determinate rulings

1994 Arabic p. 138 & 139 · BA §289 · 2015 Arabic p. 310 · French p. 311

Whoever holds that rulings are attributes of things’ essences—whether known when the Law is added, or beforehand, or with both kinds among them, as the Muʿtazila hold—cannot declare every independent jurist correct. The same applies to those rejecting qiyās in the Law. They too hold that whatever has received no legal discourse remains under original freedom from obligation, as permissible; whereas something receiving legal discourse has a determinate ruling.

أَمَّا مَنْ يَرَى أَنَّ الْأَحْكَامَ صِفَاتُ ذَوَاتٍ، سَوَاءٌ عُلِمَتْ بِانْضِمَامِ الشَّرْعِ إِلَيْهَا أَوْ قَبْلَهُ، أَوْ كَانَ فِيهَا الصِّنْفَانِ جَمِيعًا عَلَى مَا تَرَاهُ الْمُعْتَزِلَةُ، فَلَيْسَ يُمْكِنُهُ تَصْوِيبُ كُلِّ مُجْتَهِدٍ. وَكَذَلِكَ يَلْزَمُ مَنْ لَا يَرَى الْقِيَاسَ فِي الشَّرْعِ، فَإِنَّ هَؤُلَاءِ أَيْضًا يَرَوْنَ أَنَّ مَا لَمْ يَرِدْ فِيهِ خِطَابٌ شَرْعِيٌّ فَهُوَ عَلَى الْبَرَاءَةِ الْأَصْلِيَّةِ مِنَ الْإِبَاحَةِ، وَمَا كَانَ بِهَذِهِ الصِّفَةِ، أَعْنِي مَا وَرَدَ فِيهِ خِطَابٌ شَرْعِيٌّ، فَفِيهِ حُكْمٌ مُتَعَيِّنٌ.

§ 239 Ibn Rushd’s answer: discourse determines the ruling

1994 Arabic p. 139 · BA §290 · 2015 Arabic p. 310 · French p. 311

Our own position has already been stated: legal rulings are apprehended through discourse, which sometimes requires a ruling through its form and sometimes through its understood meaning. What they mean by qiyās falls within this class. Both kinds divide, with respect to the obligation to act on them, into unambiguous and prima facie indications. Consequently, one cannot maintain that every independent jurist is correct, since rulings are received through the given discourse in all the kinds we have enumerated, whether verbal expression or contextual indication.

وَأَمَّا نَحْنُ فَقَدْ سَلَفَ مِنْ قَوْلِنَا أَنَّ مَدَارِكَ أَحْكَامِ الشَّرْعِ الْخِطَابُ، وَأَنَّ الْخِطَابَ مِنْهُ مَا يُوجِبُ الْحُكْمَ بِصِيغَتِهِ، وَمِنْهُ بِمَفْهُومِهِ. وَأَنَّ الَّذِي يَعْنُونَ بِالْقِيَاسِ دَاخِلٌ فِي هَذَا الْجِنْسِ، وَأَنَّ كِلَا هَذَيْنِ الصِّنْفَيْنِ يَنْقَسِمَانِ فِي وُجُوبِ الْعَمَلِ بِهِمَا إِلَى نَصٍّ وَإِلَى ظَاهِرٍ. وَإِذَا كَانَ هَذَا هَكَذَا لَمْ يَتَصَوَّرْ أَنْ يُقَالَ كُلُّ مُجْتَهِدٍ مُصِيبٌ، إِذْ كَانَتْ سَبِيلُ تَلَقِّي الْأَحْكَامِ الْخِطَابَ الْوَارِدَ، وَذَلِكَ فِي جَمِيعِ أَصْنَافِهِ الَّتِي عُدِّدَتْ مِنْ لَفْظٍ أَوْ قَرِينَةٍ.

Where knowledge comes through discourse, there is undoubtedly a determinate ruling: that to which the discourse relates. What the given discourse does not contain, and no contextual

وَمَا كَانَ سَبِيلُ الْمَعْرِفَةِ بِهِ الْخِطَابَ فَثَمَّ لَا شَكَّ حُكْمٌ مُتَعَيِّنٌ، وَهُوَ الَّذِي تَعَلَّقَ بِهِ الْخِطَابُ. وَمَا لَمْ يَتَضَمَّنْهُ

indication signifies, remains under original freedom from obligation and is excused. This is one kind of permission ascribed to the Law. This is the meaning of His saying, mighty and exalted, “We have neglected nothing in the Book”: nothing bearing a ruling is left uncontained there; whatever it does not contain through any of the forms of legal evidence is passed over.

الْخِطَابُ الْوَارِدُ، وَلَا دَلَّتْ عَلَيْهِ قَرِينَةٌ، فَهُوَ عَلَى الْبَرَاءَةِ الْأَصْلِيَّةِ مَعْفُوٌّ عَنْهُ، وَهُوَ أَحَدُ أَصْنَافِ الْمُبَاحِ الْمَنْسُوبِ إِلَى الشَّرْعِ. وَهَذَا مَعْنَى قَوْلِهِ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ: «مَا فَرَّطْنَا فِي الْكِتَابِ مِنْ شَيْءٍ» كَانَ فِيهِ حُكْمٌ إِلَّا وَضَمَّنَاهُ إِيَّاهُ وَمَا لَمْ يَتَضَمَّنْهُ بِأَحَدِ الْأَدِلَّةِ الشَّرْعِيَّةِ فَهُوَ مَصْفُوحٌ عَنْهُ.

Editorial notes

N113 [translation] The quotation from Qur’ān 6:38 ends at “the Book” in the English translation of ما فرطنا في الكتاب من شيء. The following explanation about things bearing rulings is Ibn Rushd’s gloss, not additional Qur’ānic wording.

N114 [translation] “Original freedom from obligation” renders البراءة الأصلية. The paragraph distinguishes an issue on which the discourse determines a ruling from an issue left without an imposed obligation; it does not identify all legal certainty with literal wording alone.

BA016 [scholarship] The crux is the Lawgiver’s determinate intention and the meaningful difference between a decisive or probable indication and the absence of any applicable indication, which leaves original non-liability in place. Bou Akl locates Ibn Rushd against al-Ghazālī’s stronger “every mujtahid is correct” account; this must not be exaggerated into the assertion that the evidence is always certain. Source: Bou Akl, “Splitting the Process and the Result,” in Philosophy and Jurisprudence in the Islamic World (De Gruyter, 2019), pp. 141–143.

§ 240 Al-Ghazālī’s first argument for universal correctness

1994 Arabic p. 139 & 140 · BA §291–292 · 2015 Arabic p. 312 · French p. 313

Abū Ḥāmid holds here that every independent jurist is correct. He has enumerated and rejected the objections to that claim, but has not included the argument we have given. He follows two routes in establishing that every independent jurist is correct. We shall show that his alleged consequences do not follow.

وَأَبُو حَامِدٍ يَرَى هُنَا أَنَّ كُلَّ مُجْتَهِدٍ مُصِيبٌ، وَقَدْ عَدَّدَ الْأُمُورَ الَّتِي نُوقِضَ بِهَا أَنَّ كُلَّ مُجْتَهِدٍ مُصِيبٌ وَزَيَّفَهَا، إِلَّا أَنَّهُ لَمْ يُعَدِّدْ فِي ذَلِكَ هَذَا الَّذِي قُلْنَاهُ. وَقَدْ سَلَكَ هُوَ فِي تَثْبِيتِ أَنَّ كُلَّ مُجْتَهِدٍ مُصِيبٌ طَرِيقَيْنِ، وَنَحْنُ نُوقِفُ عَلَى أَنَّ مَا أَلْزَمَ مِنْ ذَلِكَ غَيْرُ لَازِمٍ:

His first route is this. He says: if there were a determinate ruling in matters whose path is independent inquiry, the obligation would concern attaining it. In that case there would be decisive evidence leading to it; otherwise this would impose an obligation beyond one’s capacity, which has already been shown impossible.

إِحْدَاهُمَا أَنَّهُ قَالَ: لَوْ كَانَ هَهُنَا حُكْمٌ مُتَعَيِّنٌ فِيمَا طَرِيقُهُ الِاجْتِهَادُ لَكَانَ التَّكْلِيفُ مُتَعَلِّقًا بِإِصَابَتِهِ، وَلَوْ كَانَ ذَلِكَ لَكَانَ عَلَيْهِ دَلِيلٌ قَطْعِيٌّ يُفْضِي إِلَيْهِ، وَإِلَّا كَانَ مِنْ بَابِ تَكْلِيفِ مَا لَا يُطَاقُ، وَقَدْ تَقَدَّمَ امْتِنَاعُهُ.

He then attempts to show that the indications used in independent inquiry are probable, yield the two contradictories equally, and acquire preponderance only according to each person’s natural inclination in each ruling and each case.

ثُمَّ أَخَذَ يُبَيِّنُ أَنَّ الدَّلَائِلَ الْمُسْتَعْمَلَةَ فِي الِاجْتِهَادِ ظَنِّيَّةٌ يَحْصُلُ عَنْهَا النَّقِيضَانِ بِالسَّوَاءِ، وَأَنَّ التَّرَجُّحَ فِيهَا إِنَّمَا هُوَ بِحَسَبِ مَا طُبِعَ عَلَيْهِ شَخْصُ شَخْصٍ مِنَ الْمَيْلِ فِي حُكْمٍ حُكْمٍ، وَنَازِلَةٍ نَازِلَةٍ.

§ 241 Evidence signifies; inclination does not make a ruling

1994 Arabic p. 140 & 141 · BA §293 · 2015 Arabic p. 312 · French p. 313

وَالْقَوْلُ بِمِثْلِ هَذَا كَبِيرَةٌ وَمَصِيرٌ إِلَى التَّحَكُّمِ فِي الشَّرْعِ بِالْأَهْوَاءِ وَالْإِرَادَاتِ، نَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنْ ذَلِكَ. بَلِ الْأَدِلَّةُ الشَّرْعِيَّةُ، كَمَا تَقَدَّمَ مِنْ قَوْلِنَا، إِمَّا قَطْعِيَّةٌ، وَإِمَّا ظَنِّيَّةٌ أَكْثَرِيَّةٌ وَجَبَ الْعَمَلُ بِهَا بِالْأَصْلِ الْمَقْطُوعِ بِهِ. وَمَا كَانَ هَكَذَا فَالْحُكْمُ لَا شَكَّ يَحْصُلُ عَنْهَا بِذَاتِهَا، لَا بِحَسَبِ مَا طُبِعَ عَلَيْهِ إِنْسَانٌ إِنْسَانٌ، بَلْ بِحَسَبِ دَلَالَتِهَا،

To say such a thing is a grave offence and a resort to arbitrary judgement in the Law through desires and inclinations; we seek God’s protection from it. Legal evidence, as we said, is either decisive or preponderantly probable, with action on the latter required by a certainly established principle. In either case the ruling undoubtedly follows from the evidence itself, according to its signification, not according to each person’s natural disposition.

وَلِذَلِكَ مَا كَانَ مِنَ الْأَدِلَّةِ مُتَرَدِّدًا بَيْنَ النَّقِيضَيْنِ عَلَى السَّوَاءِ سُمِّيَ فِي هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ مُجْمَلًا، وَلَمْ يُجْعَلْ دَلِيلًا شَرْعِيًّا أَصْلًا. وَبِالْجُمْلَةِ الْقَوْلُ بِأَنْ لَيْسَ هُنَا أَدِلَّةٌ يَحْصُلُ عَنْهَا بِذَاتِهَا الطَّلَبُ، سَوَاءٌ كَانَتِ الْأَدِلَّةُ عَقْلِيَّةً أَوْ شَرْعِيَّةً، هُوَ قَوْلٌ سُوفَسْطَائِيٌّ جِدًّا، وَيَنْبَغِي أَنْ يُتَجَنَّبَ، فَإِنَّهُ عَظِيمُ الضَّرَرِ فِي الشَّرِيعَةِ. وَإِذَا كَانَ هَذَا هَكَذَا، وَكَانَ هَهُنَا أَدِلَّةٌ تُفْضِي إِلَى الْمَطْلُوبِ، لَمْ يَكُنْ تَكْلِيفُ إِصَابَتِهِ مِنْ بَابِ مَا لَا يُطَاقُ.

Hence an indication undecided equally between contradictories is called indeterminate in this discipline and is not accepted as legal evidence at all. In general, denying that evidence itself yields what is sought—whether the evidence is rational or legal—is a thoroughly sophistical claim, to be avoided because of its great harm to the Law. Since evidence leading to the object sought exists, requiring one to attain it is not an obligation beyond one’s capacity.

Editorial notes

N115 [translation] The author’s sharp criticism is directed at the account of evidence just reported from Abū Ḥāmid. The editor’s separate comparison with the more flexible treatment in Bidāyat al-mujtahid is not merged into Ibn Rushd’s authorial voice.

N116 [textual] Printed الطلب is understood here as the result sought in inquiry, in light of المطلوب in the following sentence.

BA017 [scholarship] Ibn Rushd rejects treating an investigator’s inclination as constitutive of the Law’s judgement. This is a claim about the objectivity of evidential indication even when inquiry is probable, not a denial that jurists can reasonably disagree or be excused when they err. Bou Akl sets this within the distinction between alethic truth and legal responsibility. Source: Bou Akl, “Splitting the Process and the Result,” in Philosophy and Jurisprudence in the Islamic World (De Gruyter, 2019), pp. 141–143.

§ 242 Al-Ghazālī’s second argument: absence of sin

1994 Arabic p. 141 · BA §294 · 2015 Arabic p. 314 · French p. 315

وَأَمَّا الطَّرِيقَةُ الْأُخْرَى الَّتِي احْتَجَّ بِهَا فَأَخَذَهَا مِنَ الْوَاجِبِ، وَذَلِكَ أَنَّهُ كَمَا قِيلَ فِيهِ هُوَ مَا فِي تَرْكِهِ عِقَابٌ قَالَ: فَلَوْ كَانَ الْوَاجِبُ فِي الشَّيْءِ حُكْمًا مُتَعَيِّنًا لَكَانَ فِي تَرْكِ إِصَابَتِهِ إِثْمٌ، وَالْإِجْمَاعُ قَدِ انْعَقَدَ عَلَى سُقُوطِ التَّأْثِيمِ عَنِ الْمُجْتَهِدِينَ، فَلِذَلِكَ يَلْزَمُ عَنِ انْتِفَاءِ التَّأْثِيمِ انْتِفَاءُ الْخَطَأِ.

His other argument is drawn from obligation. Since the obligatory was defined as that whose omission incurs punishment, he argues: if the obligation concerning a thing were a determinate ruling, failure to attain it would incur sin. But consensus establishes that independent jurists are not charged with sin. Therefore, the absence of sin entails the absence of error.

§ 243 An error can be pardoned without becoming correct

1994 Arabic p. 141 · BA §295 · 2015 Arabic p. 314 · French p. 315

We say that exemption from sin does not entail absence of error. Unintentional error is pardoned in the Law; it occurs through forgetfulness, inattention, and inadvertence. We have repeatedly said that legal evidence is either decisive or preponderant. The path to decisive evidence is plainly accessible, and inadvertence and mistake are rare in it; hence error there seems to entail sin. With probable evidence, however, mistake and inadvertence occur often, so error does not entail sin.

وَنَحْنُ نَقُولُ إِنَّهُ لَيْسَ يَلْزَمُ عَنْ سُقُوطِ التَّأْثِيمِ انْتِفَاءُ الْخَطَأِ، إِذِ الْخَطَأُ غَيْرُ الْمُتَعَمَّدِ مَصْفُوحٌ عَنْهُ فِي الشَّرْعِ، وَهُوَ يَقَعُ بِهِ النِّسْيَانُ وَالْغَفْلَةُ وَالسَّهْوُ. وَقَدْ قُلْنَا غَيْرَ مَا مَرَّةٍ إِنَّ الْأَدِلَّةَ الشَّرْعِيَّةَ إِمَّا قَطْعِيَّةٌ، وَإِمَّا أَكْثَرِيَّةٌ. أَمَّا الْقَطْعِيَّةُ فَالطَّرِيقُ إِلَيْهَا مَهْيَعٌ، وَوُقُوعُ السَّهْوِ فِيهَا وَالْغَلَطِ يَقِلُّ، فَلِذَلِكَ يُشْبِهُ أَنْ يَلْزَمَ التَّأْثِيمُ فِيهَا بِلُزُومِ الْخَطَأِ. وَأَمَّا الظَّنِّيَّةُ فَالْغَلَطُ كَثِيرًا مَا يَقَعُ فِيهَا وَالسَّهْوُ، فَلِذَلِكَ لَمْ يَلْزَمْ مِنَ الْخَطَأِ فِيهَا التَّأْثِيمُ.

The definition of the obligatory as that whose omission incurs punishment means that punishment attaches to omission after its obligatory status has become known, where decisive evidence leads to that knowledge. If someone errs or is inadvertent in a matter liable to error and thus has no way to know its obligatory status, how could he incur sin? The Prophet, peace be upon him, has said, “Error and forgetfulness have been lifted from my community.”

وَالَّذِي أُخِذَ فِي حَدِّ الْوَاجِبِ بِأَنَّهُ الَّذِي فِي تَرْكِهِ عِقَابٌ، إِنَّمَا مَعْنَى ذَلِكَ أَنَّ الْعِقَابَ يَتَعَلَّقُ بِتَرْكِهِ بَعْدَ الْمَعْرِفَةِ بِوُجُوبِهِ، فِيمَا كَانَ إِلَى الْمَعْرِفَةِ بِوُجُوبِهِ دَلِيلٌ قَطْعِيٌّ. وَأَمَّا مَنْ غَلِطَ أَوْ سَهَا فِيمَا الْغَلَطُ فِيهِ مُعَرَّضٌ فَلَمْ يَكُنْ لَهُ سَبِيلٌ إِلَى مَعْرِفَةِ وُجُوبِهِ، فَكَيْفَ يَلْحَقُ بِمِثْلِ هَذَا تَأْثِيمٌ. وَقَدْ قَالَ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ: «رُفِعَ عَنْ أُمَّتِي الْخَطَأُ وَالنِّسْيَانُ».

Editorial notes

N117 [textual] The compressed clause وهو يقع به النسيان والغفلة والسهو has an awkward pronoun/preposition sequence. Its contextual point is that forgetfulness and inadvertence belong to the pardoned class of unintentional error; the English expresses this relation without claiming a new Arabic reading.

BA018 [scholarship] Most important distinction: unintentional error (khaṭaʾ ghayr mutaʿammad) may be pardoned without becoming a correct judgement. Bou Akl cites this very argument as §295 of his 2015 edition, while the al-ʿAlawī-based reader numbers it §243. His 2019 reading distinguishes truth/error from an accusation of culpable error, applying the juristic distinction to philosophical inquiry in the Faṣl al-maqāl. Source: Bou Akl, “Splitting the Process and the Result,” in Philosophy and Jurisprudence in the Islamic World (De Gruyter, 2019), pp. 140–144, esp. p. 143 n. 26. The current Arabic wording remains that of al-ʿAlawī 1994, not a verified 2015 variant.

BA15-I10 [interpretive] Wrong vs blameworthy. Bou Akl 2015 intro pp.93–99 distinguishes an incorrect proposition from a culpable error. Unintentional error after qualified effort may be excused even though an objectively correct answer exists. The parallel with philosophy in the Decisive Treatise is explored in Bou Akl 2019.

§ 244 Degrees of culpability and the clarity of evidence

1994 Arabic p. 141 & 142 · BA §296 · 2015 Arabic p. 314 · French p. 315

If it is said that this entails freedom from sin even when a jurist unintentionally misses something established by decisive evidence, we reply: this requires examination. The difference is clear. Decisive evidence is seldom hidden from someone

فَإِنْ قِيلَ فَسَيَلْزَمُ عَلَى هَذَا أَنَّ مَا كَانَ عَلَيْهِ دَلِيلٌ قَطْعِيٌّ فَأَخْطَأَهُ الْمُجْتَهِدُ عَلَى غَيْرِ عَمْدٍ أَنَّهُ لَا يَأْثَمُ. قِيلَ فِي هَذَا نَظَرٌ. وَالْفَرْقُ بَيْنَهُمَا بَيِّنٌ. فَإِنَّ الدَّلِيلَ الْقَطْعِيَّ قَلَّمَا يَخْفَى عَلَى

who has attained the rank of independent inquiry. Its being hidden is conceivable only through desire, partiality, something opposing it, or other psychological impediments. This has degrees corresponding to the degrees of evidence. Hence some cases incur a judgement of unbelief and others a charge of sin; the Law determines these differences.

أَحَدٍ مِمَّنْ بَلَغَ رُتْبَةَ الِاجْتِهَادِ، وَإِنَّمَا يُتَصَوَّرُ خَفَاؤُهُ لِهَوًى أَوْ هَوَادَةٍ أَوْ لِشَيْءٍ عَلَى خِلَافِهِ أَوْ غَيْرِ ذَلِكَ مِنَ الْعَوَارِضِ النَّفْسِيَّةِ. وَلِهَذَا مَرَاتِبُ بِحَسَبِ مَرَاتِبِ الْأَدِلَّةِ، وَلِذَلِكَ يُكَفَّرُ فِي بَعْضِهَا، وَيُؤَثَّمُ فِي بَعْضٍ، وَمُدْرَكُ هَذَا التَّفَاوُتِ الشَّرْعُ.

Editorial notes

BA019 [scholarship] Bou Akl argues that the relevant juristic differentiation turns in part on the relative accessibility of evidence: easy, conclusive matters differ from difficult, presumptive matters where an unwilled mistake is more likely. The legal consequences still depend on the Law; the claim is not that every sincere doctrinal mistake is excused. Source: Bou Akl, “Splitting the Process and the Result,” in Philosophy and Jurisprudence in the Islamic World (De Gruyter, 2019), pp. 142–143.

§ 245 Attainable truth and merciful pardon

1994 Arabic p. 142 · BA §297 · 2015 Arabic p. 316 · French p. 317

Our discussion has shown that not every independent jurist is correct, in what respect he is free from sin when he errs, and that he is charged with attaining something that is itself attainable. When he errs, he is forgiven out of mercy and pardon.

فَقَدْ تَبَيَّنَ مِنْ قَوْلِنَا أَنْ لَيْسَ كُلُّ مُجْتَهِدٍ مُصِيبًا، وَأَنَّهُ إِنْ أَخْطَأَ فَعَلَى أَيِّ جِهَةٍ لَا يَأْثَمُ، وَأَنَّ الْمُجْتَهِدَ كُلِّفَ إِصَابَةَ مَا هُوَ فِي نَفْسِهِ مُمْكِنُ الْإِصَابَةِ، وَعُفِيَ عَنْهُ عِنْدَ الْخَطَأِ رَحْمَةً لَهُ وَصَفْحًا عَنْهُ.

Editorial notes

BA020 [scholarship] This conclusion preserves BOTH a truth one may miss and an excuse when a qualified jurist has diligently pursued it. Bou Akl stresses professional effort and methodology as grounds of exculpation, whereas the Arabic here still states that the jurist is charged with attaining what is in itself attainable. Keep the textual statement and record the interpretive tension rather than rewriting it as “only effort, never correctness, is obligatory.” Source: Bou Akl, “Splitting the Process and the Result,” in Philosophy and Jurisprudence in the Islamic World (De Gruyter, 2019), pp. 142–144.

§ 246 Conflict: suspension, caution or free choice?

1994 Arabic p. 142 · BA §298 · 2015 Arabic p. 316 · French p. 317

It remains to consider the jurist’s position when evidence conflicts for him on a question, and what course he should take. Abū Ḥāmid reports three views: suspending judgement, adopting the more cautious course, and the Judge’s view that the jurist may choose. This last view is weak, because granting a choice is permission, whereas contradictory evidence concerning the command about a single matter is more apt to produce doubt and perplexity than to be thought to establish such permission.

وَقَدْ بَقِيَ عَلَيْنَا مِنْ هَذَا الْبَابِ كَيْفَ حَالَةُ الْمُجْتَهِدِ، إِذَا تَعَارَضَتْ عِنْدَهُ الْأَدِلَّةُ فِي مَسْأَلَةٍ مَا، وَإِلَى أَيِّ شَيْءٍ يَصِيرُ فَنَقُولُ: إِنَّ الَّذِي حَكَى فِي ذَلِكَ أَبُو حَامِدٍ ثَلَاثَةُ آرَاءٍ: أَحَدُهَا رَأْيُ مَنْ يَرَى التَّوَقُّفَ وَالثَّانِي الْأَخْذُ بِالْأَحْوَطِ وَالثَّالِثُ رَأْيُ الْقَاضِي وَهُوَ أَنْ يَتَخَيَّرَ الْمُجْتَهِدُ، وَهَذَا رَأْيٌ ضَعِيفٌ لِأَنَّ التَّخْيِيرَ إِبَاحَةٌ، وَالْأَدِلَّةُ الْمُتَنَاقِضَةُ فِي الْأَمْرِ بِالشَّيْءِ الْوَاحِدِ هِيَ أَوْلَى أَنْ تُوقِعَ الشَّكَّ وَالْحَيْرَةَ مِنْ أَنْ يُظَنَّ بِهَا أَنَّهَا تُنْتِجُهُ.

وَكَذَلِكَ التَّوَقُّفُ لَا مَعْنَى لَهُ، فَإِنَّ فِي ذَلِكَ تَعْطِيلًا لِلْأَحْكَامِ. وَأَيْضًا فَإِنَّهُ غَيْرُ مُمْكِنٍ فِي الْأَشْيَاءِ الَّتِي لَيْسَ يُمْكِنُ الْإِنْسَانَ فِيهَا إِلَّا أَنْ يَأْتِيَ أَحَدَ الضِّدَّيْنِ، كَالْأَحَادِيثِ الْوَارِدَةِ مَثَلًا فِي الْغُسْلِ مِنَ الْمَاءِ، وَالْغُسْلِ مِنِ الْتِقَاءِ الْخِتَانَيْنِ، فَإِنَّ مِثْلَ هَذِهِ الْأَحَادِيثِ إِذَا تَعَارَضَتْ لَمْ يُمْكِنْ فِيهَا التَّوَقُّفُ، فَإِنَّهُ لَا بُدَّ مِنَ الْمَصِيرِ إِلَى أَحَدِهِمَا.

Suspending judgement likewise makes no sense, since it leaves rulings inoperative. It is also impossible where a person must do one of two opposite things. Consider the reports about ritual bathing because of the emission of fluid, and bathing because of the meeting of the circumcised parts. When such reports conflict, suspension is impossible: one must adopt one or the other.

وَفِي مِثْلِ هَذَا يُخَيَّلُ الْمَصِيرُ إِلَى الْأَخْذِ بِالْأَحْوَطِ. وَهُوَ وَإِنْ كَانَ يُخَيَّلُ فِيهِ أَنَّهُ أَوْلَى لِمَكَانِ النَّجَاةِ مِنَ الذَّمِّ، فَكَذَلِكَ يُخَافُ لُحُوقُ الذَّمِّ بِزِيَادَةِ مَا لَيْسَ مِنَ الشَّرْعِ فِي الشَّرْعِ.

In such a case, adopting the more cautious course appears plausible. Although it may seem preferable because it avoids blame, one must equally fear blame for adding to the Law something that does not belong to it.

Editorial notes

N118 [translation] The compressed bathing examples concern whether emission is required or whether intercourse itself requires the ritual bath. The Arabic formulations are retained. The “Judge” is left as the author’s designation; no unsupported personal identification is inserted.

§ 247 The Ẓāhirī response: return to original nonliability

1994 Arabic p. 142 & 143 · BA §299 · 2015 Arabic p. 318 · French p. 319

وَلِلظَّاهِرِيَّةِ فِي هَذَا قَوْلٌ رَابِعٌ، وَهُوَ أَنْ يَرْجِعَ الْمُجْتَهِدُ عِنْدَ تَكَافُؤِ الْأَدِلَّةِ إِلَى الْبَرَاءَةِ الْأَصْلِيَّةِ، لِأَنَّ التَّكْلِيفَ بِالْأَدِلَّةِ الْمُتَنَاقِضَةِ تَكْلِيفُ مَا لَا يُطَاقُ، وَهُوَ فِي ذَلِكَ بِمَنْزِلَةِ التَّكْلِيفِ بِمَا لَيْسَ عَلَيْهِ دَلِيلٌ. فَكَمَا أَنَّ مَا لَيْسَ عَلَيْهِ دَلِيلٌ تُسْتَصْحَبُ فِيهِ الْبَرَاءَةُ الْأَصْلِيَّةُ، أَوْ مَا كَانَ عَلَيْهِ دَلِيلٌ إِلَّا أَنَّهُ لَمْ يُمْكِنْ بُلُوغُهُ، كَذَلِكَ مَنْ تَعَارَضَتْ عِنْدَهُ الْأَدِلَّةُ فِي شَيْءٍ مَا سَاقِطَةٌ فِي حَقِّهِ.

The Ẓāhirīs have a fourth view: when the evidence is equally balanced, the independent jurist returns to original freedom from obligation. An obligation imposed through contradictory evidence exceeds one’s capacity and is like an obligation lacking evidence. Just as original freedom from obligation is presumed to continue where there is no evidence—or where evidence exists but cannot be reached—it likewise continues where available proofs appear to conflict. And just as a ruling supported by evidence does not bind someone whom that evidence has not reached, so apparently opposed proofs cease to bind the person for whom they conflict.

وَإِنَّمَا يَقَعُ هَذَانِ الصِّنْفَانِ فِي حَقِّ قَوْمٍ وَأَهْلِ زَمَانٍ مَا مِمَّنْ لَمْ يَصِلْهُمُ الدَّلِيلُ الشَّرْعِيُّ، أَوْ مِمَّنْ لَمْ يَتَمَيَّزْ لَهُمُ النَّاسِخُ فِي ذَلِكَ وَالْمَنْسُوخُ وَغَيْرُ ذَلِكَ مِمَّا يُوجِبُ التَّعَارُضَ، إِذْ كَانَ لَيْسَ يَجُوزُ وُقُوعُ دَلَائِلَ مُتَضَادَّةٍ فِي الشَّرْعِ.

These two conditions occur only relative to particular people or people of a particular period: those whom the legal evidence has not reached, or who have not distinguished the abrogating from the abrogated, or other matters producing conflict. For contradictory evidence cannot occur within the Law itself.

Editorial notes

N119 [translation] The opening explicitly reports a Ẓāhirī position. The final sentence distinguishes conflict as it appears to particular inquirers from contradiction in the Law itself; the translation does not erase that distinction.

BA15-I11 [interpretive] Contradictory evidence. Bou Akl 2015 intro pp.99–106 relates equal evidential balance (takāfu') to preference (tarjīḥ). Ibn Rushd's view that unreconciled opposition can reflect missing historical information is not a license to choose arbitrary rulings.

BA15-T01 [translation] Bou Akl 2015 §299 (Arabic p.318; facing French p.319) preserves two distinct analogies concerning unavailable and opposed evidence. First, the presumption of original nonliability applies where legal proof is missing or unreachable, and likewise where evidence appears to conflict; second, a proof not yet reaching its addressee cannot bind that person, just as apparent opposition cannot bind the person unable to resolve it. This is not a claim that Law intrinsically contains contradictory evidence; Ibn Rushd expressly denies that in the following sentence.

§ 248 From independent inquiry to following authority

1994 Arabic p. 143 · BA §300 · 2015 Arabic p. 318 · French p. 319

Having completed the discussion of independent inquiry and its subject matter, let us discuss following authority and the person who does so.

وَإِذْ قَدْ فَرَغْنَا مِنَ الْقَوْلِ فِي الِاجْتِهَادِ وَالْمُجْتَهَدِ فِيهِ، فَلْنَقُلْ فِي التَّقْلِيدِ وَالْمُقَلِّدِ.

§ 249 Trust, probability and following the Prophet

1994 Arabic p. 143 · BA §301 · 2015 Arabic p. 318 · French p. 319

Following authority (تقليد) is accepting someone's statement whose truth is judged preponderantly probable because of confidence in that person. It differs from following the Prophet, God bless him and grant him peace: following him is accepting a statement of which one attains certainty, because the miracle indicates his truthfulness, God bless him and grant him peace.

وَالتَّقْلِيدُ هُوَ قَبُولُ قَوْلِ قَائِلٍ يَغْلِبُ عَلَى الظَّنِّ صِدْقُهُ لِحُسْنِ الثِّقَةِ فِيهِ. وَالْفَرْقُ بَيْنَ هَذَا وَبَيْنَ تَقْلِيدِهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ، أَنَّ تَقْلِيدَهُ هُوَ قَبُولُ قَوْلٍ يَقَعُ لِلْإِنْسَانِ الْيَقِينُ بِهِ لِدَلَالَةِ الْمُعْجِزَةِ عَلَى صِدْقِهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ.

§ 250 Why juristic expertise is a collective obligation

1994 Arabic p. 143 & 144 · BA §302 · 2015 Arabic p. 318 · French p. 319

Those permitted to follow authority are ordinary people. The proof is that people must fall under one of three arrangements. Either all are independent jurists; this is impossible both in practice and as an obligation, since, even if everyone could attain that rank, it would bring the means of livelihood to a halt.

وَأَمَّا مَنْ يَجُوزُ لَهُمُ التَّقْلِيدُ، فَهُمُ الْعَوَامُّ، بِدَلِيلِ أَنَّ النَّاسَ لَا يَخْلُونَ مِنْ ثَلَاثَةِ أَقْسَامٍ: إِمَّا أَنْ يَكُونُوا كُلُّهُمْ مُجْتَهِدِينَ، وَهَذَا مُحَالٌ وُقُوعُهُ وَالتَّكْلِيفُ بِهِ، لِأَنَّهُ كَانَ يُؤَدِّي إِلَى انْقِطَاعِ الْمَعَايِشِ لَوْ كَانَ مُمْكِنًا أَنْ يَحْصُلَ لِكُلِّ أَحَدٍ رُتْبَةُ الِاجْتِهَادِ.

Or all lack the qualifications for independent inquiry. This too is impossible, because it would lead to the neglect of most rulings: independent jurists are those who discharge the obligation of knowing most prescribed duties and practices and teaching them to people.

وَإِمَّا أَنْ تُفْقَدَ فِي جَمِيعِهِمْ شُرُوطُ الِاجْتِهَادِ، وَهَذَا أَيْضًا مُمْتَنِعٌ، لِأَنَّهُ كَانَ يُؤَدِّي إِلَى إِهْمَالِ أَكْثَرِ الْأَحْكَامِ، إِذْ أَكْثَرُ الْفَرَائِضِ وَالسُّنَنِ إِنَّمَا يَقُومُ بِفَرْضِ مَعْرِفَتِهَا وَتَعْلِيمِهَا لِلنَّاسِ الْمُجْتَهِدُونَ.

Or both classes exist: one group preserves the prescribed duties and practices for the public, lays them upon people, requires their observance, and derives what may be derived from them at each time and in each case. Another group, ordinary people, follows the authority of the first because of confidence in them and a preponderant judgement of their truthfulness.

وَإِمَّا أَنْ يُوجَدَ فِي النَّاسِ الصِّنْفَانِ جَمِيعًا، وَهُوَ أَنْ تَكُونَ فِيهِمْ طَائِفَةٌ تَقُومُ لِلْجُمْهُورِ بِضَبْطِ الْفَرَائِضِ وَالسُّنَنِ، وَجَعْلِهَا عَلَيْهِمْ، وَأَخْذِهِمْ بِهَا، وَاسْتِنْبَاطِ مَا شَأْنُهُ أَنْ يُسْتَنْبَطَ مِنْهَا فِي وَقْتٍ وَقْتٍ وَنَازِلَةٍ نَازِلَةٍ. وَتَكُونَ فِيهِمْ طَائِفَةٌ أُخْرَى، وَهُمُ الْعَوَامُّ، شَأْنُهُمْ تَقْلِيدُ هَؤُلَاءِ لِحُسْنِ الثِّقَةِ بِهِمْ، وَغَلَبَةِ الظَّنِّ فِي صِدْقِهِمْ.

Here it is as though preponderant judgement based on confidence has been made a sign that the rulings bind them, just as the independent jurist's preponderant judgement is a sign that a ruling binds him. This is rightly called a collective obligation (فرض كفاية), since its performance by some suffices on behalf of others.

وَكَأَنَّ غَلَبَةَ الظَّنِّ لِحُسْنِ الثِّقَةِ جُعِلَتْ هَهُنَا أَمَارَةً لِلزُّومِ الْأَحْكَامِ لَهُمْ، كَمَا جُعِلَتْ غَلَبَةُ الظَّنِّ لِلْمُجْتَهِدِ أَمَارَةً لِلزُّومِ الْحُكْمِ لَهُ. وَبِالْوَاجِبِ مَا سُمِّيَ هَذَا فَرْضَ كِفَايَةٍ، إِذْ يَكْفِي فِي الْقِيَامِ بِهِ الْبَعْضُ عَنِ الْبَعْضِ.

Editorial notes

BA021 [scholarship] The general public and trained interpreters occupy complementary positions because not everybody can devote themselves to the craft of legal inference. Bou Akl observes that the Decisive Treatise's philosopher/layperson distinction draws upon juridical mujtahid/muqallid relations; this is about relation to disciplinary competence, not an immutable caste classification. Source: Bou Akl, "Averroes on Juridical Reasoning," in Interpreting Averroes: Critical Essays (Cambridge UP, 2018), p. 63; Bou Akl, "Splitting the Process and the Result," in Philosophy and Jurisprudence in the Islamic World (De Gruyter, 2019), pp. 139–141.

§ 251 May a mujtahid follow a more knowledgeable jurist?

1994 Arabic p. 144 · BA §303–304 · 2015 Arabic p. 320 · French p. 321

It is therefore clear that people are of two classes. One is obliged to follow authority: ordinary people who have not attained the rank of independent inquiry defined earlier. The second comprises independent jurists who fully possess its qualifications.

فَقَدْ تَبَيَّنَ مِنْ هَذَا أَنَّ النَّاسَ صِنْفَانِ: صِنْفٌ فَرْضُهُ التَّقْلِيدُ، وَهُمُ الْعَوَامُّ الَّذِينَ لَمْ يَبْلُغُوا رُتْبَةَ الِاجْتِهَادِ الَّتِي حُدِّدَتْ فِيمَا قَبْلُ. وَصِنْفٌ ثَانٍ وَهُمُ الْمُجْتَهِدُونَ الَّذِينَ كَمُلَتْ لَهُمْ شُرُوطُ الِاجْتِهَادِ.

Whether those in the second class may follow one another's authority requires examination. Ordinary people's following authority is required by necessity and established by consensus. Nevertheless, one should say that an independent jurist may follow another who is more knowledgeable than he, when his confidence in the other's judgement outweighs the probable judgement he himself reaches through independent inquiry into the matter.

وَأَمَّا هَلْ لِهَذَا الصِّنْفِ الثَّانِي وَهُمُ الْمُجْتَهِدُونَ أَنْ يُقَلِّدَ بَعْضُهُمْ بَعْضًا، فَفِيهِ نَظَرٌ. فَإِنَّ تَقْلِيدَ الْعَوَامِّ شَيْءٌ أَدَّتْ إِلَيْهِ الضَّرُورَةُ، وَوَقَعَ عَلَيْهِ الْإِجْمَاعُ. لَكِنْ يَنْبَغِي أَنْ يُقَالَ: يَجُوزُ لِلْمُجْتَهِدِ تَقْلِيدُ الْمُجْتَهِدِ إِذَا كَانَ أَعْلَمَ مِنْهُ، وَتَرَجَّحَ عِنْدَهُ حُسْنُ الظَّنِّ بِهِ تَرَجُّحًا يَفْضُلُ عِنْدَهُ الظَّنَّ الْوَاقِعَ لَهُ فِي الشَّيْءِ عَنِ اجْتِهَادِهِ.

§ 252 Memorised school doctrine is not an independent source

1994 Arabic p. 144 & 145 · BA §305 · 2015 Arabic p. 322 · French p. 323

There is a group resembling ordinary people in one respect and independent jurists in another: those mostly called jurists in our time. We should examine to which class they more properly belong. Their condition plainly shows that their rank is that of ordinary people and that they are followers of authority.

وَلِأَنَّ هَهُنَا طَائِفَةً تُشْبِهُ الْعَوَامَّ مِنْ جِهَةٍ، وَالْمُجْتَهِدِينَ مِنْ جِهَةٍ، وَهُمُ الْمُسَمَّوْنَ فِي زَمَانِنَا هَذَا أَكْثَرَ ذَلِكَ بِالْفُقَهَاءِ، فَيَنْبَغِي أَنْ نَنْظُرَ فِي أَيِّ الصِّنْفَيْنِ أَوْلَى أَنْ نُلْحِقَهُمْ. وَهُوَ ظَاهِرٌ مِنْ أَمْرِهِمْ أَنَّ مَرْتَبَتَهُمْ مَرْتَبَةُ الْعَوَامِّ، وَأَنَّهُمْ مُقَلِّدُونَ.

They differ from ordinary people by memorising independent jurists' opinions and reporting them to others, without themselves possessing the qualifications for independent inquiry. Their rank is thus like that of transmitters from independent jurists. Had they stopped there, matters would have been more fitting. Instead, they go beyond it, analogising cases for which no ruling has been transmitted from their authorities to cases for which one has. They make a source of what is not a source, turning independent jurists' statements into sources for their own inquiry. That is sufficient error and innovation!

وَالْفَرْقُ بَيْنَ هَؤُلَاءِ وَبَيْنَ الْعَوَامِّ، أَنَّهُمْ يَحْفَظُونَ الْآرَاءَ الَّتِي لِلْمُجْتَهِدِينَ فَيُخْبِرُونَ عَنْهَا الْعَوَامَّ، مِنْ غَيْرِ أَنْ تَكُونَ عِنْدَهُمْ شُرُوطُ الِاجْتِهَادِ، فَكَأَنَّ مَرْتَبَتَهُمْ فِي ذَلِكَ مَرْتَبَةُ النَّاقِلِينَ عَنِ الْمُجْتَهِدِينَ. وَلَوْ وَقَفُوا فِي هَذَا لَكَانَ الْأَمْرُ أَشْبَهَ، لَكِنْ يَتَعَدَّوْنَ فَيَقِيسُونَ أَشْيَاءَ لَمْ يُنْقَلْ فِيهَا عَنْ مُقَلَّدِيهِمْ حُكْمٌ عَلَى مَا نُقِلَ عَنْهُ فِي ذَلِكَ حُكْمٌ، فَيَجْعَلُونَ أَصْلًا مَا لَيْسَ بِأَصْلٍ، وَيُصَيِّرُونَ أَقَاوِيلَ الْمُجْتَهِدِينَ أُصُولًا لِاجْتِهَادِهِمْ، وَكَفَى بِهَذَا ضَلَالًا وَبِدْعَةً.

§ 253 Why inherited opinions cannot replace living inquiry

1994 Arabic p. 145 · BA §306 · 2015 Arabic p. 322 · French p. 323

May they, however, remain in the first condition: transmitting from an independent jurist whom they judge probably correct, with successors carefully transmitting from predecessors, so that, for example, no one in our time discharges the obligation of independent inquiry, apart from those of the past? Would it suffice that someone in the earliest period discharged it, even one man or more, as we find among these groups—the Mālikīs, Shāfiʿīs, and Ḥanafīs?

فَأَمَّا هَلْ يَجُوزُ لَهُمُ الْحَالُ الْأُولَى، وَهِيَ أَنْ يَكُونُوا فِي ذَلِكَ نَاقِلِينَ عَنْ مُجْتَهِدٍ غَلَبَ عَلَى ظَنِّهِمْ إِصَابَتُهُ وَيَتَحَرَّى ذَلِكَ خَلَفُهُمْ عَنْ سَلَفِهِمْ فِي النَّقْلِ حَتَّى يَكُونَ الْقَائِمُونَ بِفَرْضِ الِاجْتِهَادِ غَيْرَ مَوْجُودِينَ فِي زَمَانِنَا هَذَا مَثَلًا، إِلَّا مَا قَدْ سَلَفَ وَيَكْفِي فِي ذَلِكَ مَثَلًا أَنْ كَانَ فِي الصَّدْرِ الْأَوَّلِ مَنْ قَامَ بِهَذَا الْفَرْضِ وَلَوْ رَجُلٌ وَاحِدٌ أَوْ أَكْثَرُ مِنْ وَاحِدٍ، عَلَى مِثَالِ مَا أَدْرَكْنَا عَلَيْهِ هَذِهِ الطَّوَائِفَ، أَعْنِي الْمَالِكِيَّةَ وَالشَّافِعِيَّةَ وَالْحَنَفِيَّةَ،

By my life, consensus proves that this is impermissible: for every collective obligation there must be someone in every period who performs it; only then does it cease to bind the others. Moreover, the cases that arise are without

فَيَدُلُّ لَعَمْرِي عَلَى امْتِنَاعِ ذَلِكَ انْعِقَادُ الْإِجْمَاعِ عَلَى أَنَّ جَمِيعَ فُرُوضِ الْكِفَايَاتِ يَنْبَغِي أَنْ يَكُونَ فِي زَمَانِ زَمَانِ مَنْ يَقُومُ بِهَا، وَحِينَئِذٍ تَسْقُطُ عَنِ الْغَيْرِ. وَأَيْضًا فَإِنَّ النَّوَازِلَ

limit. It is impossible to transmit from earlier independent jurists a separate pronouncement for every case.

الْوَاقِعَةَ غَيْرُ مُتَنَاهِيَةٍ، وَلَيْسَ يُمْكِنُ نَقْلُ قَوْلٍ قَوْلٍ عَنْ مَنْ سَلَفَ مِنَ الْمُجْتَهِدِينَ فِي نَازِلَةٍ نَازِلَةٍ، فَإِنَّ ذَلِكَ مُمْتَنِعٌ.

§ 254 No period should lack an active mujtahid

1994 Arabic p. 145 & 146 · BA §307 · 2015 Arabic p. 324 · French p. 325

This leaves only three possibilities: to make earlier independent jurists' legal opinions into sources from which rulings are derived; to leave many rulings inoperative; or, since both alternatives are impermissible, to accept the third —that no period should be without an independent jurist.

وَإِذَا كَانَ ذَلِكَ كَذَلِكَ فَلَمْ يَبْقَ إِلَّا وَاحِدٌ مِنْ ثَلَاثَةٍ: إِمَّا أَنْ نَجْعَلَ أَقَاوِيلَ مَنْ سَلَفَ مِنَ الْمُجْتَهِدِينَ فِيمَا أَفْتَوْا فِيهِ أُصُولًا يُسْتَنْبَطُ عَنْهَا. وَإِمَّا أَنْ يَتَعَطَّلَ كَثِيرٌ مِنَ الْأَحْكَامِ. وَكِلَا الْوَجْهَيْنِ مُمْتَنِعٌ، فَلَمْ يَبْقَ إِلَّا الْوَجْهُ الثَّالِثُ وَهُوَ أَلَّا يَخْلُوَ زَمَانٌ مِنْ مُجْتَهِدٍ.

You know that the period just past was in this condition: it had no practising independent jurist. Although it cannot be denied that someone in it had attained the rank of independent inquiry, he nevertheless acted only as a follower of authority.

وَأَنْتَ تَعْلَمُ أَنَّ الزَّمَانَ الَّذِي سَلَفَ هَكَذَا كَانَتْ حَالُهُ، أَعْنِي أَنَّهُ لَمْ يَكُنْ فِيهِ مُجْتَهِدٌ. وَإِنْ كَانَ لَا يُدْفَعُ أَنَّهُ قَدْ كَانَ فِيهِ مَنْ بَلَغَ رُتْبَةَ الِاجْتِهَادِ. لَكِنْ مَعَ هَذَا فَإِنَّمَا كَانَ مُقَلِّدًا.

Editorial notes

N120 [translation] "Practicing" makes explicit the distinction in the Arabic between possessing the rank of ijtihād and actually exercising it. The criticism concerns the author's own preceding period; it is not a claim that independent juristic inquiry historically ceased in every place.

BA022 [scholarship] The demand for available qualified juristic interpretation should be read with the preceding distinction between ijtihād and taqlīd. Bou Akl uses this institutional pattern to explain how Ibn Rushd frames expertise in the Decisive Treatise. That parallel does not prove that every social judgement in the philosophical work is explicitly stated in the present section. Source: Bou Akl, "Splitting the Process and the Result," in Philosophy and Jurisprudence in the Islamic World (De Gruyter, 2019), pp. 139–144.

§ 255 The valid and invalid uses of following authority

1994 Arabic p. 146 · BA §308 · 2015 Arabic p. 324 · French p. 325

This discussion has clarified who follows authority, what following authority is, and where it is and is not valid.

فَقَدْ تَبَيَّنَ مِنْ هَذَا الْقَوْلِ مَنِ الْمُقَلِّدُ، وَمَا التَّقْلِيدُ، وَفِي أَيِّ الْمَوَاضِعِ يَصِحُّ وَفِي أَيِّهَا لَا.

§ 256 Why an exhaustive catalogue of preferences is unnecessary

1994 Arabic p. 146 · BA §309 · 2015 Arabic p. 324 · French p. 325

There remains the third chapter, concerning the comparative weight of transmission routes and of what expressions signify through their understood meanings. This concerns evidence of the same kind, since the relative weight of different kinds has already been established. The

وَبَقِيَ الْقَوْلُ فِي الْفَصْلِ الثَّالِثِ وَهُوَ يَتَضَمَّنُ الْقَوْلَ فِي تَرْجِيحِ طُرُقِ النَّقْلِ، وَتَرْجِيحِ مَا تَدُلُّ عَلَيْهِ الْأَلْفَاظُ بِمَفْهُومَاتِهَا، وَذَلِكَ فِيمَا كَانَ مِنْ ذَلِكَ مِنْ نَوْعٍ وَاحِدٍ، لِأَنَّ الْأَدِلَّةَ الَّتِي أَنْوَاعُهَا مُخْتَلِفَةٌ قَدْ تَبَيَّنَ تَرَجُّحُ بَعْضِهَا عَلَى بَعْضٍ

relevant rules attach to particular items of evidence and particular chains of transmission, and are virtually without limit.

فِيمَا سَلَفَ، وَهِيَ قَوَانِينُ تَقْتَرِنُ بِدَلِيلٍ دَلِيلٍ وَسَنَدٍ وَسَنَدٍ وَتَكَادُ لَا تَتَنَاهَى.

Practitioners of this discipline have attempted to enumerate them. We have no need to do so, since a person can determine for himself which produce a preponderant judgement and which do not. Anyone with leisure who wishes to record them here may do so. However, the contextual indications establishing the superiority of transmission routes should be placed in the discussion of reports, and those establishing the superiority of an understood meaning in Part Three of this book.

وَقَدْ رَامَ أَهْلُ هَذِهِ الصِّنَاعَةِ حَصْرَهَا، لَكِنْ أَمَّا نَحْنُ فَلَا حَاجَةَ لَنَا إِلَى تَعْدِيدِهَا، إِذْ كَانَ الْإِنْسَانُ يُمْكِنُهُ مِنْ تِلْقَاءِ نَفْسِهِ الْوُقُوفُ عَلَى مَا فِيهَا يُفِيدُ غَلَبَةَ ظَنٍّ مِمَّا لَيْسَ يُفِيدُ. فَأَمَّا مَنْ كَانَ لَهُ فَرَاغٌ، وَأَحَبَّ أَنْ يُثْبِتَهَا هَهُنَا فَلْيَفْعَلْ، لَكِنْ يَجِبُ أَنْ يُثْبِتَ الْقَرَائِنَ الَّتِي يَقَعُ بِهَا تَرْجِيحُ طُرُقِ النَّقْلِ فِي كِتَابِ الْأَخْبَارِ، وَالَّتِي يَقَعُ بِهَا تَرْجِيحُ الْمَفْهُومِ فِي الْجُزْءِ الثَّالِثِ مِنْ هَذَا الْكِتَابِ.

§ 257 The obligation to follow the stronger judgement

1994 Arabic p. 146 · BA §310 · 2015 Arabic p. 326 · French p. 327

That adopting and acting upon the stronger of two probable judgements constitutes legal evidence is shown by the Companions' consensus on this, and by what a person finds in himself: he turns to the stronger of two probable judgements when they conflict.

فَأَمَّا أَنَّ الْمَصِيرَ إِلَى الْعَمَلِ بِأَرْجَحِ الظَّنَّيْنِ دَلِيلٌ شَرْعِيٌّ، فَيَدُلُّ عَلَيْهِ إِجْمَاعُ الصَّحَابَةِ عَلَى ذَلِكَ، وَمَا يَجِدُهُ الْإِنْسَانُ فِي نَفْسِهِ مِنَ الْمَصِيرِ إِلَى أَرْجَحِ الظَّنَّيْنِ عِنْدَ تَعَارُضِهِمَا.

§ 258 An abridgement completed and supplemented: 552 AH

1994 Arabic p. 146 · BA §311 · 2015 Arabic p. 326 · French p. 327

Here our purpose in this abridgement is complete. It resembles an abridgement in removing prolixity, and an original work in its additions and completions. This was during the middle ten days of Dhū al-Ḥijja in the year five hundred and fifty-two.

وَهُنَا انْتَهَى غَرَضُنَا فِي هَذَا الِاخْتِصَارِ. وَهُوَ يُشْبِهُ الْمُخْتَصَرَ مِنْ جِهَةِ حَذْفِ التَّطْوِيلِ، وَالْمُخْتَرَعَ مِنْ جِهَةِ التَّتْمِيمِ وَالتَّكْمِيلِ. وَذَلِكَ فِي الْعَشْرِ الْوُسْطِ مِنْ ذِي الْحِجَّةِ مِنْ سَنَةِ اثْنَتَيْنِ وَخَمْسِينَ وَخَمْسِ مِائَةٍ.

Editorial notes

N121 [translation] This is Ibn Rushd's authorial conclusion and date, 552 AH. The following 606 AH copying notice and ownership statement belong to later manuscript voices and are presented separately.

N122 [lexical] الْوُسْط is retained with ḍamma and sukūn. This is an attested reading of the calendrical expression العشر الوسط: Ibn Ḥajar, Fatḥ al-bārī on the report about the middle ten nights (Bukhārī 2016), records al-Bājī's sukūn reading alongside other readings. No change to the date is intended. https://hadithprophet.com/hadith-32830.html

COPYIST’S NOTE

Later manuscript record

§ Colophon Copyist’s colophon and ownership notice

1994 Arabic p. 146 · not authorial

The copying of the abridgement was completed on the tenth of Rajab, the solitary sacred month, in the year six hundred and six, by the hand of Muḥammad ibn ʿAlī ibn ʿAfīf. Praise belongs to God, Lord of the worlds, and blessings upon Muḥammad, the Seal of the Prophets.

خَلَصَ الْمُخْتَصَرُ بِالنَّسْخِ فِي الْعَاشِرِ مِنْ رَجَبٍ الْفَرْدِ مِنْ سَنَةِ سِتٍّ وَسِتّمِائَةٍ عَلَى يَدِ مُحَمَّدِ بْنِ عَلِيِّ بْنِ عَفِيفٍ وَالْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ وَالصَّلَاةُ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ خَاتَمِ النَّبِيِّينَ.

Owned by the servant of his Lord, Aḥmad ibn Aḥmad al-Muṭarrifī. May God treat all with His hidden kindness.

مِلْكٌ لِعَبْدِ رَبِّهِ أَحْمَدَ بْنِ أَحْمَدَ الْمُطَرِّفِيِّ عَامَلَ اللَّهُ الْجَمِيعَ بِلُطْفِهِ الْخَفِيِّ.

Editorial notes

N123 [textual] These are a copyist’s colophon and an ownership note, not words attributed to Ibn Rushd. Their date is 606 AH, distinct from the author’s 552 AH date in §258. The owner’s unvocalized surname is printed المطرفي; its vocalization in English is provisional.

Twenty-eight comparative cases in the Bidāya

The connections are selected editorial illustrations, not an exhaustive mapping or a claim that Ibn Rushd explicitly paired each passage.

B01 · Marriage: one form of act, different legal rulings

Marriage · ch. 1, preliminaries, issue 1: the legal status of marriage

The majority recommend marriage; the Ẓāhirīs require it; later Mālikīs distinguish obligatory, recommended and permitted marriage according to the person's circumstances. Ibn Rushd identifies both the interpretation of imperative expressions and an appeal to welfare as causes of the disagreement. This illustrates the distinction between an act's general description and the ruling applicable to a situated agent. It does not prove that an imperative by itself encodes all those contextual differences. The welfare argument reported here should also be compared with the stricter controls of Darūrī §§146 and 217.

Illustrative parallel

B02 · Wiping the head: a minimum performance and a contested particle

Purification from ritual impurity · Book of Wuḍū', ch. 2, issue 6: the extent of wiping the head

Mālik requires the whole head, al-Shāfiʿī allows part, and Abū Ḥanīfa specifies a quarter. Ibn Rushd relates the disagreement to the bā' in Q 5:6—whether emphatic or partitive—and to reports describing the Prophet's wiping. Even on the emphatic reading, the amount satisfying the name of the act remains disputed. This is a representative application of the Darūrī's minimum-sufficiency problem, but one in which grammar and transmitted practice jointly determine the legally adequate minimum.

Illustrative parallel

B03 · Proposing over another proposal: prohibition and contractual effect

Marriage · ch. 1, preliminaries, issue 3: proposing over another man's proposal

Jurists distinguish the prohibition of intervening in an existing proposal from the validity of the ensuing marriage. Ibn Rushd records invalidation by Dāwūd, validity according to al-Shāfiʿī and Abū Ḥanīfa, and differing Mālikī outcomes. The question is whether the forbidden preliminary act vitiates the contract or is an independently culpable circumstance. Read this alongside the Darūrī's distinctions of aspect and the later question whether prohibition entails invalidity; the note identifies a legal parallel, not an explicit cross-citation between the books.

Illustrative parallel

B04 · Zakāt on a child's property: worship or a claim upon wealth?

Zakāt · first division: those liable; property belonging to minors

Mālik, al-Shāfiʿī and others impose zakāt on a minor's property; other views exempt it or distinguish agricultural produce. Ibn Rushd identifies the underlying question: is zakāt principally worship requiring adult responsibility, or a financial right of the poor in wealth? The latter need not depend on the owner's puberty. This demonstrates why exemption from direct moral obligation does not automatically remove every legal consequence affecting a child's property.

Illustrative parallel

B05 · Intention in ablution: devotional act and intelligible cleansing

Purification from ritual impurity · Book of Wuḍūʾ, ch. 2, issue 1: intention as a condition of validity

Mālik, al-Shāfiʿī and others require intention; Abū Ḥanīfa and al-Thawrī do not. Ibn Rushd locates ablution between pure devotion and an act whose cleansing purpose is intelligible. The relevant inquiry is which resemblance governs its legal classification. Read beside Darūrī §43, this shows that intending obedience and performing an objectively effective act are distinguishable questions, and that a condition of worship cannot simply be transferred to every act associated with worship.

Illustrative parallel

B06 · Coerced divorce: voluntary utterance is not sufficient freedom

Divorce · second division, ch. 2: the person whose divorce is legally effective; coerced divorce

Abū Ḥanīfa treats the coerced utterance as effective, whereas Mālik, al-Shāfiʿī and others do not. Ibn Rushd locates the dispute in the sense of choice: the speaker chooses the words, but the threat may still make him “coerced” in the Law’s usage. He invokes Q 16:106 against identifying every chosen utterance with unqualified freedom. This sharpens Darūrī §47: physical possibility, intention, legal coercion and the effect of an act must be distinguished.

Illustrative parallel

B07 · Financial maturity: an operative condition or its official recognition?

Interdiction · ch. 2: release of minors from interdiction; those under an executor

Some Mālikī positions continue to invalidate transactions until an executor or judge formally releases the ward. Ibn al-Qāsim gives decisive weight to actual maturity or improvidence. Ibn Rushd criticizes treating the continued formal status as controlling when maturity is established: the operative consideration is maturity, not the judge’s declaration. This provides an institutional illustration of the difference between a condition’s existence and a procedure which establishes or announces it, without reducing all judicial acts to mere factual reports.

Illustrative parallel

B08 · A remoter guardian: invalidity, permission, or ratification

Marriage · ch. 2; conditions of contract; guardians, third topic, issue 1: a remoter guardian contracts while the nearer is present

For the cases under discussion, Mālik’s transmitted positions include invalidity, validity and dependence on the nearer guardian’s approval. Ibn Rushd explains the alternatives through three questions: is priority a rule of revelation at all; if so, is it the nearer guardian’s right; or is it a right of God? These yield, respectively, validity, a ratifiable contract, or invalidity. The ruling is not produced simply by attaching the word “condition” to priority. The discussion excludes certain father–virgin-daughter and executor cases from that threefold variation.

Illustrative parallel

B09 · A traveller who fasts: an implied condition in the verse

Fasting · ch. on those permitted to break the fast; the traveller's performance of the fast

A minority requires the travelling person to make up the days even if he fasts; the majority accepts his fast. Ibn Rushd connects the disagreement to whether Q 2:184 implicitly says "and breaks the fast" before requiring other days, alongside reports allowing travelling Companions to fast or refrain. This illustrates both the classification of a concession and the interpretation of an omitted condition. It must not be read as though the mere grammatical form settled the whole dispute.

Illustrative parallel

B10 · The basmala: Qurʾānic wording and membership in a sūra

Prayer · third division, verbal constituents, issue 4: reciting the basmala

The practical disagreement concerns reciting the basmala and whether aloud or silently. Ibn Rushd separates uncertainty about its status as a verse of al-Fātiḥa from denying that the wording is Qurʾānic at all. He also analyses conflicting reports of the Companions' practice. This parallels Darūrī §64, while warning against an over-simple appeal to mass transmission: the identity of transmitted words and their structural membership in a particular sūra are distinct propositions.

Illustrative parallel

B11 · An absent father: welfare within a structured legal situation

Marriage · ch. 2; guardians, third topic, issue 3: the father's absence

The Mālikī distinctions turn on distance, knowledge of the father's whereabouts, maintenance, protection and the woman's need to marry. Ibn Rushd then suggests that urgent risk might justify the ruler's intervention even when the father is relatively near. This is a concrete use of welfare-oriented reasoning, not an unrestricted power to legislate. Its relation to the Darūrī's demand for an acknowledged warrant remains a question of interpretation: the later case develops an existing institution's purpose, but does not expressly cite that earlier restriction.

Comparison with a methodological tension

B12 · Touching women: equivocation, generality and counterevidence

Purification from ritual impurity · Book of Wuḍūʾ, ch. 4, issue on touching women

Ibn Rushd explains that touching in Arabic can mean contact by the hand or signify intercourse. Among those taking bodily contact, some require pleasure and others do not; reports about contact between the Prophet and ʿĀʾisha enter the assessment. The first disagreement concerns competing meanings, the second the scope of a selected meaning. This clarifies why the Darūrī distinguishes equivocation from generality: collecting two possible meanings is not the same operation as including all instances under one universal.

Illustrative parallel

B13 · Minimum dower: clarification cannot be postponed beyond need

Marriage · ch. 2; conditions of contract; dower, first topic, issue 2: its amount

In Sahl’s marriage report, the request for even an iron ring is taken against a fixed minimum. Ibn Rushd expressly argues that a required threshold would have needed explanation at that moment. He also disputes the premises that dower is purely worship and that worship must always be quantitatively fixed. This is a direct application of the rule against delaying clarification beyond need, rather than a merely suggestive similarity supplied by the present editor.

Express methodological discussion in the Bidāya

B14 · The sales-session option: what counts as “separation”?

Sales · part 3, conditions of validity, ch. 1: the contract and the parties’ option before separation

Mālik and Abū Ḥanīfa make the completed exchange binding without physical separation; al-Shāfiʿī and others retain the session option. Ibn Rushd examines whether the report concerns bodily separation or completion of bargaining. He weighs the strong Ibn ʿUmar report against Medinan practice, another report’s weakness, analogies to other contracts, and the general command to fulfil contracts. The case joins semantic interpretation to evidential preference: a plausible lexical reinterpretation is not enough unless proportionate evidence supports it.

Illustrative parallel

B15 · Guardianship: a disputed condition cannot be established by ambiguity alone

Marriage · ch. 2, conditions of validity; guardians, first topic: whether guardianship is a condition

In examining marriage guardianship, Ibn Rushd tests the scope of Qurʾānic expressions and the guardian-permission reports rather than treating every apparent address to guardians as a decisive condition of validity. He also considers whether such a widespread requirement could have remained insufficiently explained. The case exemplifies the evidential burden for a restrictive interpretation. It is especially pertinent to Darūrī §171, which rejects an excessively remote narrowing of the permission report; the Bidāya’s fuller argument must not be reduced to that single objection.

Illustrative parallel

B16 · Pilgrimage now or later: a control against a simplistic application

Pilgrimage · first kind of inquiry: when the pilgrimage obligation falls due

Ibn Rushd explicitly denies that the dispute is merely whether an unrestricted command demands immediacy. The competing arguments compare the first available pilgrimage season with the beginning or end of prayer-time, consider the interval when pilgrimage cannot be performed, and assess the risk of death before another year. This is a useful counterexample to a mechanical concordance: Darūrī §201 supplies distinctions, but the Bidāya warns that the applied dispute has additional temporal structure.

Explicit caution against a reductive parallel

B17 · Completing ʿumra does not by itself prove an initial duty to begin it

Pilgrimage · first kind of inquiry: the legal status of ʿumra

One argument for obligation invokes Q 2:196's command to complete pilgrimage and ʿumra. The opposing reading takes completion to govern an observance once begun, whether its initiation was obligatory or voluntary. Ibn Rushd also records conflicting reports. The lesson is the distinct scope of commands: an obligation to complete an undertaking need not establish an obligation to undertake it. Compare the Darūrī's insistence that a further performance needs its own warrant, rather than extending a command beyond its demonstrated conditions.

Illustrative parallel

B18 · Menstrual divorce: a forbidden act may still have legal effect

Divorce · first division, ch. 2: Sunnī and irregular divorce; divorce during menstruation

The majority count a divorce pronounced during menstruation, while another position does not. Ibn Rushd distinguishes conditions of validity from conditions of proper or complete performance and examines the command that Ibn ʿUmar take his wife back. This provides an especially clear application of the Darūrī's question about prohibition and invalidity. Whether an act is forbidden and whether it produces a legal consequence are different inquiries; their relation must be demonstrated from the relevant address and reports.

Illustrative parallel

B19 · Foetal compensation: the identity of the right-holder matters

Offences and injuries · second part, compensation; accidental loss of a foetus, question "to whom is it due?"

Mālik, al-Shāfiʿī and Abū Ḥanīfa treat the compensation as inheritable by the foetus's heirs. Rabīʿa and al-Layth assign it to the mother, comparing the foetus with one of her bodily parts. The dispute illustrates that identifying the legal subject precedes assigning a consequence. It is related to Darūrī §211's caution about the original and derivative terms of an analogy, not a textual claim that the two passages explicitly cross-reference each other.

Illustrative parallel

B20 · Jewellery: resemblance to usable possessions or to monetary wealth?

Zakāt · second division: assets subject to zakāt; gold and silver jewellery

The Ḥijāzī jurists exempt jewellery intended for adornment; Abū Ḥanīfa includes it. Ibn Rushd attributes the disagreement chiefly to its double resemblance: usable possessions on one side, gold and silver serving exchange on the other. Conflicting reports matter, but he regards them as weak, especially the exemption report. This is a particularly accessible example of competing analogical descriptions; disagreement about the case's legally relevant likeness need not amount to disagreement about the underlying commodity itself.

Illustrative parallel

B21 · Deathbed divorce: blocking an evasion without erasing doctrinal difficulty

Divorce · second division, ch. 2: irrevocable divorce during fatal illness

Some jurists preserve the divorced woman's inheritance because the husband may be evading her entitlement; others apply divorce's ordinary consequences. Ibn Rushd expressly identifies blocking the means (sadd al-dharā'iʿ) as the issue, but also questions a hybrid status retaining only selected effects of marriage. He rejects a claim of Companion consensus because Ibn al-Zubayr's disagreement is known. Thus purposive prevention and proof of consensus require distinct warrants; the case is not evidence that every welfare argument is self-validating. The Darūrī itself cites this case in §217 while rejecting excessively remote welfare arguments; the difference of framing is therefore substantive.

Express methodological discussion in the Bidāya

B22 · Ribā in foodstuffs: competing identifications of the operative feature

Sales · part 2, causes of invalidity; ribā in the named foodstuffs and their analogues

Mālikī analysis emphasizes staple, storable food; al-Shāfiʿī emphasizes edibility; Ḥanafī reasoning emphasizes weight or measure. Ibn Rushd treats the dispute as identifying the meaning behind the named commodities, while also evaluating the rival rationales. This corresponds closely to the Darūrī's account of resemblance and uncertain grounds. Yet the Bidāya's comparative assessment is more developed than a blanket dismissal: no uniform verdict on all "analogy" should be imported from either book into the other.

Close parallel, with differences of assessment

B23 · Dower and the theft threshold: verbal resemblance is not one legal meaning

Marriage · ch. 2; dower, first topic, issue 2: critique of the minimum-dower analogy

The proposed analogy sets the minimum dower by the monetary threshold for theft. Ibn Rushd objects that the shared description of bodily "authorization" masks different meanings: punishment and injury differ from lawful marital enjoyment and affection. The relevant similarity must be one in meaning, not merely words, and must ground the original ruling. He distinguishes using this weak analogy to select an amount from establishing that a minimum exists at all.

Express criticism of a defective analogy

B24 · Triple divorce after mutual imprecation: the limits of tacit approval

Divorce · first division, ch. 2: whether three divorces may be pronounced together; the report of ʿUwaymir

One argument relies on the Prophet's not objecting when ʿUwaymir pronounced three divorces after mutual imprecation (liʿān). The counterargument is that liʿān had already severed the marriage: the utterance then effected no further divorce. Silence cannot establish permissibility for an act whose legally relevant object was absent. This is a precise application of Darūrī §227's contextual restriction: approval must concern the very act and circumstances for which authority is being claimed.

Illustrative parallel

B25 · A mistaken qibla: required success or adequately conducted inquiry?

Prayer · second division, conditions; facing the qibla, second issue

Al-Shāfiʿī requires repetition when an error in direction becomes known; Mālik and Abū Ḥanīfa do not impose the same unconditional repetition after due inquiry. Ibn Rushd identifies disagreement about whether correct orientation or the act of inquiry is required, and weighs a report against analogy with prayer before its time. The case illuminates Darūrī §§237–245 without proving that every mujtahid's conclusion is true: excusing an error and making its conclusion correct remain different claims.

Illustrative parallel

B26 · A physician's mistake: compensation need not imply moral wrongdoing

Offences and injuries · second part, compensation; accidental injury caused in medical treatment

Ibn Rushd reports compensation for a treatment error, while also recording a Mālikī exemption for a qualified practitioner and agreement on liability for an unqualified intruder. The analogy is with accidental injury; there is further disagreement about which fund bears payment. This is an illustrative legal parallel to the Darūrī's distinction between error and sin. It does not assimilate medical judgement to every form of juristic inquiry, nor does compensation alone establish culpability.

Illustrative parallel

B27 · Cupping while fasting: three ways of treating conflicting reports

Fasting · ch. on acts from which the fasting person abstains; cupping

A report invalidating the fast of cupper and cupped is set beside the report that the Prophet was cupped while fasting. Ibn Rushd describes disagreement over prohibition, dislike and permissibility, and examines preference, reconciliation and relinquishing the conflicting proofs. This makes concrete the Darūrī's alternatives when evidence appears equipollent. Returning to an original rule is itself a reasoned response to evidential failure; it is not the same as choosing whichever report one happens to prefer.

Illustrative parallel

B28 · Deferred animal barter: conflict can concern scope as well as authenticity

Sales · part 2, ribā; exchanging animals with deferred delivery

Reports allowing an animal to be exchanged for more animals with later delivery stand against a prohibition of deferred animal-for-animal exchange. Ibn Rushd records different evaluations and reconciliations, including Mālikī attention to whether the animals have distinct uses. The disagreement is not only over which chain is stronger: a proposed distinction of legal purposes may reconcile reports which otherwise conflict. This illustrates why Darūrī §§256–257 insist on a stronger judgement rather than an exhaustive mechanical list of preference rules.

Illustrative parallel

Glossary: 153 principal headwords

Contextual working definitions; dictionary attestations in the separate web dictionary are selectively source-checked, not every entry is from a historical authority.

adāʾ · أَدَاء — Timely performance: discharging an act within its legally appointed time; distinguish repetition and make-up performance. R §§57, 59

ʿadāla · عَدَالَة — Probity: a disposition supporting a transmitter's reliability, not a claim that every lapse destroys credibility. R §§86, 87, 90, 98

ʿāmm · عَامّ — General expression: wording embracing the instances of a meaning. Do not confuse this linguistic scope with several equivocal meanings. R §§169, 170, 174, 177

ʿaql · عَقْل — Intellect or reason; its relation to goodness, obligation and revealed authority is discussed without making theology the whole of uṣūl. R §§11, 13, 37, 45

ʿazīma / ʿazm · عَزِيمَة / عَزْم — Original legal requirement, contrasted with a concession. The text uses the vocabulary of the unrelaxed requirement in defining the contrast. R §§60

aṣl · أَصْل — Foundation, source, original case, or governing principle. In qiyās it is the case or meaning from which extension proceeds. R §§62, 141, 210, 212

bāṭil / buṭlān · بَاطِل / بُطْلَان — Invalid / invalidity. In contracts, absence of the intended legal effect; invalidity is not interchangeable with moral prohibition. R §§28, 56, 206

bayān · بَيَان — Clarification: whatever validly brings a meaning to understanding, including wording, context and explanatory action. R §§159, 160, 161, 228

barāʾa aṣliyya · بَرَاءَة أَصْلِيَّة — Original freedom from liability: obligation requires a warrant; absence of such a warrant is not itself a newly revealed duty. R §§141, 142, 247

burhān · بُرْهَان — Demonstration or conclusive proof. Its logical analysis belongs to a different discipline from the present abridgement's immediate task. R §§9, 15, 75

ḍamīr · ضَمِير — Pronoun: an expression whose referent can be determinate or ambiguous; reference is one component of verbal indication. R §§152, 157, 158

ḍarūrī · ضَرُورِيّ — Necessary; in knowledge, immediately or inevitably known rather than acquired through a consciously constructed argument. In the title, what is indispensable to the craft. R §§1, 2, 15, 76

ḍarūra · ضَرُورَة — Necessity or constraint. In practical law it can ground a concession; this is distinct from the epistemic sense of necessary knowledge. R §§53, 60

ḍidd · ضِدّ — Contrary: opposed acts or qualities. Whether alternatives exhaust the possibilities is crucial to the argument about commands and prohibitions. R §§26, 32, 33, 34, 52

dalāla · دَلَالَة — Indication or signification: the relation by which words, understood meanings, acts or approval make a ruling intelligible. R §§148, 149, 150, 193

dalīl · دَلِيل — Evidence, indicator or proof. Its strength may be conclusive or probable; "proof" does not always mean logical demonstration. R §§62, 74, 81, 241

dalīl al-khiṭāb · دَلِيل الْخِطَاب — Contrary implication inferred from a restriction, condition or qualification. Its force depends on context, not form alone. R §§193, 195

farʿ · فَرْع — Derivative case or branch of law; in qiyās, the case whose ruling is sought through a relation to the original. R §§2, 210, 211

farḍ · فَرْض — Obligatory requirement. The discussion records a distinction from wājib made by some jurists and its evidential basis. R §§17

fasād · فَسَاد — Corruption or invalidity; in legal use, failure of an act or contract in the respect relevant to its ruling. R §§28, 29, 56, 206

fiqh · فِقْه — Understanding of practical legal rulings. Detailed branch-law learning is related to, but not identical with, the requirements of independent inquiry. R §§2, 235, 252

fiʿl · فِعْل — Act: voluntary human performance or Prophetic action. An act has no imperative grammatical form of its own. R §§43, 150, 228, 229

furūʿ · فُرُوع — Branches or derivative rulings, distinguished from sources and the general method for understanding their indications. R §§2, 235, 252

ghāya · غَايَة — End or limit. In a temporal expression such as “until night,” it means an endpoint, not a purposive final cause. R §§2, 195

ghalabat al-ẓann · غَلَبَة الظَّنّ — Preponderant judgement: the balance of probable evidence which guides action; it does not create truth merely through preference. R §§90, 237, 241, 257

ḥadd · حَدّ — Definition or boundary. In another context, a prescribed penalty; these senses must not be collapsed into one English rendering. R §§10, 11, 219

ḥadīth · حَدِيث — A transmitted report, especially one attributed to the Prophet. The discussion distinguishes its wording, content, chain and resulting degree of assent. R §§66, 80, 109, 233

ḥākim · حَاكِم — One who determines or commands; in the account of legal judgement, ultimately God, with derivative human authority distinguished. R §§36, 37

ḥaqīqa · حَقِيقَة — Proper or literal usage, opposed to transferred or figurative usage; context determines which sense is established. R §§65, 153, 162, 164

ḥarām · حَرَام — Forbidden: subject to legal prohibition. Whether a forbidden act is also invalid is a further issue. R §§17, 28, 206

ḥaraj · حَرَج — Restriction, difficulty or legal impediment; removing a prohibition need not itself issue a positive recommendation. R §§60, 203

ḥaṣr · حَصْر — Restriction or exclusive limitation, conveyed by expressions such as innamā; its contrary implication is assessed contextually. R §§195

ḥiss · حِسّ — Sense perception. Actual sensory apprehension, not mere perceptibility, matters in the account of transmitted certainty. R §§15, 45, 77, 78

ḥujja · حُجَّة — Authoritative evidence or argument capable of supporting a legal conclusion; its authority and degree of certainty are separate questions. R §§1, 81, 130, 144

ḥukm · حُكْم — Judgement or ruling: the legal determination concerning an act, with its author, addressee and object analysed separately. R §§10, 11, 17, 36, 239

ḥusn / qubḥ · حُسْن / قُبْح — Goodness / badness: evaluative terms whose intrinsic, relational and revealed senses are distinguished at the beginning of the book. R §§11, 12, 13

ʿibāda · عِبَادَة — Worship or devotional observance. Its valid performance, intention and timing are analysed without identifying all legal consequences with worship. R §§43, 56, 57

ibdāl / tabdīl · إِبْدَال / تَبْدِيل — Substitution: expression of a universal through a particular or vice versa, central to Ibn Rushd’s account of semantic extension. R §§154, 165, 191, 212, 221

ibāḥa · إِبَاحَة — Permission: a legal allowing of alternatives, distinguished from obligation and from mere absence of an established prohibition. R §§16, 17, 27, 203

idhn · إِذْن — Permission or authorization; its context matters in reports about guardianship and in a teacher’s authorization to transmit. R §§103, 171

ijāza · إِجَازَة — Authorization to transmit, distinguished from hearing a reading, reading before the teacher, and receiving a written text. R §§100, 103, 104

ijmāʿ · إِجْمَاع — Consensus: agreement of those competent in the relevant inquiry. Mere majority, silence and unidentified Medinan practice are not equivalent to it. R §§130, 133, 134, 137, 138

ijzāʾ · إِجْزَاء — Sufficiency or discharge: performance which fulfils the legally required act, including its relevant conditions. R §§23, 56, 204, 205

ijtihād · اجْتِهَاد — Independent juristic inquiry: exertion of competent judgement concerning a ruling not already determined by conclusive evidence. R §§231, 236, 237, 250

ʿillа · عِلَّة — Effective ground or explanatory feature connecting a ruling with a case. It must be distinguished from a general benefit or an accidental concomitant. R §§210, 213, 217, 218, 222

ʿilm · عِلْم — Knowledge, sometimes certain cognition and sometimes a discipline. Its theoretical, practical and instrumental ends are distinguished. R §§2, 8, 74, 75

imkān · إِمْكَان — Possibility: physical capacity to perform an act is not the same as the presence of every legal condition governing it. R §§45, 49, 50

iqrār · إِقْرَار — Tacit approval: the Prophet's non-objection in relevant circumstances, indicating permissibility rather than automatically establishing obligation. R §§150, 227

irāda · إِرَادَة — Will or volition. Its relation to desire, assent and intending obedience is discussed in the account of voluntary action. R §§43, 44

ishtirāk · اشْتِرَاك — Equivocation: one expression's established use for distinct meanings, not the inclusion of many instances within a single general meaning. R §§158, 177

istidlāl · اسْتِدْلَال — Inference or reasoning from an indication to what it establishes. It need not be a formal syllogism. R §§1, 2, 81, 148

istiḥsān · اسْتِحْسَان — Juristic preference. A judgement so named needs a recognized evidential warrant; its name does not confer authority. R §§146

istiʿāra · اسْتِعَارَة — Transfer or metaphorical borrowing of an expression, one way words can signify beyond their original assignment. R §§153, 164, 180

istiṣḥāb · اسْتِصْحَاب — Presumption of continuity: retaining an established judgement, subject to whether the relevant case or attribute has changed. R §§141, 142

istiṣlāḥ · اسْتِصْلَاح — Welfare-oriented reasoning. The Darūrī asks what makes a proposed benefit legally authoritative rather than merely attractive. R §§146, 217

istiqrāʾ · اسْتِقْرَاء — Induction: discerning a pattern from cases, including the recovery of early jurists' implicit methods from their decisions. R §§4, 217

istithnāʾ · اسْتِثْنَاء — Exception: exclusion related to a statement's scope, with distinct problems of connection, reach and the genus excepted. R §§183, 184, 185, 186, 187, 188

jarḥ · جَرْح — Criticism of a narrator's credibility or probity; the grounds and relative force of such criticism require assessment. R §§94, 95, 96

jins · جِنْس — Genus or kind: a grouping by an intelligible common feature, important in classification and in recognized suitable grounds. R §§185, 217, 224

juzʾī · جُزْئِيّ — Particular: an individual case or more restricted meaning relative to a universal. It is not simply a grammatical "specific expression." R §§2, 165, 191, 212

kalām · كَلَام — Speech; also rational theology. Which sense applies depends on the argument, and the latter is not the whole subject of uṣūl. R §§9, 41, 63, 235

karāha · كَرَاهَة — Dislike or disapproval, sometimes distinguished from strict prohibition; the required contextual indication must be examined. R §§17, 29, 208

kasb / iktisāb · كَسْب / اكْتِسَاب — Acquisition: the disputed account of human agency, choice and voluntary action. The reported theological positions are not all Ibn Rushd's own. R §§43, 44, 45

khabar · خَبَر — Report: a communicated assertion assessed through its source, wording and evidential consequences. R §§66, 74, 80, 109

khabar al-wāḥid · خَبَر الْوَاحِد — Solitary report: a report not attaining the certainty of mass transmission; "solitary" does not necessarily mean only one transmitter at every stage. R §§79, 81, 83, 112

khāṣṣ · خَاصّ — Specific expression: wording directly designating a restricted subject, which may nevertheless indicate an intended universal through context. R §§165, 191

khaṭa' · خَطَأ — Error: failure to attain the true ruling or perform correctly. It can be pardoned without becoming correctness. R §§237, 243, 244, 245

khiṭāb · خِطَاب — Address or discourse: the Lawgiver's communication as directed to an addressee concerning an act; context is constitutive of understanding. R §§11, 36, 38, 239

kināya · كِنَايَة — Indirect expression: signifying by an associated meaning rather than simply naming the referent directly. R §§164, 167

kullī · كُلِّيّ — Universal: a meaning under which particulars fall, crucial to understanding legal extension beyond a named example. R §§2, 165, 191, 212, 221

lafẓ · لَفْظ — Expression or wording; its verbal form is distinguished from the meaning indicated in the whole discourse. R §§109, 148, 149, 153

mafhūm · مَفْهُوم — Understood import: the meaning apprehended through an expression and its context, including but not limited to contrary implication. R §§149, 193, 194, 195

maḥkūm fīhi · مَحْكُوم فِيهِ — The act or matter about which a legal judgement is made; distinguish the person addressed by it. R §§36, 43

maḥkūm 'alayhi · مَحْكُوم عَلَيْهِ — The person to whom the ruling applies; understanding, capacity and other conditions affect the nature of the address. R §§36, 38, 42

majāz · مَجَاز — Figurative or transferred usage. It includes omission, addition and substitution, not merely literary metaphor. R §§65, 153, 154, 162, 164

makrūh · مَكْرُوه — Disapproved or disliked, one of the fivefold legal classifications; use in context can require distinction from outright forbiddance. R §§17, 208

ma'lūl · مَعْلُول — That explained or grounded by an 'illa; correspondence with a feature does not by itself establish explanatory dependence. R §§210, 220, 222

ma'nā · مَعْنَى — Meaning, intelligible content or relevant feature. Translating it uniformly as "cause" would conceal important distinctions. R §§149, 158, 193, 212

mandūb · مَنْدُوب — Recommended: an act commended without being obligatorily demanded. Its contrary does not acquire a ruling by a purely verbal inversion. R §§17, 32, 208

manṭūq · مَنْطُوق — What is explicitly expressed, contrasted with the unmentioned case or the meaning understood beyond verbal form. R §§149, 191, 210, 212

maqṣūd · مَقْصُود — What is intended: the intelligible aim of the address, recovered through indications rather than supplied by arbitrary preference. R §§161, 191, 217, 239

ma'qūl · مَعْقُول — Intelligible meaning or object of understanding. In legal interpretation it contrasts with reliance upon verbal form alone. R §§149, 193, 212

maṣlaḥa · مَصْلَحَة — Benefit or welfare. Its legal authority depends on its relation to recognized purposes or evidence, not on attractiveness alone. R §§146, 217

mashhūrāt · مَشْهُورَات — Widely accepted propositions; general acceptance alone does not establish rational necessity or demonstrative truth. R §§12

mithāl · مِثَال — Example or illustrative case; its relation to a universal meaning must be distinguished from a merely verbal likeness. R §§1, 6, 212

mu'awwal · مُؤَوَّل — Interpreted wording: an expression taken in a less immediately apparent sense because an adequate indication supports that reading. R §§151, 164, 166

mubāḥ · مُبَاح — Permitted: not demanded or forbidden in the respect being considered. Its status as "commanded" is itself disputed. R §§16, 17, 27

mudrak · مُدْرَك — Source or means of apprehension: where or how a judgement is known. The lexical vocalization has an initial ḍamma. R §§13, 47

mujmal · مُجْمَل — Indeterminate wording or indication, insufficient by itself to select the required meaning; clarification can come through several kinds of evidence. R §§151, 155, 158, 214, 218

mujtahid · مُجْتَهِد — One qualified to undertake independent juristic inquiry; competence may concern a determinate question rather than every branch of law. R §§231, 232, 233, 234, 236

mukallaf · مُكَلَّف — A person subject to legal responsibility; physical action, comprehension and the relevant legal conditions must be distinguished. R §§38, 42, 45, 50

mukhayyil · مُخَيِّل — A ground presenting a plausible rationale for a ruling, often considered with suitability. Not “imaginal” in the metaphysical sense. R §§217, 224

mulāʾim · مُلَائِم — Congruent or fitting: a proposed ground related to a kind of consideration which revelation has recognized. R §§217, 224

munāsib · مُنَاسِب — Suitable: a proposed ground connected intelligibly with a legally recognized benefit or prevention of harm. R §§217, 224

munāwala · مُنَاوَلَة — Handing over a written text with authorization to transmit; distinct from direct hearing and a bare written attribution. R §§104, 105

muqaddima · مُقَدِّمَة — Premise, or an introductory discussion. Premises can contribute to assent without being consciously arranged as a syllogism. R §§9, 75, 76

muqayyad · مُقَيَّد — Qualified: wording limited by a condition or attribute. Moving a qualification between contexts requires a warrant. R §§189, 195

mursal · مُرْسَل — A report whose chain leaves an intermediary unmentioned; acceptance is discussed separately from connected transmission. R §§111

musnad · مُسْنَد — A report with an articulated connected attribution; its comparative force still depends on the relevant transmitters and circumstances. R §§111

mutawātir · مُتَوَاتِر — Mass-transmitted: a mode of communication yielding certainty through the circumstances of its transmission, not a universally fixed count. R §§75, 76, 78

muṭlaq · مُطْلَق — Unqualified: wording without a stated restriction in the relevant respect. Unqualified and general are not simply interchangeable categories. R §§189, 201, 203

nadb · نَدْب — Recommendation, distinct from obligation; its establishment depends on the relevant usage and indication. R §§17, 200, 208

nahy · نَهْي — Prohibition or prohibitive address. Its force, contextual restriction and possible effect on validity need separate analysis. R §§28, 197, 206, 208

naql · نَقْل — Transmission; also a word’s transfer from one usage to another. Context distinguishes the two technical senses. R §§66, 153, 256

naṣṣ · نَصّ — Unambiguous indication: a determinate meaning, not simply any “text.” The book admits unambiguity through understood import as well as wording. R §§151, 157, 193, 215

naskh · نَسْخ — Abrogation: termination of an earlier legal ruling by later revelation; not identical with specification or additional explanation. R §§114, 115, 118, 126, 181

naẓar · نَظَر — Inquiry or reflective consideration, including the disciplined examination of evidence; more specific than casual “looking.” R §§1, 13, 45, 148

niyya · نِيَّة — Intention: aiming at obedience or distinguishing a particular performance; not every legal effect depends on such an intention. R §§22, 43, 47

qaḍāʾ · قَضَاء — Make-up performance outside the appointed time; also judgement in other contexts. Whether it needs a distinct command is a central question. R §§51, 57, 204

qaṭʿī · قَطْعِيّ — Conclusive: an indication or judgement not merely probable. Degrees of evidential clarity remain important for culpability. R §§74, 125, 237, 244

qarīna · قَرِينَة — Contextual indication: verbal or circumstantial evidence that guides meaning, interpretation or an extension beyond the named case. R §§161, 166, 193, 213

qiyās · قِيَاس — Analogy or syllogistic inference, depending on context. Much juristic qiyās is analysed here as substitution within an understood meaning rather than a syllogism. R §§210, 212, 223, 226

qiyās al-shabah · قِيَاس الشَّبَه — Analogy of resemblance: extending a ruling because a likeness is thought to contain a shared ground, without identifying that ground securely. R §§218, 224

qurʾ · قُرْء — An equivocal legal expression for a menstrual period or a period of purity, used as an example of indeterminate wording. R §§158

rāwī · رَاوٍ — Narrator or transmitter. Reception, retention, probity, attribution and denial are separate aspects of assessment. R §§83, 85, 94, 107

rukhṣa · رُخْصَة — Concession: a legally warranted relaxation under an impediment or need; not mere indulgence outside the Law. R §§58, 60

sabab · سَبَب — Cause, occasion or sign. A legal cause may manifest a ruling without producing it as a physical cause produces an effect. R §§54, 55, 176

sabr wa-taqsīm · سَبْر وَتَقْسِيم — Testing and division: enumerating and examining candidates for a relevant ground, then eliminating those not warranted. R §§220, 221

ṣaḥīḥ / ṣiḥḥa · صَحِيح / صِحَّة — Valid / validity; also soundness of a report in transmission. The intended legal or hadith sense must be specified. R §§56, 93, 205

ṣalāḥ · صَلَاح — Welfare, right ordering or fitness; its appearance in a proposed rationale must be disciplined by the Law's recognition. R §§19, 146, 217

ṣīgha · صِيغَة — Verbal form: grammatical or conventional expression as distinct from the meaning understood in context. R §§149, 151, 197, 223

ṣināʿa · صِنَاعَة — Craft or disciplined art: an organized competence governed by methods and standards, not modern industrial production. R §§1, 2, 6, 9

sharʿ · شَرْع — Revealed Law or revelation as normative authority; distinguish its address from the jurist's reconstruction of a ruling. R §§11, 13, 37, 239

sharṭ · شَرْط — Condition: a qualification for a legal ruling or valid performance; not every legal condition is a condition of physical possibility. R §§23, 49, 50, 56, 195

shubha · شُبْهَة — Ground of uncertainty or apparent likeness. Its exact force varies between evidential doubt and a proposed analogy. R §§92, 218, 238

sibār · سِبَار — Probe or testing instrument: the opening image for a discipline that guides the mind. It is not the name of a separate metaphysical science. R §§2

sunna · سُنَّة — Prophetic normative teaching and practice; "it is Sunna" as a transmission formula must be assessed for its source and scope. R §§66, 71, 114

taʿāruḍ · تَعَارُض — Conflict of evidence: an apparent opposition requiring assessment of reconciliation, chronology, preference or suspension. R §§96, 181, 229, 246

taʿdīl · تَعْدِيل — Attestation of probity, distinct from criticism and from an automatic guarantee of every report. R §§94, 95, 96, 97

taklīf · تَكْلِيف — Legal responsibility or imposition of a duty, directed to an agent under conditions of comprehension and capacity. R §§17, 38, 42, 45

takhṣīṣ · تَخْصِيص — Specification: restricting a general expression's scope on adequate evidence; chronology helps distinguish it from abrogation. R §§174, 181, 182, 190

tamthīl · تَمْثِيل — Exemplification or reasoning by a comparable particular; do not assume that every legal extension has this structure. R §§1, 210, 212, 223

tanbīh · تَنْبِيه — Indication or directing attention to an unstated meaning, often through the relation between a named particular and an intended universal. R §§191, 209, 212, 215

taqlīd · تَقْلِيد — Following another's authority. Trustworthy expert reliance is distinguished from treating memorized school opinions as independent evidence. R §§249, 250, 251, 252, 255

tarjīḥ · تَرْجِيح — Giving greater weight: preferring the stronger evidence or judgement on a relevant ground, not free personal choice. R §§96, 246, 256, 257

taṣdīq · تَصْدِيق — Assent to an assertion. Its cause, necessity and degree are discussed especially in the analysis of mass transmission. R §§15, 44, 74, 75, 76

taṣwīb · تَصْوِيب — Declaring juristic conclusions correct; the debate asks whether every qualified conclusion is true or whether one determinate ruling is sought. R §§237, 239, 240, 243

ta'thīm · تَأْثِيم — Attribution of sin. Its absence does not entail the absence of error; knowledge and the accessibility of evidence matter. R §§242, 243, 244, 245

ta'wīl · تَأْوِيل — Interpretation supported by evidence, especially departure from an expression's apparent meaning to a less evident one. R §§164, 166, 171

tawaqquf · تَوَقُّف — Suspension of judgement when the evidence does not justify a determinate conclusion; distinct from arbitrary choice. R §§229, 246

tawātur · تَوَاتُر — Mass transmission producing certainty, whose conditions are contextual and not captured by a single numerical threshold. R §§74, 75, 76, 78

tawqīf · تَوْقِيف — Dependence on revealed instruction; in §229 the printed term is understood contextually as withholding judgement. Note the distinct usages. R §§49, 229

ʿumūm · عُمُوم — Generality: inclusion of the instances falling within a meaning. Its force differs across forms and contexts. R §§169, 170, 174, 178

ʿumūm al-balwā · عُمُوم الْبَلْوَى — Widespread practical need: a consideration in assessing whether a solitary report plausibly preserves a generally required observance. R §§112, 113

ʿurf · عُرْف — Established usage or convention, linguistic or legal; a command's force must be learned in its relevant convention. R §§153, 199, 200, 203

uṣūl al-fiqh · أُصُول الْفِقْه — Principles of jurisprudence: in this abridgement, above all the disciplined understanding of revealed indications and the means of reaching rulings. R §§1, 2, 5, 6, 148

wājib · وَاجِب — Obligatory: legally demanded. Alternative duties, extended times, necessary means and culpability prevent a merely schematic definition from doing all the work. R §§17, 18, 21, 23, 243

waḍʿ · وَضْع — Assignment or institution of a word's meaning; distinguish original linguistic assignment from subsequent transfer and specialized legal usage. R §§153, 199

yaqīn · يَقِين — Certainty: assent not merely outweighed probability. Its sources and possible degrees are discussed without reducing it to a transmitter count. R §§74, 75, 78, 125

ẓāhir · ظَاهِر — Apparent or prima-facie indication: the meaning more readily warranted, though another remains possible. It can arise from understood import as well as verbal form. R §§164, 166, 193, 224

ẓann · ظَنّ — Probable judgement: an evidentially grounded but nonconclusive assent, not necessarily a pejorative "guess." R §§74, 79, 90, 237, 257

ziyāda · زِيَادَة — Addition: extra wording in a report, an added legal requirement, or linguistic surplus; these distinct contexts have different rules. R §§108, 118, 154

ṭaliba · طَلِبَة — Request or petition, one of the forms of complete discourse. This is the noun for a request, not the plural ṭalaba, "students." R §§152, 197

Concepts, categories and legal operations

302 main concept headings; sections and subtopics refer to the reader’s stable numbering, not Bou Akl’s numbering.

Authorship and method — 1, 7; — 3; — 5; — 6, 148; — 6; — 8; — 20; — 30; — 41; — 61; — 116; — 140; — 147

Craft (ṣināʿa) — 1; — 2

Inquiry (naẓar) — 1; — 13; — 14

Inference (istidlāl) — 1

Knowledge — 2; — 2; — 9; — 14; — 15; — 55; — 75; — 76; — 243

Universal and particular — 2; — 4; — 6; — 53; — 163; — 165; — 169; — 186; — 221

Indication (dalāla) — 2; — 131; — 148; — 152; — 156

Analogy — 2; — 6; — 11; — 82; — 95; — 112; — 209; — 210; — 210; — 212, 223; — 214; — 215; — 216; — 218; — 225

Atom — 2

Companions — 3, 4; — 62; — 68, 72; — 83; — 88; — 98; — 99; — 127; — 136; — 144; — 182; — 225; — 257

Transmission — 3; — 15; — 64; — 66, 74; — 70; — 75; — 75; — 75; — 77; — 80, 100; — 97; — 100; — 101; — 102; — 105

Language — 3; — 27; — 57; — 65; — 65; — 69; — 70; — 101; — 103; — 149; — 152; — 152; — 153; — 161; — 168

Induction (istiqrāʾ) — 4; — 70; — 161; — 163; — 200

Judgement (ḥukm) — 5; — 10; — 11; — 17; — 24; — 35; — 36; — 97; — 223

Sources of law — 5; — 6; — 62; — 114; — 143; — 146; — 231; — 252; — 254

Ijtihād — 5; — 11; — 47; — 53; — 64; — 90; — 99; — 108; — 110; — 230; — 231; — 236; — 237; — 245; — 248

Ẓāhirīs — 6; — 58; — 69; — 136; — 142; — 223; — 224; — 238; — 247

Ghazālī, Abū Ḥāmid al- — 7; — 9; — 30; — 39; — 63; — 81; — 140; — 179; — 203; — 229; — 240; — 242

Teaching and learning — 8; — 9

Logic — 9; — 12; — 26

Definitions — 10; — 211

Goodness and badness — 11; — 12; — 13

Muʿtazilites — 11, 12; — 16; — 19; — 211; — 238

Sunni theologians — 11

Relation — 11

Widely accepted propositions (mashhūrāt) — 12

Prophecy — 13

Rational knowledge — 13

Infinite regress — 14; — 44

Assent (taṣdīq) — 15; — 44; — 74; — 76; — 78; — 125; — 159

Miracle — 15

Obligation — 15; — 17; — 17; — 18; — 18, 21, 22; — 19; — 20; — 20; — 21; — 23, 33; — 23; — 25; — 242

Pre-revelation acts — 16

Permission (ibāḥa) — 16; — 17; — 26; — 27; — 227; — 246

Suspension of judgement — 16; — 187; — 246

Ḥanafīs — 17; — 28; — 56

Recommendation (nadb) — 17; — 27; — 86; — 201

Disapproval (karāha) — 17; — 208

Original nonliability (barāʾa) — 17; — 62; — 128; — 141; — 239

Choice (takhyīr) — 18; — 21; — 53

Divine knowledge — 19

Welfare (ṣalāḥ) — 19

Possibility — 19, 20

Intention — 22; — 31; — 43; — 47

Disagreement — 22

Capacity — 23; — 33; — 38; — 42; — 45; — 50; — 52; — 55

Purification — 23; — 49; — 176; — 23; — 43; — 158

Quantification — 23

Head-wiping — 23

Prayer — 23; — 31; — 118; — 141; — 194; — 228; — 64; — 237; — 64; — 237

Probability (ẓann) — 25; — 59; — 106; — 181; — 193; — 214; — 237; — 240; — 243; — 250; — 251; — 257

Pilgrimage — 25; — 204; — 205; — 228; — 201; — 204; — 201; — 204

Discretionary punishment (taʿzīr) — 25

Consensus (ijmāʿ) — 25; — 111; — 122; — 129; — 130; — 130; — 130; — 130; — 131; — 132; — 133; — 134; — 135; — 136; — 137

Abrogation (naskh) — 26; — 40; — 114; — 115; — 115; — 116; — 117; — 118; — 119; — 120; — 121; — 122; — 123; — 124; — 126

Contrariety — 26, 34; — 28; — 31; — 32; — 33; — 52

Legal responsibility (taklīf) — 27; — 36; — 43; — 46; — 50

Prohibition (nahy) — 28; — 29; — 31; — 34; — 56; — 206; — 207; — 208; — 28

Validity — 28; — 54; — 56; — 56; — 205

Divorce — 28; — 195; — 217; — 47; — 206; — 217; — 227; — 47; — 206; — 217; — 227

Shāfiʿī, al- — 28; — 64; — 91; — 124; — 125

Contextual indications (qarāʾin) — 29; — 68; — 75; — 77; — 79; — 84; — 90; — 102; — 108; — 123; — 137; — 144; — 150; — 153; — 155

Unqualified and qualified (muṭlaq, muqayyad) — 29; — 189; — 189

Textual difficulties — 29; — 39; — 44; — 71; — 89; — 143; — 145; — 160; — 192; — 224; — 229

Usurped land — 31; — 53

Commands (amr) — 32; — 41; — 49; — 69; — 82; — 152; — 196; — 197; — 198; — 198; — 198; — 199; — 200; — 200; — 201

Lawgiver (ḥākim) — 37; — 45

Authority — 37

Reward and punishment — 37; — 47; — 48

Theology (kalām) — 37; — 41, 63; — 115; — 235

Children — 38; — 38; — 84; — 84

Intoxication — 38; — 39; — 40

Certainty — 38; — 76; — 77; — 125; — 130; — 214

Qurʾān — 38, 40; — 49; — 63; — 64; — 64; — 65; — 65; — 121; — 125; — 145; — 182; — 232; — 239

Puberty — 42

Signs — 42

Acquisition (kasb) — 43; — 44; — 45

Will (irāda) — 44

Ashʿarī, al- — 45

Juwaynī, al- — 45

Causality — 45; — 55; — 164

Coercion (ikrāh) — 47

Harm — 47; — 53

Homicide — 47; — 53

Omission (tark) — 48

Fasting — 48; — 120; — 172; — 194; — 58; — 246; — 58; — 246

Branches of law (furūʿ) — 48

Conditions (shurūṭ) — 49; — 50; — 117

Unbelievers — 49; — 178; — 244

Interpretation (taʾwīl) — 49; — 119; — 151; — 166; — 167; — 168; — 170; — 171

Conversion — 51

Apostasy — 51

Make-up performance (qaḍāʾ) — 51; — 57; — 59; — 172; — 204

Timely performance (adāʾ) — 51; — 57

Causes and signs — 54; — 55; — 60

Contracts — 56

Repetition (iʿāda) — 57

Menstruation — 57; — 195

Travel — 57; — 58

Illness — 57; — 58

Karkhī, al- — 58; — 107

Ellipsis — 58

Concession (rukhṣa) — 58; — 60

Zakāt — 58; — 173; — 195; — 38; — 214; — 38; — 214

Bāqillānī, al- (the Qāḍī) — 59

Original requirement (ʿazm) — 60

Necessity — 60; — 166

Earlier revealed law — 62; — 145

Qurʾānic readings — 64; — 121

Expiations — 64; — 219

Basmala — 64

Ambiguity — 65

Sunna — 66; — 71; — 117

Reports (akhbār) — 66; — 67; — 68; — 69; — 70; — 71; — 72; — 73

Textual explicitness (naṣṣ) — 67; — 151; — 155; — 157; — 166

Dāwūd al-Ẓāhirī — 69; — 181

Tacit approval (iqrār) — 72; — 102; — 150; — 226; — 227; — 227

Syllogism — 75

Existence — 75

Practice of Medina — 77; — 138; — 138

Widespread need (ʿumūm al-balwā) — 77, 112; — 113

Mass transmission (tawātur) — 78; — 131; — 133

Solitary reports — 79; — 80; — 81; — 81; — 82

Transmitters — 80; — 83; — 85; — 85; — 93; — 129; — 233

Testimony — 81, 83, 95; — 85; — 92; — 106

Generality — 82; — 135; — 142; — 169; — 170; — 174; — 175; — 177; — 178; — 190; — 225; — 228

Probity (ʿadāla) — 86; — 87; — 87; — 88; — 90; — 91; — 98

Disposition — 86

Sinlessness — 87

Unknown transmitters — 88; — 89; — 111

Fāṭima bint Qays — 88

Crescent sighting — 89

Interpretive wrongdoing — 91, 99; — 92

Khārijites — 91

Nabīdh — 92

Preference (tarjīḥ) — 93; — 96; — 230; — 256; — 256; — 257

Narrator criticism (jarḥ) — 94; — 96

Attestation (taʿdīl) — 94; — 95; — 96; — 97

Conflicting evidence — 96; — 107; — 246; — 247

Silence — 97; — 137

ʿUthmān — 99

Truthfulness — 102

Authorization (ijāza) — 103; — 104

Written transmission — 104; — 105; — 105

Authenticity — 104

Taqlīd — 105; — 110; — 133; — 144; — 230; — 248; — 249; — 250; — 251; — 252; — 255

Bukhārī, al- — 105; — 233

Additional wording (ziyāda) — 108

Translation — 109; — 110

Substitution (ibdāl) — 109; — 154; — 165; — 186; — 191; — 212; — 213; — 216; — 221

Synonymy — 109

Al-Zarkashī — 110

Mursal reports — 111

Musnad reports — 111

Touching the penis — 112

Collective obligation — 113; — 145; — 250; — 253

Contradiction — 113; — 247

Prophetic teaching — 113; — 148

Time — 115; — 128; — 204

Jurist — 116

Whole and part — 117

Identity — 118

Penalties — 118; — 124; — 219

Sacrificial meat — 119

Private consultation — 119

Temporary marriage — 120

ʿĀshūrāʾ — 120

Stoning verse — 121

Bequests — 121, 124

Qibla — 123; — 204

Specification (takhṣīṣ) — 126; — 135; — 172; — 173; — 179; — 181; — 182; — 183; — 225

Muʿādh — 126

Chronology — 126; — 129; — 181; — 258; — colophon

Community — 131; — 132; — 134; — 135

Error — 132

Lost reports — 136

Fear or awe — 137

Ṣāʿ measure — 138

Political coercion — 138

Probable indications — 138

Absence of evidence — 141

Proof — 141

Claimant and defendant — 141

Presumption of continuity (istiṣḥāb) — 142

Change of attributes — 142

Umm walad — 142

Infallibility — 144

Juristic preference (istiḥsān) — 146

Welfare reasoning (istiṣlāḥ) — 146

Benefit (maṣlaḥa) — 146; — 213; — 217; — 217; — 224

Understood import (mafhūm) — 149; — 193; — 256

Intelligible meaning (maʿqūl) — 149

Prophetic action — 150; — 226; — 228; — 229; — 229; — 229

Indeterminate wording (mujmal) — 151; — 155; — 160; — 174

Apparent meaning (ẓāhir) — 151; — 155; — 166; — 224

Requests (ṭaliba) — 152; — 197

Equivocation (ishtirāk) — 153; — 158; — 161; — 168; — 177; — 201

Transfer (istiʿāra) — 153; — 162; — 164; — 165

Legal terminology — 153; — 163

Figurative usage (majāz) — 154; — 180

Assertions — 156; — 196

Pronouns — 157; — 158

Divine unity — 157

Qurʾ — 158

Dower — 158; — 160; — 223

Guardian — 158; — 171; — 56; — 146; — 171

Clarification (bayān) — 159; — 160; — 161; — 162; — 163

Speaker and addressee — 161; — 162

Cow of the Israelites — 163

Indirect expression (kināya) — 164; — 167

Touching women — 167; — 177

Justice — 167

Divine attributes — 168

Negation — 170; — 211

Definite article — 170

Slave women — 171

Emancipation contract (kitāba) — 171

Vows — 172

Irrigation — 173

Occasion of revelation or report — 176

Water — 176

Legal convention — 177; — 199

Gender — 178

Slavery and emancipation — 178; — 216

Plural — 179; — 180

Dual — 180

Sībawayh — 180

Evidence — 182; — 241; — 244

Exception (istithnāʾ) — 183; — 184; — 184; — 185; — 186; — 187; — 188

Genus — 184

Poetry — 185

Qurʾānic quotations — 185

Conversation — 186

Conjunction wāw — 187

False accusation (qadhf) — 187

Oath expiation — 187

Marriage — 189; — 194; — 219; — 18; — 28; — 56; — 146; — 160; — 171; — 223

Contrary implication — 189; — 194; — 195; — 195; — 195; — 195

Specific expressions — 190; — 191

Parents — 191; — 215

Booty — 191; — 215

Garlic — 191

Silver vessels — 191

Ribā — 191; — 218

Omission (ḥadhf) — 193; — 194

Clientage (walāʾ) — 195

Supplication — 197

Speech — 198

Threat — 200

Ordinary usage — 200

Hunting — 203

Restriction — 203

Sufficiency (ijzāʾ) — 205

Acts — 206

Book structure — 207; — 256; — 258

Effective ground (ʿilla) — 210; — 212; — 218; — 220; — 222

Nonexistence — 211

Cats — 212

Gold and silver vessels — 212

Indeterminacy — 214; — 218; — 228; — 241

A fortiori indication — 215

Mālik — 217

Legislation — 217

Ranking — 218

Abū Ḥanīfa — 219

Sales — 219; — 167; — 218; — 256; — 167; — 218; — 256

Testing and division — 220; — 221; — 225

Concomitance — 220; — 222; — 222

Revelation — 223

Wine drinking — 223

Prophet — 227; — 249

Ḥudaybiyya — 229

Mujtahid — 231; — 231; — 232; — 233; — 234; — 235; — 236; — 250

Memory — 232

Hadith collections — 233

Muslim — 233

Faith — 235

Derived rulings — 235

Correctness and error — 237; — 238; — 239; — 241; — 242; — 243; — 244; — 245

Discourse — 239

Impossible obligation — 240

Sophistry — 241

Forgetfulness — 243

Culpability — 244

Mercy — 245

Caution — 246

Ghusl — 246

Trust — 249

Livelihood — 250

Expertise — 251

School affiliation — 252; — 254

Innovation — 252

Cases — 253

Schools — 253

Legal practice — 254

Manuscript voices — colophon

Bidāya applications — 18; — 23; — 28; — 38; — 43; — 47; — 55; — 56; — 58; — 64; — 146; — 158; — 160; — 167; — 171

Purification from ritual impurity — 23; — 43; — 158

Interdiction — 55

Offences and injuries — 211; — 243

Compensation — 211; — 243

Blocking the means — 217

Cross-edition concordance: 258 to 311

Editorial alignment of paragraph openings and ends: some old sections group several new sections, some successive old sections belong to one new section. Scores are mechanical estimates, not manuscript testimony.

R §	BA §§	Arabic p.	French p.	R section heading
1	1	118	119	Purpose, brevity, and the craft of legal reasoning
2	2	118	119	Three kinds of knowledge: belief, action, and rules of inquiry
3	3	120	121	Why later jurists need an explicit method
4	4	120	121	Implicit competence and induction from early legal opinions
5	5	120	121	The four parts of the discipline
6	5–7	120	121	The proper subject of uṣūl and a comparative method
7	8	122	123	Retaining al-Ghazālī’s arrangement
8	9	122	123	The introductory questions a learner needs
9	10	122	123	Why the logical prolegomenon is omitted
10	11	124	125	Definition, divisions, elements, and manifestation of rulings
11	12–14	124	125	Revealed judgement and intrinsic or relational goodness
12	15	126	127	Why general acceptance does not establish rational necessity
13	16–17	126	127	The obligation to inquire and the challenge to revealed authority
14	18	126	127	An objection from infinite regress
15	19	126	127	Miracles, assent, and necessary knowledge
16	20	128	129	The status of acts before revelation
17	21–24	128	129	The five rulings and the distinction between farḍ and wājib
18	25	130	131	Obligations with alternatives and extended times
19	26	130	131	Alternative duties, welfare, and divine foreknowledge
20	27	132	133	Legal examples suffice without resolving the metaphysics
21	28–29	132	133	When does an extended-time obligation become binding?
22	29	132	133	Intention distinguishes postponement from abandonment
23	30–31	134	135	Necessary means and the minimum sufficient performance
24	32	134	135	From definitions to universal questions
25	33	134	135	Death during the time and reasonable postponement
26	34	136	137	Abrogation of obligation and the logic of opposites
27	35	136	137	Is the permissible commanded or legally burdensome?
28	36–37	136	137	Can one act be obligatory and forbidden in different respects?
29	38	138	139	Prohibitive wording versus a qualified prohibition’s meaning
30	38	138	139	A methodological objection to the placement of the question
31	39–40	140	141	Forbidden places of prayer and prayer on usurped land
32	41	140	141	Does a ruling about an act determine its contrary?
33	41	140	141	Legal contrariety versus physical incompatibility

R §	BA §§	Arabic p.	French p.	R section heading
34	42	142	143	When prohibiting one contrary obliges the other
35	43	142	143	Conclusion of the classification of rulings
36	44	142	143	The three elements of a legal judgement
37	45	142	143	Divine authority and delegated human obedience
38	46–48	142	143	Understanding the address: children and impaired reason
39	48	144	145	A defective reading about partial intoxication
40	48	144	145	Addressing the sober about later intoxication
41	49	144	145	Eternal command and the limits of the present discipline
42	50	146	147	Puberty as a practical legal sign
43	51	146	147	The voluntary act and intention of obedience
44	51–53	146	147	Choice, necessary assent, and the will to obey
45	54–55	148	149	Human agency and the impossibility of burdens beyond capacity
46	56	148	149	Further questions concerning responsible action
47	57–58	148	149	Coercion, intention, and degrees of harm
48	59	150	151	Active restraint and mere non-performance
49	60–61	150	151	Commands before fulfilment of their conditions
50	62	152	153	Legal conditions are not conditions of physical possibility
51	63	152	153	Conversion, apostasy, and a distinct command to make up acts
52	64	154	155	No demand to combine or abandon exhaustive contraries
53	64–66	154	155	Hard cases: usurped fields and unavoidable injury
54	67	156	157	Manifesting causes and the attributes of rulings
55	68	156	157	Legal signs and perceptible causes
56	69–70	156	157	Validity in worship and the validity of contracts
57	71–72	158	159	Timely performance, repetition, and making up
58	73	160	161	The traveller’s fast: concession or an alternative duty?
59	74	160	161	Does an expectation of death shorten the prescribed time?
60	75	160	161	Original requirements and concessions under necessity
61	76	162	163	The first part concluded
62	77	164	165	The four sources and original negation
63	78	164	165	Divine speech and the bounds of theological inquiry
64	79–81	164	165	The Qur’ānic corpus, variant additions, and the basmala
65	82–84	166	167	Literal, figurative, arabicized, and ambiguous expressions
66	85	168	169	The authority of the Sunna and the routes of transmission
67	86	168	169	First rank: explicit attestation of direct hearing
68	87	170	171	Second rank: “The Messenger said”
69	88	170	171	Third rank: reporting a command rather than its wording
70	89	170	171	How linguistic usage is established

R §	BA §§	Arabic p.	French p.	R section heading
71	90	172	173	Fourth rank: “We were commanded” and “It is Sunna”
72	91	172	173	Fifth rank: practices in the Prophet’s lifetime
73	92	172	173	The reporting formulas concluded
74	93	172	173	The degrees of assent yielded by transmission
75	94–95	172	173	Recurrent transmission: certainty without a fixed number
76	96–97	174	175	How premises produce assent, even when unarticulated
77	97–98	174	175	Sensory actuality, contextual evidence, and common legal knowledge
78	99	178	179	The conditions of certainty from mass transmission
79	100	178	179	Can a solitary report ever produce certainty?
80	101	178	179	Four questions governing solitary reports
81	102–104	178	179	The rational and legal warrant for acting on a solitary report
82	105–106	182	183	Does the command to warn establish the duty to accept a report?
83	107–108	184	185	One transmitter need not satisfy the numerical rules of testimony
84	109	184	185	Hearing in childhood and transmitting after puberty
85	110–111	186	187	Accurate retention, religious identity, and transmission
86	112	186	187	Probity as a disposition rather than a mere label
87	112	186	187	How much moral integrity must a transmitter possess?
88	113	186	187	Unknown character and the presumption of trustworthiness
89	113	186	187	The Bedouin’s crescent testimony and an uncertain printed reading
90	114	188	189	Probity aims at probable truthfulness, not an arbitrary threshold
91	115	188	189	Wrongdoing based on interpretation and the acceptance of reports
92	115	188	189	Probable wrongdoing: the example of disputed nabīdh
93	116	190	191	Minimum conditions differ from grounds of preference
94	117	190	191	Four questions about criticism and attestation
95	117	190	191	How many people must attest a narrator’s probity?
96	118	190	191	Stating grounds and resolving conflicting evaluations
97	119	190	191	What conduct counts as an attestation of probity?
98	120	192	193	The majority position on the Companions’ probity
99	121	192	193	The civil wars and interpretive error
100	122	194	195	Five levels of receiving a report
101	123	194	195	Hearing the teacher read
102	124	194	195	Reading before a silent teacher
103	125	194	195	Authorization without a reading
104	126	194	195	Handing over a book with permission to transmit it
105	127	196	197	Handwriting, accurate copies, and acting without direct hearing
106	128–129	196	197	The narrator’s certainty is not the recipient’s probability
107	130	198	199	When a teacher denies or forgets a report

R §	BA §§	Arabic p.	French p.	R section heading
108	131	198	199	An addition reported by one reliable narrator
109	132	200	201	Reporting meaning: synonymy and translation
110	133–134	200	201	Why an independent jurist needs the Lawgiver’s wording
111	135	202	203	Omitted links, connected chains, and “from” formulae
112	136	204	205	Solitary reports concerning matters of widespread need
113	137	204	205	Neither universal acceptance nor universal rejection is justified
114	138	206	207	Both Qur’ān and Sunna are subject to abrogation
115	139	206	207	Does abrogation remove a ruling or reveal its time limit?
116	140–141	208	209	What the jurist needs to know about abrogation
117	142	208	209	Removing a part, a condition, or a recommended observance
118	143	208	209	When an addition changes the identity of an obligation
119	144	210	211	Abrogation without a substitute
120	145	210	211	Replacing a lighter duty with a heavier one
121	146	210	211	Abrogating recitation, ruling, or both—and the demand for proof
122	147	212	213	Consensus reveals earlier abrogation but cannot itself abrogate
123	148	212	213	The unequal force of reports during and after the Prophet’s life
124	149	214	215	May mass-transmitted Sunna abrogate the Qurʾān?
125	149	214	215	Certainty itself can admit degrees
126	150–151	216	217	Analogy may clarify a text but may not repeal it
127	152	216	217	A Companion’s assertion of abrogation needs a transmitted basis
128	153	218	219	Conditions implicit in the definition of abrogation
129	154	218	219	How the later of two conflicting texts is established
130	156	218	219	Consensus as certainty beyond surviving explicit texts
131	157	220	221	Cumulative scriptural evidence for the authority of consensus
132	158	222	223	Why consensus is not merely a rational inference from numbers
133	159	222	223	Why lay agreement adds no independent proof
134	160	222	223	All qualified jurists of one age, not every age
135	161	222	223	Can later agreement override an earlier disagreement?
136	162	224	225	Why the Ẓāhirīs restrict consensus to the Companions
137	163–164	224	225	Unanimity, majority, and the evidential limits of silence
138	165	226	227	Medinan practice must be traced as transmission
139	166	228	229	Must an agreeing generation die out before consensus binds?
140	167	228	229	The essential account is enough to understand further objections
141	168	228	229	Original freedom from liability and the burden of proof
142	169–170	230	231	Five forms of continuity and the problem of a changed subject
143	171	230	231	Conclusion of the four sources
144	172	232	233	A Companion’s opinion attracts weight but is not infallible

R §	BA §§	Arabic p.	French p.	R section heading
145	173	232	233	Earlier revealed laws are not an independent source
146	174	232	233	Preference and welfare require a recognized legal warrant
147	175	234	235	Conclusion of Part Two
148	176	236	237	The distinctive task: understanding prophetic indications
149	176	236	237	Verbal form and intelligible import
150	176	236	237	Action and approval as nonverbal indications
151	177	236	237	Four classes of verbal indication
152	178	236	237	Simple expressions, compounds, and complete utterances
153	179–181	238	239	Original assignment, transfer, and specialized legal usage
154	182	240	241	Omission, addition, and substitution in figurative speech
155	182	240	241	Clarity and obscurity arise from meaning as well as form
156	183	240	241	A classification useful for legal inference
157	184	240	241	Unambiguous expressions and determinate pronoun reference
158	185	240	241	Equivocation: qur’, ‘ayn, and the marriage bond
159	186	242	243	Clarification encompasses every valid means of understanding
160	187–188	242	243	May clarification be delayed when action is required?
161	189	242	243	How speakers rely on context and hearers seek clarification
162	190	244	245	A figurative meaning needs an intelligible indication
163	191–194	246	247	Partial knowledge can precede a more specific explanation
164	196	250	251	Transfer through resemblance, relation, and indirect expression
165	197	250	251	Substituting a universal for a particular, or the reverse
166	198–199	250	251	Why apparent meanings bind and interpretation needs proportionate proof
167	200–202	252	253	Three degrees: clothing, the balance, and touching women
168	203	254	255	Established usage, ambiguity, and certain interpretation
169	204	254	255	General meaning is a real feature of language
170	205–206	256	257	Forms of generality and their unequal apparent force
171	207	256	257	A remote restriction of the guardian-permission report
172	208	256	257	Restricting the requirement of a nightly fasting intention
173	209	258	259	Does the tithe report include vegetables?
174	210	258	259	General wording with a known or unknown specific intention
175	211	258	259	Disputed boundaries of generality
176	212	258	259	A particular occasion does not confine a general answer
177	213	260	261	Equivocation is not the generality of a universal
178	214	260	261	Who is included by “people” and by a masculine plural?
179	215	260	261	Can a plural be restricted below its minimum?
180	216	260	261	Three is the normal plural; two or one requires a clue
181	217–218	262	263	Specification or contradiction? The importance of chronology

R §	BA §§	Arabic p.	French p.	R section heading
182	219	264	265	Specific evidence can govern without a known chronological order
183	220	264	265	Why an exception must accompany its statement
184	221	264	265	Connected and disconnected exceptions; one or several sentences
185	222	264	265	How can an exception belong to another genus?
186	223	266	267	A disconnected exception belongs to the understood wider meaning
187	224	268	269	How far does an exception reach over coordinated clauses?
188	225	268	269	An exception larger than the remainder
189	226	268	269	Unqualified and qualified wording in the same or different contexts
190	227	270	271	From general to specific expressions
191	228–233	270	271	Specific expressions may stand for an intended universal
192	234	274	275	From verbal form to understood meaning
193	235	274	275	Context determines the force of an implied meaning
194	236–239	274	275	Omitted meanings: villagers, marriage, fasting, and a prayer cycle
195	240–241	276	277	Description, condition, restriction, and endpoint
196	242	278	279	From assertions to prescriptions
197	243	278	279	Command, request, and supplication depend on the relation of speakers
198	244	280	281	Questions about obligation, timing, and repetition
199	244	280	281	Linguistic convention and legal usage must be distinguished
200	245–247	280	281	The imperative’s legal force must be learned from revelation
201	247–248	282	283	Neither timing nor repetition follows from the form alone
202	249	282	283	Further questions about command forms
203	250	284	285	A command after prohibition may merely remove the restriction
204	251	284	285	Does making up a timed observance need a new command?
205	252	284	285	Compliance discharges a duty only when all its conditions are met
206	253	286	287	Does prohibition entail invalidity?
207	253	286	287	Returning to the earlier account of the forbidden
208	254	286	287	Absolute prohibition and dislike: the need for an indication
209	255	286	287	From commands to the contextual indications called qiyās
210	256–257	288	289	The jurists’ definition of analogy: original, derivative and ground
211	258	288	289	Nonexistence, negation and the scope of the definition
212	259–260	290	291	Most legal qiyās is substitution within an understood meaning
213	261	290	291	What warrants substitution: relevant contextual indications
214	262	292	293	Certain, probable and indeterminate extensions
215	263	292	293	The stronger case: a fortiori indication
216	264	292	293	Equal extension: the legal meaning beyond a named individual
217	265–266	292	293	Suitable grounds, recognised goods and the limit of legislation
218	267	294	295	Resemblance and uncertainty about the operative ground

R §	BA §§	Arabic p.	French p.	R section heading
219	268–269	296	297	Analogy in fixed penalties and expiations
220	269	296	297	Testing, division and concomitance
221	270	296	297	Eliminating candidates for the universal meaning
222	271	296	297	Positive and negative concomitance are not enough
223	272–273	298	299	Why much juristic qiyās is not a syllogism
224	273	298	299	Meaning can be apparent without an apparent verbal form
225	274	300	301	The disputed claim of Companion consensus on qiyās
226	275	300	301	The class and limits of qiyās; action and approval remain
227	276	302	303	What tacit approval establishes
228	277	302	303	Actions that explain a revealed command
229	278–279	302	303	Peculiar, unexplained and conflicting Prophetic actions
230	281	306	307	Inquiry, authority and weighing evidence
231	282	306	307	The jurist, the question and the act of inquiry
232	283	306	307	How much Qur’ānic knowledge is required?
233	284	306	307	Hadith competence, collections and transmitter evaluation
234	285	308	309	Consensus and the indispensable knowledge of Arabic
235	286	308	309	Theology and detailed fiqh: what is actually required?
236	287	308	309	Issue-specific independent inquiry
237	288	310	311	Is there a determinate ruling to be found?
238	289	310	311	Essential attributes, Ẓāhirī restraint and determinate rulings
239	290	310	311	Ibn Rushd’s answer: discourse determines the ruling
240	291–292	312	313	Al-Ghazālī’s first argument for universal correctness
241	293	312	313	Evidence signifies; inclination does not make a ruling
242	294	314	315	Al-Ghazālī’s second argument: absence of sin
243	295	314	315	An error can be pardoned without becoming correct
244	296	314	315	Degrees of culpability and the clarity of evidence
245	297	316	317	Attainable truth and merciful pardon
246	298	316	317	Conflict: suspension, caution or free choice?
247	299	318	319	The Ẓāhirī response: return to original nonliability
248	300	318	319	From independent inquiry to following authority
249	301	318	319	Trust, probability and following the Prophet
250	302	318	319	Why juristic expertise is a collective obligation
251	303–304	320	321	May a mujtahid follow a more knowledgeable jurist?
252	305	322	323	Memorised school doctrine is not an independent source
253	306	322	323	Why inherited opinions cannot replace living inquiry
254	307	324	325	No period should lack an active mujtahid
255	308	324	325	The valid and invalid uses of following authority

R §	BA §§	Arabic p.	French p.	R section heading
256	309	324	325	Why an exhaustive catalogue of preferences is unnecessary
257	310	326	327	The obligation to follow the stronger judgement
258	311	326	327	An abridgement completed and supplemented: 552 AH